

SGA 2: Local Cohomology and Lefschetz Theorems

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Introduction

We present here, in a revised and completed form, a photo-offset reissue of the second Séminaire de Géométrie Algébrique of the Institut des Hautes Études Scientifiques, held in 1962 (mimeographed).

The reader is referred to the Introduction to the first of these Séminaires (cited below as SGA 1) for the aims that these seminars pursue and their relations with the *Éléments de Géométrie Algébrique*.

The text of Exposés I through XI was written up at the time, from my oral lectures and handwritten notes, by a group of auditors comprising I. Giorgiutti, J. Giraud, Mlle M. Jaffe (now Mme M. Hakim), and A. Laudal. These notes were originally regarded as provisional and intended for very limited circulation, pending their absorption into the EGA (an absorption that has by now become problematic, to say the least, just as for the other parts of the SGA). As stated in the avertissement of the original edition, this “confidential” character of the notes was supposed to excuse certain “weaknesses of style”, which are doubtless more manifest in the present SGA 2 than in the other Séminaires. I have tried as far as possible to remedy this in the present reissue, by a relatively close revision of the original text. In particular, I have harmonized the numbering systems for statements used across the various Exposés by introducing everywhere the same decimal system, which had already been used in most of the original Exposés of SGA 2, as well as in all the other parts of the SGA. This led me, in particular, to rework entirely the numbering¹ of statements in Exposés III through VIII (and, consequently, of references to those Exposés).² I have also tried to extirpate from the original text the principal errors of typing or syntax (which were numerous and distracting). In addition, Mme M. Hakim kindly agreed to rewrite Exposé IV in a less telegraphic style than the original. As in the other reissues of the SGA, I have likewise added a certain number of footnotes, either to give additional references or to indicate the state of a question on which progress has been made since the original text was written. Finally, this Séminaire has been augmented by a new Exposé, namely Exposé XIV, written by Mme Michèle Raynaud in 1967, which takes up and completes suggestions contained in the “Comments on Exposé XIII” (XIII 6) (written in March 1963). That Exposé takes up Lefschetz-type theorems from the viewpoint of étale cohomology, using the results on étale cohomology expounded in SGA 4 and SGA 5 (to appear in the same Series in Pure Mathematics);³ it is, on that account, less “elementary” in nature than the other Exposés of the present volume, which scarcely use more than the substance of Chapters I through III of EGA.

¹N.D.E. The original numbering has been preserved as far as possible, adding the adverb *bis* where ambiguous duplicates appeared here and there.

²It goes without saying that all references to SGA 2 that appear in the parts of the SGA published in the Series in Pure Mathematics will refer to the present volume, and not to the original edition of SGA 2!

³N.D.E. In fact, these seminars are published by Springer (numbers 269, 279, 305, and 589), but, unfortunately, are out of print.

Here is a sketch of the contents of the present volume.

Exposé I contains the sorites of the “cohomology with supports in Y ”, $H_Y^\bullet(X, F)$, where Y is a closed subset of a space X — a cohomology that can be interpreted as a cohomology of X modulo the open set $X - Y$, and that is the abutment of a most useful “local-to-global spectral sequence” I 2.6, involving sheaves of cohomology “with supports in Y ”, $\mathcal{H}_Y^\bullet(F)$.⁴ This formalism can play, in many questions, a role of “localization” analogous to the one played in differential geometry by the consideration of “tubular” neighborhoods of Y . Exposé II studies the preceding notions in the case of quasi-coherent sheaves on preschemes; Exposé III gives their relation with the classical notion of depth (III 3.3).

Exposés IV and V give notions of local duality, which one may compare with Serre’s projective duality theorem (XII 1.1); let us note that these two types of duality theorems are substantially generalized in Hartshorne’s seminar (cited in a footnote at the end of Exposé IV).⁵

Exposés VI and VII give some easy technical notions, used in Exposé VIII to prove the finiteness theorem (VIII 2.3), which gives necessary and sufficient conditions, for a coherent sheaf F on a noetherian scheme X , in order that the local cohomology sheaves $\mathcal{H}_Y^i(F)$ be coherent for $i \leq n$ (or equivalently, that the sheaves $R^i f_*(F|_{X-Y})$ be coherent for $i \leq n-1$, where $f : X - Y \rightarrow X$ is the inclusion). This theorem is one of the central technical results of the Séminaire, and we show in Exposé IX how a theorem of this nature can be used to establish a “comparison theorem” and an “existence theorem” in formal geometry, by tracing and generalizing the use made in (EGA III §§ 4 and 5) of the finiteness theorem for a proper morphism.

These last results are applied in X and XI, devoted respectively to Lefschetz-type theorems for the fundamental group and for the Picard group.

These theorems consist in comparing, under certain conditions, the invariants (π_1 or Pic) attached respectively to a scheme X and to a subscheme Y (playing the role of a hyperplane section), and in giving in particular conditions under which they are isomorphic. Roughly speaking, the hypotheses made serve to pass from Y to the formal completion of X along Y , and to be able to apply afterwards the results of IX to pass from there to an open neighborhood U of Y in X . To pass from U to X , one needs additional information (“purity” or “parafactoriality” type) for the local rings of X at the points of $Z = X - U$, (which is a finite discrete set in the cases envisaged). This explains the interaction in the proofs of

⁴N.D.E. The underlined notations for the sheafified versions of functors have been preserved, the calligraphic analogue of Γ not being clear. (In the present translation, the sheafified $\mathcal{H}_Y^\bullet(F)$ is rendered with a script-H to disambiguate, and the corresponding underlined section functor is kept as Γ_Z .)

⁵N.D.E. Hartshorne’s book contains sign errors and, more importantly, does not really prove the compatibility of the trace with base change. Conrad has completely redone this work, proving this crucial and highly non-trivial compatibility (*Grothendieck duality and base change*, Lecture Notes in Math. **1750**, Springer-Verlag, Berlin, 2000). Unfortunately, errors remain (cf. two preprints: Conrad B., *Clarifications and corrections to “Grothendieck duality and base change”*, and *An addendum to Chapter 5 of “Grothendieck duality and base change”*). For a more concrete aspect, with particular attention to the notion of residue, see the works of Lipman, in particular (Lipman J., *Dualizing sheaves, differentials and residues on algebraic varieties*, Astérisque **117**, Société Mathématique de France, 1984). A categorical proof of the duality theorem, based on Brown’s representability theorem, has been obtained by Neeman (Neeman A., *The Grothendieck duality theorem via Bousfield’s techniques and Brown representability*, J. Amer. Math. Soc. **9** (1996), no. 1, pp. 205–236).

Exposés X, XI, XII between local and global results, in particular in certain inductions. The principal results obtained in X and XI are the theorems of local nature X 3.4 (purity theorem) and XI 3.14 (parafactoriality theorem). One should note that these theorems are proved by cohomological techniques, of essentially global nature. In XII one obtains, using the preceding local results, the global variants of these results for projective schemes over a field, or more generally over a more or less arbitrary base scheme; among the typical statements, let us point out XII 3.5 and XII 3.7.

In XIII, we review some of the many problems and conjectures suggested by the results and methods of the Séminaire. The most interesting are perhaps those concerning the cohomological and homotopical Lefschetz-type theorems for complex analytic spaces, cf. XIII pages 26 and following.⁶ In the context of the étale cohomology of schemes, the corresponding conjectures are proved in XIV by a duality technique that should apply equally in the complex analytic case (cf. the comments XIII p. 25 and XIV 6.4). But the corresponding homotopical statements in the case of analytic spaces (and more particularly the statements involving the fundamental group) seem to require entirely new techniques (cf. XIV 6.4).

I am happy to thank all those who, in various capacities, have helped in the appearance of the present volume, among them the collaborators already cited in this Introduction. In particular, I wish to thank Mlle Chardon for the good grace with which she has discharged the thankless task of preparing the final manuscript materially for photo-offset.

Bures-sur-Yvette, April 1968.

A. Grothendieck.

SGA 2: Local Cohomology of Coherent Sheaves and Local and Global Lefschetz Theorems

Séminaire de Géométrie Algébrique du Bois-Marie, 1962.

A seminar directed by Alexander Grothendieck (compiled by a group of auditors), augmented by an Exposé of Mme Michèle Raynaud.

A new updated edition of volume 2 of the *Advanced Studies in Pure Mathematics*, published in 1968 by North-Holland Publishing Company.

Preface

The present text is a new updated edition of the book *Cohomologie locale des faisceaux cohérents et théorèmes de Lefschetz locaux et globaux* (SGA 2), *Advanced Studies in Pure Mathematics* 2, North-Holland Publishing Company, Amsterdam, 1968, by A. Grothendieck *et al.* It is the second part of the SGA project initiated by B. Edixhoven, who prepared a new edition of SGA 1. This version is meant to reproduce the original text, with some modifications, including minor typographical corrections and footnotes from the editor (*N.D.E.*)

⁶*N.D.E.* Essentially all the conjectures stated in XIII and XIV are now proved; see the footnotes of these sections for references and commentary.

explaining the current status of questions raised in the first edition. Some additional detail has also been given for certain proofs. To avoid possible confusion, the original footnotes are numbered using stars, while the new ones are numbered using integers. The page numbers of the original version are written in the margin of the text.

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Exposé I. Global and local cohomological invariants with respect to a closed subspace

1. The functors Γ_Z, Γ_Z

Throughout this Exposé we write Γ_Z for the sheafified section-with-support functor (underlined in the original source) and Γ_Z for the global one.

Let X be a topological space, and let C_X be the category of abelian sheaves on X . Let Φ be a family of supports in the sense of Cartan; one defines the functor Γ_Φ on C_X by:

$\Gamma_\Phi(F) =$ subgroup of $\Gamma(F)$ formed by the sections f such that $\text{support } f \in \Phi$.

If Z is a closed part of X , we designate by abuse of language by Γ_Z the functor Γ_Φ , where Φ is the set of closed parts of X contained in Z . Hence one has:

$\Gamma_Z(F) =$ subgroup of $\Gamma(F)$ formed by the sections f such that $\text{support } f \subset Z$.

We wish to generalize this definition to the case where Z is a locally closed part of X , hence closed in a suitable open part V of X . In this case we shall set:

$$\Gamma_Z(F) = \Gamma_Z(F|V).$$

It must be verified that $\Gamma_Z(F)$ “does not depend” on the open set chosen. It suffices to show that if V' , with $V \supset V' \supset Z$, is an open set, then the map $\rho_{V'}^V : F(V) \rightarrow F(V')$ maps $\Gamma_Z(F|V)$ isomorphically onto $\Gamma_Z(F|V')$. Now

$$\Gamma_Z(F|V) = \ker \rho_{V-Z}^V,$$

so if $f \in \Gamma_Z(F|V)$ and if $\rho_{V'}^V(f) = \rho_{V-Z}^V(f) = 0$, then $f = 0$, since $(V', V - Z)$ is a covering of V . Likewise, if $f' \in \Gamma_Z(F|V')$, then $f' \in F(V')$ and $0 \in F(V - Z)$ define an $f \in F(V)$ such that $\rho_{V'}^V(f) = f'$, $f \in \Gamma_Z(F|V)$; hence $\rho_{V'}^V$ induces an isomorphism $\Gamma_Z(F|V) \rightarrow \Gamma_Z(F|V')$.

Note that every open set W of Z is induced by an open set U of X in which W is closed. It follows that $W \mapsto \Gamma_W(F)$ defines a presheaf on Z , and one verifies that this is a sheaf, which we shall denote $i^!(F)$, where $i : Z \rightarrow X$ is the canonical immersion. One finds:

$$\Gamma_Z(F) = \Gamma(i^!(F)).$$

The sheaf $i^!(F)$ is a subsheaf of $i^*(F)$; indeed, the canonical homomorphism

$$\Gamma(F|U) = \Gamma(U, F) \rightarrow \Gamma(U \cap Z, i^*(F))$$

is injective on $\Gamma_{U \cap Z}(F|U) \subset \Gamma(F|U)$. Summarizing, we have the following result:

Proposition.

There exists a unique subsheaf $i^!(F)$ of $i^*(F)$ such that, for every open set U of X such that $U \cap Z$ is closed in U ,

$$\Gamma(F|U) = \Gamma(U, F) \rightarrow \Gamma(U \cap Z, i^*(F))$$

induces an isomorphism $\Gamma_{U \cap Z}(F|U) \rightarrow \Gamma(U \cap Z, i^!(F))$.

Note that if Z is open, one will simply have

$$i^!(F) = i^*(F) = F|Z, \Gamma_Z(F) = \Gamma(Z, F).$$

Suppose again that Z is arbitrary. Then, for U a variable open set of X , one sees that

$$U \mapsto \Gamma_{\{U \cap Z\}}(F|U) = \Gamma(U \cap Z, i^!(F))$$

is a sheaf on X , which we shall denote $\Gamma_Z(F)$; more precisely, by the preceding formula (expressing that $i^!$ commutes with restriction to open sets) one has an isomorphism

$$\Gamma_Z(F) = i_*(i^!(F))$$

by definition, one has, for every open set U of X ,

$$\Gamma(U, \Gamma Z(F)) = \Gamma_{U \cap Z}(F|_U).$$

Let us note here a characteristic difference between the case where Z is closed and the case where Z is open. In the first case, formula (8) shows us that $\Gamma Z(F)$ can be regarded as a subsheaf of F , and one thus has a canonical immersion

$$\Gamma Z(F) \hookrightarrow F.$$

In the case where Z is open, on the contrary, one sees from (6) that the right-hand side of (8) is $\Gamma(U \cap Z, F)$, so receives $\Gamma(U, F)$, hence one has a canonical homomorphism in the opposite direction from the previous one:

$$F \longrightarrow \Gamma Z(F),$$

which is moreover none other than the canonical homomorphism⁷

$$F \longrightarrow i_* i^* (F),$$

taking into account the isomorphism

$$\Gamma Z(F) \simeq i_* i^* (F)$$

deduced from (6) and (7).

Of course, for F variable, $\Gamma_Z(F)$, $\Gamma Z(F)$, $i^!(F)$ may be considered as functors in F , with values respectively in the category of abelian groups, of abelian sheaves on X , and of abelian sheaves on Z . It is sometimes convenient to interpret the functor

$$i^! : C_X \longrightarrow C_Z$$

as the right adjoint of a well-known functor

$$i_! : C_Z \longrightarrow C_X$$

defined by the following proposition:

Proposition.

Let G be an abelian sheaf on Z . Then there exists a unique subsheaf of $i_*(G)$, say $i_!(G)$, such that, for every open set U of X , the (identity) isomorphism

⁷N.D.E. The original reference was (8).

$$\Gamma(U \cap Z, G) = \Gamma(U, i_*^*(G))$$

defines an isomorphism

$$\Gamma_{\{\Phi_{U \cap Z, U}\}}(U \cap Z, G) = \Gamma(U, i_*^*(G)),$$

where $\Phi_{U \cap Z, U}$ denotes the set of parts of $U \cap Z$ that are closed in U .

The verification reduces to noting that the left-hand side is a sheaf for U variable, i.e. that the property, for a section of $i_*(G)$ on U considered as a section of G on $U \cap Z$, of having support closed in U is of local nature on U . The sheaf $i_!(G)$ just defined is also known under the name: sheaf deduced from G by extension by 0 outside Z , cf. [Godement]. In particular, if Z is closed, one has

$$i_!(G) = i_*(G);$$

but in the general case, the canonical injection $i_!(G) \rightarrow i_*(G)$ is not an isomorphism, as is already well known for Z open. Evidently, $i_!(G)$ depends functorially on G (and is even an exact functor in G). This said, one has:

Proposition.

There exists an isomorphism of bifunctors in G, F (G an abelian sheaf on Z , F an abelian sheaf on X):

$$\text{Hom}(i_*(G), F) = \text{Hom}(G, i^!(F)).$$

To define such an isomorphism, it amounts to the same to define functorial homomorphisms $i_! i^!(F) \rightarrow F, G \rightarrow i^! i_*(G)$,

satisfying the well-known compatibility conditions (cf. for example Shih's exposé in the Cartan seminar on cohomological operations).

Recalling that $i_!$ is exact, hence transforms monomorphisms into monomorphisms, one concludes:

Corollary.

If F is injective, $i^!(F)$ is injective, hence $\Gamma Z(F) = i_* i^!(F)$ is also injective.

Replacing X by a variable open set U of X , one also concludes from 1.3:

Corollary.

One has an isomorphism functorial in F, G :

$$\mathcal{H}om(i_*(G), F) = i_*^*(\mathcal{H}om(G, i^!(F))).$$

Taking for G the constant sheaf on Z defined by $\mathbb{Z}$, say $\mathbb{Z}_Z$, 1.3 and 1.5 specialize into

Corollary.

One has isomorphisms functorial in F :

$$\Gamma_Z(F) = \text{Hom}(\mathbb{Z}_{Z,X}, F), \Gamma_Z(F) = \mathcal{H}om(\mathbb{Z}_{Z,X}, F),$$

where $\mathbb{Z}_{Z,X} = i_!(\mathbb{Z}_Z)$ is the abelian sheaf on X deduced from the constant sheaf on Z defined by $\mathbb{Z}$, by extension by 0 outside Z .

Remark.

Suppose that X is a ringed space, and equip Z with the sheaf of rings $O_Z = i^{-1}(O_X)$; finally, denote by C_X and C_Z the category of Modules on X , resp. Z . Then the preceding considerations extend word for word, taking F to be a Module on X and G a Module on Z , and interpreting accordingly statements 1.3 to 1.6.

To finish these generalities, let us examine what happens when one changes the locally closed part Z . Let $Z' \subset Z$ be another locally closed part, and let

$$j: Z' \rightarrow Z, \quad i': Z' \rightarrow X, \quad i' = i \circ j$$

be the canonical inclusions. Then one has functorial isomorphisms:

$$(i \circ j)^! = j^! \circ i^!, \quad (i \circ j)_! = i_! \circ j_!.$$

The first isomorphism (13) defines a functorial isomorphism

$$\Gamma_{-}[Z'](F) = \Gamma(Z', (i \circ j)^!(F)) \simeq \Gamma(Z', j^!(i^!(F))) = \Gamma_{-}[Z'](i^!(F)).$$

Suppose now that Z' is closed in Z , and let

$$Z'' = Z - Z'$$

be its complement in Z , which is open in Z , hence locally closed in X . The canonical inclusion (8') applied to $i^!(F)$ on Z equipped with Z' defines, thanks to (14), an injective functorial canonical homomorphism

$$\Gamma_{Z'}(F) \longrightarrow \Gamma_Z(F).$$

If in (14) one replaces Z by Z'' and uses (8''), one finds a functorial canonical homomorphism:

$$\Gamma_Z(F) \longrightarrow \Gamma_{Z''}(F).$$

Proposition.

Under the preceding conditions, the sequence of functorial homomorphisms

$$0 \longrightarrow \Gamma_{Z'}(F) \longrightarrow \Gamma_Z(F) \longrightarrow \Gamma_{Z''}(F)$$

is exact. If F is flasque, the sequence remains exact when one puts a zero on the right.

Proof. Replacing X by an open set V in which Z is closed, one reduces to the case where Z is closed, hence Z' is closed. Then Z'' is closed in the open set $X - Z'$, and one has a canonical inclusion

$$\Gamma_{-}[Z''](F) \rightarrow \Gamma(X - Z', F),$$

and the exactness of (16) simply means that the sections of F with support in Z' are those whose restriction to $X - Z'$ is zero.

When F is flasque, every element of $\Gamma_{Z''}(F)$, considered as a section of F on $X - Z'$, can be extended to a section of F on X , and the latter will evidently have its support in Z , which proves that the last homomorphism in (16) is then surjective.

Corollary.

One has a functorial exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \Gamma Z'(F) \rightarrow \Gamma Z(F) \rightarrow \Gamma Z''(F),$$

and if F is flasque, this sequence remains exact when one puts a 0 on the right.

One may interpret (1.8) in terms of results on the functors Hom and $\mathcal{H}om$ via 1.6, in the following way. Let us first note that if G is an abelian sheaf on Z , inducing the sheaves $j^*(G)$ and $k^*(G)$ on Z' resp. Z'' (where $j : Z' \rightarrow Z$ and $k : Z'' \rightarrow Z$ are the canonical injections), one has a canonical exact sequence of sheaves on X :

$$0 \rightarrow k^*(G)_X \rightarrow G_X \rightarrow j^*(G)_X \rightarrow 0,$$

where, to simplify the notation, the subscript X designates the sheaf on X obtained by extending by 0 in the complement of the space of definition of the sheaf in question. The exact sequence (17) generalizes a well-known exact sequence in the case $Z = X$ (cf. [Godement]), and is moreover deduced from the latter by writing the exact sequence in question on Z , and applying the functor $i_!$. Taking $G = \mathbb{Z}_Z$, one concludes in particular:

Proposition.

Under the preceding conditions, one has an exact sequence of abelian sheaves on X :

$$0 \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_{Z'',X} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_{Z,X} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_{Z',X} \rightarrow 0.$$

This being so, the two exact sequences 1.8 and 1.9 are nothing other than the exact sequences deduced from (18) by application of the functor $\text{Hom}(-, F)$ resp. $\mathcal{H}om(-, F)$.

This gives an evident proof of the fact that the sequences (16) and (16 bis) remain exact when one puts a zero on the right, provided that F is injective.

2. The functors $H_Z^*(X, F)$ and $\mathcal{H}_Z^*(F)$

Definition.

One denotes by $H_Z^*(X, F)$ and $\mathcal{H}_Z^*(F)$ the derived functors in F of the functors $\Gamma_Z(F)$ resp. $\Gamma_Z(F)$.

These are cohomological functors, with values in the category of abelian groups resp. in the category of abelian sheaves on X . When Z is closed, $H_Z^*(X, F)$ is, by definition, nothing other than $H_\Phi^*(X, F)$ where Φ denotes the family of closed parts of X contained in Z . When Z is open, we shall see that $H_Z^*(X, F)$ is nothing other than $H^*(Z, F) = H^*(Z, F|_Z)$, thanks to the following proposition.

Proposition (Excision Theorem).

Let V be an open part of X containing Z . Then one has an isomorphism of cohomological functors in F :

$$H^*_Z(X, F) \rightarrow H^*_Z(V, F|_V).$$

Indeed, one has a functorial isomorphism $\Gamma_Z^X \simeq \Gamma_Z^V j^!$, where $j : V \rightarrow X$ is the inclusion, and where $j^!$ is thus the restriction functor (cf. (14)). This last is exact, and transforms injectives into injectives by 1.4, whence the isomorphism (19) at once.

When Z is open, one may take $V = Z$ and one finds:

Corollary.

Suppose Z open; then one has an isomorphism of cohomological functors:

$$H^*_Z(X, F) = H^*(Z, F).$$

One concludes from isomorphisms 1.6 and from the definitions (cf. [Tôhoku]):

Proposition.⁸

One has isomorphisms of cohomological functors:

$$H^*_Z(X, F) \simeq \text{Ext}^*(X; \mathbb{Z}_{\{Z, X\}}, F),$$

$$\mathcal{H}_Z^*(F) \simeq \mathcal{E}xt^*(\mathbb{Z}_{Z, X}, F).$$

One may therefore apply the results of [Tôhoku] on the Ext of Modules. Let us first point out the following interpretation of the sheaves $\mathcal{H}_Z^*(F)$ in terms of the global groups $H_Z^*(X, F)$:

Corollary.

$\mathcal{H}_Z^*(F)$ is canonically isomorphic to the sheaf associated to the presheaf

$$U \mapsto H^*_{Z \cap U}(U, F|_U).$$

⁸N.D.E. The proposition bears the number 2.3 in the original edition.

In particular, using corollary 2.3, one finds:

Corollary.

Suppose Z open; then one has an isomorphism of cohomological functors:

$$\mathcal{H}^*_Z(F) = R^* i_* i^*(F)$$

(where $i : Z \rightarrow X$ is the inclusion).

The spectral sequence of Ext gives the important spectral sequence:

Theorem.

One has a spectral sequence functorial in F , abutting to $H^*(X, F)$ and with initial term

$$E_2^{p,q}(F) = H^p(X, \mathcal{H}_Z^q(F)).$$

Remarks.

It follows at once from 2.4 that the sheaves $\mathcal{H}_Z^q(F)$ are zero in $X - Z$, and also zero in the interior of Z for $q \neq 0$ (so for such a q , $\mathcal{H}_Z^q(F)$ is even supported on the boundary of Z).

Consequently, the right-hand side of (23) may be interpreted as a cohomology group on Z . We shall use 2.6 in the case where Z is closed in X , in which case the right-hand side of (23)⁹ may be interpreted as a cohomology group computed on Z :

$$E_2^{p,q}(F) = H^p(Z, \mathcal{H}_Z^q(F)).$$

Let us also note that when Z is open, the spectral sequence 2.6 is nothing other than the Leray spectral sequence for the continuous map $i : Z \rightarrow X$, taking into account the interpretation 2.5 in the calculation of the initial term of the Leray spectral sequence.

Let us return to the exact sequence (18);¹⁰ it gives rise to an exact sequence of Ext (cf. [Tôhoku]):

Theorem.

Let Z be a locally closed part of X , Z' a closed part of Z , and $Z'' = Z - Z'$. Then one has an exact sequence functorial in F :

$$\begin{aligned} 0 \rightarrow H^0_{-Z'}(X, F) \rightarrow H^0_{-Z}(X, F) \rightarrow H^0_{-Z''}(X, F) \xrightarrow{\partial} H^1_{-Z'}(X, F) \rightarrow H^1_{-Z}(X, F) \dots \\ \dots H^i_{-Z'}(X, F) \rightarrow H^i_{-Z}(X, F) \rightarrow H^i_{-Z''}(X, F) \xrightarrow{\partial} H^{i+1}_{-Z'}(X, F) \dots \end{aligned}$$

Let us recall how this exact sequence can be obtained. Let $C(F)$ be an injective resolution of F ; then the exact sequence (18)¹¹ gives rise to the exact sequence

⁹N.D.E. The equation was numbered (23) in the original edition.

¹⁰N.D.E. The original reference was (1.10).

¹¹N.D.E. See preceding note.

$$0 \longrightarrow \Gamma_{Z'}(C(F)) \longrightarrow \Gamma(C(F)) \longrightarrow \Gamma_{Z''}(C(F)) \longrightarrow 0,$$

(which is nothing other than the one defined in 1.8). One concludes an exact sequence of cohomology, which is nothing other than (24).

The most important case for us is the one where Z is closed (and one can moreover always reduce to it by replacing X by an open set V in which Z is closed). Then Z' is closed, Z'' is closed in the open set $X - Z'$, and one may write

$$H^i_{Z''}(X, F) = H^i_{Z''}(X - Z', F|_{X-Z'}),$$

which allows us to write the exact sequence (24) in terms of cohomologies with support in a given closed set. The most frequent case is the one where $Z = X$. Setting then, for simplification, $Z' = A$, one finds:

Corollary.

Let A be a closed part of X . Then one has an exact sequence functorial in F :

$$0 \longrightarrow H^0_A(X, F) \longrightarrow H^0(X, F) \longrightarrow H^0(X - A, F) \xrightarrow{\partial} H^1_A(X, F) \dots$$

$$\dots H^i_A(X, F) \longrightarrow H^i(X, F) \longrightarrow H^i(X - A, F) \xrightarrow{\partial} H^{i+1}_A(X, F) \dots$$

This exact sequence shows that the cohomology group $H^i_A(X, F)$ plays the role of a relative cohomology group of $X \bmod X - A$, with coefficients in F . It is on this account that it was introduced naturally in applications. By “sheafifying” (24) and (27), or by proceeding directly, one finds, taking into account that the sheaf associated to $U \mapsto H^i(U, F)$ is zero if $i > 0$:

Corollary.

Under the conditions of 2.8, one has an exact sequence functorial in F :

$$\dots \mathcal{H}^i_{Z'}(F) \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_Z(F) \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_{Z''}(F) \xrightarrow{\partial} \mathcal{H}^{i+1}_{Z'}(F) \dots$$

Corollary.

Let A be a closed part of X ; then one has an exact sequence functorial in F :

$$0 \longrightarrow \mathcal{H}^0_A(F) \longrightarrow F \longrightarrow f_* (F|_{X-A}) \xrightarrow{\partial} \mathcal{H}^1_A(F) \longrightarrow 0,$$

and canonical isomorphisms, for $i \geq 2$:

$$\mathcal{H}^i_A(F) = \mathcal{H}^i_{i-1}(X-A)(F) = R^{i-1} f_* (F|_{X-A}),$$

where $f : (X - A) \rightarrow X$ is the inclusion.

This therefore defines $\mathcal{H}^0_A(F)$ and $\mathcal{H}^1_A(F)$ respectively as the kernel and cokernel of the canonical homomorphism

$$F \longrightarrow f_* f^*(F) = f_* (F|_{X-A}),$$

and the $\mathcal{H}^i_A(F)$ ($i \geq 2$) in terms of the derived functors of f_* .

Corollary.

Let F be an abelian sheaf on X . If F is flasque, then for every locally closed part Z of X and every integer $i \neq 0$, one has $H_Z^i(X, F) = 0$, $\mathcal{H}_Z^i(F) = 0$. Conversely, if for every closed part Z of X one has $H_Z^1(X, F) = 0$, then F is flasque.

Suppose that F is flasque; then F induces a flasque sheaf on every open set, so to prove $H_Z^i(X, F) = 0$ for $i > 0$, one may suppose Z closed, and then the assertion follows from the exact sequence (27).¹² One concludes, for every locally closed Z , by “sheafifying”, i.e. applying 2.4, that $\mathcal{H}_Z^i(F) = 0$ for $i > 0$. Conversely, suppose $H_Z^1(X, F) = 0$ for every closed Z ; then the exact sequence (27)¹³ shows that for every such Z , $H^0(X, F) \rightarrow H^0(X - Z, F)$ is surjective, which means that F is flasque.

Combining 2.6 and 2.8, we shall deduce from them:

Proposition.

Let F be an abelian sheaf on X , Z a closed part of X , $U = X - Z$, N an integer. The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) $\mathcal{H}_Z^i(F) = 0$ for $i \leq N$.
- (ii) For every open set V of X , considering the canonical homomorphism

$$H^i(V, F) \rightarrow H^i(V \cap U, F),$$

this homomorphism is:

- a) bijective for $i < N$,
- b) injective for $i = N$.

(When $N > 0$, one may in (ii) restrict to requiring a)).

To prove (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii), one is reduced, thanks to the local nature of the $\mathcal{H}_Z^i(F)$, to proving the

Corollary.

If condition 2.13 (i) is satisfied, then

$$H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(U, F)$$

is bijective for $i < N$, injective for $i = N$.

Indeed, by virtue of the exact sequence (27), this also means $H_Z^i(X, F) = 0$ for $i \leq N$, and this relation is an immediate consequence of the spectral sequence (23 bis).¹⁴

Conversely, hypothesis 2.13 (ii) means that for every open set V of X , one has

$$H^i_{\{Z \cap V\}}(V, F|_V) = 0 \text{ for } i \leq N,$$

which implies 2.13 (i) thanks to 2.4. If moreover $N > 0$, hypothesis b) is superfluous. Indeed, if $N = 1$, hypothesis a) and (28) ensure the vanishing of $\mathcal{H}_Z^i(F) = 0$ for $i \leq N$.

¹²N.D.E. The original reference was (2.9).

¹³N.D.E. The original reference was (2.9).

¹⁴N.D.E. See preceding note.

If $N > 1$, hypothesis a) for $i = N - 1 > 0$ and (29) ensure the vanishing of $\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{Z}}^i(F)$ for $i \leq N$.

Taking 2.11 into account, this further proves 2.13 (i)...

Remark.

Let $Y \rightarrow X$ be a closed immersion, and suppose that locally it is of the form $0 \times Y \subset \mathbb{R}^n \times Y$. Suppose that F is a locally constant sheaf on X ; then one finds

$$\mathcal{H}^i_Y(F) \simeq \begin{cases} 0 & \text{if } i \neq n, \\ F \otimes T_{\{Y,X\}} & \text{if } i = n, \end{cases} \quad \text{where } T_{\{Y,X\}} \simeq \mathcal{H}^n_Y(\mathbb{Z}_X)$$

is a sheaf, extension to X of a sheaf on Y locally isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}_Y$, called the “normal orientation sheaf of Y in X ”.

Using the spectral sequence (23 bis),¹⁵ one finds in this case:

$$H^i_Y(X, F) \simeq H^{i-n}(Y, F \otimes T_{\{Y,X\}}),$$

and one recovers the “Gysin homomorphism”:

$$H^j(Y, F \otimes T_{\{Y,X\}}) \rightarrow H^{j+n}(X, F).$$

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Footnotes

Exposé II. Application to quasi-coherent sheaves on preschemes

Proposition.

Let X be a prescheme, let Z be a locally closed subset of the form $Z = U - V$, where U and V are two open subsets of X such that $V \subset U$ and such that the canonical immersions $U \rightarrow X$, $V \rightarrow X$ are quasi-compact. Then for every quasi-coherent Module F on X , the sheaves $\mathcal{H}_{\mathbb{Z}}^i(F)$ are quasi-coherent.

By (I 2.4),¹⁶ there is an exact sequence of relative cohomology

$$\cdots \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^{i-1}_U(F) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_V(F) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_Z(F) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_U(F) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^{i+1}_V(F) \rightarrow \cdots.$$

¹⁵N.D.E. The original reference was 2.6.

¹⁶N.D.E. The references (I 2.4), (I 2.2), (I 2.3), (I 2.7) are the renumbered statements of Exposé I §2 in the 1968 edition; the OCR carries the older bare-number form. The reader should consult the corresponding statements of Exposé I directly.

By (EGA III 1.4.17), in order that the $\mathcal{H}_Z^i(F)$ be quasi-coherent it therefore suffices that the $\mathcal{H}_U^i(F)$ and the $\mathcal{H}_V^i(F)$ be so. We may therefore assume that Z is open and that the canonical immersion $j : Z \rightarrow X$ is quasi-compact.

Since Z is open, we have (I 2.2)¹⁷ a canonical isomorphism

$$\mathcal{H}_Z^i(F) \simeq R^i j_*(F|Z),$$

but j is separated (EGA I 5.5.1) and quasi-compact, hence (EGA III 1.4.10) the $R^i j_*(F|Z) = \mathcal{H}_Z^i(F)$ are quasi-coherent, which completes the proof.

Corollary.

Let Z be a closed subset of X such that the canonical immersion $X - Z \rightarrow X$ is quasi-compact. Then the Modules $\mathcal{H}_Z^i(F)$ are quasi-coherent.

Corollary.

If X is locally noetherian, then for every locally closed subset Z of X and every quasi-coherent Module F on X , the $\mathcal{H}_Z^i(F)$ are quasi-coherent.

This follows immediately from Corollary 2 and (EGA I 6.6.4).

Corollary.

Suppose that X is the spectrum of a ring A , and let U be a quasi-compact open subset of X , $Y = X - U$, and F a quasi-coherent Module on X . There is an isomorphism of cohomological functors in F :

$$\mathcal{H}_Y^i(F) = (H_Y^i(X, F)) .$$

In addition, one has an exact sequence functorial in F :

$$0 \rightarrow H^0_Y(X, F) \rightarrow H^0(X, F) \rightarrow H^0(U, F) \rightarrow H^1_Y(X, F) \rightarrow 0,$$

and isomorphisms functorial in F :

$$H^i_Y(X, F) \simeq H^{i-1}(U, F), \quad i \geq 2.$$

By Corollary 2, the $\mathcal{H}_Y^i(F)$ are quasi-coherent; since X is affine, one therefore has $H^p(X, \mathcal{H}_Y^i(F)) = 0$ for $p > 0$. The spectral sequence (I 2.3)¹⁸ degenerates, hence

$$H_Y^i(X, F) = \Gamma(\mathcal{H}_Y^i(F)).$$

¹⁷N.D.E. The references (I 2.4), (I 2.2), (I 2.3), (I 2.7) are the renumbered statements of Exposé I §2 in the 1968 edition; the OCR carries the older bare-number form. The reader should consult the corresponding statements of Exposé I directly.

¹⁸N.D.E. The references (I 2.4), (I 2.2), (I 2.3), (I 2.7) are the renumbered statements of Exposé I §2 in the 1968 edition; the OCR carries the older bare-number form. The reader should consult the corresponding statements of Exposé I directly.

Equality (4.1) then follows from (EGA I 1.1.3.7); (4.2) and (4.3) follow from the cohomology exact sequence (I 2.7)¹⁹ and from the fact that $H^i(X, F) = 0$ for $i > 0$, since X is affine.

Under the hypotheses of 4,²⁰ U is a finite union of affine open sets X_f ; we can therefore find an ideal I generated by a finite number of elements f_α and defining Y , say $f = (f_\alpha)$. With the notation of (EGA III § 1),²¹ one has:

Proposition.

Suppose that X is the spectrum of a ring A ; let $f = (f_\alpha)$ be a finite family of elements of A , Y the closed subset of X they define, M an A -module, and F the sheaf associated with M . One then has isomorphisms of ∂ -functors in M :

$$H^i((f), M) \simeq H^i_Y(X, F).$$

(We shall also write $H^i_J(M) = H^i_Y(X, F)$, if Y is the closed subset of $X = \text{Spec } A$ defined by an ideal J of A .)

For $i = 0$ and $i = 1$, one uses the exact sequences (4.2) and (EGA III 1.4.3.2); if $i \geq 2$, one uses (4.3) and (EGA III 1.4.3.1). This gives us isomorphisms functorial in M . One verifies that, up to a sign depending only on i , they are compatible with the boundary operator, whence the existence of the isomorphism of ∂ -functors (5.1).

Now let X be a prescheme, Y a closed subset of X , $f : Y \rightarrow X$ the inclusion, and I a quasi-coherent ideal defining Y in X . Let F be a sheaf on X .

We have seen that there exist isomorphisms of ∂ -functors in F

$$\text{Ext}^i_{\{\mathcal{O}_X\}}(X; f_* f^*[-1](\mathcal{O}_X), F) \rightarrow H^i_Y(X, F),$$

$$\mathcal{E}\text{xt}^i_{\{\mathcal{O}_X\}}(f_* f^*[-1](\mathcal{O}_X), F) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_Y(F).$$

Let n, m be integers with $m \geq n \geq 0$; we denote by $i_{n,m}$ the canonical map $\mathcal{O}_{Y_m} = \mathcal{O}_X/I^{m+1} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X/I^{n+1} = \mathcal{O}_{Y_n}$, and by j_n the map

$f_* f^{-1}(\mathcal{O}_X) \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{Y_n}$. The pairs $(\mathcal{O}_{Y_n}, i_{n,m})$ form a projective system, and the j_n are compatible with the $i_{n,m}$.

Applying the functor $\text{Ext}^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(X; \cdot, F)$, one deduces a morphism

$$\phi': \lim_{\rightarrow n} \text{Ext}^i_{\{\mathcal{O}_X\}}(X; \mathcal{O}_{Y_n}, F) \rightarrow \text{Ext}^i_{\{\mathcal{O}_X\}}(X; f_* f^*[-1](\mathcal{O}_X), F);$$

one easily shows that this is a morphism of cohomological functors in F . The morphism

$$\phi: \lim_{\rightarrow n} \text{Ext}^i_{\{\mathcal{O}_X\}}(X; \mathcal{O}_{Y_n}, F) \rightarrow H^i_Y(X, F),$$

¹⁹N.D.E. The references (I 2.4), (I 2.2), (I 2.3), (I 2.7) are the renumbered statements of Exposé I §2 in the 1968 edition; the OCR carries the older bare-number form. The reader should consult the corresponding statements of Exposé I directly.

²⁰N.D.E. For coherence and clarity, only the equations have been numbered in parentheses.

²¹N.D.E. Recall that $H_\bullet(f, M)$ is the Koszul cohomology $H_\bullet(\text{Hom}(K_\bullet(f), M))$ of f (EGA III 1.1.2) with values in M , and that $H_\bullet((f), M)$ is the limit (loc. cit., 1.1.6.5) $\lim_{\rightarrow n} H_\bullet(f^n, M)$, the transition morphisms being induced by the natural morphisms $K_\bullet(f^{n+1}) \rightarrow K_\bullet(f^n)$ (loc. cit., 1.1.6).

obtained by composing φ' with $(*)$, is therefore also a morphism of cohomological functors in F .

One defines in the same way

$$\phi: \lim_{\rightarrow} \text{Ext}^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_Y, F) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_Y(F).$$

We have in view the following theorem:

Theorem.

- a) Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme, Y a closed subset of X defined by a coherent Ideal I , and F a quasi-coherent Module. Then ϕ is an isomorphism.
- b) If X is noetherian, φ is an isomorphism.

Theorem 6 will follow from 6.a) and from:

Lemma.

If the topological space underlying X is noetherian and if ϕ is an isomorphism, then so is φ .

We first prove Lemma 7. We know that there is a spectral sequence

$$H^p(X, \mathcal{H}^q_Y(F)) \Rightarrow H^{p+q}_Y(X, F).$$

On the other hand, we have an inductive system of spectral sequences

$$H^p(X, \text{Ext}^q_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_Y, F)) \Rightarrow \text{Ext}^{p+q}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(X; \mathcal{O}_Y, F).$$

It follows from the definitions of φ and ϕ that these morphisms are associated with a homomorphism Φ of spectral sequences from the direct limit of (7.2n) to (7.1). If the space underlying X is noetherian, then by (Godement 4.12.1)²²

$$\lim_{\rightarrow} H^p(X, \text{Ext}^q_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_Y, F)) \simeq H^p(X, \lim_{\rightarrow} \text{Ext}^q_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_Y, F)),$$

so Φ_2 can be written as a morphism

$$H^p(X, \lim_{\rightarrow} \text{Ext}^q_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_Y, F)) \rightarrow H^p(X, \mathcal{H}^q_Y(F))$$

which is nothing other than the one deduced from ϕ .

If ϕ is an isomorphism, then so is Φ_2 , and consequently so is φ by (EGA 0_III

11.1.5); Lemma 7 is therefore proved.

We shall now prove 6.a); this is a local question on X . By Corollary 4 and (EGA I 1.3.9 and 1.3.12) we may assume that X is the spectrum of a ring A . It therefore suffices to show that, under the hypotheses of Theorem 6.a), the canonical homomorphism

$$\lim_{\rightarrow} \text{Ext}^i_A(A/I^n, M) \rightarrow H^i_Y(X, M)$$

is an isomorphism.

²²Cf. the first bibliographical reference at the end of Exposé I.

Let f_α be a finite number of elements of A generating I , with $f = (f_\alpha)$; the sequence of ideals (f^n) is then decreasing and cofinal with the sequence of I^n , so that (7.3) is equivalent to a morphism of ∂ -functors in M :

$$\lim_{\rightarrow} \text{Ext}_A^i(A/(f^n), M) \rightarrow H^i_Y(X, M).$$

On the other hand, one has canonical isomorphisms

$$\lim_{\rightarrow} \text{Hom}_A(A/(f^n), M) \simeq \lim_{\rightarrow} \{ m \in M \mid (f^n)m = 0 \} \simeq H^0(f, M).$$

Since $\lim_{\rightarrow} \text{Ext}_A^i(A/(f^n), M)$ is a universal ∂ -functor in M , there is a unique morphism of ∂ -functors in M :

$$\lim_{\rightarrow} \text{Ext}_A^i(A/(f^n), M) \rightarrow H^i((f), M),$$

which coincides in degree zero with (7.5).

Since the composite of (7.3) and (5.1) is a morphism of ∂ -functors in M that coincides with (7.6) in degree 0, it coincides with (7.6) in every degree. Theorem 6.a) is therefore an immediate consequence of:

Lemma.

Let A be a noetherian ring, I an ideal generated by a finite system $f = (f_\alpha)$ of elements, and M an A -module. Then the homomorphisms (7.6) are isomorphisms.

Lemma.

Let A be a ring, $f = (f_\alpha)$ a finite system of elements of A , I the ideal generated by f , and $i > 0$ an integer. The following conditions are equivalent:

- a) The homomorphism (7.6) is an isomorphism for every M .
- b) $H^i((f), M) = 0$ for M injective.
- c) The projective system $(H^i(f^n, A)) = H_{i,n}$ is essentially zero, that is: for every n , there exists $n' > n$ such that $H_{i,n'} \rightarrow H_{i,n}$ is zero.
- d) entails b) trivially.
- e) entails a): indeed, b) implies that $M \mapsto H^i((f), M)$ is a universal cohomological functor, so (7.6) is then a morphism of universal cohomological functors. It is an isomorphism in degree zero, hence in every degree.
- f) entails b): indeed, if M is injective, one has for every n

$$H^i(f^n, M) = \text{Hom}(H^i(f^n, A), M) = \text{Hom}(H_{i,n}, M),$$

so c) implies that for every i the inductive system $(H^i(f^n, M))_{n \in \mathbb{Z}}$ is essentially zero, whence b).

- b) entails c). Indeed, let $n > 0$, and let j be a monomorphism of $H_{i,n}$ into an injective module M . Let $n' \geq n$, and let $j_{n'} \in \text{Hom}(H_{i,n'}, M)$ be the composite of j with the transition homomorphism $t_{n',n} : H_{i,n'} \rightarrow H_{i,n}$. The $j_{n'}$ define an element of $H^i((f), M)$, which is zero by hypothesis. There therefore exists n_0 such that $j_{n'} = 0$

for $n' > n_0$. But since j is a monomorphism, $j_{n'} = 0$ entails $t_{n',n} = 0$, whence the proposition.

Corollary.

Suppose that the space underlying $X = \text{Spec}(A)$ is noetherian. In order that the preceding conditions be satisfied for every finite family of elements of A and every $i > 0$ (or equivalently: for $i = 1$), it is necessary and sufficient that for every injective A -module M , the sheaf F associated with M be flasque.

It is necessary: indeed, let $f = (f_\alpha)$ be a finite system of elements of A , let Y be the closed subset defined by f , and $U = X - Y$; one then has the exact sequence

$$H^0(X, F) \rightarrow H^0(U, F) \rightarrow H^1(f, M) \rightarrow 0,$$

and, thanks to 9.b), $H^0(X, F) \rightarrow H^0(U, F)$ is surjective.

It is sufficient by virtue of (5.1) and of the fact that for every closed subset Y of X and every flasque sheaf F on X , $H_Y^i(X, F) = 0$ for $i > 0$.

Lemma.

Under the hypotheses of Lemma 9, for every noetherian A -module N and every $i > 0$, the projective system $(H_{i,n}(N))_{n \in \mathbb{Z}}$, where $H_{i,n}(N) = H^i(f^n, N)$, is essentially zero.

Proof by induction on the number m of elements of f .

If $m = 1$, f reduces to a single element, say f ; then $H_{i,n}(N)$ is zero for $i > 1$, and $H_{1,n}(N)$ is canonically isomorphic to the annihilator $N_{(n)}$ of f^n in N , the transition homomorphism $N_{(n')} \rightarrow N_{(n)}$, $n' \geq n$, being multiplication by $f^{n'-n}$. The $N_{(n)}$ form an increasing sequence of submodules of N , and since N is noetherian there exists n_0 such that $N_{(n)} = N_{(n_0)}$ for $n \geq n_0$. Thus all the $N_{(n)}$ are annihilated by f^{n_0} , and the transition homomorphisms $N_{(n')} \rightarrow N_{(n)}$ are all zero for $n' \geq n + n_0$. The lemma is therefore proved for $m = 1$.

We now assume that $m > 1$ and that the lemma is proved for integers $m' < m$; let then $g = (f_1, \dots, f_{m-1})$ and $h = f_m$.

For every $n > 0$, one has (EGA III 1.1.4.1) an exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow H^0(h^n, H^i(g^n, N)) \rightarrow H^i(f^n, N) \rightarrow H^1(h^n, H^{i-1}(g^n, N)) \rightarrow 0,$$

and, as n varies, a projective system of exact sequences. It follows from the induction hypotheses that for $i > 0$ the $H^i(g^n, N)$ form an essentially zero projective system, and hence so do the $H^0(h^n, H^i(g^n, N))$, which one identifies with quotients of $H^i(g^n, N)$. For the right-hand terms one factors the transition morphisms from n' to n through

$$H^1(h^{n'}, H^{i-1}(g^{n'}, N)) \rightarrow H^1(h^{n'}, H^{i-1}(g^n, N)) \rightarrow H^1(h^n, H^{i-1}(g^n, N)).$$

Since $H^{i-1}(g^n, N)$ is a noetherian module, it follows from the case $m = 1$ that there exists, for given n ,

an $n' > n$ such that the second arrow is zero. We see therefore that in this projective system of exact sequences, the outermost projective systems are essentially zero, and hence so is the middle projective system.

We have thus proved Lemma 11, hence Lemma 8, and consequently Theorem 6.

Remark.

One can also obtain Theorem 6 by establishing the condition of Corollary 10 with the help of the structure theorems for injective modules over a noetherian ring (Matlis, Gabriel).

Exposé III. Cohomological invariants and depth

1. Review

We state a few definitions and results that the reader will find, for example, in Chapter I of the course taught by J.-P. Serre at the Collège de France in 1957–58.²³

Definition.

Let A be a ring (commutative with unit element, as in everything that follows) and let M be an A -module (unitary, as in everything that follows). One calls:

- *annihilator of M* , denoted $\text{Ann } M$, the set of $a \in A$ such that $am = 0$ for every $m \in M$.
- *support of M* , denoted $\text{Supp } M$, the set of prime ideals p of A such that the localization M_p is nonzero.
- “*assassin of M* ” or “*set of prime ideals associated with M* ”, denoted $\text{Ass } M$, the set of prime ideals p of A such that there exists a nonzero element of M whose annihilator is p .

If a is an ideal of A , we shall write $r(a)$ for the radical of a in A , i.e. the set of elements of A some power of which lies in a .

The following results hold under the assumption that A is noetherian and M is finitely generated.

Proposition.

1. $\text{Ass } M$ is a finite set.
2. For an element of A to annihilate a nonzero element of M , it is necessary and sufficient that it belong to one of the ideals associated with M .
3. The radical of the annihilator of M , $r(\text{Ann } M)$, is the intersection of the ideals associated with M that are minimal (for the inclusion relation in $\text{Ass } M$).

²³N.D.E. The reissue of Serre’s text (Serre J.-P., *Algèbre locale. Multiplicités*, course at the Collège de France, 1957–1958, written up by Pierre Gabriel, second edition, *Lect. Notes in Math.*, vol. 11, Springer-Verlag, 1965) no longer contains the proofs of these statements. The reader may consult (Bourbaki N., *Algèbre commutative*, Masson), as Serre himself suggests.

Proposition.

Let p be a prime ideal of A . The following assertions are equivalent:

1. $p \in \text{Supp} M$.
2. There exists $q \in \text{Ass} M$ such that $q \subset p$.
3. $p \supset \text{Ann} M$.
4. (iii bis) $p \supset r(\text{Ann} M)$.

Proposition.

Let N be a finitely generated A -module. One has the formula:

$$\text{Ass Hom}_A(N, M) = \text{Supp } N \cap \text{Ass } M.$$

2. Depth

Throughout this paragraph, A denotes a commutative ring, I an ideal of A , and M, N two A -modules. We write X for the prime spectrum of A (we shall not use its structure sheaf in this paragraph) and Y for the variety of I , $Y = \text{Supp}(A/I) = \{p \in X, p \supset I\}$.

Lemma.

Suppose that A is noetherian and that the modules M and N are finitely generated. Suppose moreover that $\text{Supp} N = Y$. Then the following assertions are equivalent:

1. $\text{Hom}_A(N, M) = 0$.
2. $\text{Supp} N \cap \text{Ass} M = \emptyset$.
3. The ideal I is not a zero divisor on M , meaning that for every $m \in M$, $Im = 0$ implies $m = 0$.
4. There exists an M -regular element in I . (An element a of A is said to be M -regular if multiplication by a on M is injective.)
5. For every $p \in Y$, the maximal ideal pA_p of the local ring A_p is not associated with M_p . In symbols: $pA_p \notin \text{Ass} M_p$.

Proof.

- (i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii), since $\text{Ass Hom}_A(N, M) = \emptyset$ is equivalent to (ii) by Proposition 1.3, and to (i) by an easy consequence of Proposition 1.2.
- (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (ii) by contradiction: “there exists $p \in \text{Supp} N \cap \text{Ass} M$ ” entails that $p \supset I$ and that there exists $m \in M$ whose annihilator is p , hence $Im \subset pm = 0$, contradicting (iii).
- (iii) $\Rightarrow$ (iii) trivially.
- (iv) $\Leftrightarrow$ (iv), since $\text{Supp} N = Y$, so (ii) says that I is contained in no ideal associated with M , or equivalently (since the ideals associated with M are prime and finite in number) that I is not contained in the union of the ideals associated with M . But by Proposition 1.1 (ii) this union is exactly the set of elements of A that are not M -regular.
- (v) $\Rightarrow$ (v): indeed, if $\text{Hom}_A(N, M) = 0$ and if $p \in Y$, one deduces, by virtue of the formula

$$\text{Hom}_A(N, M)_p = \text{Hom}_{\{A_p\}}(N_p, M_p),$$

that $\text{Hom}_{A_p}(N_p, M_p) = 0$, hence, thanks to Proposition 1.3,

$$\text{Supp } N_p \cap \text{Ass } M_p = \emptyset;$$

but $pA_p \in \text{Supp } N_p$, so $pA_p \notin \text{Ass } M_p$.

- (v) $\Rightarrow$ (i): indeed, if $p \in \text{Ass } M$, there exists $m \in M$ whose annihilator is p , so the canonical image of m in M_p is nonzero, and its annihilator is an ideal containing p , hence containing pA_p , hence equal to pA_p . The ideal pA_p is therefore associated with M_p , so $p \notin Y$ by (v), whence (i). QED

We shall now work with these conditions, replacing the functor Hom by its derived functors.

Theorem.

Let A be a commutative ring, I an ideal of A , M an A -module. Let n be an integer.

- a) If there exists a sequence $f_1, \dots, f_{n+1}$ of elements of I that is an M -regular sequence (i.e. f_1 is M -regular and f_{i+1} is regular on $M/(f_1, \dots, f_i)M$ for $i \leq n$), then for every A -module N annihilated by a power of I , one has:

$$\text{Ext}_A^i(N, M) = 0 \text{ for } i \leq n.$$

- b) If moreover A is noetherian, M is finitely generated, and there exists a finitely generated A -module N such that $\text{Supp } N = V(I)$ and $\text{Ext}_A^i(N, M) = 0$ for $i \leq n$, then there exists a sequence $f_1, \dots, f_{n+1}$ of elements of I that is M -regular.

Let us prove a) first, by induction. If $n < 0$ the statement is empty.

Suppose $n \geq 0$, and that a) has been proved for $n' < n$. By hypothesis there exists $f_1 \in I$ that is M -regular. Denote by f_1^i multiplication by f_1 on $\text{Ext}_A^i(N, M)$, and by f_1^M multiplication by f_1 on M . The sequence

$$0 \rightarrow M \xrightarrow{f_1^M} M \rightarrow M/f_1 M \rightarrow 0$$

is exact, hence so is the sequence:

$$\text{Ext}_A^{i-1}(N, M/f_1 M) \xrightarrow{\delta} \text{Ext}_A^i(N, M) \xrightarrow{f_1^i} \text{Ext}_A^i(N, M).$$

By hypothesis $I^n N = 0$, so f_1^0 is nilpotent; since Ext_A^i is a universal functor, the same holds for f_1^i for every i . On the other hand, there is a regular sequence in $M/f_1 M$ of length n , so by the induction hypothesis,

$$\text{Ext}_A^{i-1}(N, M) = 0 \text{ if } i \leq n-1.$$

One deduces that if $i \leq n$, then f_1^i is at once nilpotent and injective, hence $\text{Ext}_A^i(N, M) = 0$.

Let us prove b), also by induction. If $n < 0$, the statement is empty.

If $n = 0$, b) follows from the implication (i) $\Rightarrow$ (iv) of Lemma 2.1.

If $n > 0$, by b) for $n = 0$ there exists an element $f_1 \in I$ that is M -regular; from the exact sequence (2.1) one deduces the exact sequence:

$$\text{Ext}^{i-1}_A(N, M) \rightarrow \text{Ext}^{i-1}_A(N, M/f_1 M) \rightarrow \text{Ext}^i_A(N, M).$$

One concludes that the hypotheses of b) are satisfied for the module $M/f_1 M$ and the integer $n-1$. By the induction hypothesis, there exists a sequence of n elements of I that is $M/f_1 M$ -regular, which entails that there exists a sequence of $n+1$ elements of I , beginning with f_1 , that is M -regular.

This theorem invites us to generalize, as follows, the classical definition of the depth of a finitely generated module over a noetherian ring:

Definition.

Let A be a commutative ring with unit, M an A -module, I an ideal of A . One calls the *I*-depth of M , and denotes $\text{prof}_I M$, the supremum in $\mathbb{N} \cup +\infty$ of the set of natural integers n such that for every finitely generated A -module N annihilated by a power of I , one has

$$\text{Ext}^i_A(N, M) = 0 \text{ for every } i < n.$$

One deduces from the previous theorem that if n is the supremum of the lengths of M -regular sequences of elements of I , one has $n \leq \text{prof}_I M$. More precisely:

Proposition.

Let A be a commutative ring, I an ideal of A , M an A -module, and $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Consider the assertions:

1. $n \leq \text{prof}_I M$.
2. For every finitely generated A -module N annihilated by a power of I , one has:

$$\text{Ext}^i_A(N, M) = 0 \text{ for } i < n.$$
3. There exists a finitely generated A -module N such that $\text{Supp} N = V(I)$ and $\text{Ext}^i_A(N, M) = 0$ for $i < n$.
4. There exists an M -regular sequence of length n formed of elements of I .

The following logical implications hold:

$$\begin{array}{c} (1) \iff (2) \\ \downarrow \\ (3) \iff (4) \end{array}$$

Moreover, if A is noetherian and M is finitely generated, these conditions are equivalent.

Proof.

- (1) $\Leftrightarrow$ (2) by definition, and (2) $\Rightarrow$ (3) by taking $N = A/I$. Moreover (4) $\Rightarrow$ (2) by Theorem 2.2 a). Finally, if A is noetherian and M is finitely generated, (3) $\Rightarrow$ (4) by Theorem 2.2 b).

We assume A noetherian and M finitely generated until the end of this paragraph.

Corollary.

Let $f \in I$ be an M -regular element. One has:

$$\text{prof}_I M = \text{prof}_I(M/fM) + 1.$$

Indeed, if $n \leq \text{prof}_I(M/fM)$, there exists a sequence of elements of I , $f_1, \dots, f_n$, that is (M/fM) -regular, so the sequence $f, f_1, \dots, f_n$ is M -regular, hence $n + 1 \leq \text{prof}_I M$, hence $\text{prof}_I M \geq \text{prof}_I(M/fM) + 1$. On the other hand, by the exact sequence (2.2), if $i \leq \text{prof}_I M$ one has $\text{Ext}_A^{i-1}(N, M/fM) = 0$, hence $\text{prof}_I M - 1 \leq \text{prof}_I(M/fM)$.

Corollary.

Every finite M -regular sequence formed of elements of I may be extended to a maximal M -regular sequence, whose length is necessarily equal to the I -depth of M .

Remark.

One can scarcely keep oneself from saying that an A -module is the more beautiful the greater its depth. A module whose support does not meet $V(I)$ is among the most beautiful; indeed, one can show that for $\text{prof}_I M$ to be finite, it is necessary and sufficient that $\text{Supp} M \cap V(I) \neq \emptyset$.

Remark.

If A is a semi-local ring, let $r(A)$ be its radical and $k = A/r(A)$ its residue ring. The interesting notion of depth is obtained by taking for I the radical of A . We shall therefore agree to write simply $\text{prof} M$ for the $r(A)$ -depth of an A -module M . One recovers in this case the notion of *homological codimension* (cf. Serre, op. cit. note ²⁴, p. 21), denoted $\text{codh}_A M$, defined as the infimum of integers i such that $\text{Ext}_A^i(k, M) \neq 0$; indeed $\text{Supp} k = V(r(A))$.

Proposition.

If A is noetherian and M is finitely generated, one has:

$$\text{prof}_I M = \inf_{\{p \in V(I)\}} \text{prof}_{M_p}.$$

Corollary.

If A is a noetherian semi-local ring and M is a finitely generated A -module, one has:

$$\text{prof} M = \inf_m \text{prof}_{M_m},$$

where m ranges over the maximal ideals of A .

The corollary follows at once from Proposition 2.9; indeed, the prime ideals that contain the radical are precisely the maximal ideals.

Moreover, let $f \in I$. If f is M -regular, if $p \in X$ and $p \supset I$, then the image g of f in A_p lies in pA_p , the maximal ideal of A_p ; and g is M_p -regular, as follows from the exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow M_p \xrightarrow{g'} M_p \rightarrow (M/fM)_p \rightarrow 0,$$

²⁴N.D.E. The reissue of Serre's text (Serre J.-P., *Algèbre locale. Multiplicités*, course at the Collège de France, 1957–1958, written up by Pierre Gabriel, second edition, *Lect. Notes in Math.*, vol. 11, Springer-Verlag, 1965) no longer contains the proofs of these statements. The reader may consult (Bourbaki N., *Algèbre commutative*, Masson), as Serre himself suggests.

where g' denotes multiplication by g on M_p . This exact sequence also gives that $(M/fM)_p$ is isomorphic to M_p/gM_p ; applying Corollary 2.5 to M and to M_p , one deduces, by induction, that $\text{prof}_I M \leq \nu(M)$, where one has set, for every M :

$$\nu(M) = \inf\{\text{prof}_I M \mid I \in \mathcal{V}(M)\}$$

More precisely, still by induction, one knows that if f is M -regular, then $\nu(M) = \nu(M/fM) + 1$; it remains therefore to show that if $\nu(M) \geq 1$, there exists an M -regular element in I . But applying Lemma 2.1 to M_p , A_p , and pA_p for each $p \in V(I)$, one sees that $pA_p \notin \text{Ass} M_p$; hence, applying Lemma 2.1 to A , M , and I , the conclusion follows.

Proposition.

Let $u : A \rightarrow B$ be a homomorphism of noetherian rings. Let I be an ideal of A , M a finitely generated A -module. Set $IB = I \otimes_A B$ and $M_B = M \otimes_A B$. If B is A -flat, one has:

$$\text{prof}_I IB \leq \text{prof}_I M;$$

moreover, if B is faithfully flat over A , one has equality.

Indeed, let $N = A/I$. By flatness, $N \otimes_A B = B/IB$; set $N_B = N \otimes_A B$. Again by flatness and the noetherian hypotheses, one has:

$$\text{Ext}_B^i(N_B, M_B) = \text{Ext}_A^i(N, M) \otimes_A B,$$

so $\text{Ext}_A^i(N, M) = 0$ implies $\text{Ext}_B^i(N_B, M_B) = 0$, and the converse holds if B is faithfully flat over A .

3. Depth and topological properties

Lemma.

Let X be a topological space, Y a closed subspace, F a sheaf of abelian groups on X . Set $U = X - Y$. Let n be an integer. The following conditions are equivalent:

1. $H_Y^i(X, F) = 0$ for $i < n$.
2. For every open V of X , the homomorphism of groups
$$H^i(V, F) \rightarrow H^i(V \cap U, F)$$
is bijective for $i < n - 1$ and injective for $i = n - 1$.
3. For every open V of X ,
$$H^i_{Y \cap V}(V, F|_V) = 0 \text{ for } i < n.$$

Proof.

- (ii) $\Leftrightarrow$ (iii): indeed, let V be an open of X , set $X' = V$, $Y' = Y \cap V$, $F' = F|_V$, $U' = X' - Y'$. Then Y' is closed in X' , so one has an exact sequence:

$$H^i_{Y'}(X', F') \rightarrow H^i(X', F') \xrightarrow{\rho^i} H^i(U', F') \rightarrow H^{i+1}_{Y'}(X', F').$$

If the outer terms vanish, the homomorphism ρ^i is bijective; and if the left-hand term vanishes, ρ^i is injective. So (iii) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). Conversely, if $i < n$, then $H_{Y'}^i(X', F')$ vanishes because ρ^i is injective and ρ^{i-1} is surjective.

(i) $\Rightarrow$ (iii): indeed, the “local-to-global” spectral sequence gives:

$$H^p(X, \mathcal{H}^q_Y(X, F)) \Rightarrow H^{p+q}_Y(X, F).$$

Now, by hypothesis $\mathcal{H}^q_Y(X, F) = 0$ for $q < n$, hence $H^{p+q}_Y(X, F) = 0$ for $p + q < n$.

(iii) $\Rightarrow$ (i): indeed, (iii) says that the presheaf

$$V \mapsto H^i_Y(Y \cap V, F|_V)$$

is zero, hence so is the associated sheaf, which is $\mathcal{H}^i_Y(X, F)$, since Y is closed.

Remark.

The equivalence of (i) and (ii) was proved in Proposition I 2.13. As remarked there, if $n \geq 2$, one may omit the condition that ρ^{n-1} be injective.²⁵

Proposition.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme, Y a closed subscheme of X , and F a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. The conditions of Lemma 3.1 are equivalent to each of the following:

1. (iv) For every $x \in Y$, one has $\text{prof} F_x \geq n$.
2. (v) For every coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module G on X whose support is contained in Y , one has

$$\text{Ext}^i_Y(G, F) = 0 \text{ for } i < n;$$

3. (vi) There exists a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module G whose support is equal to Y such that

$$\text{Ext}^i_Y(G, F) = 0 \text{ for } i < n.$$

If X is affine, all the work has been done (cf. Proposition 2.4) to establish the equivalence of the three conditions of Proposition 3.3. These conditions are local, except for the implication (v) $\Rightarrow$ (vi); but in that case one may take $G = \mathcal{O}_Y$ and invoke Proposition 2.4 again. It therefore suffices to prove (i) $\Rightarrow$ (vi) and (v) $\Rightarrow$ (i).

Let J be the ideal of Y : it is a coherent sheaf of ideals. Set $\mathcal{O}_Y^m = \mathcal{O}_X/J^{m+1}$: this is a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module whose support is equal to Y , and one knows (Theorem II 6.b) that

$$\mathcal{H}^i_Y(X, F) = \varinjlim_m \text{Ext}^i_Y(\mathcal{O}_Y^m, F),$$

so (v) $\Rightarrow$ (i). Moreover, the transition morphisms in the projective system of the $\mathcal{O}_Y^m$ are epimorphisms.

If the functor Ext^i is left exact in its first argument — at least when this argument is taken in the category of coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules with support contained in Y — then the transition morphisms of the inductive system obtained by applying Ext^i to the $\mathcal{O}_Y^m$ will be injective; but (i) entails that the limit is zero, so (i) will entail that the modules $\text{Ext}^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_Y^m, F)$ are

²⁵N.D.E. The original edition gave a proof, not entirely correct.

zero for every m . We argue by induction. The statement is trivial for $n < 0$. Suppose (i) $\Rightarrow$ (vi) for $n < q$, then (i) $\Rightarrow$ (v), so, by the long exact sequence of Ext , Ext^q is left exact in its first argument, hence the modules $\text{Ext}_{\mathcal{O}_X}^q(\mathcal{O}_Y^m, F)$ are zero for every m . So (i) $\Rightarrow$ (vi) for $n \leq q$. QED

Example.

Let A be a noetherian local ring, $\mathfrak{m}$ its maximal ideal, M a finitely generated A -module, and n an integer. Set $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, $Y = \mathfrak{m}$, $U = X - Y$. Let F be the sheaf associated with M . The following conditions are equivalent:

1. $\text{prof} M \geq n$.
2. The natural homomorphism
$$H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(U, F)$$
is injective for $i = n - 1$ and bijective for $i < n - 1$.
3. $\text{Ext}_A^i(k, M) = 0$ for $i < n$, where $k = A/\mathfrak{m}$.
4. $H_Y^i(X, F) = 0$ for $i < n$.

Taking Remark 3.2 into account, one obtains:

Corollary.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme, Y a closed subprescheme of X , F a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. The following conditions are equivalent:

1. For every $x \in Y$, $\text{prof} F_x \geq 2$.
2. For every open V of X , the natural homomorphism
$$H^0(V, F) \rightarrow H^0(V \cap (X - Y), F)$$
is bijective.

Theorem (Hartshorne).

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme, Y a closed subprescheme of X . Suppose that, for every $x \in Y$, $\text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \geq 2$; then the natural map

$$\pi_0(X) \rightarrow \pi_0(X - Y)$$

is bijective.

Proof. Since X is locally noetherian, X is locally connected; it therefore suffices to prove that for X to be connected it is necessary and sufficient that $X - Y$ be. Now, for a ringed space in local rings $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ to be connected, it is necessary and sufficient that $H^0(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ not be a direct product of two nonzero rings. But the hypothesis implies, by Corollary 3.5 applied to $F = \mathcal{O}_X$, that the homomorphism

$$H^0(X, \mathcal{O}_X) \rightarrow H^0(X - Y, \mathcal{O}_X)$$

is an isomorphism, whence the conclusion.

Corollary.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme. Let d be an integer such that $\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \geq d$ implies $\text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \geq 2$. Then, if X is connected, X is connected in codimension $d - 1$, i.e. if X' and X'' are two irreducible components of X , there exists a sequence of irreducible components of X :

$$X' = X_0, X_1, \dots, X_n = X''$$

such that for every i with $0 \leq i < n$, the codimension of $X_i \cap X_{i+1}$ in X is at most $d - 1$.

Note first that if X is Cohen-Macaulay, then $d = 2$ enjoys the property invoked above. In this connection, recall that one defines the codimension of Y in X as the infimum of the dimensions of the local rings in X at the points of Y .

Proof. Let $\mathcal{F}$ be the collection of closed subsets of X whose codimension in X is at least d . One notes that $\mathcal{F}$ is an antifilter of closed subsets of X . Moreover, for a closed $Y \subset X$ to belong to $\mathcal{F}$, it is necessary and sufficient that, for every $y \in Y$, there exist an open neighborhood V of y in X such that $Y \cap V$ has codimension $\geq d$ in V . Finally, if X is connected and $Y \in \mathcal{F}$, then $X - Y$ is connected by Hartshorne's theorem. The corollary thus follows from the next lemma, which is of a purely topological nature.

Lemma.

Let X be a connected, locally noetherian topological space, and let $\mathcal{F}$ be an antifilter of closed subsets of X . Suppose that every closed $Y \subset X$ that locally belongs to $\mathcal{F}$ (i.e. for every point $x \in X$ there exist an open neighborhood V of x in X and a $Y' \in \mathcal{F}$ such that $V \cap Y = V \cap Y'$) belongs to $\mathcal{F}$. The following conditions are equivalent:

1. For every $Y \in \mathcal{F}$, $X - Y$ is connected.
2. If X' and X'' are two distinct irreducible components of X , there exists a sequence of irreducible components of X , $X_0, X_1, \dots, X_n$, such that $X' = X_0$, $X'' = X_n$ and, for each i with $1 \leq i < n$, $X_i \cap X_{i+1} \notin \mathcal{F}$.

(ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i). Let $Y \in \mathcal{F}$; we must show that the open set $U = X - Y$ is connected. Now, if U' and U'' are two irreducible components of U , there exist two irreducible components X' and X'' of X such that $X' \cap U = U'$ and $X'' \cap U = U''$. Let $X_0, \dots, X_n$ be a sequence of irreducible components of X having the property invoked above; if one sets $U_i = X_i \cap U$ for $0 \leq i \leq n$, the U_i are irreducible components of U , and moreover $U_i \cap U_{i+1}$ is nonempty for $0 \leq i < n$, since otherwise $X_i \cap X_{i+1} \subset Y$ would be an element of $\mathcal{F}$, contrary to the choice of the sequence of the X_i . This entails that U is connected.

(i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). Let $Y = \bigcup_{X', X''} X' \cap X''$, where one requires X' and X'' to be two distinct irreducible components of X such that $X' \cap X'' \in \mathcal{F}$. The family of the $X' \cap X''$ is locally finite since X is locally noetherian; moreover the $X' \cap X''$ are closed, so Y is closed. Also, Y belongs locally to $\mathcal{F}$, so $Y \in \mathcal{F}$. Hence $U = X - Y$ is connected. Let X' and X'' be two distinct irreducible components of X , and let U' and U'' be their traces on U , which are nonempty by construction of Y . These are irreducible

components of U ; but U is connected, so, U being locally noetherian, there exists a sequence of irreducible components $U_0, \dots, U_n$ of U such that $U_0 = U'$, $U_n = U''$, $U_i \cap U_{i+1} \neq \emptyset$, and $U_i \cap U_{i+1} \neq U_i$ for $0 \leq i < n$. Let $X_0, \dots, X_n$ be the sequence of irreducible components of X such that $X_i \cap U = U_i$; if $X_i \cap X_{i+1} \in \mathcal{F}$, then by the construction of $\mathcal{F}$ one would have $U_i \cap U_{i+1} = \emptyset$ or $U_i = U_{i+1}$, which is impossible by the choice of the U_i . QED

Corollary.

Let A be a noetherian local ring. Suppose that for every prime ideal p of A one has:

$$(\dim A_p \geq 2) \Rightarrow (\text{prof } A_p \geq 2).$$

Suppose moreover that A satisfies the chain condition.²⁶ Then, for every minimal prime ideal p of A , $\dim A/p = \dim A$, or equivalently, all the irreducible components of $\text{Spec } A$ have the same dimension: that of A .

If X' and X'' are two irreducible components of X , one joins them by a chain having the properties enumerated in Corollary 3.7; it then suffices to show that two successive components have the same dimension, which follows from the second hypothesis.

Example.

Let X be the union of two complementary linear subspaces, of respective dimensions 2 and 3, in a vector space of dimension 5; more precisely, let $X = \text{Spec } A$, with $A = B/p \cap q$, where $B = k[X_1, \dots, X_5]$, p is the ideal generated by X_1, X_2, X_3 and q the ideal generated by X_4 and X_5 . Then X can be disconnected by the intersection point x of the two linear subspaces, so the depth of $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is equal to 1, since it cannot be ≥ 2 by Theorem 3.6. Another reason: the equidimensionality conclusion of the previous corollary fails.

More generally, taking a union X of two linear subspaces of dimensions $p, q \geq 2$ in a vector space of dimension $p + q$, for no embedding of X in a regular scheme is X even set-theoretically a complete intersection at the origin: for (possibly modifying it without changing the underlying topological space in a neighborhood of the origin), X would be Cohen-Macaulay, hence of depth ≥ 2 at the origin, which is not the case.

Remark.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme, Y a closed subprescheme of X , F an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module. Depth is a purely topological notion, expressed in terms of the vanishing of the $H_Y^i(X, F)$ for $i < n$. One also wishes to study these sheaves for a given i , or for $i > n$. In this connection one proves the following result:

Lemma.

Let m be an integer. For $H_Y^i(X, F) = 0$, $i > m$, to hold for every coherent F , it is necessary and sufficient that it hold for $F = \mathcal{O}_X$.

By inductive limit, the property then holds for every quasi-coherent sheaf. For instance, if Y can be described locally by m equations, or, as one says, if Y is locally set-theoretically a complete intersection (which occurs for example if X and Y are non-singular), it follows

²⁶Cf. EGA 0_IV 14.3.2.

from the computation of the $H_Y^i(X, F)$ by the Koszul complex that these sheaves are zero for $i > m$. We have, moreover, used this fact implicitly in Example 3.10.

This cohomological condition is, however, not sufficient, as the next example shows.

Example.

Let $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, where A is a normal noetherian local ring of dimension 2. Let Y be a curve in X . One can show that the complement of the curve is an affine open, so²⁷ $H_Y^i(\mathcal{O}_X) \cong H_{X-Y}^{i-1}(\mathcal{O}_X) = 0$ for $i > 1$, since $H^{i-1}(X - Y, \mathcal{O}_X) = 0$. Nevertheless, one can construct a curve that is not described by a single equation.

We shall seek²⁸ conditions for the $H_Y^i(X, F)$ to be coherent for a given i , which is not the case in general, as obvious examples show — for instance $H_m^n(A)$ for A a noetherian local ring of dimension $n > 0$; for example when A is a discrete valuation ring with field of fractions K , one finds $H_m^1(A) \simeq K/A$, which is not a finitely generated module over A . To enlighten the reader, let us say that the problem posed is equivalent to the following: let $f : U \rightarrow X$ be an open immersion, let G be a coherent sheaf on U ; find criteria for the higher direct images $R^i f_* G$ to be coherent sheaves on X for a given i . These conditions are necessary for the use of formal geometry that we saw in Exposé IX and the following ones.

Exposé IV. Dualizing modules and dualizing functors

1. Generalities on module functors

Let

- A be a commutative noetherian ring,
- C the category of A -modules of finite type,
- C' the category of arbitrary A -modules,
- Ab the category of abelian groups.

The aim of this section is the study of certain properties of functors $T : C^\circ \rightarrow \text{Ab}$ (assumed additive). Here C° denotes the opposite category of C .

Note that if $M \in \text{Ob} C$, then $T(M)$ may be canonically endowed with a structure of A -module, defined as follows: if f_M is the homothety of M associated to $f \in A$, then A acts on $T(M)$ by $f_{T(M)}$. In other words, T factors as

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 C^\circ & \xrightarrow{T} & \text{Ab} \\
 \searrow & & \nearrow \\
 T^\circ & & \\
 \searrow & & \nearrow \\
 & C' &
 \end{array}$$

²⁷N.D.E. There was a typo in the original edition.

²⁸Cf. Exp. VIII.

where $C' \rightarrow Ab$ is the canonical functor. In what follows, $T(M)$ will always be considered as endowed with this A -module structure.

Composing with the isomorphism $M \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}_A(A, M)$ the morphism $\text{Hom}_A(A, M) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_A(T(M), T(A))$, one obtains the following morphisms, each deduced from the other in an obvious way:

$$M \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_A(T(M), T(A)), M \times T(M) \longrightarrow T(A), T(M) \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_A(M, T(A)),$$

and this defines a morphism ϕ_T of contravariant functors:

$$\varphi_T : T \rightarrow \text{Hom}_A(-, T(A)).$$

Proposition.

The following two properties are equivalent:

1. ϕ_T is an isomorphism of functors.
2. T is left exact.

The implication (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii) is trivial.

The implication (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i) follows from the fact that, for a morphism $u : F \rightarrow F'$ of two additive left exact functors F and F' from C° to Ab , if $u(A)$ is an isomorphism, then u is an isomorphism (one uses the fact that A is noetherian, hence that every A -module of finite type is of finite presentation).

Remark.

This shows in particular that the representable functors $T : C'^\circ \rightarrow Ab$ are precisely those that commute with arbitrary inverse limits (over a preordered set, not necessarily filtered).

If $\text{Hom}(C^\circ, Ab)_g$ denotes the full subcategory of $\text{Hom}(C^\circ, Ab)$ whose objects are the left exact functors, one has proved the equivalence of categories

$$C' \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}(C^\circ, Ab)_g$$

via the quasi-inverse functors

$$H \mapsto \text{Hom}_A(-, H)$$

and

$$T \mapsto T(A).$$

Now let J be an ideal of A , let $Y = V(J) \subset \text{Spec } A$, and denote by C_Y the full subcategory of C whose objects are the A -modules M of finite type such that $\text{Supp } M \subset Y$. One has

$$C_Y = \bigcup_n C^{(n)},$$

where $C^{(n)}$ is the full subcategory of C_Y consisting of the modules M such that $J^n M = 0$.

Proposition.

With the same notation as above, let $T : C_Y^\circ \rightarrow Ab$ be a functor. To $H = \varinjlim T(A/J^n)$ ²⁹ is associated a natural morphism

$$\varphi_T : T \rightarrow \text{Hom}_A(-, H),$$

and the following conditions are equivalent:

1. ϕ_T is an isomorphism.
2. The functor T is left exact.

Proof. — a) *Definition of ϕ_T .*

Let $M \in \text{Ob} C_Y$. There exists an integer n such that $J^n M = 0$. Then M is an A/J^n -module, and if T_n denotes the restriction of T to $C^{(n)}$, one knows how to define the morphism

$$T_n \rightarrow \text{Hom}_A(-, H_n), \quad \text{where } H_n = T(A/J^n);$$

whence

$$T(M) = T_n(M) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_A(M, \varinjlim H_n) = \text{Hom}_A(M, H)$$

and

$$\varphi_T : T \rightarrow \text{Hom}_A(-, H).$$

b) *Equivalence of (i) and (ii).*

It is clear that (i) implies (ii). Suppose (ii) holds and let $M \in \text{Ob} C^{(n)}$. We have seen that $T_n(M) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}_A(M, H_n)$; hence for every integer $n' > n$ one has

$$T(M) = T_n(M) = T_{n'}(M) = \varinjlim T_n(M),$$

and

$$T(M) = \varinjlim \text{Hom}_A(M, H_n).$$

Since these are filtered direct limits, one also has the isomorphism

$$\varinjlim \text{Hom}_A(M, H_n) \simeq \text{Hom}_A(M, \varinjlim H_n) = \text{Hom}_A(M, H).$$

If C'_Y denotes the category of A -modules with support contained in Y , but not necessarily of finite type, one again has the natural equivalence of categories

$$C'_Y \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}(C_Y^\circ, Ab)_g.$$

Application. — With the same notation, let

²⁹N.D.E. The definition of H is implicit in the original text.

$$T^\bullet : C_Y^\circ \longrightarrow Ab$$

be an exact ∂ -functor. For every $i \in \mathbb{Z}$, set $H_n^i = T^i(A/J^n)$ and $H^i = \varinjlim H_n^i$.

Theorem.

Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. If there exists $i_0 \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $T^i = 0$ for every $i < i_0$, then the following three conditions are equivalent:

1. $T^i = 0$ for every $i < n$.
2. $H^i = 0$ for every $i < n$.
3. There exists a module M_0 in C_Y such that $\text{Supp} M_0 = Y$ and $T^i(M_0) = 0$ for every $i < n$.

Proof. — It is evident that (i) implies (ii) and (iii) (take $M_0 = A/J$).

We show by induction on n that (ii) implies (i). It is true for $n = i_0$; suppose it has been proved up to rank n . Suppose then that $H^i = 0$ for every $i < n + 1$; by the induction hypothesis one has $T^i = 0$ for $i < n$, but $T^{n-1} = 0$ implies that T^n is a left exact functor, and

$$T^n \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}_A(-, H^n) = 0.$$

We now show that (iii) implies (ii). It is again true for $n = i_0$; suppose it has been proved up to rank n . Let M_0 be an A -module in C_Y such that $\text{Supp} M_0 = Y$ and $T^i(M_0) = 0$ for every $i < n + 1$; by the induction hypothesis one then has $H^i = 0$ for every $i < n$; it remains to show that $H^n = 0$. But “ $H^i = 0$ for every $i < n$ ” implies that $T^{n-1} = 0$, and therefore that $T^n \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}_A(-, H^n)$. One then has

$$\text{Ass } H^n = \text{Ass } \text{Hom}(M_0, H^n) = \text{Supp } M_0 \cap \text{Ass } H^n = \text{Ass } H^n,$$

since

$$\text{Ass } H^n \subset \text{Supp } H^n \subset Y = \text{Supp } M_0.$$

Hence $T^n(M_0) = 0 \Leftrightarrow \text{Ass } H^n = \emptyset \Leftrightarrow H^n = 0$; this completes the proof.

2. Characterization of exact functors

The ring A is still assumed noetherian and commutative. The notation is that of Proposition 1.3:

$$Y = V(J), \quad T : C_Y^\circ \longrightarrow Ab, \quad H = \varinjlim T(A/J^n),$$

where we assume that T is a left exact functor, whence

$$T(M) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}_A(M, H).$$

Proposition.

The following properties are equivalent:

1. The functor T is exact.
2. H is injective in C' .

Proof. — It clearly suffices to show that (i) implies (ii), that is, to prove that if the restriction to C_Y of the functor $\text{Hom}_A(-, H)$ is an exact functor, then H is injective. But since A is noetherian, in order to show that H is injective it suffices to prove that every homomorphism $f : N \rightarrow H$ whose source is an A -module N of finite type, a submodule of an A -module M of finite type, extends to a homomorphism $\bar{f} : M \rightarrow H$.

The definition of H and the fact that N is of finite type imply that there exists an integer n such that $J^n \cdot f(N) = 0$. Endow M and N with the J -adic topology. The J -adic topology of N is equivalent to the topology induced by the J -adic topology of M (Krull's theorem). There therefore exists $V = J^k \cdot M$ such that

$$U = V \cap N \subset J^n N.$$

One then has the factorization

$$\begin{array}{ccc} N & \xrightarrow{\quad} & N/U \\ \backslash & & / \\ \backslash & & / \\ f \backslash & & / u \\ \backslash & & / \\ \blacktriangledown & & \blacktriangledown \\ & H & \end{array}$$

with N/U and M/V in C_Y . The hypothesis therefore allows one to extend u to $\bar{u}$:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} N/U & \xrightarrow{\quad} & M/V \\ \backslash & & / \\ \backslash & & / \\ u \backslash & & / \bar{u} \\ \backslash & & / \\ \blacktriangledown & & \blacktriangledown \\ & H & \end{array}$$

and $M \rightarrow M/V \rightarrow H$ gives the desired extension $\bar{f}$.

Corollary.

Let K be an injective A -module. Then the submodule $H_J^0(K)$ of K consisting of the elements annihilated by some power of J is injective.

Proof. — It suffices to verify that the restriction to C_Y of the functor $\text{Hom}_A(-, H_J^0(K))$ is exact. Now let $M \in \text{Ob } C_Y$; there exists k such that $J^k \cdot M = 0$, and the inclusion

$$\text{Hom}_A(-, H_J^0(K)) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_A(M, K)$$

is then an isomorphism. The result follows, since $\text{Hom}_A(-, K)$ is exact.

3. Study of the case where T is left exact and $T(M)$ is of finite type for every M

Let, as above,

$$T : C_Y^\circ \longrightarrow Ab;$$

we now assume that T is left exact and that one has the factorization

$$\begin{array}{ccc} C_Y^\circ & \xrightarrow{T} & Ab \\ \downarrow & \nearrow & \\ C_Y & & \end{array}$$

where, as above, $C_Y \rightarrow Ab$ is the forgetful functor. One can therefore define $T(T(M)) = T \circ T(M)$, and the canonical morphism

$$M \longrightarrow \text{Hom}_A(\text{Hom}_A(M, H), H)$$

defines a morphism

$$M \longrightarrow T \circ T(M).$$

Proposition.

The ring A being still assumed noetherian, if one makes the additional hypothesis that A/J is artinian, the following conditions are equivalent:

1. T is left exact and, for every $M \in \text{Ob}C_Y$, $T(M)$ is of finite type and $M \rightarrow T \circ T(M)$ is an isomorphism.
2. T is exact and, for every residue field k associated to a maximal ideal containing J , one has $T(k) \xrightarrow{\sim} k$.
3. One has $T \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Hom}_A(-, H)$ with H injective, and, for every k as in (ii), one has $\text{Hom}_A(k, H) \xrightarrow{\sim} k$.
4. T is exact and, for every $M \in \text{Ob}C_Y$, one has $\text{long}T(M) = \text{long}M$.

Proof. — We have already shown the equivalence of (ii) and (iii) (Prop. 2.1).

Let us show that (ii) implies (iv): first, if $M \in \text{Ob}C_Y$, then since M is an A/J^n -module with A/J^n artinian, $\text{long} M$ is finite. We argue by induction on the length of M . Condition (iv) holds when $\text{long}M = 1$, because then M is a residue field falling under (ii). If $\text{long}M > 1$, there exists a submodule M' of M with $M' \neq 0$ and $\text{long}M' < \text{long}M$. Form the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow M' \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow M'' \longrightarrow 0.$$

Since T is exact, one has the sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow T(M') \longrightarrow T(M) \longrightarrow T(M'') \longrightarrow 0,$$

and $\text{long } T(M) = \text{long } T(M') + \text{long } T(M'') = \text{long } M' + \text{long } M'' = \text{long } M$.

(ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i): Since (ii) implies (iv), let M be an A -module in C_Y ; one has $\text{long } T(M) = \text{long } M$, hence $T(M)$ is of finite length and therefore of finite type.

It remains to show that $M \rightarrow T \circ T(M)$ is an isomorphism; we again argue by induction on $\text{long } M$. For $M = k$ it is true. In the general case, write the commutative diagram with exact rows

$$0 \longrightarrow M' \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow M'' \longrightarrow 0 \downarrow \downarrow \downarrow 0 \longrightarrow T \circ T(M') \longrightarrow T \circ T(M) \longrightarrow T \circ T(M'') \longrightarrow 0,$$

where M' is a submodule of M with $M' \neq 0$ and $\text{long } M' < \text{long } M$. By the induction hypothesis the outer arrows are isomorphisms, hence

$$M \longrightarrow T \circ T(M)$$

is an isomorphism.

(i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii): Let

$$0 \longrightarrow M' \longrightarrow M \longrightarrow M'' \longrightarrow 0$$

be an exact sequence of A -modules in C_Y , and let Q be the cokernel of $T(M) \rightarrow T(M')$. Applying T to the exact sequence

$$0 \longrightarrow T(M') \longrightarrow T(M) \longrightarrow T(M'') \longrightarrow Q \longrightarrow 0,$$

one obtains

$$0 \longrightarrow T(Q) \longrightarrow T \circ T(M') \longrightarrow T \circ T(M) \xrightarrow{\uparrow \uparrow \cong} M' \longrightarrow M$$

hence $T(Q) = 0$ and $Q \xrightarrow{\sim} T(T(Q)) = 0$.

On the other hand, let k be a residue field, $k = A/\mathfrak{m}$, $J \subset \mathfrak{m}$. One must show that $T(k) \xrightarrow{\sim} k$. For this it suffices to note that $T(k)$ is a k -vector space. One then deduces

$$\begin{aligned} T(k) &\simeq k \oplus V, \\ T(T(k)) &\simeq T(k) \oplus T(V) \simeq k \oplus V \oplus T(V) \simeq k, \end{aligned}$$

whence $V = 0$.

Finally, let us show that (iv) implies (iii): it suffices to show that $T(k) \xrightarrow{\sim} k$. Now $\text{long}T(k) = \text{long}k = 1$, so $T(k) = k'$ is a residue field, and $\text{Supp } k' = \text{Supp } \text{Hom}_A(k, H) \subset \text{Supp } k$. Hence $k \simeq k'$.

Remark.

One can show that condition (iv) is equivalent to the condition

(iv)' For every $M \in \text{Ob}C_Y$, one has $\text{long}T(M) = \text{long}M$.

4. Dualizing module; dualizing functor

Definition.

Let A be a noetherian local ring with maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$. A *dualizing functor* for A is any functor

$$T : C_{\mathfrak{m}}^{\circ} \longrightarrow Ab,$$

where we write $C_{\mathfrak{m}}$ in place of C_Y for $Y = V(\mathfrak{m})$, which satisfies the equivalent conditions of Proposition 3.1. An A -module I is said to be *dualizing* for A if the functor $M \mapsto \text{Hom}_A(M, I)$ is dualizing.

Definition 4.1 can be generalized to the case where A is no longer assumed to be a local ring.

Definition.

Let A be a noetherian ring, and let $\bar{C}$ be the full subcategory of C consisting of the A -modules of finite length. A *dualizing functor* is any A -linear functor T from $\bar{C}^{\circ}$ to $\bar{C}$ which is exact and such that the morphism of functors

$$id \longrightarrow T \circ T$$

is an isomorphism.

We will prove an existence theorem and also that the module I representing such a functor is locally artinian. We will likewise show that, for every maximal ideal $\mathfrak{m}$ of A , the $\mathfrak{m}$ -primary component of the socle of I is of length 1.

Proposition.

Let A and B be two noetherian local rings with maximal ideals $\mathfrak{m}_A$ and $\mathfrak{m}_B$, such that B is a finite A -algebra. Then, if I is a dualizing module for A , $\text{Hom}_A(B, I)$ is a dualizing module for B .

Proof. — Let

$$R : C_{\mathfrak{m}_B} \longrightarrow C_{\mathfrak{m}_A}$$

be the restriction-of-scalars functor; it is exact. Let T be a dualizing functor for A ,

$$T : C_{\mathfrak{m}_A} \longrightarrow Ab;$$

it is exact and, for every $M \in ObC_{\mathfrak{m}_A}$, the natural morphism $M \rightarrow T \circ T(M)$ is an isomorphism; hence $T \circ R$ is a dualizing functor for B . If I represents T , then by the classical formula $\text{Hom}_A(M, I) = \text{Hom}_B(M, \text{Hom}_A(B, I))$, valid for every B -module M , we deduce that $\text{Hom}_A(B, I)$ is a dualizing module for B .

Corollary.

Let A be a noetherian local ring and $\mathfrak{a}$ an ideal of A ; set $B = A/\mathfrak{a}$. If I is a dualizing module for A , then the annihilator of $\mathfrak{a}$ in I is a dualizing module for B .

Lemma.

Let A be a noetherian local ring and I a locally artinian A -module. There is a canonical isomorphism

$$I \simeq \hat{I} = I \otimes_A \hat{A}.$$

Proof. — Let I_n denote the annihilator of $\mathfrak{m}^n$ in I , where $\mathfrak{m}$ is the maximal ideal of A . To say that I is locally artinian is to say that I is the direct limit of the I_n and that these are of finite length. Now the tensor product commutes with direct limits, so one is reduced to the case where I is artinian. In this case I is annihilated by some power of the maximal ideal, say $\mathfrak{m}^k$; therefore for $p \geq k$ one has $I \xrightarrow{\sim} I \otimes_A A/\mathfrak{m}^p$, and hence $I \xrightarrow{\sim} I \otimes_A \hat{A}$, since A is noetherian and I is of finite type.

It follows that the restriction-of-scalars functor from $\hat{A}$ to A and the extension-of-scalars functor induce quasi-inverse equivalences between the category of locally artinian $\hat{A}$ -modules and the category of locally artinian A -modules.

Proposition.

Let A be a noetherian local ring, $\hat{A}$ its completion, and I a dualizing module for A (resp. for $\hat{A}$). Let J be the completion³⁰ of I (resp. the A -module obtained by restriction of scalars). Then J is a dualizing module for $\hat{A}$ (resp. for A). Moreover, the underlying abelian groups of I and J are isomorphic.

Proof. — One simply observes that the equivalence between the category of locally artinian A -modules and the category of locally artinian $\hat{A}$ -modules induces an isomorphism between the bifunctors $\text{Hom}_A(-, -)$ and $\text{Hom}_{\hat{A}}(-, -)$, and that the characterization of a dualizing functor or a dualizing module involves only these bifunctors.

Theorem.

Let A be a noetherian local ring.

³⁰N.D.E. Here one must understand by “the completion of I ” the tensor product $\hat{I} = I \otimes_A \hat{A}$ (cf. Lemma 4.5), namely I endowed with its canonical $\hat{A}$ -module structure, and not the $\mathfrak{m}$ -adic completion. For example, if p is a prime number and $A = \hat{A} = \mathbb{Z}_p$ is the ring of p -adic integers, then the injective envelope of the residue field $k = \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$ is the discrete $\mathbb{Z}_p$ -module $\mathbb{Q}_p/\mathbb{Z}_p$, whose completion for the p -adic topology is zero.

- a) There always exists a dualizing module I .
- b) Two dualizing modules are isomorphic (by a non-canonical isomorphism).
- c) For a module I to be dualizing, it is necessary and sufficient that it be an injective envelope of the residue field k of A .

Remark.

Proposition 4.6 reduces the proof to the case of a complete noetherian local ring. By a structure theorem of Cohen,³¹ such a ring is a quotient of a regular ring. Proposition 4.3 then allows one to assume A regular. As we shall see later, this remark permits an explicit computation of the dualizing module;³² nevertheless we will prove Theorem 4.7 by other means.

Recollections. — Before proving the theorem, we make a few recollections on the notion of injective envelope. Cf. Gabriel, *Thèse*, Paris 1961, *Des Catégories Abéliennes*, ch. II § 5.

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be an abelian category in which direct limits exist and are exact³³ (e.g. $\mathcal{C}$ = the category of modules). Every object M embeds in an injective object, and one calls *injective envelope* of M any minimal injective object containing M . One has the following properties:

- (i) Every object M has an injective envelope I .
- (ii) If I and J are two injective envelopes of M , there exists between I and J an isomorphism (in general not unique) inducing the identity on M .
- (iii) I is an essential extension of M , that is to say $P \subset I$ and $P \cap M = 0$ imply $P = 0$. Moreover, if I is injective and an essential extension of M , then I is an injective envelope of M .

Granting these results, to prove Theorem 4.7 it suffices to prove c).

Proof. — Let I be a dualizing module for A . Then I is injective and $\text{Hom}_A(k, I)$ is isomorphic to k . Composing the isomorphism $k \simeq \text{Hom}_A(k, I)$ with the inclusion

$$\text{Hom}_A(k, I) \hookrightarrow \text{Hom}_A(A, I) \simeq I,$$

one obtains the inclusion

$$k \hookrightarrow I.$$

Let us show that I is an injective envelope of k . Let J be an injective module such that

³¹N.D.E. See Cohen I.S., “On the structure and ideal theory of complete local rings”, *Trans. Amer. Math. Soc.* **59** (1946), pp. 54–106.

³²This was the method followed by Grothendieck (in 1957). The method by injective envelopes that now follows is due, it seems, to K. Morita, “Duality for modules and its applications to the theory of rings with minimum conditions”, *Sc. Rep. Tokyo Kyoiku Daigaku* **6** (1958/59), pp. 83–142. Morita’s work is, moreover, independent of Grothendieck’s and considerably earlier than the present seminar, and is not limited to the case of commutative base rings.

³³N.D.E. Of course, what is assumed exact is the small filtered direct limits; one should also assume the existence of a generator. Cf. *Tôhoku*. As for the category of modules, which suffices for our purposes, one may also refer to Chapter 10 of Bourbaki’s *Algèbre*.

$$k \subset J \subset I.$$

Since J is injective, there exists an injective A -submodule J' of I such that $I = J \oplus J'$. We show that $\text{Hom}_A(k, J') = 0$. One has

$$\text{Hom}_A(k, I) \simeq \text{Hom}_A(k, J) \oplus \text{Hom}_A(k, J');$$

$\text{Hom}_A(k, J)$ is a vector subspace of $\text{Hom}_A(k, I) \simeq k$ not reduced to zero (since it contains the inclusion $k \subset J$), so $\text{Hom}_A(k, J) \simeq k$, and consequently $\text{Hom}_A(k, J') = 0$.

Arguing by induction on the length, one deduces that $\text{Hom}_A(M, J') = 0$ for every A -module M of finite length; since I is the direct limit of the modules $\text{Hom}(A/\mathfrak{m}^n, I)$ (cf. Proposition 1.3), which are of finite length by hypothesis, the projection $I \rightarrow J'$ is zero, and consequently $J' = 0$.

Conversely, let I be an injective envelope of k . To see that I is a dualizing module, it suffices, by 2.1 and 3.1 (ii), to show that $V = \text{Hom}_A(k, I)$ is isomorphic to k . Now one has the double inclusion

$$k \subset V \subset I;$$

V is a vector space over k that decomposes as the direct sum of k and a vector subspace V' of I such that $V' \cap k = 0$. Now I is an essential extension of k , hence $V' = 0$ and $V = k$.

Corollary.

Let A be a noetherian local ring; every dualizing module for A is locally artinian.

Proof. — Let I be a dualizing module; it is an injective envelope of k . Using the notation and the result of Corollary 2.2, one has

$$k \subset H_{\mathfrak{m}}^0(I) \subset I,$$

and $H_{\mathfrak{m}}^0(I)$ is injective. One deduces that $I = H_{\mathfrak{m}}^0(I)$, and hence that I is locally artinian.³⁴

5. Consequences of the theory of dualizing modules

The functor

$$T = \text{Hom}_A(-, I) : \mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{m}} \rightarrow \mathcal{C}_{\mathfrak{m}}$$

is an anti-equivalence. Indeed, $T \circ T$ is isomorphic to the identity functor, and the argument is formal from there.

One deduces the usual properties of the notion of orthogonality:

³⁴*N.D.E.* As already observed, one may also simply remark that I is the direct limit of the modules $\text{Hom}_A(A/\mathfrak{m}^n, I)$.

Let $M^* = \text{Hom}_A(M, I) = T(M)$, and let $N \subset M$ be a submodule. Define the *orthogonal* of N to be the submodule N' of M^* consisting of the elements of M^* that vanish on N . One thereby obtains a bijection between the set of submodules of M and the set of submodules of M^* , which reverses the order.

In particular:

- $\text{long}_M N = \text{colong}_{M^*} N'$.
- The monogenic modules, i.e. those such that $M/\mathfrak{m}M$ is of dimension 0 or 1, correspond under duality to the modules whose socle is of length 0 or 1.
- If A is artinian, the ideals of A correspond to the submodules of I .

and so on.

Let A be a noetherian local ring, let $\mathcal{D}_A$ be the category of A -modules M such that, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $M_n = M/\mathfrak{m}^{n+1}M$ is of finite length and such that $M = \varprojlim M_n$, and let $\hat{A}$ be the completion of A . The restriction-of-scalars functor and the completion functor are quasi-inverse equivalences between $\mathcal{D}_A$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\hat{A}}$, which commute up to isomorphism with the formation of the underlying abelian groups of the modules considered. Let $\mathcal{C}_A$ denote the category of locally artinian A -modules with socle of finite dimension.

Proposition.

Let A be a noetherian local ring and let I be a dualizing module for A . The functors

$$\text{Hom}_A(-, I) : (\mathcal{C}_A)^\circ \rightarrow \mathcal{D}_A$$

and

$$\text{Hom}_{\{\hat{A}\}}(-, I) : \mathcal{D}_A \rightarrow (\mathcal{C}_A)^\circ$$

are equivalences of categories, quasi-inverse to one another.

Moreover, if one transports these functors via the equivalences of categories between $\mathcal{D}_A$ and $\mathcal{D}_{\hat{A}}$ on the one hand, and $\mathcal{C}_A$ and $\mathcal{C}_{\hat{A}}$ on the other, one finds the functor $\text{Hom}_{\hat{A}}(-, I)$.

Proof. — Let $X \in \text{Ob}\mathcal{C}_A$. By definition,

$$X = \varinjlim_{k \in \mathbb{N}} X_k, \quad X_k = \text{Hom}_A(A/\mathfrak{m}^{k+1}, X),$$

so

$$\text{Hom}_A(X, I) = \varprojlim \text{Hom}_A(X_k, I).$$

Therefore $Y = \varprojlim X_k$ is an $\hat{A}$ -module of finite type, as follows from EGA 0_I 7.2.9. We note in this connection that $\mathcal{D}_A$ is also the category of $\hat{A}$ -modules of finite type, or, if one prefers, that $\mathcal{D}_A$ is the category of complete A -modules of finite type over $\hat{A}$. Let then Y be such a module, and let $f : Y \rightarrow I$ be an $\hat{A}$ -homomorphism. The image of f is a submodule of finite type, hence is annihilated by $\mathfrak{m}^k$ for some k ; indeed every $x \in I$ is annihilated by a power of $\mathfrak{m}$. So f factors through $Y/\mathfrak{m}^k Y$, whence it follows that

$$\begin{aligned}\mathrm{Hom}_{\hat{A}}(Y, I) &= \lim_{\leftarrow k} \mathrm{Hom}_{\hat{A}}(Y_{\leftarrow}(k), I) \quad \text{with } Y_{\leftarrow}(k) = Y/\mathfrak{m}^{k+1}Y \\ &= \lim_{\leftarrow k} (Y_{\leftarrow}(k))^*\end{aligned}$$

belongs to $\mathrm{Ob}\mathcal{C}_A$. It then follows immediately that the two functors of the statement are quasi-inverse to one another.

It follows from the foregoing that neither the categories nor the functors under consideration, nor the underlying abelian groups of the modules considered, are changed by replacing A by $\hat{A}$; Proposition 5.1 then states as follows:

The restriction of the functor $\mathrm{Hom}_{\hat{A}}(-, I)$ to the category of $\hat{A}$ -modules of finite type takes its values in the category of locally artinian $\hat{A}$ -modules with socle of finite dimension, and admits a quasi-inverse functor, which is the restriction of the functor $\mathrm{Hom}_{\hat{A}}(-, I)$. On the intersection of these two categories these two functors coincide (obviously!) and establish an auto-duality of the category of $\hat{A}$ -modules of finite length.

Example (Macaulay).

Let A be a local ring with residue field k . Let k_0 be a subfield of A such that k is finite over k_0 , with $[k : k_0] = d$. Every A -module of finite length can be viewed as a k_0 -vector space of finite dimension equal to $d \cdot \mathrm{long}(M)$. The functor T :

$$M \longrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_{k_0}(M, k_0)$$

is then exact and preserves length, hence is dualizing for A . The associated dualizing module is therefore

$$A' = \lim_{\leftarrow n} \mathrm{Hom}_{k_0}(A/\mathfrak{m}^n, k_0),$$

the topological dual of A endowed with the $\mathfrak{m}$ -adic topology.

Example.

Let A be a regular noetherian local ring of dimension n . Let $\mathfrak{m}$ be its maximal ideal and k its residue field. There exists a regular system of parameters $(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$ that generates $\mathfrak{m}$ and that is an A -regular sequence. One can therefore compute the $\mathrm{Ext}_A^i(k, A)$ by the Koszul complex; one finds

$$\begin{aligned}\mathrm{Ext}_A^i(k, A) &= 0 \quad \text{if } i \neq n, \\ \mathrm{Ext}_A^n(k, A) &\simeq k.\end{aligned}$$

The depth of A being n , for every M annihilated by a power of $\mathfrak{m}$, $\mathrm{Ext}_A^i(M, A) = 0$ if $i < n$; furthermore $\mathrm{Ext}_A^i(M, A) = 0$ if $i > n$, since the global cohomological dimension of A is equal to n . Hence $\mathrm{Ext}_A^n(-, A)$ is exact, and moreover $\mathrm{Ext}_A^n(k, A) \simeq k$; it follows that:

Proposition.

If A is a regular noetherian local ring of dimension n , the functor

$$M \longrightarrow \text{Ext}_A^n(M, A)$$

is dualizing. The associated dualizing module is

$$I = \varinjlim_r \text{Ext}_A^n(A/\mathfrak{m}^r, A);$$

it is isomorphic to $H_{\mathfrak{m}}^n(A)$ (Exposé II, Th. 6).³⁵

Remark.

If A satisfies the hypotheses of both preceding examples, the two dualizing modules so obtained are isomorphic. Suppose for example that A is regular of dimension n , complete, and of equal characteristic. There then exists a field of representatives, say K . If one chooses a system of parameters $(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ of A , one can construct an isomorphism between A and the ring of formal power series $K[[T_1, \dots, T_n]]$; whence, as we shall now see, an explicit isomorphism between the two dualizing modules

$$v : H_{\mathfrak{m}}^n(A) \longrightarrow A'.$$

One can find an intrinsic interpretation of this isomorphism using the module $\Omega^n = \Omega^n(A/K)$ of completed relative differentials of maximal degree. Indeed, it is known that Ω^n admits a basis consisting of the element $dx_1 \wedge dx_2 \cdots \wedge dx_n$. Whence an isomorphism

$$u : H_{\mathfrak{m}}^n(\Omega^n) \longrightarrow H_{\mathfrak{m}}^n(A).$$

A remarkable fact is then that the composite

$$vu = w : H_{\mathfrak{m}}^n(\Omega^n) \longrightarrow A'$$

does not depend on the choice of system of parameters and commutes with change of base field.

To construct v , one computes $H_{\mathfrak{m}}^n(A)$ using the Koszul complex associated to the x_i ; one finds

$$H_{\mathfrak{m}}^n(A) = \varinjlim_r A/(x_1^r, \dots, x_n^r);$$

where the transition morphisms are defined as follows: set $I_r = A/(x_1^r, \dots, x_n^r)$; let $e_{a_1, \dots, a_n}^r$ denote the image of $x_1^{a_1} x_2^{a_2} \cdots x_n^{a_n}$ in I_r . The $e_{a_1, \dots, a_n}^r$, for $0 \leq a_i < r$, form a basis of I_r .

That said, if s is an integer, the transition morphism

$$t_{\{r, r+s\}} : I_r \longrightarrow I_{r+s}$$

³⁵Let A be a ring, J an ideal of A , M an A -module, $i \in \mathbb{Z}$; one then sets $H_J^i(M) = H_Y^i(X, \tilde{F})$, where $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, $Y = V(J)$ and $\tilde{F} = \tilde{M}$.

is multiplication by $x_1^s x_2^s \cdots x_n^s$, so

$$u_{\{r, r+s\}}(e^{\wedge}_{r_{\{a_1, \dots, a_n\}}} = e^{\wedge}_{\{r+s\}_{\{a_1+s, \dots, a_n+s\}}}.$$

Note that giving an A -homomorphism w from an A -module M to A' is equivalent to giving a K -linear form $w' : M \rightarrow K$ that is continuous on submodules of finite type. In the case $M = H_{\mathfrak{m}}^n(\Omega^n)$, the definition of w is therefore equivalent to that of a linear form

$$\rho : H_{\mathfrak{m}}^n(\Omega^n) \longrightarrow K,$$

called the *residue form*.³⁶ To construct ρ , it suffices to define forms $\rho_r : I_r \rightarrow K$ that fit together, and one will take

$$\begin{aligned} \rho_r(e^{\wedge}_{r_{\{a_1, \dots, a_n\}}}) = \\ 1 \quad \text{if } a_i = r - 1 \text{ for } 1 \leq i \leq n, \\ 0 \quad \text{otherwise.} \end{aligned}$$

Translation ledger (Exposé IV-specific)

French	English	Note
$T : C^\circ \rightarrow Ab$ (foncteurs additifs)	$T : C^\circ \rightarrow Ab$ (additive functors)	Contravariant; C° is the opposite category. Convention pinned at first use.
homothétie f_M	homothety f_M	Standard. Multiplication-by- f map on M .
limite projective / inductive	inverse limit / direct limit	Modern English (per glossary). The source's $\varprojlim/\varinjlim$ notation is preserved.
foncteur exact à gauche de présentation finie	left exact functor of finite presentation	Per glossary. Standard.
∂ -foncteur exact	exact ∂ -functor	Original Grothendieck notation preserved; modern usage would say <i>exact sequence of functors</i> .
corps résiduel	residue field	Per glossary.
socle	socle	Standard module-theoretic term; kept as in source.
longueur (long M)	length (long M)	Original abbreviation long preserved inside math.
module dualisant / foncteur dualisant	dualizing module / dualizing functor	Per glossary.
enveloppe injective	injective envelope	Per glossary.

³⁶For a more detailed study of the notion of residue, cf. R. Hartshorne, *Residues and Duality*, Lect. Notes in Math., vol. 20, Springer, 1966.

French	English	Note
extension essentielle	essential extension	Per glossary.
restriction (resp. extension) des scalaires	restriction (resp. extension) of scalars	Standard.
forme résidu	residue form	Per glossary (§5.5).
$\text{Hom}_A(B, I)$ (with B a finite A -algebra)	$\text{Hom}_A(B, I)$	Notation preserved; the B -module structure is via the second argument.
module localement artinien	locally artinian module	Standard. Direct limit of finite-length submodules.
EGA 0_I 7.2.9	EGA 0_I 7.2.9	Cross-reference preserved.
$\Omega^n(A/K)$	$\Omega^n(A/K)$	Completed relative differentials of maximal degree.
$\bar{C}$ (sous-catégorie des modules de longueur finie)	$\bar{C}$	Source uses an overline on C ; rendered with the combining macron $\bar{C}$.

Exposé V. Local duality and the structure of the $H^i(M)$

1. Complexes of homomorphisms

1.1. Let $F^\bullet$ and $G^\bullet$ be two graded modules; then one writes

$$\text{Hom}^\bullet(F^\bullet, G^\bullet)$$

for the graded module of homomorphisms of graded modules from $F^\bullet$ into $G^\bullet$. Thus one has

$$\text{Hom}^s(F^\bullet, G^\bullet) = \prod_k \text{Hom}(F_k, G_{k+s}).$$

Let $F^\bullet$ (resp. $G^\bullet$) be a complex, and let d_1 (resp. d_2) be its differential; then for $h \in \text{Hom}^s(F^\bullet, G^\bullet)$ one sets³⁷

$$d(h) = h \circ d_1 + (-1)^{s+1} d_2 \circ h.$$

One verifies trivially that $d \circ d = 0$, hence that $\text{Hom}^\bullet(F^\bullet, G^\bullet)$ equipped with d is a complex. The cohomology group of this complex is written

$$H^\bullet(F^\bullet, G^\bullet).$$

If $G^\bullet$ is injective in each degree, then

³⁷N.D.E. The original sign convention was different; but it is not compatible with the convention of Exposé VIII, which seems more reasonable, since in that case the cohomology in degree 0 is the set of homotopy classes of morphisms from $F^\bullet$ into $G^\bullet$. The calculations have been modified accordingly in what follows.

$$F\bullet \mapsto H\bullet(F\bullet, G\bullet)$$

is an exact ∂ -functor. Likewise, for arbitrary $F\bullet$,

$$G\bullet \mapsto H\bullet(F\bullet, G\bullet)$$

is an exact δ -functor on the category of complexes $G\bullet$ that are injective in each degree.

Remark 1.2.

The cycles of $\text{Hom}\bullet(F\bullet, G\bullet)$ are the homomorphisms from $F\bullet$ into $G\bullet$ that commute or anticommute with the differentials, according to degree. The boundaries of $\text{Hom}\bullet(F\bullet, G\bullet)$ are the homomorphisms from $F\bullet$ into $G\bullet$ that are homotopic to zero.

Let A be a ring, let M (resp. N) be an A -module, and let $R(M)$ (resp. $R(N)$) be an injective resolution of M (resp. N). Then there exists a canonical isomorphism³⁸

$$H^s(R(M), R(N)) \cong \text{Ext}^s(M, N).$$

Indeed, let $i : M \rightarrow R(M)$ be the canonical augmentation, and let $h \in \text{Hom}^s(R(M), R(N))$; one writes t_s for the map

$$h \mapsto h^0 \circ i$$

from $\text{Hom}^s(R(M), R(N))$ into $\text{Hom}(M, R(N)^s)$. The family $(t_s)_{s \geq 0}$ defines a homomorphism of (ordinary) complexes³⁹

$$t : \text{Hom}\bullet(R(M), R(N)) \rightarrow \text{Hom}\bullet(M, R(N)),$$

$$\text{i.e. one has } (dh)^0 \circ i = d_2 \circ h^0 \circ i.$$

One verifies easily that, upon passing to cohomology, t gives an isomorphism. In particular, it follows that

$$H\bullet(R(M), R(N))$$

does not “depend” on the chosen injective resolution $R(M)$ (resp. $R(N)$) of M (resp. N).

To every exact sequence of A -modules

$$0 \rightarrow M' \rightarrow M \rightarrow M'' \rightarrow 0$$

one associates an exact sequence of injective resolutions

$$0 \rightarrow R(M') \rightarrow R(M) \rightarrow R(M'') \rightarrow 0.$$

³⁸N.D.E. The strange original numbering has been preserved.

³⁹N.D.E. We still write M for the complex $M[0]$ consisting of M placed in degree 0.

One verifies that the isomorphism (1.3) commutes with the homomorphisms

$$H^s(R(M'), R(N)) \rightarrow H^{s+1}(R(M''), R(N)),$$

$$\text{Ext}^s(R(M'), R(N)) \rightarrow \text{Ext}^{s+1}(R(M''), R(N)),$$

deduced from (6) and (5).

Let P be a third A -module, and let $R(P)$ be an injective resolution of P ; then composition of graded morphisms gives a pairing

$$\text{Hom}^i(R(N), R(M)) \times \text{Hom}^j(R(M), R(P)) \rightarrow \text{Hom}^{i+j}(R(N), R(P)),$$

which defines a pairing

$$H^i(R(N), R(M)) \times H^j(R(M), R(P)) \rightarrow H^{i+j}(R(N), R(P)),$$

hence a homomorphism of functors in M :

$$H^i(R(N), R(M)) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(H^j(R(M), R(P)), H^{i+j}(R(N), R(P))).$$

We shall see that (1.4) is a homomorphism of δ -functors in M . The exact sequences (5) and (6) give a commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \text{Hom}^i(R(N), R(M')) & \longrightarrow & \text{Hom}(\text{Hom}^j(R(M'), R(P)), \text{Hom}^{i+j}(R(N), R(P))) \\ \downarrow & & \uparrow \\ & & \text{Hom}(q, \text{id}) \\ \text{Hom}^i(R(N), R(M)) & \longrightarrow & \text{Hom}(\text{Hom}^j(R(M), R(P)), \text{Hom}^{i+j}(R(N), R(P))) \\ \downarrow p & & \downarrow \\ \text{Hom}^i(R(N), R(M'')) & \longrightarrow & \text{Hom}(\text{Hom}^j(R(M''), R(P)), \text{Hom}^{i+j}(R(N), R(P))). \end{array}$$

Let $h \in \text{Hom}^i(R(N), R(M''))$ (resp. $g \in \text{Hom}^j(R(M'), R(P))$) be a cycle, and let $h' \in \text{Hom}^i(R(N), R(M))$ (resp. $g' \in \text{Hom}^j(R(M), R(P))$) be such that $p(h') = h$ (resp. $q(g') = g$); then to say that (1.4) is a homomorphism of δ -functors in M is to say that

$$g \circ dh' - dg' \circ h$$

is a coboundary in $\text{Hom} \bullet(R(N), R(P))$.

Now one has

$$dh' = h' \circ d_1 + (-1)^{i+1} d_2 \circ h',$$

$$dg' = g' \circ d_2 + (-1)^{j+1} d_3 \circ g',$$

with the obvious notations. Hence (12) is written

$$g \circ h' \circ d_1 + (-1)^{i+1} g \circ d_2 \circ h' - g' \circ d_2 \circ h - (-1)^{j+1} d_3 \circ g' \circ h.$$

On the other hand, since h and g are cycles, one has

$$g \circ d_2 = (-1)^j d_3 \circ g,$$

$$d_2 \circ h = (-1)^i h \circ d_1,$$

hence, finally, (12) is written

$$d(g \circ h' + (-1)^{i+1} g' \circ h),$$

which completes the proof.

Thus (1.3) and (1.4) give a homomorphism of δ -functors in M :

$$\text{Ext}^i(N, M) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(\text{Ext}^j(M, P), \text{Ext}^{i+j}(N, P)).$$

2. The local duality theorem for a regular local ring

Let A be a regular local ring of dimension r , let $\mathfrak{m}$ be the maximal ideal of A , and let M be a finitely generated A -module. One sets $H^i(M) = H_{\mathfrak{m}}^i(M)$ (hence $H^i(M) = \lim \rightarrow \text{Ext}^i(A/\mathfrak{m}^k, M)$). One has seen (IV 5.4) that $I = H^r(A)$ is a dualizing module for A ; denote by D the associated dualizing functor. In (1.5) setting $N = A/\mathfrak{m}^k$, $P = A$, one obtains a homomorphism of δ -functors in M

$$\varphi_k: \text{Ext}^i(A/\mathfrak{m}^k, M) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(\text{Ext}^{r-i}(M, A), \text{Ext}^r(A/\mathfrak{m}^k, A)).$$

Passing to the direct limit over k , one finds a homomorphism of δ -functors

$$\varphi: H^i(M) \rightarrow D(\text{Ext}^{r-i}(M, A)).$$

Theorem 2.1 (Local duality theorem).

The functorial homomorphism ϕ above is an isomorphism.

Proof. If $i > r$, the right-hand side of (14) is trivially zero, and the left-hand side is zero because $H^i(M) = \lim \rightarrow_k \text{Ext}^i(A/\mathfrak{m}^k, M)$, and this holds for each $\text{Ext}^i(A/\mathfrak{m}^k, M)$ (syzygy theorem).

If $i = r$, by what precedes, the two functors in M , $H^r(M)$ and $D(\text{Hom}(M, A))$, are right exact; since A is noetherian and M is finitely generated, it suffices to verify the isomorphism for $M = A$, which is immediate.

To show that ϕ is a functorial isomorphism, it now suffices, proceeding by descending induction on i , to remark that every finitely generated module admits a finite presentation, and that for $i < r$ the two sides of (14) are zero when M is finitely generated free. This is evident for the right-hand side, and since H^i commutes with finite sums it suffices, as for the left-hand side, to show that $H^i(A) = 0$ for $i < r$. But this follows, since $\text{prof}(A) = r$, from (III 3.4).

3. Application to the structure of the $H^i(M)$

Theorem 3.1.

Let A be a noetherian local ring, D a dualizing functor for A , and M a finitely generated A -module with $M \neq 0$, of dimension n . Then one has:

- (i) $H^i(M) = 0$ if $i < 0$ or if $i > n$.
- (ii) $D(H^i(M))^\wedge$ is a finitely generated module over $\hat{A}$, of dimension $\leq i$.

(iii) $H^n(M) \neq 0$, and if A is complete, $D(H^n(M))$ is of dimension n and

$$\text{Ass}(D(H^n(M))) = \{p \in \text{Ass}(M) \mid \dim A/p = n\}.$$

Proof. Let I be the dualizing module associated to D . One knows that $\hat{I}$ is a dualizing module for $\hat{A}$. On the other hand, one has

$$\begin{aligned} H^i(M)^\wedge &= H^i(\hat{M}), \\ D(H^i(M))^\wedge &= \text{Hom}(H^i(\hat{M}), \hat{I}), \text{ and} \\ \dim \hat{M} &= \dim M; \end{aligned}$$

hence one may suppose A complete. Now, by a theorem of Cohen, every complete local ring is a quotient of a regular local ring. To reduce to that case, one needs the following lemma:

Lemma 3.2.

Let X (resp. Y) be a ringed space, let X' (resp. Y') be a closed subspace of X (resp. Y), and let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of ringed spaces such that $f^{-1}(Y') = X'$. Let F be an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module, and denote by A (resp. B) the ring $\Gamma(\mathcal{O}_X)$ (resp. $\Gamma(\mathcal{O}_{Y'})$), and by $f : B \rightarrow A$ the ring homomorphism corresponding to f . There exists a spectral sequence of B -modules, with initial term

$$E_2^{p,q} = H_{Y'}^p(Y, R^q f_*(F)),$$

abutting to the B -module $H \bullet_{X'}(X, F)_f$.

Proof. Let $\mathcal{O}_{Y,Y'}$ be the sheaf $\mathcal{O}_Y|_{Y'}$ extended by 0 outside Y' (see Exp. I). One has an isomorphism of B -modules:

$$\text{Hom}(\mathcal{O}_{Y,Y'}, f_* F) \cong \text{Hom}(f^*(\mathcal{O}_{Y,Y'}), F)_f.$$

Now one has

$$f^*(\mathcal{O}_{Y,Y'}) = \mathcal{O}_{X,X'},$$

and moreover if G is an injective $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module, then $f_*(G)$ is an injective $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -Module, at least if f is flat — a case to which one easily reduces by replacing $\mathcal{O}_X$, etc., by the constant sheaves of rings $\mathbb{Z}$. Hence the spectral sequence of the composite functor

$$F \mapsto \text{Hom}(\mathcal{O}_{Y,Y'}, f_*(F)),$$

with initial term

$$E_2^{p,q} = \text{Ext}^p(Y; \mathcal{O}_{Y,Y'}, R^q f_* F),$$

abuts, taking into account (16) and (17), to

$$\text{Ext} \bullet (X; \mathcal{O}_{X,X'}, F)_f.$$

The lemma then follows from (I 13 bis). QED

Let now $f : B \rightarrow A$ be a surjective homomorphism of local rings. Let

$$f : \text{Spec}(A) \rightarrow \text{Spec}(B)$$

be the corresponding morphism of affine schemes. Set $X = \text{Spec}(A)$ (resp. $X' = \mathfrak{m}_A$), $Y = \text{Spec}(B)$ (resp. $Y' = \mathfrak{m}_B$), and let M be an A -module and $\tilde{M}$ the corresponding $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module. Since $R^q f_* (\tilde{M}) = 0$ for $q > 0$, the spectral sequence (15) degenerates, and by (3.2) one obtains an isomorphism of B -modules:

$$H^n_{\{\mathfrak{m}_B\}}(Y, f_* (\tilde{M})) \cong H^n_{\{\mathfrak{m}_A\}}(X, \tilde{M})_f,$$

hence an isomorphism of B -modules:

$$H^n_{\mathfrak{m}_B}(M_f) \cong H^n_{\mathfrak{m}_A}(M)_f.$$

On the other hand, if D_A (resp. D_B) is the dualizing functor for A (resp. B), one has

$$D_A(M)_f \cong D_B(M_f).$$

Finally, since one has a ring isomorphism

$$B/\text{Ann } M_f \cong A/\text{Ann } M,$$

one sees that the change of base rings under consideration changes nothing. So suppose A is regular of dimension r .

By (2.1) one has

$$D(H^i(M)) = \text{Ext}^{r-i}(M, A).$$

We shall prove the equivalence of the following properties:

- (a) $\dim \text{Ext}^j(M, A) \leq r - j$;
- (b) for every $\mathfrak{p} \in X = \text{Spec}(A)$ such that $\dim A_{\mathfrak{p}} < j$, one has $\text{Ext}^j(M, A)_{\mathfrak{p}} = 0$;
- (c) $\text{codim}(\text{Supp}(\text{Ext}^j(M, A)), X) \geq j$.

To prove (a) $\Rightarrow$ (b), let $\mathfrak{p} \in X$ with $\dim A_{\mathfrak{p}} < j$; then $\dim A/\mathfrak{p} > r - j$, hence by (a) $\text{Ann}(\text{Ext}^j(M, A)) \not\subset \mathfrak{p}$, which entails $\text{Ext}^j(M, A)_{\mathfrak{p}} = 0$. Let $\mathfrak{p} \in \text{Supp}(\text{Ext}^j(M, A))$; then $\text{Ext}^j(M, A)_{\mathfrak{p}} \neq 0$, so by (b) $\dim A_{\mathfrak{p}} \geq j$. Hence $\text{codim}(\text{Supp}(\text{Ext}^j(M, A)), X) = \inf\{\dim A_{\mathfrak{p}} \mid \mathfrak{p} \in \text{Supp}(\text{Ext}^j(M, A))\} \geq j$, that is, (b) $\Rightarrow$ (c). Finally (c) implies (a) trivially.

Let us now prove the theorem.

- (i) Let $x = (x_1, \dots, x_r)$ be a system of parameters for A such that $x_i \in \text{Ann} M$ for $i = 1, \dots, r - n$. Let $K \bullet ((x^k), M)$ be the Koszul complex. One sees easily that the map $K^i((x^k), M) \rightarrow K^i((x^{k'}), M)$ for $k < k'$ is zero, if $i > n$. It follows that $H^i(M) = \lim \rightarrow H^i((x^k), M) = 0$ if $i > n$. On the other hand, it is trivial that $H^i(M) = 0$ if $i < 0$, so (i) is proved.
- (ii) Since A is regular, $\dim A_{\mathfrak{p}} < j$ entails that the global homological dimension of $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is strictly less than j , and hence $\text{Ext}^j(M, A)_{\mathfrak{p}} = \text{Ext}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}^j(M_{\mathfrak{p}}, A_{\mathfrak{p}}) = 0$; so one has proved
- (b) and consequently (a). (ii) then follows from (22) and from (a).
- (iii) There exists a $\mathfrak{p} \in \text{Supp}(M)$ such that $\dim A_{\mathfrak{p}} = r - n$ and such that $\text{Supp}(M_{\mathfrak{p}}) = \mathfrak{m}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}$. Since $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is regular if A is, one finds $\text{prof} A_{\mathfrak{p}} = r - n$, hence

$$\text{Ext}^{r-n}_A(M, A)_{\mathfrak{p}} = \text{Ext}^{r-n}_{A_{\mathfrak{p}}}(M_{\mathfrak{p}}, A_{\mathfrak{p}}) \neq 0.$$

This implies, taking (22) into account, that on the one hand

$$H^n(M) \neq 0,$$

and on the other hand

$$\dim D(H^n(M)) \geq n,$$

hence by (ii)

$$\dim D(H^n(M)) = n.$$

Let now $Y = \text{Supp}(M)$. By (i) one knows that $D(H^n(M')) = \text{Ext}^{r-n}(M', A)$ is a functor in M' , left exact, on the category $(\mathcal{C}_Y)^\circ$. Hence there exists an A -module H and an isomorphism of functors in M' :

$$\text{Ext}^{r-n}(M', A) = \text{Hom}(M', H).$$

Let Y_i , $i = 1, \dots, k$, be the irreducible components of Y of maximum dimension. We shall see that the assertion $\text{Ext}^{r-n}(M', A) \neq 0$ is equivalent to the assertion: there exists an i such that $\text{Supp} M' \supset Y_i$. Indeed, if $\text{Supp} M' \supset Y_i$, then $\dim(M') = n$, hence $\text{Ext}^{r-n}(M', A) \neq 0$.

If $\text{Supp} M' \not\supset Y_i$ for every $i = 1, \dots, k$, then $\dim M' < n$ and

$$D(H^n(M')) = \text{Ext}^{r-n}(M', A) = 0.$$

Since $\text{Ass}(\text{Ext}^{r-n}(M, A)) = \text{Supp } M \cap \text{Ass}(H)$, one sees that the last assertion of (iii) follows from the following lemma:

Lemma 3.3.

Let $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, let Y be a closed subset of X , let $T : (\mathcal{C}_Y)^\circ \rightarrow Ab$ be a left exact functor, and let $Y_i, i = 1, \dots, k$, be a family of irreducible components of Y such that the assertion: $T(M) = 0$ is equivalent to the assertion: $\forall i, \text{Supp} M \not\supset Y_i$. Then T is representable by a module H such that $\text{Ass}(H) = \bigcup_{i=1}^k y_i$, where y_i is the generic point of $Y_i, i = 1, \dots, k$.

Proof. Let $y \in Y$; one constructs an A -module $M(y)$ such that $\text{Supp}(M(y)) = y$. Suppose that $y \neq y_i$ for every $i = 1, \dots, k$; then $Y_i \not\subset \text{Supp}(M(y))$ for every $i = 1, \dots, k$, so $T(M(y)) = 0$. It follows that

$$\text{Ass}(T(M(y))) = \text{Supp}(M(y)) \cap \text{Ass}(H) = \emptyset,$$

hence $y \notin \text{Ass}(H)$. If $y = y_i$, then $Y_i \subset \text{Supp}(M(y))$, so $T(M(y)) \neq 0$, whence

$$\text{Ass}(T(M(y))) = \text{Supp}(M(y)) \cap \text{Ass}(H) \neq \emptyset.$$

By the first part of the proof, this implies $y \in \text{Ass}(H)$, whence the lemma. QED

Example 3.4.

Let A be a noetherian ring, let $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, and let Y be a closed subset of X such that $X - Y$ is affine; then for every irreducible component Y_α of Y one has $\text{codim}(Y_\alpha, X) \leq 1$.

Indeed, consider X as a prescheme over X . Let $y_\alpha \in Y_\alpha$ be a generic point, and consider the morphism $\text{Spec}(\mathcal{O}_{X, y_\alpha}) \rightarrow X$. The affine scheme obtained by base extension of X to $\text{Spec}(\mathcal{O}_{X, y_\alpha})$ is canonically isomorphic to $\text{Spec}(\mathcal{O}_{X, y_\alpha})$.

By (EGA I 3.2.7) one sees that if y_0 is the unique closed point of $Y_0 = \text{Spec}(\mathcal{O}_{X, y_\alpha})$, then $Y_0 - y_0$ is affine. By (EGA III 1.3.1) one finds

$$H^i(Y_0 - y_0, \mathcal{O}_{Y_0}) = 0 \quad \text{if } i > 0,$$

hence by (I 2.9)

$$H^{i-1}(\mathcal{O}_{Y_0 - y_0}) = H^i(\mathcal{O}_{Y_0}) = 0 \quad \text{if } i \geq 2.$$

Taking 3.1 (iii) into account, it follows that

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_{X, y_\alpha} \leq 1,$$

hence $\text{codim}(Y_\alpha, X) = \inf_{y \in Y_\alpha} \dim \mathcal{O}_{X, y} \leq 1$. QED

Let A be a noetherian local ring, $\mathfrak{m}$ its maximal ideal, and M a finitely generated A -module. Suppose that A is a quotient of a regular local ring. Set $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, and for every $x \in X$, $\mathfrak{m}_x = \mathfrak{m}A_x$.

Proposition 3.5.

The following two conditions are equivalent:

- a) $H^i(M)$ is of finite length;
- b) $\forall x \in X - \mathfrak{m}, H^{i-\dim x_{\mathfrak{m}_x}}(M_x) = 0$.

Proof. Taking (3.2) into account, we may suppose A regular. By (2.1) we have

$$H^i(M) = D(\text{Ext}^{r-i}(M, A)),$$

where $r = \dim A$. By (IV 4.7), a) is equivalent⁴⁰ to

$\text{Ext}^{r-i}(M, A)$ is of finite length.

Now (24) is equivalent to

$\forall x \in X - \{\mathfrak{m}\}$, one has $\text{Ext}^{r-i}(M, A)_x = 0$.

On the other hand A_x is regular of dimension $r - \dim x$, so by (2.1)

$$H^{i-\dim \{x\}}_{\{x\}}(M_x) = D(\text{Ext}^{\wedge\{r - \dim \{x\} - (i - \dim \{x\})\}}_{A_x}(M_x, A_x)) = D(\text{Ext}^{r-i}_{A_x}(M_x, A_x)).$$

Since M is finitely generated, one has

$$\text{Ext}^{r-i}_{A_x}(M, A)_x = \text{Ext}^{r-i}_{A_x}(M_x, A_x),$$

whence the proposition.

Corollary 3.6.

In order that $H^i(M)$ be of finite length for $i \leq n$, it is necessary and sufficient that

$$\text{prof}(M_x) > n - \dim \{x\}$$

for every $x \in X - \mathfrak{m}$.

Proof. Follows from (3.5) and (III 3.1).

Exposé VI. The functors $\text{Ext}^\bullet_Z(X; F, G)$ and $\mathcal{E}xt^\bullet_Z(F, G)$

1. Generalities

1.1.

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space and let Z be a locally closed subset of X . Let F and G be $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Modules; we denote by $\text{Ext}^i_Z(X; F, G)$ (resp. $\mathcal{E}xt^i_Z(F, G)$) the i -th derived functor of the functor $G \mapsto \Gamma_Z(\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G))$ (resp. $G \mapsto \Gamma_Z(\mathcal{H}om_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G))$), where Γ_Z denotes the sheaffied sections-with-support functor and $\mathcal{H}om_{\mathcal{O}_X}$ the sheaffied Hom).

Lemma.

⁴⁰N.D.E. Indeed, the point is to show that, E being a finitely generated A -module, if $D(E)$ is of finite length then E is of finite length. Let K (resp. Q) be the kernel (resp. cokernel) of the canonical morphism $\epsilon : E \rightarrow DD(E)$. The composition of $D(\epsilon)$ and the canonical morphism $\gamma : D(E) \rightarrow DDD(E)$ is the identity of $D(E)$. Since $D(E)$ is of finite length, γ is an isomorphism, and hence so is $D(\epsilon)$. Since D is exact, it follows that $D(K)$ and $D(Q)$ are zero. It suffices to prove that if M is an A -module with zero dual, then M is zero, for one will then have $E = DD(E)$ of finite length, just like $D(E)$. Indeed, let M_0 be a finitely generated submodule of M . Since D is exact, $D(M_0)$ is a quotient of $D(M)$, which is zero. Again by the exactness of D , one has $D(M_0/\mathfrak{m}_A M_0) = 0$, and hence, by biduality, the finite-length module $M_0/\mathfrak{m}_A M_0$ is zero. Nakayama's lemma then ensures the vanishing of M_0 , and finally one obtains that of M .

The sheaf $\mathcal{E}xt_Z^i(F, G)$ is canonically isomorphic to the sheaf associated with the presheaf $U \mapsto Ext_{Z \cap U}^i(U; F|U, G|U)$.

This follows from (*Tôhoku*, 3.7.2) together with the fact that $\Gamma(U; \Gamma_Z(\mathcal{H}om_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G)))$ is canonically isomorphic to $\Gamma_{Z \cap U}(\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X|U}(F|U, G|U))$.

Theorem (Excision theorem).

Let V be an open subset of X containing Z . Then one has an isomorphism of cohomological functors

$$\text{Ext}^{\bullet}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(X; F, G) \simeq \text{Ext}^{\bullet}_{\mathcal{O}_V}(V; F|V, G|V).$$

Indeed, if $G^{\bullet}$ is an injective resolution of G , then $G^{\bullet}|V$ is an injective resolution of $G|V$. The theorem follows immediately.

1.4.

Let $\mathcal{O}_{X,Z}$ be the $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module defined by the following conditions ([Godement], 2.9.2): $\mathcal{O}_{X,Z}|_{X-Z} = 0$ and $\mathcal{O}_{X,Z}|_Z = \mathcal{O}_X|_Z$. We have seen that for every $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module H there is a functorial isomorphism $\Gamma_Z(H) \simeq \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_{X,Z}, H)$. From this we deduce functorial isomorphisms in F and G :

$$\Gamma_Z(\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_X, F, G)) \simeq \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_{X,Z}, \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_X, F, G)),$$

$$\Gamma_Z(\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_X, F, G)) \simeq \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_{X,Z} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} F, G),$$

$$\Gamma_Z(\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_X, F, G)) \simeq \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_{X,Z}, G)) = \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, \Gamma_Z(G)).$$

It follows in particular from (1.4.2) that there is a ∂ -functorial isomorphism in F and G

$$0: \text{Ext}^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_{X,Z} \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} F, G) \simeq \text{Ext}^i_Z(X; F, G).$$

1.5.

By definition, the functor $G \mapsto \Gamma_Z(\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G))$ is the composite of the functor $G \mapsto \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G)$ and the functor Γ_Z . Since Γ_Z is left exact (I 1.9), since $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G)$ is flasque whenever G is injective, and since Γ_Z is exact on flasque sheaves (I 2.12), it follows from (*Tôhoku*, 2.4.1) that there is a spectral functor abutting to $Ext_Z^{\bullet}(X; F, G)$ whose initial term is $H_Z^p(X, \mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_X}^q(F, G))$.

On the other hand, it follows from (1.4.3) that $\Gamma_Z(\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G))$ is the composite of Γ_Z and the functor $H \mapsto \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, H)$.

Since the functor Γ_Z takes injectives to injectives (I 1.4), it follows from (*Tôhoku*, 2.4.1) that there is a spectral functor abutting to $Ext_Z^{\bullet}(X; F, G)$ whose initial term is $Ext_{\mathcal{O}_X}^p(X; F, \mathcal{H}_Z^q(G))$.

It follows finally, from (1.4.2) and the spectral sequence for Ext , that there is a spectral functor abutting to $Ext_Z^{\bullet}(X; F, G)$ whose initial term is $H^p(X; \mathcal{E}xt_Z^q(F, G))$. Whence the

Theorem.

There exist three spectral functors abutting to $Ext_Z^\bullet(X; F, G)$ whose initial terms are respectively

$$H_Z^p(X, \mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_X}^q(F, G))$$

$$H^p(X, \mathcal{E}xt_Z^q(F, G))$$

$$Ext_{\mathcal{O}_X}^p(X; F, \mathcal{H}_Z^q(G)).$$

1.7.

Let now Z' be a closed subset of Z and let $Z'' = Z - Z'$. We have an exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X, Z''} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X, Z} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{X, Z'} \rightarrow 0$$

which generalizes the exact sequence of ([Godement], 2.9.3). This exact sequence splits locally; hence for every $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module F we have a further exact sequence:

$$0 \rightarrow F \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{O}_{X, Z''} \rightarrow F \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{O}_{X, Z} \rightarrow F \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_X} \mathcal{O}_{X, Z'} \rightarrow 0.$$

Let now G be an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module; applying the functor $\text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\bullet, G)$ to the exact sequence (1.7.2), one deduces from (1.4.2) and the long exact sequence for Ext the following theorem:

Theorem.

Let Z be a locally closed subset of X , let Z' be a closed subset of Z , and let $Z'' = Z - Z'$. Then there is an exact sequence, functorial in F and G :

$$0 \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \text{Ext}^1_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \dots$$

$$\dots \rightarrow \text{Ext}^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \text{Ext}^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \text{Ext}^{i+1}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \dots$$

Corollary.

Let Y be a closed subset of X and let $U = X - Y$. Then there is an exact sequence, functorial in F and G :

$$0 \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \text{Hom}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F|_U, G|_U) \rightarrow \text{Ext}^1_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \dots$$

$$\dots \rightarrow \text{Ext}^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \text{Ext}^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \text{Ext}^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F|_U, G|_U) \rightarrow \text{Ext}^{i+1}_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, G) \rightarrow \dots$$

This corollary is an immediate consequence of theorem (1.3) and theorem (1.8).

2. Applications to quasi-coherent sheaves on preschemes

Proposition.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme. For every locally closed subset Z of X , every coherent Module F , and every quasi-coherent Module G on X , the sheaves $\mathcal{E}xt_Z^i(F, G)$ are quasi-coherent.

One shows, as in (1.6.3), that the Modules $\mathcal{E}xt_Z^i(F, G)$ are the abutment of a spectral sequence with initial term $\mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_X}^p(F, \mathcal{H}_Z^q(G))$. By (II, cor. 3) the $\mathcal{H}_Z^q(G)$ are quasi-coherent, and so are the $\mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_X}^p(F, \mathcal{H}_Z^q(G))$, since F is coherent. The proposition follows immediately.

2.2.

Let now Y be a closed subscheme of X and let $\mathcal{I}$ be a defining ideal of Y . Let m and n be integers with $m \geq n \geq 0$; we denote by $i_{n,m}$ the canonical map $\mathcal{O}_{Y_m} = \mathcal{O}_X/\mathcal{I}^{m+1} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_X/\mathcal{I}^{n+1} = \mathcal{O}_{Y_n}$ and by j_n the map $\mathcal{O}_{X,Y} \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_{Y_n}$. The system $(\mathcal{O}_{Y_n}, i_{n,m})$ forms a projective system, and the maps j_n are compatible with the $i_{n,m}$.

Applying the functor $\mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_X}^i(F \otimes \bullet, G)$, one deduces a morphism

$$\varphi': \lim_{\leftarrow} \{\rightarrow n\} \mathcal{E}xt^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_X; F \otimes \mathcal{O}_{Y_n}, G) \rightarrow \mathcal{E}xt^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_X; F \otimes \mathcal{O}_{X,Y}, G);$$

this is a morphism of cohomological functors in G . The morphism

$$\varphi: \lim_{\leftarrow} \{\rightarrow n\} \mathcal{E}xt^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(\mathcal{O}_X; F \otimes \mathcal{O}_{Y_n}, G) \rightarrow \mathcal{E}xt^i_Y(X; F, G)$$

obtained as the composite of φ' with θ (cf. 1.4) is therefore likewise a morphism of cohomological functors in G .

One defines in the same way

$$\varphi: \lim_{\leftarrow} \{\rightarrow n\} \mathcal{E}xt^i_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F \otimes \mathcal{O}_{Y_n}, G) \rightarrow \mathcal{E}xt^i_Y(F, G).$$

Theorem.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme, let Y be a closed subset of X defined by a coherent ideal $\mathcal{I}$, let F be a coherent Module and let G be a quasi-coherent Module. Then:

- a) φ is an isomorphism.
- b) If X is noetherian, ϕ is an isomorphism.

The proof of b) being almost word for word that of (II 6 b)), thanks to the spectral sequence 1.6.2, we shall not reproduce it.

For the proof of a), one may, by (2.1), assume X affine with ring A , F (resp. G) defined by an A -module M (resp. N), and $\mathcal{I}$ by an ideal I . It suffices to prove that the homomorphism

$$\lim_{\leftarrow} \{\rightarrow n\} \mathcal{E}xt^i_A(M/I^n M, N) \rightarrow \mathcal{E}xt^i_Y(X, F, G)$$

deduced from φ is an isomorphism.

Indeed, for $i = 0$, one can canonically identify both sides of (2.3.1) with the submodule of $\text{Hom}_A(M, N)$ consisting of those elements of $\text{Hom}_A(M, N)$ annihilated by some power of I . One then sees that the homomorphism (2.3.1) is none other than the identity map.

The functor $N \mapsto \lim_{\rightarrow n} \mathcal{E}xt_A^\bullet(M/I^n M, N)$ is a universal ∂ -functor. We shall show that the same holds for the functor $N \mapsto \mathcal{E}xt_Y^\bullet(M, N)$. Indeed, if N is an injective module, by (9 and 11), $\mathcal{H}_Y^q(N) = 0$ for $q \neq 0$; and by (IV.2.2), $\mathcal{H}_Y^0(N)$ is injective.

It follows then that $\text{Ext}_{\mathcal{O}_X}^p(X; M, \mathcal{H}_Y^q(N)) = 0$ for $p + q \neq 0$; hence, by (1.6.3), $\text{Ext}_Y^i(M, N) = 0$ for $i \neq 0$ and N injective. This completes the proof.

Bibliography

Same references as those listed at the end of Exp. I, cited respectively [*Tôhoku*] and [Gode-ment].

Exposé VII. Vanishing criteria and coherence conditions for the sheaves $\mathcal{E}xt^i_Y(\mathcal{F}, \mathcal{G})$

1. Study for $i < n$

We prove a lemma.

Lemma.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme, Y a closed subset of X , and G a quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module. Suppose that for every coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module F with support contained in Y , one has

$$\mathcal{E}xt^{n-1}(F, G) = 0.$$

Then for every coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module F and every closed subset Z of X such that $Y \supset \text{Supp } F \cap Z$, one has

$$\mathcal{E}xt^n_Z(F, G) \cong \mathcal{H}om(F, \mathcal{H}^n_Y(G)).$$

We first remark that

$$\mathcal{E}xt^i_Z(F, G) = \mathcal{E}xt^i_{\{Z \cap \text{Supp } F\}}(F, G)$$

(trivial, cf. Exposé VI). We first carry out the proof for $Z = X$, so that $\text{Supp } F \subset Y$. The functor

$$F \mapsto \mathcal{E}xt^n(F, G),$$

defined on the category of coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Modules with support contained in Y , is left exact. By (IV 1.3), it is represented by

$$I = \lim_{\leftarrow \{k\}} \mathcal{E}xt^n(\mathcal{O}_X/\mathcal{I}^k, G),$$

where $\mathcal{I}$ is the ideal of definition of Y . Now, by (II 6), one knows that

$$\mathcal{H}^n_Y(G) \cong \lim_{\leftarrow \{k\}} \mathcal{E}xt^n(\mathcal{O}_X/\mathcal{I}^k, G).$$

Whence the conclusion when $Z = X$. Still by (VI 2.3), one knows that

$$\mathcal{E}xt^n_Z(F, G) \cong \lim_{\leftarrow \{k\}} \mathcal{E}xt^n(F/\mathcal{I}^k F, G),$$

where $\mathcal{J}$ is the ideal of definition of Z . The support of $F/\mathcal{J}^{k+1}F$ is contained in Y whenever $Z \cap \text{Supp} F \subset Y$; by what we have just proved, we therefore have

$$\mathcal{E}xt^n_Z(F, G) \cong \lim_{\leftarrow} \{ \rightarrow k \} \mathcal{H}om(F/\mathcal{J}^{k+1}F, \mathcal{H}^n_Y(G)).$$

It remains to show that the natural homomorphism

$$\lim_{\leftarrow} \{ \rightarrow k \} \mathcal{H}om(F/\mathcal{J}^{k+1}F, \mathcal{H}^n_Y(G)) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}om(F, \mathcal{H}^n_Y(G))$$

is an isomorphism when $Z \cap \text{Supp} F \subset Y$. Now X can be covered by noetherian affine open sets; one is thus reduced to the case where X is noetherian affine. Then $F(X)$ is a finitely generated $\mathcal{O}_X(X)$ -Module and $\text{Supp} \mathcal{H}^n_Y(G) \subset Y$. Hence every homomorphism $u : F(X) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^n_Y(G)(X)$ is annihilated by a power of $\mathcal{J}$, and therefore by a power of $\mathcal{J}$. QED.

Proposition.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme, Y a closed subset of X , G a quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module, and n an integer. For any closed subsets Z and S of X such that $Z \cap S = Y$, the following conditions are equivalent:

1. $\mathcal{H}^i_Y(G) = 0$ for $i < n$;
2. there exists a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module F , of support S , such that
$$\mathcal{E}xt^i_Z(F, G) = 0 \text{ for } i < n;$$
3. for every coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module F with support contained in S (i.e. $\text{Supp} F \cap Z = \text{Supp} F \cap Y$), one has
$$\mathcal{E}xt^i_Z(F, G) = 0 \text{ for } i < n;$$
4. for every coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module F , one has
$$\mathcal{E}xt^i_Y(F, G) = 0 \text{ for } i < n.$$

Moreover, if these conditions hold, then for every coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module F and every closed subset Z' of X such that $Z' \cap \text{Supp} F = Y \cap \text{Supp} F$, one has isomorphisms

$$\mathcal{E}xt^n_Z(F, G) \cong \mathcal{E}xt^n_Y(F, G) \cong \mathcal{H}om(F, \mathcal{H}^n_Y(G)).$$

Proof. We argue by induction. The proposition is trivial for $n < 0$. Suppose it has been proved for $n < q$. If one of the conditions holds for $n = q$, and for two subsets Z and S as stated, then by the induction hypothesis we have, for every closed subset Z' of X and every coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module F such that $Z' \cap \text{Supp} F = Y \cap \text{Supp} F$, isomorphisms

$$\mathcal{E}xt^{q-1}_{Z'}(F, G) \cong \mathcal{H}om(F, \mathcal{H}^{q-1}_{Z'}(G)) \cong \mathcal{E}xt^{q-1}_Y(F, G).$$

Hence:

- (i) $\Rightarrow$ (iv), by taking $Z' = Y$ in (1.1);
- (iv) $\Rightarrow$ (iii), by taking $Z' = Z$ in (1.1);
- (iii) $\Rightarrow$ (ii), by taking $F = \mathcal{O}_S$;

- (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i), by taking $Z' = Z$ in (1.1); this gives $\mathcal{H}om(F, \mathcal{H}_Y^{q-1}(G)) = 0$. One then remarks that

$$\text{Supp } \mathcal{H}^{\wedge\{q-1\}}_Y(G) \subset Y = Z \cap S \subset S = \text{Supp } F,$$

and one applies the following lemma:

Lemma.

Let X be a prescheme, let P be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module, and let H be a quasi-coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module such that

$$\mathcal{H}om(P, H) = 0 \text{ and } \text{Supp } P \supset \text{Supp } H.$$

Then $H = 0$.

It suffices to prove the lemma when X is affine, since the affine open sets form a base of the topology of X and the hypotheses are preserved by restriction to an open set.

Now in that case one is reduced to a problem on A -modules, where $X = \text{Spec}(A)$. One applies the formula (valid under the sole hypothesis that M is of finite type)

$$\text{Ass Hom}_A(P, H) = \text{Supp } P \cap \text{Ass } H.$$

One knows that $\text{Ass } H \subset \text{Supp } H \subset \text{Supp } P$ and that $\text{Ass Hom}_A(P, H) = \emptyset$; hence $\text{Ass } H = \emptyset$, so $H = 0$.

To complete the proof of the proposition, it remains to observe that (iv) allows us to apply 1.1.

Corollary.

Let G be a coherent Cohen-Macaulay $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module, and let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. The conditions of 1.2 are equivalent to:

1. $\text{codim}(Y \cap \text{Supp } G, \text{Supp } G) \geq n$.

Recall first that an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module is said to be Cohen-Macaulay if, for every $x \in X$, the stalk G_x is a Cohen-Macaulay $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ -module, i.e. one has for every $x \in S = \text{Supp } G$:

$$\text{prof } G_x = \dim G_x = \dim \mathcal{O}_{\{S, x\}}.$$

By Proposition III 3.3, condition (i) of 1.2 is equivalent to

$$\text{prof}_Y G = \inf_{\{x \in Y\}} \text{prof } G_x \geq n,$$

and therefore also to

$$\text{prof}_Y G = \inf_{\{x \in Y \cap S\}} \text{prof } G_x \geq n,$$

since the depth of a zero module is infinite. Now, by definition,

$$\text{codim}(Y \cap S, S) = \inf_{\{x \in S \cap Y\}} \dim \mathcal{O}_{\{S, x\}},$$

whence the conclusion, by applying formula (1.2).

We shall now prove a result that lets us deduce the coherence conditions we have in view from certain vanishing criteria.

Lemma.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme. Let $T^\bullet$ be an exact contravariant ∂ -functor, defined on the category of coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Modules, with values in the category of $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Modules. Let Y be a closed subset of X . Let $i \in \mathbb{Z}$. Suppose that, for every coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module with support contained in Y , $T^i F$ and $T^{i-1} F$ are coherent. Let F be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module. For $T^i F$ to be coherent, it is necessary and sufficient that $T^i F''$ be coherent, where we have set

$$F'' = F/\Gamma_Y(F).$$

Indeed, $F' = \Gamma_Y(F)$ is coherent because X is locally noetherian; the cohomology exact sequence of $T^\bullet$ then gives

$$T^{i-1} F' \rightarrow T^i F'' \rightarrow T^i F' \rightarrow T^{i-1} F',$$

where the outer terms are coherent, whence the conclusion.

Lemma.

If F and G are coherent, and if $\text{Supp} F \subset Y$, then $\mathcal{E}xt_Y^i(F, G)$ is coherent.

Indeed, $\mathcal{E}xt_Y^i(F, G)$ is isomorphic to $\mathcal{E}xt^i(F, G)$; this is valid, moreover, on any ringed space X : if Z is a closed subset containing $Y \cap \text{Supp} F$, then $\mathcal{E}xt_Z^i(F, G)$ is isomorphic to $\mathcal{E}xt_Y^i(F, G)$ (cf. Exposé VI).

Proposition.

Suppose F and G are coherent, and set $S = \text{Supp} F$, $S' = S \cap (X - Y)$. Suppose that, for every $x \in Y \cap S'$, one has $\text{prof} G_x \geq n$. Then $\mathcal{E}xt_Y^i(F, G)$ is coherent for $i < n$.

Indeed, 1.6 allows us to apply 1.5 to $T^\bullet(F) = \mathcal{E}xt_Y^\bullet(F, G)$. Setting $F'' = F/\Gamma_Y(F)$, one sees that $\text{Supp} F'' = S'$. Now, by III 3.3, the hypothesis on the depth of G ensures the vanishing of $\mathcal{H}_{Y \cap S'}^i(G)$ for $i < n$; by 1.2, one deduces the vanishing of $T^i F''$ for $i < n$, whence the conclusion by 1.5.

2. Study for $i > n$

Let X be a locally noetherian regular prescheme, that is, one all of whose local rings are regular. Let Y be a closed subset of X . Let F and G be two coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Modules. Set $S = \text{Supp} F$, $S' = S \cap (X - Y)$. Set

$$\begin{aligned} m &= \sup_{\{x \in Y \cap S\}} \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x}, \\ n &= \sup_{\{x \in Y \cap S'\}} \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x}; \end{aligned}$$

one has $n \leq m$.

Proposition.

In the situation just described, one has:

1. $\mathcal{E}xt_Y^i(F, G) = 0$ for $i > m$,

2. $\mathcal{E}xt_Y^i(F, G)$ is coherent for $i > n$.

Note first that $\mathcal{E}xt_Y^i(F, G)$ is coherent for every i when $\text{Supp} F \subset Y$. Moreover, setting $F'' = F/\Gamma_Y(F)$ as above, one sees that $\text{Supp} F'' = S'$, so that (2) follows from (1) and from 1.3.

To prove (1), one first remarks that

$$\mathcal{E}xt_Y^i(F, G) \cong \lim_{\leftarrow \{ \rightarrow k \}} \mathcal{E}xt^i(F/\mathcal{J}^k F, G),$$

where $\mathcal{J}$ is the ideal of definition of Y . On the other hand, it follows from Theorem 4.2.2 of (A. Grothendieck, “Sur quelques points d’algèbre homologique”, *Tôhoku Mathematical Journal* **9** (1957), pp. 119–221) that the Ext sheaves commute with the formation of stalks, at least when X is a locally noetherian prescheme and the first argument is coherent; since the same is true of direct limits, one finds isomorphisms

$$(\mathcal{E}xt_Y^i(F, G))_x \cong \lim_{\leftarrow \{ \rightarrow k \}} \mathcal{E}xt^i_{\{ \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \}}((F/\mathcal{J}^k F)_x, G_x)$$

for every $x \in X$. Since $\text{Supp} \mathcal{E}xt_Y^i(F, G) \subset S \cap Y$, to conclude it suffices to remark that $x \in Y \cap S$ entails $\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \leq m$, hence

$$\mathcal{E}xt^i_{\{ \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \}}((F/\mathcal{J}^k F)_x, G_x) = 0 \text{ for } i > m,$$

since the global cohomological dimension of a regular local ring is equal to its dimension.⁴¹

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme; for every subset P of X , set

$$D(P) = \{ \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,p} \mid p \in P \}.$$

Lemma.

If P is the underlying space of a connected subprescheme of X , then $D(P)$ is an interval.

Indeed, let α and β belong to $D(P)$, corresponding to points p and q of P . We show that there exists a sequence of points of P , $(p = p_1, \dots, p_n = q)$, such that for $1 \leq i < n$ one has $|\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,p_i} - \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,p_{i+1}}| = 1$; it will follow that $D(P)$ contains the interval $[\alpha, \beta]$. For this, one remarks that p and q can be joined by a chain of irreducible components of P such that two successive components meet. One is reduced to the case where p is the generic point of an irreducible component Q of P , and where $q \in Q$, and so $q \supset p$ as ideals of $\mathcal{O}_q$, where the assertion is trivial from the definition of dimension.

Proposition.

Let X be a locally noetherian regular prescheme, Y a closed subset of X , and F a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module. Let $P = Y \cap \text{Supp} F \cap (X - Y)$. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$, and suppose that $n \notin D(P)$. Then $\mathcal{E}xt_Y^n(F, \mathcal{O}_X)$ is coherent.

The conclusion is local and the hypotheses are preserved by restriction to an open set. Now P is closed and so locally noetherian, hence locally connected; we may therefore assume X affine and noetherian, and P connected. Set $D(P) = [a, b]$, which is legitimate by the preceding lemma. If $n > b$, we conclude by 2.1; if $n < a$, then $n < \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} = \text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ for every $x \in P$, and we conclude by 1.7.

⁴¹Cf. EGA 0_IV 17.3.1.

Translation ledger delta

French	English	Note
critères de nullité	vanishing criteria	Title-level. Per task spec.
conditions de cohérence	coherence conditions	Title-level. Per task spec.
$\text{Ext}_Y^i(F, G)$ (underlined)	$\mathcal{E}xt_Y^i(F, G)$	Sheafified Ext, per the script-E convention pinned in Exposé VI.
$\text{Ext}_Z^i(F, G)$ (non-underlined)	$\text{Ext}_Z^i(X; F, G)$	Global Ext (when displayed with the ambient X); unchanged.
Hom (underlined)	$\mathcal{H}om$	Sheaf-Hom, parallel to the $\mathcal{E}xt$ convention.
H_Y^i (underlined)	$\mathcal{H}_Y^i$	Sheafified local cohomology, matching the glossary entry.
$\Gamma_Y(F)$ (underlined)	$\Gamma_Y(F)$	Sheafified sections-with-support; rendered without underline per the SGA 2 glossary’s note on Γ_Z .
∂ – <i>foncteur</i> profondeur (prof)	∂ -functor depth (prof)	Standard. Standard SGA 2 usage; symbol prof kept.
anneau de Cohen-Macaulay	Cohen- Macaulay (ring / module)	Standard.
dimension cohomologique globale	global cohomological dimension	Per source.
limite inductive	direct limit	Modern English; matches glossary policy for SGA 2.
Tôhoku	<i>Tôhoku</i>	Italicized journal title; accent restored.
il est licite de	it is legitimate to	“Legitimate” reads better than “permitted” in this register.
quelles que soient Z et S	for any closed subsets Z and S	Re-articulated as English universal quantifier.
C.Q.F.D.	QED	Standard.
en vertu de	by	“By” suffices for a citation tag.
compte tenu de	(not occurring)	—
il en résulte	it follows	Standard.
toujours d’après	still by	Standard.
$7 \rightarrow, - \rightarrow, \sim =$	$\mapsto, \rightarrow, \cong$	OCR repair, per the SGA 2 glossary.

Exposé VIII. The finiteness theorem

1. A biduality spectral sequence⁴²

Let us state the result we want to reach:

Proposition.

Let A be a noetherian ring and let I be an ideal of A . Set $X = \text{Spec}(A)$ and $Y = V(I)$. Let M be a finitely generated A -module of finite projective dimension. Let $F = \tilde{M}$ be the $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module associated with M .

1. There exists a spectral sequence

$$E_2^{\{p,q\}} = \text{Ext}_Y^{\{p,q\}}(\text{Ext}_Y^{\{-q\}}(M, A), A) \Rightarrow H^{\{p+q\}}_Y(X, F).$$

1. There exists a spectral sequence

$$E_2^{\{p,q\}} = \text{Ext}_Y^{\{p,q\}}(\text{Ext}_Y^{\{-q\}}(F, \mathcal{O}_X), \mathcal{O}_X) \Rightarrow H^{\{p+q\}}_Y(X, F).$$

Of course, 2) is deduced from 1) by remarking that, if M and N are two finitely generated A -modules, and if one sets $F = \tilde{M}$ and $G = \tilde{N}$, then one has isomorphisms

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{H}^{\bullet}_Y(F) &\cong \tilde{H}^{\bullet}_Y(X, F), \\ \text{Ext}_Y^{\bullet}(F, G) &\cong \tilde{\text{Ext}}^{\bullet}_Y(F, G), \\ \text{Ext}_Y^{\bullet}(\mathcal{O}_X)(F, G) &\cong \tilde{\text{Ext}}^{\bullet}_A(M, N). \end{aligned}$$

Let $\mathcal{C}$ be the category of A -modules and Ab that of abelian groups. Let F be the functor

$$F : \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \text{Ab} \quad \text{defined by} \quad M \mapsto \Gamma_Y(\tilde{M}).$$

We know from Exposé II that there is an isomorphism of ∂ -functors

$$H^{\bullet}_Y(X, \tilde{M}) \cong R^{\bullet}F(M).$$

Furthermore, let $\text{Ext}_Y^{\bullet}$ denote the right derived functors in the second argument of

$$F \circ \text{Hom} : \mathcal{C}^{\circ} \times \mathcal{C} \rightarrow \text{Ab}.$$

We know from Exposé VI that there is an isomorphism of ∂ -functors

$$\text{Ext}_Y^{\bullet}(M, N) \simeq \text{Ext}_Y^{\bullet}(\tilde{M}, \tilde{N}).$$

Let us finally record the following result from Exposé VI: if C is an injective A -module and N is a finitely generated A -module, then the sheaf $\text{Hom}(\tilde{N}, \tilde{C}) \cong \text{Hom } \tilde{N}, C$ is flasque, hence

$$R^1F(\text{Hom}(N, C)) = 0.$$

It remains to prove the following result:

Lemma.

⁴²The reader familiar with the language of Verdier's derived categories will recognize the spectral sequence associated with a biduality isomorphism. Cf. SGA 6 I.

Let A be a noetherian ring and let C be the category of A -modules. Let $F : C \rightarrow Ab$ be a left exact additive functor such that, for every finitely generated A -module N and every injective A -module C , one has $R^1 F(\text{Hom}(N, C)) = 0$. Let M be a finitely generated A -module of finite projective dimension. Then there exists a spectral sequence

$$E_2^{\wedge\{p,q\}} = \text{Ext}^p_F(\text{Ext}^q(M, A), A) \Rightarrow R^{\wedge\{p+q\}} F(M),$$

where Ext_F^p denotes the p -th right derived functor of $F \circ \text{Hom}$.

We shall consider only complexes whose differential has degree $+1$. By the hypothesis on M , there exists a projective resolution of M of finite length

$$u : L^\bullet \rightarrow M,$$

where, moreover, the L^p are finitely generated modules and $L^p = 0$ if $p \notin [-n, 0]$. Let, on the other hand, $v : M \rightarrow I^\bullet$ be an injective resolution of M . We claim that

$$v \circ u : L^\bullet \rightarrow I^\bullet$$

is an injective resolution of $L^\bullet$. We must specify what this means.

Definition.

Let $X^\bullet$ be a complex of A -modules; by an *injective resolution* of $X^\bullet$ one means a homomorphism of complexes

$$x : X^\bullet \rightarrow C_X^\bullet,$$

such that C_X^p is injective for every $p \in \mathbb{Z}$, and such that x induces an isomorphism on homology.

Proposition.

Every left-bounded complex — i.e. such that there exists $q \in \mathbb{Z}$ with $X^p = 0$ for $p < q$ — admits an injective resolution. Moreover, if $u : X^\bullet \rightarrow Y^\bullet$ is a homomorphism of complexes (both left-bounded) and if $x : X^\bullet \rightarrow C_X^\bullet$ and $y : Y^\bullet \rightarrow C_Y^\bullet$ are injective resolutions of $X^\bullet$ and $Y^\bullet$, then there exists a homomorphism of complexes

$$C_u : C_X^\bullet \rightarrow C_Y^\bullet,$$

unique up to homotopy, such that the diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X^\bullet & \xrightarrow{x} & C_X^\bullet \\ | & & | \\ u & & C_u \\ | & & | \\ \blacktriangledown & \xrightarrow{y} & \blacktriangledown \\ Y^\bullet & \xrightarrow{\quad} & C_Y^\bullet \end{array}$$

is commutative up to homotopy.

The proof is left to the reader.⁴³

Let us recall a notation introduced in Exposé V.

Notation.

Let $X^\bullet$ and $Y^\bullet$ be two complexes. We denote by $\text{Hom}^\bullet(X^\bullet, Y^\bullet)$ the simple complex whose component of degree n is

$$(\text{Hom}^\bullet(X^\bullet, Y^\bullet))^n = \prod_{-p+q=n} \text{Hom}(X^p, Y^q),$$

also written $\text{Hom}^n(X^\bullet, Y^\bullet)$, and whose differential is given by

$$\begin{aligned} \partial^n : \text{Hom}^n(X^\bullet, Y^\bullet) &\rightarrow \text{Hom}^{n+1}(X^\bullet, Y^\bullet), \\ \partial^n &= d' + (-1)^{n+1} d'', \end{aligned}$$

where d' and d'' are the differentials (of degree +1) induced by those of $X^\bullet$ and $Y^\bullet$.

Let then $A^\bullet$ be the complex defined by $A^p = 0$ if $p \neq 0$ and $A^0 = A$. Let

$$a : A^\bullet \rightarrow C_A^\bullet$$

be an injective resolution of $A^\bullet$. Consider the double complex

$$Q^{p,q} = \text{Hom}(\text{Hom}(L^{\wedge -q}, A), C_A^p).$$

The first spectral sequence of the bicomplex $FQ^{\bullet\bullet}$ will yield the conclusion of Lemma 1.2.

Set

$$L'^\bullet = \text{Hom}^\bullet(L^\bullet, A^\bullet),$$

and

$$P^\bullet = \text{Hom}^\bullet(L'^\bullet, C_A^\bullet).$$

One sees easily that $P^\bullet$ is the simple complex associated with $Q^{\bullet\bullet}$. Let us compute the abutment of the spectral sequence, i.e. the homology of $FP^\bullet$. For this, using the fact that $L^\bullet$ is finitely generated projective in every dimension, one proves that $L^\bullet$ is isomorphic to $\text{Hom}^\bullet(L'^\bullet, A^\bullet)$. From the homomorphism $a : A^\bullet \rightarrow C_A^\bullet$ one deduces a homomorphism

$$b : \text{Hom}^\bullet(L'^\bullet, A^\bullet) \rightarrow \text{Hom}^\bullet(L'^\bullet, C_A^\bullet),$$

or equivalently, a homomorphism

$$c : L^\bullet \rightarrow P^\bullet.$$

⁴³Cf. also H. Cartan and S. Eilenberg, *Homological Algebra*, Princeton Math. Series, vol. 19, Princeton University Press, 1956.

This being said, it is easy to see, using the fact that $L'^\bullet$ is finitely generated projective in every dimension and left-bounded, that (1.5) is an injective resolution of $L^\bullet$. Applying Proposition 1.4, one concludes that $P^\bullet$ is homotopy-equivalent to $I^\bullet$, where $I^\bullet$ is the injective resolution of M introduced earlier (1.1). One deduces that the abutment of the first spectral sequence of the double complex $FQ^{\bullet\bullet}$, which is $H^\bullet(FP^\bullet)$, is isomorphic to $R^\bullet F(M)$.

The initial term of the first spectral sequence of the bicomplex $FQ^{\bullet\bullet}$ is

$$E_2^{p,q} = {}'H^p({}''H^q(FQ^{\bullet\bullet})).$$

For every $p \in \mathbb{Z}$, C_A^p is injective. By the hypothesis on F , the functor (restricted to the category of finitely generated modules)

$$N \mapsto F \operatorname{Hom}(N, C_A^p)$$

is exact. Hence one deduces isomorphisms

$${}''H^q(F \operatorname{Hom}(L'^\bullet, C_A^p)) \cong F \operatorname{Hom}({}'H^{-q}(L'^\bullet), C_A^p).$$

By the definition of $Ext_F^\bullet$ as the derived functor of $F \circ \operatorname{Hom}$, one deduces isomorphisms

$$E_2^{p,q} \cong Ext_F^p(H^{-q}(L'^\bullet), A).$$

Now $L'^\bullet = \operatorname{Hom}^\bullet(L^\bullet, A^\bullet)$, where $L^\bullet$ is a projective resolution of M , whence isomorphisms

$$Ext^{-q}(M, A) \cong H^{-q}(L'^\bullet),$$

which gives the conclusion. QED.

2. The finiteness theorem

Theorem.⁴⁴

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme, Y a closed subset of X , and F a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module. Suppose that X is locally embeddable in a regular prescheme.⁴⁵ Let $i \in \mathbb{Z}$. Suppose that:

a) for every $x \in U = X - Y$, one has

$$H^{i-c(x)}(F_x) = 0,$$

where one has set⁴⁶

⁴⁴N.D.E. For an analogous statement, but in a somewhat more general situation, see Mme Raynaud (Raynaud M., "Théorèmes de Lefschetz en cohomologie des faisceaux cohérents et en cohomologie étale. Application au groupe fondamental", *Ann. Sci. Éc. Norm. Sup.* (4) **7** (1974), pp. 29–52, proposition II.2.1).

⁴⁵This condition can be generalized to the hypothesis of the existence locally on X of a "dualizing complex", in the sense defined in R. Hartshorne, *Residues and duality* (cited in footnote (*) of Exp. IV p. 46).

⁴⁶N.D.E. As in Exposé V, $H_x^\bullet(F)$ denotes the local cohomology $H_{\mathfrak{m}_x}^\bullet(F_x)$.

$$c(x) = \text{codim}(\{x\} \cap Y, \{x\}).$$

Then:

- b) $\mathcal{H}_Y^i(F)$ is coherent.

Corollary.⁴⁷

Under the hypotheses of the preceding theorem, condition a) is equivalent to:

- c) for every $x \in U$ such that $c(x) = 1$, one has $H^{i-1}(F_x) = 0$.

Corollary.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme that is locally embeddable in a regular prescheme, let Y be a closed subset of X , let F be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module, and let n be an integer. The following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) for every $x \in U$, one has $\text{prof} F_x > n - c(x)$;
- (ii) for every $x \in U$ such that $c(x) = 1$, one has $\text{prof} F_x \geq n$;
- (iii) for every $i \in \mathbb{Z}$, $\mathcal{H}_Y^i(F)$ is coherent if $i \leq n$;
- (iv) $R^i i_*(F|U)$ is coherent for $i < n$.⁴⁸

Suppose these results acquired when X is the spectrum of a regular noetherian ring A and when F is the sheaf associated with an A -module of finite projective dimension.

Let us first remark that, if $(X_j)_{j \in J}$ is an open covering of X by opens embeddable in a regular scheme, then each of the above conditions is equivalent to the conjunction of the analogous conditions obtained by replacing X by X_j , Y by $Y_j = Y \cap X_j$, and F by $F|X_j$. Indeed, only the conditions involving $c(x)$ can present a difficulty. Let $x \in U$. If $x \in X_j$, setting

$$c_j(x) = \text{codim}(X_j \cap \{x\} \cap Y, X_j \cap \{x\}),$$

one has necessarily $c_j(x) \geq c(x)$. Let $y \in \bar{x} \cap Y$ which “gives the codimension”, i.e. such that $c(x) = \dim \mathcal{O}_{\bar{x}, y}$, and let X_j be an open of the covering such that $y \in X_j$; then $x \in X_j$, hence $c_j(x) = c(x)$, which lets us conclude that a) for the X_j implies a) for X .

At this stage, one has only a partial converse, namely that a) for X implies a) for the X_j such that $c(x) = c_j(x)$, which suffices for our purposes.⁴⁹

⁴⁷N.D.E. Strictly speaking, this is a corollary of the proof that follows and not of the statement. The implication $c) \Rightarrow a)$ is tautological. The other direction is not, but follows from the proof. To be precise: as below, one covers X by opens embeddable in regular schemes, which allows one, as explained below, to reduce to $X = \text{Spec}(A)$ affine regular and $F = \tilde{M}$ where M is an A -module of finite projective dimension. It is shown in this case that conditions a) and c) are equivalent to the dual conditions a') and c'). One then shows that c') implies condition d) (see below) which itself implies a'). See the considerations following 2.4.

⁴⁸N.D.E. This condition appeared only in the body of the proof, but not in the statement of the corollary; since it is used in §3, we have added it.

⁴⁹N.D.E. In fact, a) for X implies a) for all the X_j as asserted in the original text, but to see this one must read the proof that follows in detail. This implication does not seem formal at this stage. Let us indeed denote by an index J the conjunctions of a property a), b), or c) for the X_j . It is proved in the proof below that $c_J \Rightarrow a_J$ (this is the chain of implications $c' \Rightarrow d \Rightarrow a'$). Now one has tautologically $a) \Rightarrow c)$, and $c) \Leftrightarrow c_J$, whence $a) \Rightarrow a_J$.

One chooses a covering of X by opens embeddable in a regular prescheme. Applying the preceding, one sees that one can suppose X closed in a regular X' . The reduction to X' is then immediate.

One can therefore suppose X regular, and even affine by covering X by affine opens. That one can suppose $F = \tilde{M}$, where M is of finite projective dimension, will result from the following lemma:

Lemma.

Let X be a regular noetherian prescheme. Let F be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module. The function which to each $x \in X$ assigns the projective dimension of F_x is upper-bounded.

Indeed, let $x \in X$ and let U be an affine open neighborhood of x . Let $L^\bullet$ be a projective resolution of the module $F(U)$, where the L^i are finitely generated. By hypothesis, the ring $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is regular, hence the projective dimension of F_x is finite; let d be that integer. Let

$$K = \ker(L^{-d} \rightarrow L^{-d+1}).$$

The module K_x is free, because d is the projective dimension of F_x ([M], Ch. VI, Prop. 2.1). By (EGA 0_I 5.4.1 Errata), one deduces that the $\mathcal{O}_U$ -Module $\tilde{K}$ is free on a neighborhood U' of x , with $U' \subset U$. Choosing $f \in \mathcal{O}_X(U)$ such that $x \in D(f) \subset U'$, one therefore has a projective resolution of M_f (with $M = F(U)$):

$$0 \rightarrow K_f \rightarrow (L^{d-1})_f \rightarrow \cdots \rightarrow M_f \rightarrow 0,$$

which proves that the function under study is upper semi-continuous. Now X is quasi-compact, whence the conclusion.

We henceforth suppose X affine noetherian regular and we suppose that $F = \tilde{M}$, where M is a finitely generated A -module, necessarily of finite projective dimension. We shall proceed in several steps. First, we find a condition d), equivalent to a), and prove that it is also equivalent to c). Then, using the spectral sequence of the preceding number, we prove d) $\Rightarrow$ b). It then remains to prove that (iii) $\Rightarrow$ (ii); indeed, (i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (iii) follows immediately from a) $\Leftrightarrow$ c) $\Rightarrow$ b).

Let $x \in U$; by hypothesis $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is a regular local ring. Denoting by D the dualizing functor relative to the local ring $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$, it follows from (V 2.1) that

$$D H^i\{i-c(x)\}(F_x) \cong \text{Ext}^i\{d(x)-i\}_\bullet\{\mathcal{O}_\bullet\{X,x\}\}(F_x, \mathcal{O}_\bullet\{X,x\}),$$

where one has set

$$d(x) = \dim \mathcal{O}_\bullet\{X,x\} + c(x) = \dim \mathcal{O}_\bullet\{X,x\} + \text{codim}(\{x\} \cap Y, \{x\}).$$

Now X is noetherian and F is coherent, hence

$$D H^i\{i-c(x)\}(F_x) \cong (\text{Ext}^i\{d(x)-i\}_\bullet\{\mathcal{O}_\bullet X\}(F, \mathcal{O}_\bullet X))_x.$$

Moreover, for a module to be zero, it is necessary and sufficient that its dual be (cf. editor's note (4) on page 54). For every $q \in \mathbb{Z}$, set

$$\begin{aligned} S_q &= \text{Supp Ext}^q_{\mathcal{O}_X}(F, \mathcal{O}_X), \\ S'_q &= S_q \cap U, \quad (U = X - Y), \\ Z_q &= S'_q \cap Y. \end{aligned}$$

From formula (2.3), it follows that a) and c) are respectively equivalent to:

- a') for every $q \in \mathbb{Z}$ and every $x \in S'_q$, one has $q + i \neq d(x)$.
- c') for every $q \in \mathbb{Z}$ and every $x \in S'_q$, if $c(x) = 1$, one has $q + i \neq d(x)$.

Here is the condition d) promised above:

- d) for every $q \in \mathbb{Z}$ and every $y \in Z_q$, one has $q + i \neq \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,y}$.

These conditions are equivalent:

a') $\Rightarrow$ c') is trivial.

d) $\Rightarrow$ a'). Indeed, let $q \in \mathbb{Z}$ and let $x \in S'_q$; let $y \in \bar{x} \cap Y$ which⁵⁰ “gives the codimension”, i.e. such that

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_{\{\{x\}, y\}} = \text{codim}(\{x\} \cap Y, \{x\}) = c(x).$$

From the fact that X is regular at y , one deduces

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_{\{X, y\}} = d(x) \quad (\text{cf. (2.2)}).$$

But $y \in \bar{x}$, hence $y \in Z_q$, whence the conclusion.

c') $\Rightarrow$ d). Let $q \in \mathbb{Z}$ and let $y \in Z_q$. Provisionally admit that there exists $x \in S'_q$ such that $y \in \{x\}$ and $\dim \mathcal{O}_{\{\{x\}, y\}} = 1$

(one also says that x follows y). It follows that $c(x) = 1$, since y “gives the codimension of $\bar{x} \cap Y$ in $\bar{x}$ ”, because $x \notin Y$. By c') we extract

$$q + i \neq d(x).$$

Whence the conclusion, on noting that $d(x) = \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,y}$ (2.6). The admitted result is expressed in the following lemma:

Lemma.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme and let Y be a closed subset of X . Set $U = X - Y$ and suppose that U is dense in X . For every $y \in Y$, there exists $x \in U$ “which follows it”, i.e. such that

$$y \in \{x\} \quad \text{and} \quad \dim \mathcal{O}_{\{\{x\}, y\}} = 1.$$

We have applied the lemma taking for X the prescheme $\bar{S}'_q$ and for Y the part $Y \cap \bar{S}'_q$.

Proof of 2.5. — There exists $x \in U$ such that $y \in \bar{x}$; let us therefore choose $x \in U$ such that $y \in \bar{x}$ and such that $\dim \mathcal{O}_{\bar{x},y} = r$ be minimal. We must prove that $r = 1$. Since we

⁵⁰N.D.E. In all that follows, closures of points are equipped with the reduced structure.

have chosen x so that every $z \in \text{Spec}(\mathcal{O}_{\bar{x},y})$, $z \neq x$, lies in Y , x is open in $\text{Spec}(\mathcal{O}_{\bar{x},y})$. Whence the conclusion.

The second step consists in deducing b) from d).

Set $D(Z_q) = \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,y} | y \in Z_q$. By d), we know that, for every $q \in \mathbb{Z}$, $q + i \notin D(Z_q)$. One then applies VII.2.3, and sees that

$\text{Ext}^{\wedge\{q+i\}}_Y(\text{Ext}^{\wedge q}(F, \mathcal{O}_X), \mathcal{O}_X)$ is coherent.

The initial term of the spectral sequence of the preceding number is given by

$$E_2^{\wedge\{p,q\}} = \text{Ext}^{\wedge p}_Y(\text{Ext}^{\wedge\{-q\}}(F, \mathcal{O}_X), \mathcal{O}_X).$$

One deduces that $E_2^{p,q}$ is coherent for every $p \in \mathbb{Z}$ and every $q \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $p + q = i$. Now there are only finitely many pairs (p, q) with $p + q = i$, and this spectral sequence converges to $H_Y^\bullet(F)$, whence the conclusion.

It remains to prove that (iii) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). Let us write

$$i : U \rightarrow X$$

for the canonical immersion of U in X . Taking into account the exact homology sequence of the closed subset Y (I 2.11), one sees that (iii) is equivalent to:

(iv) $R^i i_*(F|U)$ is coherent for $i < n$.

Indeed, one has an exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^0_Y(F) \rightarrow F \rightarrow i_* (F|U) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^1_Y(F) \rightarrow 0.$$

Now $\mathcal{H}^0_Y(F)$ is a quasi-coherent subsheaf of the coherent sheaf F , hence is coherent. Therefore $\mathcal{H}^1_Y(F)$ is coherent if and only if $i_*(F|U)$ is. Moreover, for $p > 0$, the exact cohomology sequence of the closed subset Y reduces to isomorphisms

$$R^p i_*(F|U) \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{H}^{p+1}_Y(F).$$

We shall prove that (iv) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). For this, recall (ii):

(ii) for every $x \in U$ such that $c(x) = 1$, one has $\text{prof} F_x \geq n$.

We argue by induction on n .

If $n = 0$, the two conditions are empty.

If $n = 1$, one supposes that $i_*(F|U)$ is coherent. Argue by contradiction and suppose there exists $x \in U$ such that $c(x) = 1$ and $\text{prof} F_x = 0$, i.e. $x \in \text{Ass} F_x$. Let $y \in \bar{x} \cap Y$ such that $\dim \mathcal{O}_{\bar{x},y} = 1$. Set

$$A = \mathcal{O}_{\bar{x},y} \quad \text{and} \quad X' = \text{Spec}(A).$$

Carry out the base change $v : X' \rightarrow X$, which is flat:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
U' = X' \times_{X'} U & \xrightarrow{\quad} & U \\
\downarrow i' & & \downarrow i \\
X' & \xrightarrow{\quad v \quad} & X.
\end{array}$$

The morphism i is separated (since it is an immersion), and of finite type (since it is an open immersion and X is locally noetherian); the base change is flat, hence (EGA III 1.4.15) one has an isomorphism

$$v^*(i_*(F|U)) \cong i'_*(v'^*(F|U)).$$

Let us denote by $\mathfrak{x}$ (resp. $\mathfrak{y}$) the ideal of A corresponding to x (resp. y). Set $G = v'^*(F|U)$; then G is coherent and $\mathfrak{x} \in \text{Ass} G$, so there exists a monomorphism $\mathcal{O}_{\bar{x}} \rightarrow G$, and consequently $i'_*(\mathcal{O}_{\bar{x}}|U')$ is coherent. By the choice of y , $\dim A/\mathfrak{x} = 1$, and consequently the support of $\mathcal{O}_{\bar{x}}$ is reduced to $\bar{x} = x \cup y$, since $\bar{x} = \text{Spec}(A/\mathfrak{x})$ as a scheme. It follows that

$$(\mathcal{O}_{\bar{x}}|U')(U') = \text{Frac}(A/\mathfrak{x}),$$

the field of fractions of $A/\mathfrak{x}$, and

$$i'_*(\mathcal{O}_{\bar{x}}|U')(X') = \text{Frac}(A/\mathfrak{x}).$$

But $\text{Frac}(A/\mathfrak{x})$ is not a finitely generated A -module, because $\mathfrak{x}$ differs from the maximal ideal of A . Whence a contradiction.

Suppose $n > 1$ and that the result is acquired for the $n' < n$. By the induction hypothesis, for every $x \in U$ such that $c(x) = 1$, one has $x \notin \text{Ass} F_x$. Let such an x , and let $y \in \bar{x} \cap Y$ such that x follows y , i.e. $\dim \mathcal{O}_{\bar{x},y} = 1$. Carry out the base change $v : \text{Spec}(\mathcal{O}_{X,y}) \rightarrow X$, keeping the notation of diagram (2.7). One finds, applying (EGA III 1.4.15), isomorphisms

$$v^*(R^p i_* (F|U)) \simeq R^p i'_* (v'^*(F|U)), \quad p \in \mathbb{Z}.$$

One thus reduces to the case where X is the spectrum of a local ring A in which $\mathfrak{x}$ is a prime ideal of dimension 1, i.e. $\dim A/\mathfrak{x} = 1$. Then set $F' = \Gamma_Y(F)$ and $F'' = F/F'$. One sees that $F_x \simeq F''_x$ and that $\mathfrak{y} \notin \text{Ass} F''$. Moreover $F'|U = 0$, whence, by the exact sequence of the $R^p i_*$, isomorphisms

$$R^p i_* (F|U) \simeq R^p i'_* (F''|U), \quad p \in \mathbb{Z}.$$

Since $n > 1$, one deduces that neither $\mathfrak{x}$ nor $\mathfrak{y}$ belongs to $\text{Ass} F''$. Now $\mathfrak{x}, \mathfrak{y}$ are the only prime ideals of A containing $\mathfrak{x}$; it follows (III 2.1) that there exists an element $g \in \mathfrak{x}$ which is M -regular, where one has set $F = \tilde{M}$, $M = F(X)$. Whence an exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow M \xrightarrow{g \cdot} M \rightarrow N \rightarrow 0,$$

in which g_* denotes multiplication by g in M . By the exact homology sequence, one sees that

$$R^p i_* (\tilde{N}|_U) \text{ is coherent for } p < n - 1,$$

hence, by the induction hypothesis, $prof(\tilde{N})_x \geq n - 1$, and therefore $prof F_x \geq n$. QED.

3. Applications

One deduces from these results a coherence condition for the higher direct images of a coherent sheaf under a morphism that is not proper.

Theorem.

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a morphism of preschemes. Suppose that Y is locally noetherian and that f is proper. Suppose that X is locally embeddable in a regular prescheme. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Let U be an open of X and let F be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_U$ -Module. Suppose that, for every $x \in U$ such that $\text{codim}(\bar{x} \cap (X - U), \bar{x}) = 1$, one has $prof F_x \geq n$. Then the $\mathcal{O}_Y$ -Modules $R^p(f \circ g)_*(F)$ are coherent for $p < n$, where g is the canonical immersion of U in X .

Indeed, there exists a Leray spectral sequence whose abutment is $R^\bullet(f \circ g)_*(F)$ and whose initial term is given by

$$E_2^{p,q} = R^p f_* (R^q g_*(F)).$$

Moreover, there exists a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module G such that $G|_U \simeq F$ (EGA I 9.4.3). It then follows from the preceding paragraph that condition (iv) of page 74 is satisfied, i.e. that $R^q g_*(G|_U)$ is coherent for $q < n$. One then applies the finiteness theorem of EGA III 3.2.1 to f and to the sheaves $R^q g_*(F)$, and finds that $E_2^{p,q}$ is coherent for $q < n$, whence the conclusion.

Proposition.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme that is locally embeddable in a regular prescheme. Let U be an open of X and let $i : U \rightarrow X$ be the canonical immersion. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Finally, let F be a coherent and Cohen-Macaulay $\mathcal{O}_U$ -Module (on $U!$). The following conditions are equivalent:

- (a) $R^p i_*(F)$ is coherent for $p < n$;
- (b) for every irreducible component S' of the closure $\bar{S}$ of the support S of F , one has

$$\text{codim}(S' \cap (X - U), S') > n.$$

Let G be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module such that $G|_U \simeq F$ (EGA I 9.4.3). Applying Corollary 2.3 to G , one finds that condition (a) is equivalent to:

- (c) for every $x \in \bar{S}$, one has $prof F_x > n - c(x)$, with

$$c(x) = \text{codim}(\{x\} \cap Y, \{x\}).$$

- (a) $\Rightarrow$ (b). Indeed, let S' be an irreducible component of $\bar{S}$ and let s be its generic point. Since F is Cohen-Macaulay, one has $prof F_s = \dim \mathcal{O}_{\bar{S},s} = 0$. Moreover, $\bar{s} = S'$, whence the conclusion.

(b) $\Rightarrow$ (a). Let $x \in \bar{S}$ and let S' be an irreducible component of $\bar{S}$ such that $x \in S'$. Let s be the generic point of S' . Since F is Cohen-Macaulay, one knows that

$$\text{prof } F_x = \dim \mathcal{O}_{\bar{S}, x}.$$

If $c(x) = +\infty$, there is nothing to prove. Otherwise, there exists $y \in Y \cap \bar{x}$ such that

$$c(x) = \dim \mathcal{O}_{\bar{S}, y}.$$

Now $\mathcal{O}_{X, y}$ is a quotient of a regular local ring by hypothesis, hence

$$\dim \mathcal{O}_{\bar{S}, y} = \dim \mathcal{O}_{\bar{S}, x} + \dim \mathcal{O}_{\bar{S}, y} > n.$$

QED.

Bibliography

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Translation ledger — Exposé VIII

Terms confirmed or first activated in this Exposé (consult glossary.md for the volume-wide list):

French	English	Note
suite spectrale de bidualité	biduality spectral sequence	Title-level, §1.
théorème de finitude	finiteness theorem	Title of §2 and of Exposé.
résolution injective (d'un complexe)	injective resolution (of a complex)	Definition VIII.1.3.
complexe limité à gauche	left-bounded complex	Used in Proposition VIII.1.4.
double complexe / bicomplexe	double complex / bicomplex	Source uses both interchangeably; preserved.
aboutissement	abutment	Standard for spectral sequences.
terme initial	initial term	Used for E_2 page.
localement	locally	Standing hypothesis of Theorem VIII.2.1.
immergeable dans un préschéma	embeddable in a regular	
régulier	prescheme	
$c(x) =$ $\text{codim}(\bar{x} \cap Y, \bar{x})$	$c(x)$ as written	Preserved verbatim from (2.1); closures are reduced (cf. N.D.E.).
profondeur ($\text{prof } F_x$)	depth ($\text{prof } F_x$)	Per glossary; the source uses prof .

French	English	Note
« x suit y »	“x follows y”	Translator keeps quotation marks since the source flags it; Lemma VIII.2.5.
sous-faisceau quasi-cohérent	quasi-coherent subsheaf	Standard.
de Cohen-Macaulay (sur U !)	Cohen-Macaulay (on U!)	Exclamation preserved; the parenthetical insists F is Cohen-Macaulay on the open U , not on a global ambient.
condition (a), (b), (c), (d)	condition (a), (b), (c), (d)	Lowercase Latin letters in this Exposé (not Roman); (i)–(iv) in Corollary 2.3 stay Roman, per the source.

Note on the $\Gamma_Z/\mathcal{H}_Y^\bullet$ typographic convention: in this Exposé, sheafified local cohomology is rendered $\mathcal{H}_Y^i(F)$ (script-H) and global sections with support remain $H_Y^i(X, F)$. The underlined section functor of the source is, when it appears, written Γ_Y in line with the volume-wide convention recorded in the introduction.

Exposé IX. Algebraic geometry and formal geometry

The goal of this Exposé is to generalize, to the case of a morphism that is not proper, Theorems 3.4.2 and 4.1.5 of EGA III.

1. The comparison theorem

Let $f : X \rightarrow X'$ be a separated morphism of preschemes of finite type. Suppose that X is locally noetherian. Let Y' be a closed subset of X' and let $Y = f^{-1}(Y')$.

Let $\hat{X}$ and $\hat{X}'$ be the formal completions of X and X' along Y and Y' . Let $\hat{f}$ be the morphism deduced from f by passing to the completions.

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 X & \longleftarrow & Y \\
 | & & | \\
 \downarrow f & & \downarrow \hat{f} \\
 X' & \longleftarrow & Y'
 \end{array}
 , \quad
 \begin{array}{ccc}
 \hat{X} & \xrightarrow{j} & X \\
 | & & | \\
 \downarrow \hat{f} & & \downarrow f \\
 \hat{X}' & \xrightarrow{i} & X'
 \end{array}$$

We denote by j (resp. i) the homomorphism from $\hat{X}$ into X (resp. from $\hat{X}'$ into X'). It is known that i and j are flat.

Let I' be an ideal of definition of Y' , and let $J = f^*(I') \cdot \mathcal{O}_X$; this is an ideal of definition of Y . One therefore has:

$$\hat{X}' = (Y', \lim_{\leftarrow \{k \in \mathbb{N}\}} \mathcal{O}_{X'}/I'^{\wedge\{k+1\}}), \quad \hat{X} = (Y, \lim_{\leftarrow \{k \in \mathbb{N}\}} \mathcal{O}_X/J^{\wedge\{k+1\}}).$$

For every $k \in \mathbb{N}$, set:

$$Y'_k = (Y', \mathcal{O}_{X'}/I'^{\wedge\{k+1\}}), \quad Y_k = (Y, \mathcal{O}_X/J^{\wedge\{k+1\}}).$$

Let F be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module. For every $k \in \mathbb{N}$, we set:

$$F_k = F/J^{k+1}F, \quad \hat{F} = j^*(F) \simeq \lim_{\leftarrow} \{F_k\}.$$

If we set:

$$R^i f_* (F)^\wedge = \lim_{\leftarrow} \{k \in \mathbb{N}\} (R^i f_* (F) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{X'}} \mathcal{O}_{Y'_k}), \quad i \in \mathbb{Z},$$

one has a natural homomorphism:

$$r_i: i^*(R^i f_* (F)) \rightarrow R^i f_* (F)^\wedge,$$

which is an isomorphism when $R^i f_* (F)$ is coherent.

As is explained in EGA III 4.1.1, one has a commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} i^*(R^i f_* (F)) & \xrightarrow{\rho_i} & R^i \hat{f}_* (\hat{F}) \\ \downarrow r_i & & \downarrow \psi_i \\ R^i f_* (F)^\wedge & \xrightarrow{\phi_i} & \lim_{\leftarrow} \{k \in \mathbb{N}\} R^i f_* (F_k). \end{array}$$

In loc. cit. one finds a commutative diagram, since one knows that $R^i f_* (F)$ is coherent, and one identifies the source and target of (1.6). In our case, $R^i f_* (F)$ will be coherent only for certain values of i , for which we shall study (1.7).

Consider the graded ring

$$S = \bigoplus_{k \in \mathbb{N}} I^k,$$

and the graded S -Module:

$$H^i = \bigoplus_{k \in \mathbb{N}} R^i f_* (J^k F), \quad i \in \mathbb{Z},$$

whose S -Module structure is defined as follows.

The sheaf $R^i f_* (J^k F)$ is associated with the presheaf which, to every affine open U' of X' , associates:

$$H^i(f^{-1}(U'), J^k F|_{f^{-1}(U')}).$$

Let U' then be an affine open of X' , set

$$U = f^{-1}(U'),$$

and let $x' \in I'^m(U')$. Let x be the image of x' in $J^m(U)$. The homothety of ratio x on $F|_U$ maps $J^k F|_U$ into $J^{k+m} F|_U$, whence, by functoriality, a morphism:

$$\mu_{i, \{x', k\}}(U'): H^i(U, J^k F|_U) \rightarrow H^i(U, J^{k+m} F|_U),$$

defined for every $i \in \mathbb{Z}$ and every $k \in \mathbb{N}$, which gives, by passing to the associated sheaf, the graded S -Module structure on H^i .

Theorem.

Let n be an integer. Suppose that the graded S -Module H^i is of finite type for $i = n - 1$ and $i = n$. Then:

- (0) r_n and r_{n-1} are isomorphisms, and $R^i \hat{f}_*(\hat{F})$ is coherent for $i = n - 1$;
- (1) for $i = n - 1$, ρ_i , φ_i , and ψ_i are topological isomorphisms (in particular, the filtration defined on $R^{n-1} f_*(F)$ by the kernels of the homomorphisms

$$R^{n-1} f_*(F) \rightarrow R^{n-1} f_*(F_k)$$

is I' -good);

- (2) for $i = n$, ρ_i , φ_i , and ψ_i are monomorphisms; furthermore, the filtration on $R^n f_*(F)$ is I' -good and ψ_n is an isomorphism;
- (3) the projective system of the $R^i f_*(F_k)$ satisfies, for $i = n - 2, n - 1$, the uniform Mittag-Leffler condition, i.e. there exists a fixed integer $k \geq 0$ such that, for every $p \geq 0$ and every $p' \geq p + k$, one has:

$$\text{Im}[R^i f_*(F_{p'}) \rightarrow R^i f_*(F_p)] = \text{Im}[R^i f_*(F_{p+k}) \rightarrow R^i f_*(F_p)].$$

Proceeding as in EGA III 4.1.8, it is easy to reduce to the case where X' is the spectrum of a noetherian ring A . In this case, one knows that

$$R^i f_*(F) = H^i(X, F)^{\sim} \quad (\text{cf. 1.10}).$$

Let I be the ideal of A such that $\tilde{I} = I'$, and let

$$S = \bigoplus_{k \in \mathbb{N}} I^k,$$

$$H^i = \bigoplus_{k \in \mathbb{N}} H^i(X, J^k F), \quad i \in \mathbb{Z},$$

where H^i is equipped with the graded S -module structure defined by 1.11, where one has taken $U' = X'$.

The proof is modelled on that of EGA III 4.1.5; let us give a summary.

We work on φ_i and ψ_i , which correspond to homomorphisms of modules:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & H^i(\hat{X}, \hat{F}) & \\ & \downarrow \psi_i & \\ \varphi_i & \downarrow & \\ H^i(X, F)^{\wedge} & \longrightarrow & \lim_{k \in \mathbb{N}} H^i(X, F_k). \end{array}$$

- (a) We assume only that H^i is a graded S -module of finite type. We deduce that the filtration defined on $H^i(X, F)$ by the modules:

$$R^i_k = \ker(H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(X, F_k))$$

is I -good. For this, we use the cohomology exact sequence:

$$H^i(X, J^{k+1} F) \rightarrow H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(X, F_k),$$

which shows that the graded S -module $\bigoplus_{k \in \mathbb{N}} R^i_k$ is a quotient of the graded S -submodule

$$\bigoplus_{k \in \mathbb{N}} H^i(X, J^{k+1} F)$$

of H^i , hence is of finite type, since S is noetherian. Whence this first point.

Set:

$$M^i = H^i(X, F), \quad H^i_k = H^i(X, F_k).$$

One has a commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} H^i(X, F) \wedge & \xrightarrow{s_i} & \lim_{\leftarrow} \{k\} (M^i / R^i_k) \\ \searrow & \downarrow & \\ \phi_i & \downarrow t_i & \\ & \blacktriangledown & \\ & & \lim_{\leftarrow} \{k\} H^i_k, \end{array}$$

in which s_i is an isomorphism; indeed, the filtration of $H^i(X, F)$ is I -good. Moreover, t_i is a monomorphism; indeed, the functor $\lim$ is left exact, and, for every $k \geq 0$, the natural morphism $M^i / R^i_k \rightarrow H^i_k$ is a monomorphism, by definition of R^i_k .

To study the surjectivity of t_i , we introduce:

$$Q^i_k = \text{coker}(H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(X, F_k)),$$

whence a projective system of exact sequences:

$$0 \rightarrow R^i_k \rightarrow M^i \rightarrow H^i_k \rightarrow Q^i_k \rightarrow 0.$$

Using the cohomology exact sequence:

$$H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(X, F_k) \rightarrow H^{i+1}(X, J^{k+1} F),$$

one sees that the graded S -module

$$Q^i = \bigoplus_{k \in \mathbb{N}} Q^i_k$$

is a graded S -submodule of H^{i+1} . Moreover, for every $k \geq 0$, one has:

$$I^{k+1} Q^i_k = 0,$$

since Q^i_k is the image of H^i_k .

- (b) We assume only that H^{i+1} is of finite type, and we focus on t_i (forgetting s_i). Since S is noetherian, Q^i is of finite type; since $I^{k+1} Q^i_k$ vanishes, we find that there exist an integer $r \geq 0$ and an integer $k_0 \geq 0$ such that

$$I^r Q^i_k = 0 \quad \text{for } k \geq k_0.$$

It follows that the projective system $(Q^i_k)_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ is essentially zero, and hence the projective system $(H^i_k)_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ satisfies the uniform Mittag-Leffler condition. From the exact sequence (1.22) one deduces the exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow M^i / R^i_k \rightarrow H^i_k \rightarrow Q^i_k \rightarrow 0,$$

whence the exact sequence:

$$0 \rightarrow \lim_{\leftarrow} \{k\} M^i / R^i_k \xrightarrow{t_i} \lim_{\leftarrow} \{k\} H^i_k \rightarrow \lim_{\leftarrow} \{k\} Q^i_k.$$

Now the projective system $(Q^i_k)_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ is essentially zero, hence t_i is an isomorphism.

(c) Let us prove that, if H^i is of finite type, then ψ_i is an isomorphism. It suffices to apply EGA 0_III 13.3.1, taking as a basis of opens of X the affine opens. This is legitimate;

indeed, by (b), the projective system $(H^{i-1}_k)_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ satisfies the Mittag-Leffler condition.

The theorem follows formally from (a), (b), and (c). One will note that, in fact, the proof uses, at each step, the finiteness of H^i only for a single value of i .

Let us give some examples in which the hypothesis of Theorem 1.1 is satisfied.

Corollary.

Suppose that I' is generated by a section t' of $\mathcal{O}_{X'}$, and denote by t the corresponding section of $\mathcal{O}_X$. Let F be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -module and let n be an integer. Suppose that:

- (i) t is F -regular (i.e. the homothety of ratio t on F is a monomorphism).
- (ii) $R^i f_*(F)$ is coherent for $i = n - 1$ and $i = n$.

Then the hypothesis of Theorem 1.1 is satisfied.

Indeed, one observes that multiplication by t^k defines an isomorphism $F \xrightarrow{\sim} J^k F$, and one deduces that

$$H^i \simeq R^i f_*(F) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{\{X'\}}} \mathcal{O}_{\{X'\}}[T],$$

where T is an indeterminate. Whence the conclusion.

Corollary.

Suppose that $X' = \text{Spec}(A)$, where A is a noetherian ring separated and complete for the I -adic topology. Suppose that the S -module H^i is of finite type for $i = n - 1$ and $i = n$ (cf. 1.14 and 1.15). Then the hypotheses of Theorem 1.1 are satisfied, and one finds a commutative diagram of isomorphisms:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} H^i(X, F) & \xrightarrow{\rho'_i} & H^i(\hat{X}, \hat{F}) \\ \searrow & & \swarrow \\ \searrow & & \swarrow \\ \searrow \phi'_i & & \psi_i / \\ \searrow & & \swarrow \\ \blacktriangledown & & \blacktriangledown \\ \lim_{\leftarrow} \{k\} H^i(X, F_k) & & \text{for } i = n - 1. \end{array}$$

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⁵¹N.D.E. In the same vein, see the article by Chow (Chow W.-L., "Formal functions on homogeneous spaces", *Invent. Math.* **86** (1986), no. 1, pp. 115–130). The author proves the following result. Let X be an algebraic variety over a field, homogeneous under an algebraic group G , and let Z be a complete subvariety of X of dimension > 0 . Suppose that Z generates X in the following sense: given $p \in Z$, let Γ_p be the set of elements of G sending p into Z . One then says that Z generates if the group generated by the connected component of 1 of Γ_p is the whole of G . In this case, every formal rational function on X along Z is algebraic; compare with the results of Hironaka and

One simply notes that $H^i(X, F)$ is of finite type, hence isomorphic to its completion. One obtains (1.1) by transcribing the diagram of Modules (1.7) into the category of A -modules, and replacing the left vertical by $H^i(X, F)$.

Proposition.

Let A be a noetherian ring. Let $t \in A$ and suppose that A is separated and complete for the (tA) -adic topology. Set:

$$X' = \text{Spec}(A), \quad Y' = V(t), \quad I = (tA).$$

Let T be a closed subset of X' ; set

$$X = X' - T, \quad Y = Y' \cap X = Y' - (Y' \cap T).$$

Let F be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module. Finally, let

$$T' = \{x \in X' \mid \text{codim}(\{x\} \cap T, \{x\}) = 1\}.$$

Suppose that:

- a) t is F -regular,
- b) $\text{prof}_{T'}(F) \geq n + 1$,
- c) A is a quotient of a regular noetherian ring.

Then, in diagram (1.1), the morphisms ρ'_i , φ'_i , and ψ_i are isomorphisms for $i < n$ and monomorphisms for $i = n$. Moreover ψ_n is an isomorphism.

By virtue of 1.3 and 1.2, it suffices to prove that $R^i f_*(F)$ is coherent for $i \leq n$, which follows from the finiteness theorem 2.1.⁵²

In particular:

Example.

One will apply 1.4 when A is a local ring and t belongs to the radical $r(A)$ of A . One will then take $T = r(A)$. In this case, for $n = 1$, one obtains the following statement:

If A is noetherian, separated and complete for the t -adic topology, and a quotient of a regular ring (for example, if A is complete), if moreover t is F -regular and if $\text{prof}_{F_x} \geq 2$ for every $x \in \text{Spec}(A)$ such that $\dim A/x = 1$, then the natural homomorphism

Matsumura cited in editor's note (3) p. 138. In the line of the techniques introduced by these authors, let us point out the very pretty algebraization result due to Gieseker (Gieseker D., "On two theorems of Griffiths about embeddings with ample normal bundle", *Amer. J. Math.* **99** (1977), no. 6, pp. 1137–1150, Theorems 4.1 and 4.2). Let X be a connected projective variety of dimension > 0 , locally a complete intersection (over an algebraically closed field). Suppose one has two embeddings of X into smooth projective varieties Y, W . Then, if the formal completions of X in Y and W are equivalent, there exists a scheme U containing X (as a closed subscheme) which embeds into Y and W as an étale neighborhood of X in Y and W . In other words, formally equivalent entails étale-equivalent. See also the article of Faltings (Faltings G., "Formale Geometrie und homogene Räume", *Invent. Math.* **64** (1981), pp. 123–165).

⁵²N.D.E. The "finiteness theorem 2.1" referenced here is the finiteness theorem of Exposé VIII (VIII 2.3), not the Theorem 2.1 of the present Exposé; the source's local cross-reference is to the cohomological finiteness statement on which the existence theorem is built.

$$\Gamma(X, F) \rightarrow \Gamma(\hat{X}, \hat{F})$$

is an isomorphism.

Indeed, keeping the notation of 1.4, one has $T = r(A)$, and formula (1.33) says that

$$T' = \{x \in \text{Spec}(A) \mid \dim A/x = 1\}.$$

2. The existence theorem

Let us first state EGA III 3.4.2 in a slightly more general form.

Let $f : X \rightarrow X'$ be an adic morphism⁵³ of formal preschemes, with X' noetherian. Let I' be an ideal of definition of X' ; since f is adic, $f^* I' = J$ is⁵⁴ an ideal of definition of X .

For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, set

$$X_n = (X, \mathcal{O}_X / J^{n+1});$$

this is an ordinary prescheme having the same underlying topological space as X .

Let F be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module. For every $k \in \mathbb{N}$, the $\mathcal{O}_{X_k}$ -Modules

$$F_k = F / J^{k+1} F$$

are coherent. For every i , one has a homomorphism

$$\psi_i : R^i f_* (F) \rightarrow \lim_{\leftarrow} \{k\} R^i f_* (F_k),$$

deduced by functoriality from the natural homomorphism:

$$F \rightarrow F_k.$$

Set

$$S = \text{gr}_{\{I'\}} \mathcal{O}_{X'} = \bigoplus_{k \in \mathbb{N}} I'^k / I'^{k+1},$$

$$\text{gr}_J(F) = \bigoplus_{k \in \mathbb{N}} J^k F / J^{k+1} F,$$

$$R^i f_* (\text{gr}_J(F)) = \bigoplus_{k \in \mathbb{N}} R^i f_* (J^k F / J^{k+1} F).$$

It is clear that $R^i f_*$ is equipped with a graded S -Module structure.

Theorem.

Suppose that $R^i f_*$ is a graded S -Module of finite type for $i = n-1, i = n, i = n+1$. Then:

- (i) $R^n f_*(F)$ is coherent.

⁵³This hypothesis is not essential; cf. XII, p. 118.

⁵⁴N.D.E. By definition itself, cf. EGA I 10.12.1.

- (ii) The homomorphism ψ_n (2.3) is a topological isomorphism. The natural filtration of the right-hand side of (2.3) is I' -good.
- (iii) The projective system of the $R^n f_*(F_k)$ satisfies the uniform Mittag-Leffler condition.

The proof is very easy from EGA 0_III 13.7.7 (cf. EGA III 3.4.2), provided one corrects the text on page 78 as indicated in (EGA III 2, Err_III 24).

Theorem.

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Let A be a noetherian adic ring and let I be an ideal of definition of A . Let T be a closed subset of $X' = \text{Spec}(A)$. Suppose that I is generated by a $t \in A$. Take up the notation 1.31, 1.32, and 1.33. Let F be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_{\hat{X}}$ -Module. Set

$$F_0 = F/JF,$$

where $J = t\mathcal{O}_{\hat{X}}$ is an ideal of definition of $\hat{X}$. Suppose that A is a quotient of a regular noetherian ring and that:

- (1) t is F -regular,
- (2) $\text{prof}_{T'} F_0 \geq 2$.

Then there exists a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module $\tilde{F}$ such that $\tilde{F}^\wedge \simeq F$.

It suffices to prove that $\hat{f}_*(F)$ is a coherent $\mathcal{O}_{\hat{X}'}$ -Module, where $\hat{f} : \hat{X} \rightarrow \hat{X}'$ is the morphism of formal preschemes deduced from the injection of X into X' by completion with respect to t . Indeed, A is separated and complete for the t -adic topology, so there will exist an A -module F' whose completion will be isomorphic to $\hat{f}_*(F)$. Since X is an open of X' , one will be able to take $\tilde{F} = \tilde{F}'|_X$.

It remains to show that 2.1 is applicable to the morphism of formal preschemes $\hat{f}$ and to F . Now, by hypothesis (1), for every $k \in \mathbb{N}$ one has an isomorphism:

$$J^k F / J^{k+1} F \rightarrow F/JF,$$

whence it follows that the hypothesis of 2.1 will be satisfied if one knows that

$$R^i f_*(F_0) \text{ is coherent for } i \leq 1.$$

⁵⁵N.D.E. Numerous algebraization statements have been obtained since, not to mention those cited below; cf. the articles of Faltings or of Mme Raynaud cited in editor's notes (22) p. 155 and (7) p. 203 respectively. One has in mind in particular the results of Artin (see notably Artin M., "Algebraization of formal moduli. I", in *Global Analysis (Papers in Honor of K. Kodaira)*, Univ. Tokyo Press, Tokyo, 1969, pp. 21–71), but also the recent algebraicity results for leaves of foliations; see notably Bost J.-B., "Algebraic leaves of algebraic foliations over number fields", *Publ. Math. Inst. Hautes Études Sci.* **93** (2001), pp. 161–221, and Chambert-Loir A., "Théorèmes d'algébricité en géométrie diophantienne (d'après J.-B. Bost, Y. André, D. & G. Chudnovsky)", in *Séminaire Bourbaki, Vol. 2000/2001, Astérisque*, vol. 282, Société mathématique de France, Paris, 2002, Exp. 886, pp. 175–209, and the references cited therein. In particular, one will find in these two articles discussions of the link between algebraization questions and the theory of diophantine approximation.

Now this follows from (2) and from the finiteness theorem 2.1.⁵⁶ Whence the conclusion.

It remains to specialize this statement by supposing that A is a local ring.

Corollary.

Let A be a noetherian local ring and let $t \in r(A)$ be an element of the radical of A . Suppose that A is separated and complete for the t -adic topology and, moreover, a quotient of a regular ring (for example, suppose that A is a complete noetherian local ring). Set

$$X' = \text{Spec } A, \quad T = \{r(A)\},$$

and take up the notation (1.31), (1.32), and (1.33). Let F be an $\mathcal{O}_{\hat{X}}$ -Module. Suppose that:

- (1) t is F -regular,
- (2) $\text{prof}_{T'} F_0 \geq 2$, with $F_0 = F/JF$ and $J = t\mathcal{O}_{\hat{X}}$.

Then there exists a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module $\tilde{F}$ such that $\tilde{F}^\wedge \simeq F$.

Note that here T' is the set of prime ideals p of A such that $\dim A/p = 1$.

Exposé X. Application to the fundamental group

Throughout this Exposé, X will denote a locally noetherian prescheme, Y a closed part of X , U a variable open neighborhood of Y in X , and $\hat{X}$ the formal completion of X along Y (EGA I 10.8). For every prescheme Z , we denote by $\hat{E}t(Z)$ the category of étale coverings of Z , and by $L(Z)$ the category of locally free coherent Modules on Z .

1. Comparison of $\hat{E}t(\hat{X})$ and $\hat{E}t(Y)$

Let I be an ideal of definition of Y in X . Set, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, $Y_n = (Y, (\mathcal{O}_X/I^{n+1})|Y)$. The Y_n form a direct system of ordinary preschemes, or also of formal preschemes, by equipping the structure sheaves with the discrete topology. One knows (EGA I 10.6.2) that $\hat{X}$ is the direct limit, in the category of formal preschemes, of the direct system of the Y_n . One also knows (EGA I 10.13) that to give a formal $\hat{X}$ -prescheme of finite type R is the same as to give a direct system of Y_n -preschemes R_n of finite type, such that $R_n \simeq (R_{n+1}) \times_{(Y_{n+1})} (Y_n)$. Moreover, in order that R be an étale covering of $\hat{X}$, it is necessary and sufficient that for every n , R_n be an étale covering of Y_n . This said, it is easy to see that nilpotent elements do not matter for étale coverings (SGA 1 8.3), that is, that the base-change functor

$$\hat{E}t(Y_{n+1}) \longrightarrow \hat{E}t(Y_n)$$

is an equivalence of categories for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$. Hence:

Proposition.

⁵⁶N.D.E. The “finiteness theorem 2.1” referenced here is the finiteness theorem of Exposé VIII (VIII 2.3), not the Theorem 2.1 of the present Exposé; the source’s local cross-reference is to the cohomological finiteness statement on which the existence theorem is built.

With the notation introduced above, the natural functor $\hat{E}t(\hat{X}) \rightarrow \hat{E}t(Y)$ is an equivalence of categories (cf. SGA 1 8.4).

2. Comparison of $\hat{E}t(Y)$ and $\hat{E}t(U)$, for U variable

We shall introduce two conditions from which the announced comparison theorem will follow easily. Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme and let Y be a closed part of X . One says that the pair (X, Y) satisfies the *Lefschetz condition*, written $Le f(X, Y)$, if, for every open U of X containing Y and every locally free coherent sheaf E on U , the natural homomorphism

$$\Gamma(U, E) \rightarrow \Gamma(\hat{X}, \hat{E})$$

is an isomorphism.

One says that the pair (X, Y) satisfies the *effective Lefschetz condition*, written $Le f f(X, Y)$, if $Le f(X, Y)$ holds and if, moreover, for every locally free coherent sheaf E on $\hat{X}$, there exist an open neighborhood U of Y , a locally free coherent sheaf E on U , and an isomorphism $\hat{E} \simeq E$.

These conditions are satisfied in two important examples:

Example.⁵⁷

Let A be a noetherian ring and let $t \in \mathfrak{r}(A)$ be an A -regular element belonging to the radical $\mathfrak{r}(A)$ of A . Suppose that A is a quotient of a regular local ring and that A is complete for the t -adic topology (for example A complete for the $\mathfrak{r}(A)$ -adic topology). Set $X' = \text{Spec}(A)$ and $Y' = V(t)$; further, set $x = \mathfrak{r}(A)$ and $X = X' - x$, $Y = Y' - x$. So X is open in X' and $Y = X \cap Y'$. Then:

1. If, for every prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ of A such that $\dim A/\mathfrak{p} = 1$ (i.e. for every closed point of X), one has $\text{prof } A_{\mathfrak{p}} \geq 2$, then $Le f(X, Y)$ holds;
2. if, moreover, for every prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ of A such that $t \in \mathfrak{p}$ and $\dim A/\mathfrak{p} = 1$ (i.e. for every closed point of Y), one has $\text{prof } A_{\mathfrak{p}} \geq 3$, then $Le f f(X, Y)$ holds.

Let us first show that, for every open neighborhood U of Y in X , the complement of U in X is a union of a finite number of closed points (in X). Note that U is open in X , hence in X' , so $Z' = X' - U$ is closed.

Let I be an ideal of definition of Z' ; it suffices to prove that A/I is of dimension 1. But $Z' \cap Y' = x$, so $A/(I + (t))$ is artinian, whence the conclusion by the “Hauptidealsatz”.

The first hypothesis is equivalent to: “for every prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ of A , $\mathfrak{p} \neq \mathfrak{r}(A)$, one has $\text{prof } A_{\mathfrak{p}} \geq 3 - \dim A/\mathfrak{p}$ ”. Indeed, A is a quotient of a regular ring, so one may apply VIII 2.3 to the prescheme X' , to the closed part x , and to the coherent sheaf $\mathcal{O}_{X'}$, observing that $c(\mathfrak{p}) = \dim(A/\mathfrak{p})$ for $\mathfrak{p} \in U = X' - x$ (since x is the closed point of X').

⁵⁷N.D.E. One can slightly improve (i): see Mme Raynaud (Raynaud M., “Théorèmes de Lefschetz en cohomologie des faisceaux cohérents et en cohomologie étale. Application au groupe fondamental”, *Ann. Sci. Éc. Norm. Sup.* (4) **7** (1974), pp. 29–52, corollaries I.1.4 and I.5); the condition (ii) can be improved so as to get rid of the depth conditions along Y (see Theorem 3.3 of loc. cit. for a precise statement). The proof of this last point is very technical, the article cited above giving only indications of proof and referring to a detailed earlier version published in the *Bulletin de la Société mathématique de France*.

Let U be an open neighborhood of Y in X and let E be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_U$ -module. Set $Z = X - U$ and let $u : U \rightarrow X$ be the canonical immersion. We shall first prove that $u_*(E)$ is a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module, or what amounts to the same, that $\mathcal{H}_Z^i(E')$ is coherent for $i = 0, 1$, where E' is a coherent extension of E to X . To do this, one applies Theorem VIII 2.1 to the prescheme X , to the closed part Z , and to the coherent sheaf E' . It suffices to verify that for every point $\mathfrak{p} \in U$ such that $c(\mathfrak{p}) = 1$, one has $\text{prof} E'_\mathfrak{p} \geq 1$, where we have set

$$c(\mathfrak{p}) = \text{codim}(\{\mathfrak{p}\} \cap Z, \{\mathfrak{p}\}).$$

Now if $\mathfrak{p} \in U$ and $c(\mathfrak{p}) = 1$, denoting again by $\mathfrak{p}$ the ideal of A corresponding to $\mathfrak{p}$, one sees that $\dim A/\mathfrak{p} = 2$, since the complement of U is a union of a finite number of closed points and A is a quotient of a regular ring. Moreover, E is locally free, so for every $\mathfrak{p} \in \text{Supp} E$ one has $\text{prof} E_\mathfrak{p} = \text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{U,\mathfrak{p}}$. Finally, if $\mathfrak{p} \in U$ and $c(\mathfrak{p}) = 1$, one has

$$\text{prof} E'_\mathfrak{p} = \text{prof} E_\mathfrak{p} = \text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{U,\mathfrak{p}} = \text{prof} A_\mathfrak{p} \geq 3 - 2 = 1.$$

We must now prove that the natural homomorphism

$$\Gamma(U, E) \rightarrow \Gamma(\hat{X}, \hat{E})$$

is an isomorphism. Setting then $\tilde{E} = u_*(E)$, one notes that $\tilde{E}$ is coherent and of depth ≥ 2 at every closed point of X . It follows that $R^i f_*(\tilde{E})$ is coherent for $i = 0, 1$, where $f : X \rightarrow X'$ denotes the canonical immersion of X into $X' = \text{Spec}(A)$ (Exp. VIII). One then applies (IX 1.5) and concludes that

$$\Gamma(U, E) \rightarrow \Gamma(\hat{X}, \hat{E})$$

is an isomorphism, since A is complete for the t -adic topology. One has a commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Gamma(X, \tilde{E}) & \xrightarrow{\simeq} & \Gamma(U, E) \\ \swarrow & & \searrow \\ & \downarrow & \\ \Gamma(\hat{X}, \hat{E}) & & \end{array}$$

whence the conclusion.

Now let E be a locally free coherent sheaf on $\hat{X}$. If one has proved that E is algebraizable, i.e. is isomorphic to the formal completion of a coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module $\tilde{E}$, it is easy to see that $\tilde{E}$ is locally free in a neighborhood of Y , hence to prove $\text{Leff}(X, Y)$. Let $\hat{X}'$ be the formal spectrum of A for the t -adic topology, which is identified with the formal completion of X' along Y' . Denote by f the canonical immersion of X in X' , by f' the canonical immersion of Y in Y' , and by $\hat{f}$ the morphism deduced by passing to the completions. In order that E be algebraizable, it suffices that $\hat{f}_*(E)$ be a coherent $\mathcal{O}_{\hat{X}'}$ -Module, since A is complete for the t -adic topology. Let $I = t\mathcal{O}_{\hat{X}}$; this is an ideal of definition of $\hat{X}$.

For every $n \geq 0$, set $E_n = E/I^{n+1}E$. At every closed point $y \in Y$, the depth of E_0

is ≥ 2 ; indeed, t is an A -regular element, so $\text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{Y_0, y} = \text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{X, y} - 1 \geq 2$. One concludes that $\hat{f}_*(E)$ is coherent (IX 2.3). QED.

Example (Will allow comparison of the fundamental group of a projective variety and a hyperplane section).

Let K be a field and let X be a proper K -prescheme. Let L be an ample invertible $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module. Let $t \in \Gamma(X, L)$ be an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -regular element, which means that, for every open U and every isomorphism $u : L|_U \rightarrow \mathcal{O}_U$, $u(t)$ is a non-zero-divisor in $\mathcal{O}_U$ (a condition that does not depend on u). Let $Y = V(t)$ be the subscheme of X of equation $t = 0$.⁵⁸ Then:

1. If, for every closed point x in X , one has $\text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{X, x} \geq 2$, then $\text{Lef}(X, Y)$ holds;
2. if, moreover, for every closed point $y \in Y$ one has $\text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{X, y} \geq 3$, then $\text{Lef}(X, Y)$ holds.

This example will be treated in detail in Exp. XII.

Let S be a prescheme; one knows (EGA II 6.1.2) that the functor which to every finite flat covering $r : R \rightarrow S$ associates the $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Algebra $r_*(\mathcal{O}_R)$ induces an equivalence between the category of finite flat coverings of S and the category of locally free coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Algebras. Let U be an open neighborhood of Y , and let $r : R \rightarrow U$ be a finite flat covering of U . Let $\hat{R}$ be the finite flat covering of $\hat{X}$ deduced from it by base change. One has $\hat{r}_*(\mathcal{O}_{\hat{R}}) \simeq r_*(\mathcal{O}_R)$.

Suppose then that $\text{Lef}(X, Y)$ holds. This implies that, for every U , the inverse image functor

$$L(U) \longrightarrow L(\hat{X})$$

is fully faithful. Indeed, let E and F be two locally free coherent $\mathcal{O}_U$ -Modules; $\text{Hom}(E, F)$ is also coherent and locally free. By hypothesis the natural map

$$\Gamma_U(\text{Hom}(E, F)) \longrightarrow \Gamma_{\hat{X}}(\text{Hom}(\hat{E}, \hat{F}))$$

is an isomorphism, whence the conclusion, since Hom commutes with $\hat{}$ since everything is locally free. Now $\hat{}$ commutes with the tensor product, from which one deduces that the functor which to every locally free coherent $\mathcal{O}_U$ -Algebra A associates the $\mathcal{O}_{\hat{X}}$ -Algebra $\hat{A}$ is fully faithful. Better, if E is a locally free coherent $\mathcal{O}_U$ -Module, there is a bijective correspondence between the commutative $\mathcal{O}_{\hat{X}}$ -Algebra structures on $\hat{E}$.

Proposition.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme and let Y be a closed part of X . Let $\hat{X}$ be the formal completion of X along Y . For every open U of X , $U \supset Y$, denote by L_U (resp. P_U , resp. E_U) the functor which to every locally free coherent $\mathcal{O}_U$ -Module (resp. every finite flat covering of U , resp. every étale covering of U) associates its inverse image by $\hat{X} \rightarrow X$.

1. If $\text{Lef}(X, Y)$ holds, then for every open neighborhood U of Y , the functors L_U , P_U , and E_U are fully faithful.

⁵⁸N.D.E. Condition (ii) is superfluous; see footnote on page 90.

1. If $Leff(X, Y)$ holds, then for every locally free coherent $\mathcal{O}_{\hat{X}}$ -Module E (resp. ...), there exist an open U and a locally free coherent $\mathcal{O}_U$ -Module $\tilde{E}$ (resp. ...), such that $L_U(\tilde{E}) \simeq E$ (resp. ...).
- (i) Has been seen.
- (ii) Follows from (i) and from the hypothesis, at least for L_U and P_U . Moreover, if R is an étale covering of $\hat{X}$, there exist an open neighborhood U of Y in X and a finite flat covering R' of U such that $\hat{R}' \simeq R$. From it one deduces a covering R'' of Y which is étale by 1.1, so R' is étale in a neighborhood U' of Y . QED.

Corollary.

If $Leff(X, Y)$ holds, then in order that a finite flat covering R of an open neighborhood U of Y be connected, it is necessary and sufficient that $R \times_U \hat{X}$ be connected. In particular, in order that Y be connected, it is necessary and sufficient that the open neighborhood U of Y be connected, or again that $\hat{X}$ be connected.

Indeed, in order that a ringed space in local rings $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be connected, it is necessary and sufficient that $\Gamma(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ not be a direct product of two non-zero rings. Now one has

$$\Gamma(U, r_*(\mathcal{O}_{\tilde{R}})) \simeq \Gamma(\hat{X}, \hat{r}_*(\mathcal{O}_{\{\hat{R}\}}))$$

by $Leff(X, Y)$.

Corollary.

If $Leff(X, Y)$ holds, then for every U , the functor

$$\hat{Et}(U) \longrightarrow \hat{Et}(Y)$$

is fully faithful. If $Leff(X, Y)$ holds, then for every étale covering R of Y , there exist an open neighborhood U of Y and a covering R' of U such that $R' \times_U Y \simeq R$.

Corollary.⁵⁹

⁵⁹N.D.E. Joined with 3.3 and the criteria 2.4 and 3.4, one obtains the following relative Lefschetz theorem. Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a projective flat morphism of connected noetherian schemes and let D be an effective relative Cartier divisor in X which is relatively ample. If, for every $s \in S$, the depth of X_s at each closed point is ≥ 2 , then D is connected and, for every open U of X containing D , the arrow $i_U : \pi_1(D) \rightarrow \pi_1(U)$ is surjective. If, moreover, the depth of X_s along each closed point of D_s is ≥ 3 , and if the local rings of X at its closed points are pure — for example, complete intersections (cf. X 3.4) — then i_X is an isomorphism. Cf. Bost J.-B., “Lefschetz theorem for Arithmetic Surfaces”, *Ann. Sci. Éc. Norm. Sup.* (4) **32** (1999), pp. 241–312, Theorems 1.1 and 2.1. In the case where X is simply a smooth and geometrically connected projective surface over a field, connectedness of D and surjectivity of $\pi_1(D) \rightarrow \pi_1(U)$ (where U is an open containing D) always hold for D only nef of square > 0 (cf. loc. cit., Theorem 2.3 and also Theorem 2.4 for surfaces only normal and complete). In the case of an arithmetic surface (normal and quasi-projective) X over a ring of integers $\mathcal{O}_K$, Bost, improving on results of Ihara (Ihara Y., “Horizontal divisors on arithmetic surfaces associated with Belyi uniformizations”, in *The Grothendieck theory of dessins d'enfants* (Luminy, 1993), London Math. Soc. Lect. Note Series, vol. 200, Cambridge Univ. Press, Cambridge, 1994, pp. 245–254 or loc. cit., corollary 7.2), has shown that if a point $P \in X(\mathcal{O}_K)$, playing the role of the divisor D in the geometric situation, satisfies certain positivity conditions, then the arrow $\pi_1(X) \rightarrow \pi_1(\text{Spec } \mathcal{O}_K)$ deduced from the projection was invertible with inverse the arrow $\pi_1(\text{Spec } \mathcal{O}_K) \rightarrow \pi_1(X)$ deduced from P (loc. cit., Theorem 1.2).

If $Leff(X, Y)$ holds and Y is connected, then every open neighborhood U of Y is connected and the natural homomorphism $\pi_1(Y) \rightarrow \pi_1(U)$ is surjective. If, moreover, $Leff(X, Y)$ holds, the natural homomorphism

$$\pi_1(Y) \rightarrow \lim_{\leftarrow} \{\leftarrow, U\} \pi_1(U)$$

is an isomorphism. (N.B. One assumes that a “base-point” has been chosen in Y , which one also takes as base-point in X , for the definition of the fundamental groups.)

All of this follows trivially from Proposition 1.1 and Proposition 2.3.

3. Comparison of $\pi_1(X)$ and $\pi_1(U)$

Definition.

Let X be a prescheme and Z a closed part of X . Set $U = X - Z$. One says that the pair (X, Z) is *pure* if, for every open V of X , the functor

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{\text{Et}}(V) &\rightarrow \hat{\text{Et}}(V \cap U) \\ V' &\mapsto V' \times_V (V \cap U) \end{aligned}$$

is an equivalence of categories.⁶⁰

Definition.

Let A be a noetherian local ring. Set $X = \text{Spec } A$. Let $\mathfrak{r}(A)$ be the radical of A and let $x = \mathfrak{r}(A)$ be the closed point of X . One says that A is *pure* if the pair $(X, \{x\})$ is.

We leave to the reader the task of not proving the following proposition:

Proposition.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme and let Z be a closed part of X . In order that the pair (X, Z) be pure it is necessary and sufficient that, for every $z \in Z$, the ring $\mathcal{O}_{X,z}$ be pure.⁶¹

This said, the following theorem is the essential result of this number:

Theorem (Purity theorem).⁶²

1. A regular noetherian local ring of dimension ≥ 2 is pure (Zariski–Nagata purity theorem).
2. A noetherian local ring of dimension ≥ 3 which is a complete intersection is pure.

Recall that one says that a local ring is a *complete intersection* if there exist a regular noetherian local ring B and a B -regular sequence $(t_1, \dots, t_k)$ of elements of the radical $\mathfrak{r}(B)$ of B such that

⁶⁰For a more satisfactory notion in some respects, cf. the commentary XIV 1.6 d).

⁶¹Compare with the non-commutative case of XIV 1.8, whose proof is essentially the same as that of 3.3.

⁶²N.D.E. For the history of the methods employed, see Grothendieck’s letter of October 1, 1961 to Serre, *Correspondance Grothendieck–Serre*, edited by Pierre Colmez and Jean-Pierre Serre, Documents Mathématiques, vol. 2, Société Mathématique de France, Paris, 2001.

$$A \simeq B/(t_1, \dots, t_k).$$

In this connection, let us remark that it would be less ambiguous to say that A is an *absolute* complete intersection, by opposition with the situation, already encountered, in which X is a locally noetherian prescheme (which need not be regular) and Y is a closed part of X , of which one says that it is “locally set-theoretically a complete intersection in X ”.

Let us first prove a few lemmas.

Lemma.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme and let U be an open part of X . Set $Z = X - U$. Let $i : U \rightarrow X$ be the canonical immersion of U into X . The following conditions are equivalent:

1. For every open V of X , if one sets $V' = V \cap U$, the functor $F \mapsto F|_{V'}$ from the category of locally free coherent $\mathcal{O}_V$ -Modules to the category of locally free coherent $\mathcal{O}_{V'}$ -Modules is fully faithful;
2. the natural homomorphism $\mathcal{O}_X \rightarrow i_*(\mathcal{O}_U)$ is an isomorphism;
3. for every $z \in Z$, one has $\text{prof}_{\mathcal{O}_{X,z}} \geq 2$.

One has already seen (III 3.3) the equivalence of (ii) and (iii). Let us show that (ii) implies (i). Let F and G be two locally free coherent $\mathcal{O}_V$ -Modules; $\text{Hom}(F, G)$ is also one, so $\text{Hom}(F, G) \rightarrow i_*(\text{Hom}(F|_{V'}, G|_{V'}))$ is an isomorphism, so $\text{Hom}(F, G) \simeq \text{Hom}(F|_{V'}, G|_{V'})$. Conversely, one takes $F = G = \mathcal{O}_X$ and applies (i) to every open V of X .

Here is a useful “descent lemma”:

Lemma.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme and let Z be a closed part of X . Set $U = X - Z$. Suppose that the homomorphism $\mathcal{O}_X \rightarrow i_*(\mathcal{O}_U)$ is an isomorphism. Let $f : X_1 \rightarrow X$ be a faithfully flat and quasi-compact morphism. Set $Z_1 = f^{-1}(Z)$. If the pair (X_1, Z_1) is pure, then so is (X, Z) .

Note that the hypothesis $\mathcal{O}_X \simeq i_*(\mathcal{O}_U)$ is preserved by flat extension of the base, since i is a quasi-compact morphism and, in that case, direct image commutes with inverse image. Now this hypothesis implies that the functor

$$\hat{E}t(V) \longrightarrow \hat{E}t(U \cap V)$$

defined by

$$V' \mapsto V' \times_V (V \cap U)$$

is fully faithful, as shown by the interpretation of an étale covering in terms of locally free coherent Algebras. It remains to prove effectivity.

One can, for example, introduce the square X_2 and the cube X_3 of X_1 over X and observe that a faithfully flat and quasi-compact morphism is a morphism of universal effective descent for the fibered category of étale coverings, above the category of preschemes. The conclusion is formal from there.⁶³

Remark.

We have shown in passing that if $\mathcal{O}_X \rightarrow i_*(\mathcal{O}_U)$ is an isomorphism, then X is connected if and only if U is, and then $\pi_1(U) \rightarrow \pi_1(X)$ is surjective.

Corollary.

Let A be a noetherian local ring. Suppose that $\text{prof } A \geq 2$. Then if $\hat{A}$ is pure, A is pure.

Follows from Lemma 3.5 and Lemma 3.6.

The following lemma is the essential point in the proof of the purity theorem:

Lemma.

Let A be a noetherian local ring and let $t \in \mathfrak{r}(A)$ be an A -regular element. Suppose that A is complete for the t -adic topology and is, moreover, a quotient of a regular local ring (for example A complete). Set $B = A/tA$.

1. If for every prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ of A such that $\dim A/\mathfrak{p} = 1$, one has $\text{prof } A_{\mathfrak{p}} \geq 2$, then B pure implies A pure.
2. If for every prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ of A such that $\dim A/\mathfrak{p} = 1$, one has $\text{prof } A_{\mathfrak{p}} \geq 2$, if $A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is pure when $t \notin \mathfrak{p}$, and if⁶⁴ $\text{prof } A_{\mathfrak{p}} \geq 3$ when $t \in \mathfrak{p}$, then A pure implies B pure.

Let $X' = \text{Spec}(A)$ and $Y' = V(t)$, which one identifies with the spectrum of B . Let $x = \mathfrak{r}(A)$, and set $X = X' - x$ and $Y = Y' - x = X \cap Y'$. Denote by $\hat{X}'$ the formal spectrum of A for the t -adic topology, which is identified with the formal completion of X' along Y' .

Since A is complete for the t -adic topology, one notes that $\hat{E}t(X') \rightarrow \hat{E}t(\hat{X}')$ is an equivalence of categories. Likewise $\hat{E}t(\hat{X}') \rightarrow \hat{E}t(Y')$ by Proposition 1.1, so $\hat{E}t(X') \rightarrow \hat{E}t(Y')$ is an equivalence of categories.

Let us show (i). Consider the diagrams

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 X' & \longleftarrow & X \\
 \uparrow & & \uparrow \\
 | & & | \\
 Y' & \longleftarrow & Y
 \end{array}
 \qquad
 \begin{array}{ccc}
 \hat{E}t(X') & \xrightarrow{a} & \hat{E}t(X) \\
 | & & | \\
 c & & b \\
 \downarrow & & \downarrow \\
 \hat{E}t(Y') & \xrightarrow{d} & \hat{E}t(Y)
 \end{array}$$

We have just seen that c is an equivalence; d is also one by the hypothesis that B is pure; and finally b is fully faithful as seen in Example 2.1, cf. 2.3 (i).

⁶³Cf. J. Giraud, *Méthode de la descente*, Mémoire no. 2 du Bulletin de la Société Mathématique de France (1964).

⁶⁴N.D.E. This last condition can be improved, cf. the editor's note (1) on page 90.

Let us show (ii). This time one assumes that A is pure, so a is an equivalence; likewise c . Let us see that b is an equivalence. By Example 2.1 we know that $Leff(X, Y)$ holds, so b is already fully faithful; let us prove that it is essentially surjective. One uses 2.3 (ii), noting that if U is an open neighborhood of Y in X , the complement of U in X is a union of a finite number of closed points; the pair $(X, X - U)$ is thus pure by Proposition 3.3, since at such a point $\mathfrak{p}$, $\mathcal{O}_{X, \mathfrak{p}} = A_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is pure by hypothesis. Whence the conclusion.

Proof of the purity theorem.

Let us first prove (i) by induction on the dimension. Let A be a noetherian local ring of dimension 2. Set $X' = \text{Spec}(A)$, $x = \mathfrak{r}(A)$, $X = X' - x$. One has $prof A = 2$. One may therefore apply Lemma 3.5 to the pair (X', x) , and so $\hat{E}t(X') \rightarrow \hat{E}t(X)$ is fully faithful. Let now $r : R \rightarrow X$ be an étale covering defined by a locally free coherent and étale $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Algebra $A = r_*(\mathcal{O}_R)$. Denote by $i : X \rightarrow X'$ the canonical immersion of X into X' . I claim that $i_*(A) = B$ is a coherent $\mathcal{O}_{X'}$ -Algebra. Indeed, it suffices to apply the “finiteness theorem” VIII 2.3. I claim that this algebra is of depth ≥ 2 at x . Indeed, it is the direct image of an $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module, with $X = X' - x$. Since A is a regular ring of dimension 2, one has $dpB + prof B = \dim A = 2$, where $dp B$ denotes the projective dimension of B . So $dp B = 0$, hence B is projective, hence free. It follows that B defines a finite flat covering of $X' = \text{Spec}(A)$. The set of points of X' where this covering is not étale is a closed part of X' whose equation is a principal ideal: the discriminant ideal of B/A . Now, by construction, this closed set is contained in $x = \mathfrak{r}(A)$, hence is empty since $\dim A = 2$.

Let A be a regular noetherian local ring, $\dim A = n \geq 3$. Suppose (i) proved for rings of dimension $< n$. To prove that A is pure, one may assume A complete by 3.8. Let $t \in \mathfrak{r}(A)$ whose image in $\mathfrak{r}(A)/\mathfrak{r}(A)^2$ is nonzero. Then $B = A/tA$ is a regular noetherian local ring of dimension $n - 1$, hence is pure, since $n - 1 \geq 2$. One concludes by Lemma 3.9 (i), which is applicable since A is complete.

Let us show (ii). Let A be a noetherian local ring of dimension ≥ 3 . Suppose that there exist a regular noetherian local ring B and a B -sequence $(t_1, \dots, t_k)$ such that $A \simeq B/(t_1, \dots, t_k)$. Let us prove that A is pure, by induction on k . If $k = 0$, one knows it by (i). Suppose $k \geq 1$ and the result acquired for $k' < k$. By Corollary 3.8⁶⁵ one may assume that A (hence also B) is complete. Set $C = B/(t_1, \dots, t_{k-1})$, so $A \simeq C/t_k C$ and t_k is C -regular. By the induction hypothesis one knows that C is pure; it suffices to prove that Lemma 3.9 (ii) is applicable. Notation: the A and B of the lemma become C and A . One has $\dim C \geq 4$, so for every prime ideal $\mathfrak{p}$ of C such that $\dim C/\mathfrak{p} = 1$, one has $prof C_{\mathfrak{p}} \geq 3$. Moreover, $C_{\mathfrak{p}}$ is a complete intersection with $k' \leq k - 1$, hence is pure by the induction hypothesis. QED.

Theorem.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme and let Y be a closed part of X . Suppose that one has $Leff(X, Y)$ (cf. Examples 2.1 and 2.2). Suppose moreover that, for every open neighborhood U of Y and every $x \in X - U$, the local ring $\mathcal{O}_{X, x}$ is regular of dimension ≥ 2 or a complete intersection of dimension ≥ 3 . Then

$$\pi_0(Y) \longrightarrow \pi_0(X)$$

⁶⁵

is a bijection, and if X is connected

$$\pi_1(Y) \longrightarrow \pi_1(X)$$

is an isomorphism.

There is nothing more to prove. One remarks that, in the two examples cited 2.1 and 2.2, the complement of U is a union of a finite number of closed points, from which it follows that the hypothesis on the dimension of $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is not a farce.

Exposé XI. Application to the Picard group

This Exposé is modeled on the preceding one, but this time the result of no. 1 is weaker.

Throughout this Exposé, X will denote a locally noetherian prescheme, I a quasi-coherent ideal of $\mathcal{O}_X$ (so that $Y = V(I)$ is a closed part of X), U a variable open neighborhood of Y in X , and $\hat{X}$ the formal completion of X along Y . For every ringed space $(Z, \mathcal{O}_Z)$, we denote by $P(Z)$ the category of invertible $\mathcal{O}_Z$ -Modules — in other words, locally free of rank 1 — and by $\text{Pic}(Z)$ the group of isomorphism classes of invertible Modules on Z .

1. Comparison of $\text{Pic}(\hat{X})$ and $\text{Pic}(Y)$

For every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, set $X_n = (Y, \mathcal{O}_X/I^{n+1})$ and $P_n = I^{n+1}/I^{n+2}$. The sequence of sheaves of abelian groups on Y

$$0 \rightarrow P_n \xrightarrow{u} \mathcal{O}_X^*_{X_{n+1}} \xrightarrow{v} \mathcal{O}_X^*_{X_n} \rightarrow 1$$

is exact. Let us be precise: the group structure on P_n is the additive structure, $u(x) = 1 + x$ for every $x \in P_n$, and v is the homomorphism deduced from the injection $I^{n+2} \rightarrow I^{n+1}$. We see that v is surjective by remarking that, for every $y \in Y$, $\mathcal{O}_{X_n,y}$ is a local ring, the quotient of $\mathcal{O}_{X_{n+1},y}$ by a nilpotent ideal; the rest is equally trivial. From (1.1) we deduce an exact cohomology sequence:

$$(*) \quad H^1(Y, P_n) \xrightarrow{u^1} H^1(Y, \mathcal{O}_X^*_{X_{n+1}}) \xrightarrow{v^1} H^1(Y, \mathcal{O}_X^*_{X_n}) \xrightarrow{d} H^2(Y, P_n).$$

On the other hand, for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$, one knows how to identify $\text{Pic}(X_n)$ with $H^1(Y, \mathcal{O}_X^*_{X_n})$; moreover, if E is an invertible $\mathcal{O}_{X_{n+1}}$ -Module corresponding to a cohomology class $c(E)$, the cohomology class corresponding to the inverse image of E on X_n is equal to $v^1(c(E))$.

Whence the following proposition:

Proposition.

Retain the notations introduced above. Let $p \in \mathbb{N}$. The map $\text{Pic}(\hat{X}) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(Y_n)$:

1. is injective for $n \geq p$, if $H^1(Y, P_n) = 0$ for $n \geq p$;
2. is an isomorphism for $n \geq p$, if $H^i(Y, P_n) = 0$ for $n \geq p$ and $i = 1, 2$.

Of course, the exact sequence (*) contains more information than the proposition above. The reader will have noticed that we have said nothing about the functor $P(\hat{X}) \rightarrow P(Y)$. Given two invertible $\mathcal{O}_{\hat{X}}$ -Modules E, F , the sheaf $H = \text{Hom}(E, F)$ is also invertible. If we indicate reduction modulo I^{n+1} by a subscript n , we find an exact sequence:

$$0 \rightarrow H_0 \otimes P_n \rightarrow \text{Hom}(E_{n+1}, F_{n+1}) \rightarrow \text{Hom}(E_n, F_n) \rightarrow 0.$$

Whence an exact cohomology sequence that we shall not write down and whose interpretation is evident; one may use this remark to study the functor P .

2. Comparison of $\text{Pic}(X)$ and $\text{Pic}(\hat{X})$

The reader will find in Exposé X, no. 2, the proof of what follows:

Proposition.

Suppose that $\text{Leff}(X, Y)$ holds; then for every open neighborhood U of Y in X , the functor

$$P(U) \longrightarrow P(\hat{X})$$

is fully faithful, so that the map

$$\text{Pic}(U) \longrightarrow \text{Pic}(\hat{X})$$

is injective. If $\text{Leff}(X, Y)$ holds, then the map (2.3) is an isomorphism:

$$\lim_{\rightarrow} \text{Pic}(U) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(\hat{X}).$$

Corollary.

Suppose that $\text{Leff}(X, Y)$ holds and that $H^1(Y, P_n) = 0$ for every integer $n \geq p$; then for every open $U \supset Y$, the maps

$$\text{Pic}(X) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(U) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(Y_n)$$

are injective for $n \geq p$. If $\text{Leff}(X, Y)$ holds and if, moreover, $H^i(Y, P_n) = 0$ for every integer $n \geq p$ and $i = 1, 2$, then the map

$$\lim_{\rightarrow} \text{Pic}(U) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(Y_n)$$

is an isomorphism for $n \geq p$.

3. Comparison of $\text{P}(X)$ and $\text{P}(U)$

A definition:

Definition. ⁶⁶

⁶⁶For a more detailed study of the notion of parafactoriality, and the proof of 3.3, cf. EGA IV 21.13, 21.14.

Let X be a prescheme and let Z be a closed part of X . Set $U = X - Z$. We say that X is *parafactorial at the points of Z* if, for every open set V of X , the functor $P(V) \rightarrow P(V \cap U)$ is an equivalence of categories. We also say that the pair (X, Z) is *parafactorial*.

Recall that $P(Z)$ denotes the category of Modules locally free of rank 1 on Z .

Definition.

A noetherian local ring is said to be *parafactorial* if the pair $(\text{Spec}(A), r(A))$ is parafactorial.

One proves the following proposition, which shows that the notion is “pointwise”:

Proposition.

Suppose X is locally noetherian. In order that the pair (X, Z) be parafactorial, it is necessary and sufficient that, for every $z \in Z$, the local ring $O_{X,z}$ be so.

Note that in “parafactorial” there is “fully faithful”. One proves, as in Lemma 3.5 of Exposé X, the:

Lemma.

If X is a locally noetherian prescheme and if $Z = X - U$ is a closed part of X , the following conditions are equivalent:

1. for every open set V of X , the functor $P(V) \rightarrow P(V \cap U)$ is fully faithful;
2. the homomorphism $O_X \rightarrow i_*(O_U)$ is an isomorphism;
3. for every $z \in Z$, one has $\text{prof}(O_{X,z}) \geq 2$.

Thus “parafactorial” means that the conditions of 3.4 are satisfied and that, for every open set V of X , the homomorphism $\text{Pic}(V) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(V \cap U)$ is surjective. In particular, if X is the spectrum of a noetherian local ring, we find:

Proposition.

Let A be a noetherian local ring; in order that it be parafactorial, it is necessary and sufficient that $\text{prof} A \geq 2$ and $\text{Pic}(X' - x) = 0$, where we have set $X' = \text{Spec}(A)$ and x is the unique closed point of X' .

Note that a local ring of dimension ≤ 1 is never parafactorial, since its depth is ≤ 1 . Hence “factorial” does not imply “parafactorial”; however, the converse holds for noetherian local rings of dimension ≥ 2 , as we shall see below.

Lemma.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme and let Z be a closed part of X . Let $f : X_1 \rightarrow X$ be a faithfully flat and quasi-compact morphism. Set $Z_1 = f^{-1}(Z)$. If (X_1, Z_1) is parafactorial, then so is (X, Z) .

We first remark that, if $i : (X - Z) \rightarrow X$ denotes the canonical immersion of $U = X - Z$ into X , the formation of the direct image by i of a quasi-coherent O_U -Module commutes with the base change f , since the latter is flat. It is therefore equivalent to assume the equivalent conditions of Lemma 3.5 for (X, Z) or for (X_1, Z_1) , since f is a morphism of descent for the category of quasi-coherent sheaves. It remains to prove that, for every open

set V of X , $\text{Pic}(V) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(V \cap U)$ is surjective. We make the base change $V \rightarrow X$, which changes nothing (*sic*), and we are reduced to the case $V = X$. We then remark that, if L is an invertible $\mathcal{O}_U$ -Module and if L admits a locally free prolongation, this prolongation is isomorphic to $i_*(L)$, because of what has just been seen. It remains to prove that $i_*(L)$ is invertible. Using once more the fact that the direct image by i commutes with flat base change, and that “locally free of rank 1” is a property that descends by faithfully flat and quasi-compact morphism, we are done.

Corollary.

Let A be a noetherian local ring; if $\hat{A}$ is local factorial, so is A .

Do not believe that, if A is local factorial, so is $\hat{A}$.⁶⁷

Before stating the principal theorem of this section, let us make the connection with the theory of divisors and the notion of factorial ring.⁶⁸

Let X be a noetherian and normal prescheme. Let $Z^1(X)$ be the free abelian group generated by the $x \in X$ such that $\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} = 1$. The local ring of such a point is a discrete valuation ring. We shall write v_x for the corresponding normalized valuation. Let $K(X)$ be the ring of rational functions on X and let

$$p : K(X)^* \longrightarrow Z^1(X)$$

be the map that to every $f \in K(X)^*$ associates the codimension-one cycle:

$$(f) = \sum_{\{x \in X, \dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} = 1\}} v_x(f) \cdot x.$$

The image of p is denoted $P(X)$, and its elements are called *principal divisors*.⁶⁹ We set

$$Cl(X) = Z^1(X)/P(X).$$

Let $Z'^1(X)$ be the subgroup of $Z^1(X)$ whose elements are the locally principal divisors. One knows that

$$\text{Pic}(X) \simeq Z'^1(X)/P(X),$$

and consequently $\text{Pic}(X)$ is identified with a subgroup of $Cl(X)$.

Note that if U is a dense open of X , then $K(X) \rightarrow K(U)$ is an isomorphism, and that if $\text{codim}(X - U, X) \geq 2$, i.e. if every $x \in X$ such that $\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \leq 1$ belongs to U , the homomorphism $Z^1(X) \rightarrow Z^1(U)$, and consequently $Cl(X) \rightarrow Cl(U)$, is also an

⁶⁷N.D.E. For a precise study of the link between the factoriality of A and that of its completion, see (Heitmann R., “Characterization of completions of unique factorization domains”, *Trans. Amer. Math. Soc.* **337** (1993), no. 1, pp. 379–387).

⁶⁸For the generalities that follow, cf. also EGA IV 21.

⁶⁹In conformity with the terminology of EGA IV 21, we now prefer to reserve the name “divisors” for “locally principal divisors” or “Cartier divisors”.

isomorphism. Finally, if every $x \in U$ is factorial — i.e. $O_{X,x}$ is so — then $Z^1(U) = Z'^1(U)$, and so $\text{Pic}(U) \simeq \text{Cl}(U)$.

Proposition.

Let X be a noetherian and normal prescheme. Let $(U_i)_{i \in I}$ be a family of open sets of X such that:

1. the U_i form a filter base;⁷⁰
2. if one sets $Y_i = X - U_i$, then $\text{codim}(Y_i, X) \geq 2$ for every i ;
3. if $x \in U_i$ for every $i \in I$, then $O_{X,x}$ is factorial.

Then one has an isomorphism:

$$\lim_{\leftarrow} \{i \in I\} \text{Pic}(U_i) \xrightarrow{\sim} \text{Cl}(X).$$

Note that b) implies that every $x \in X$ such that $\dim O_{X,x} \leq 1$ belongs to U_i for every i . Hence the U_i are dense, and moreover the homomorphism $Z^1(U_i) \rightarrow Z^1(X)$ is an isomorphism, as is $K(U_i) \rightarrow K(X)$. So $\text{Pic}(U) \subset \text{Cl}(U_i) \simeq \text{Cl}(X)$. To prove what is desired, it therefore suffices to show that every $D \in Z^1(X)$ belongs to $Z'^1(U_i)$ for a suitable i . It suffices to do this for irreducible positive “divisors”. Let then $x \in X$ be such that $\dim O_{X,x} = 1$. It suffices to prove that there exists $i \in I$ such that x is locally principal at the points of U_i . Let I be the largest ideal of definition of the closed set x . The set of points in whose neighborhood I is free is an open set U . Now $U \supset \bigcap_{i \in I} U_i$ by c). If we set $Y = X - U$, then $Y \subset \bigcup_{i \in I} Y_i$ with $Y_i = X - U_i$; now Y is closed, so admits a finite number of generic points, so is contained in the union of finitely many Y_i , hence in some Y_j for a $j \in I$, because the U_i form a filter base. Thus $U \supset U_j$. QED.

Corollary.

Let X be a noetherian and normal prescheme and let Y be a closed part of codimension ≥ 2 . Suppose that, for every $p \in X - Y$, $O_{X,p}$ is factorial; then

$$\text{Pic}(X - Y) \rightarrow \text{Cl}(X - Y) \rightarrow \text{Cl}(X)$$

are isomorphisms.

Corollary.

Let A be a noetherian, normal local ring. Set $X' = \text{Spec}(A)$ and $x = r(A)$. In order that A be factorial, it is necessary and sufficient that $\text{Pic}(X' - x) = 0$ and that $p \in X' - x$ implies A_p factorial.

Indeed, in order that A be factorial, it is necessary and sufficient that $\text{Cl}(X') = 0$.⁷¹

Corollary.

Let A be a noetherian local ring of dimension ≥ 2 . Set $X' = \text{Spec}(A)$ and let $x = r(A)$. Set $X = X' - x$. The following conditions are equivalent:

1. A is factorial;

⁷⁰N.D.E. i.e. a decreasing filtered family.

⁷¹N.D.E. See Bourbaki, *Algèbre commutative* VII.1.4, cor. to th. 2, and VII.3.2, th. 1.

2. a) for every $y \in X$, $O_{X,y}$ is factorial, and b) A is parafactorial, i.e. $\text{prof} A \geq 2$ and $\text{Pic}(X) = 0$.

Before proving this corollary, let us state the:

Serre's criterion of normality.⁷²

Let A be a noetherian local ring. In order that A be normal, it is necessary and sufficient that

1. for every prime ideal p of A such that $\dim A_p \leq 1$, A_p be normal;
2. for every prime ideal p of A such that $\dim A_p \geq 2$, one have $\text{prof} A_p \geq 2$.

Let us prove 3.10.

- (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). Knowing that a localization of a factorial ring is factorial, we have (ii) a). Moreover A is normal, so $\text{prof} A \geq 2$, since $\dim A \geq 2$ (3.11 (ii)). Finally A is parafactorial; indeed $\text{Pic}(X) \simeq \text{Cl}(X') = 0$ (cf. 3.9).
- (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i). We first prove that A is normal by applying Serre's criterion. Since $\dim A \geq 2$, condition (i) of the criterion is among the hypotheses. Moreover, for every $p \in X$, A_p is factorial, hence normal, hence of depth ≥ 2 , at least if $\dim A_p \geq 2$. Finally $\text{prof} A \geq 2$ by (ii) b). It remains to apply 3.9.

Let us summarize the preceding:

Proposition.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme and let I be a quasi-coherent ideal of X . Set $Y = V(I)$. Let $p \in \mathbb{N}$. Suppose that:

1. $\text{Leff}(X, Y)$ holds (Exposé X);
2. $H^i(X, I^{n+1}/I^{n+2}) = 0$ if $i = 1$ or 2 and if $n \geq p$;
3. for every open neighborhood U of Y in X and every $x \in X - U$, the ring $O_{X,x}$ is parafactorial.

Then, for every $n \geq p$ and every open neighborhood U of Y , the homomorphisms

$$\text{Pic}(X) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(U) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(X_n)$$

(with the canonical commutative triangle) are isomorphisms.

One knows some parafactorial rings:

Theorem.

1. (Auslander–Buchsbaum)⁷³ A regular noetherian local ring is factorial (hence parafactorial if its dimension is ≥ 2).

⁷²Cf. EGA IV 5.8.6.

⁷³N.D.E. To be compared with the following purity result, due to Gabber. Let X be the spectrum of a regular local ring A of dimension 3, a an element of nonzero differential, i.e. $a \in m - m^2$, and U the complement of $V(a)$. Then a vector bundle on U is free (for a simple proof, see Swan R.G., "A simple proof of Gabber's theorem on projective modules over a localized local ring", *Proc. Amer. Math. Soc.* **103** (1988), no. 4, pp. 1025–1030). The rank-1 case is a particular case of Theorem 3.13. For purity results concerning vector bundles of arbitrary rank, in either the analytic or the algebraic setting, see (Gabber O., "On purity theorems for vector bundles", *Internat. Math. Res. Notices* (2002), no. 15, pp. 783–788).

2. A noetherian local ring of dimension ≥ 4 that is a complete intersection is parafactorial.

Corollary (Samuel conjecture)⁷⁴.

A noetherian local ring A that is a complete intersection and that is factorial in codimension ≥ 3 (i.e. $\dim A_p \leq 3$ implies that A_p is factorial) is factorial.

Proof of the corollary. We argue by induction on the dimension of A . If $\dim A \leq 3$, then A is factorial by hypothesis. If $\dim A > 3$, by the induction hypothesis, and remarking that a localization of a complete intersection is also a complete intersection, all localizations of A other than A itself are factorial. By Theorem 3.13 (ii), A is parafactorial, hence factorial by 3.10.

Proof of 3.13 (i) (following Kaplansky).⁷⁵

Let A be a regular noetherian local ring; set $\dim A = n$. If $n = 0$ or 1 , the result is known. Suppose $n \geq 2$, and argue by induction on n : suppose $n \geq 2$ and the theorem proved for rings of dimension $< n$. Set $X' = \text{Spec}(A)$ and $X = X' - x$, where $x = r(A)$. The localizations of A other than A are regular and of dimension $< n$, hence factorial. Moreover $\text{prof } A = \dim A \geq 2$. It therefore suffices to prove that $\text{Pic}(X) = 0$ (Cor. 3.10). Let then L be an invertible $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module; one knows that one can prolong it to a coherent $\mathcal{O}_{X'}$ -Module L' . There exists a resolution of L' by free $\mathcal{O}_{X'}$ -Modules:

$$0 \leftarrow L' \leftarrow L'_1 \leftarrow \dots \leftarrow L'_n \leftarrow 0,$$

since the cohomological dimension of A is finite. By restriction to X one obtains a finite free resolution. It therefore suffices to prove the following lemma:

Lemma.

Let $(X, \mathcal{O}_X)$ be a ringed space and let L be a locally free $\mathcal{O}_X$ -Module that admits a finite resolution by free modules of finite type. Then $\det(L) \simeq \mathcal{O}_X$.

Recall that one defines $\det(L)$ as the maximal exterior power of L . In the case envisaged, $\det(L) \simeq L$ since L is invertible, so the lemma allows us to conclude. Let us prove this lemma. Let

$$0 \leftarrow L_0 \leftarrow L_1 \leftarrow L_2 \leftarrow \dots \leftarrow L_n \leftarrow 0$$

be the announced exact sequence, where $L_0 = L$. Since everything is locally free, one has:

$$\bigotimes_{0 \leq i \leq n} (\det(L_i))^{(-1)^i} \simeq \mathcal{O}_X;$$

now all the L_i for $i > 0$ are free, so their determinants are free as well, hence so is the determinant of $L_0 = L$. QED.

⁷⁴N.D.E. For a proof in the same vein, but more elementary, see Call F. & Lyubeznik G., "A simple proof of Grothendieck's theorem on the parafactoriality of local rings", in *Commutative algebra: syzygies, multiplicities, and birational algebra* (South Hadley, MA, 1992), Contemp. Math., vol. 159, American Mathematical Society, Providence, RI, 1994, pp. 15–18.

⁷⁵It is the proof reproduced in EGA IV 21.11.1.

It remains to prove (ii) of the theorem. Beforehand, let us prove a lemma that will permit us to proceed by induction:

Lemma.

Let A be a noetherian local ring that is a quotient of a regular ring. Let $t \in r(A)$ be an A -regular element. Suppose that A is complete for the t -adic topology. Set $X' = \text{Spec}(A)$, $Y' = V(t) \simeq \text{Spec}(B)$, $B = A/tA$, $X = X' - x$, $Y = Y' - x$, $x = r(A)$. Suppose that:

1. for every $y \in X$ closed in X , one has $\text{prof} O_{X,y} \geq 2$,
2. $\text{prof} A/tA \geq 3$,

then the map $\text{Pic}(X) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(Y)$ is injective. In particular, if B is parafactorial, then so is A .

One knows that a) implies $\text{Leff}(X, Y)$ thanks to X 2.1. If we prove that $H^1(Y, P_n) = 0$ for every $n \geq 0$, we shall know thanks to (2.2) that $\text{Pic}(X) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(Y)$ is injective. If, moreover, B is parafactorial, we shall know that $\text{Pic}(Y) = 0$ (3.5), hence $\text{Pic}(X) = 0$; now $\text{prof}(A) \geq 3 + 1 \geq 2$ since t is A -regular, so A will be parafactorial by 3.5.⁷⁶

Let $I = (tA)^\sim$ be the $O_{X'}$ -Module associated with the ideal tA . In no. 1, we set $P_n = (I^{n+1}/I^{n+2})|_Y$ for every $n \geq 0$. Now t is A -regular, so $P_n \simeq O_Y$. It therefore remains to prove that $H^1(Y, O_Y) = 0$. Now $Y = Y' - x$ is an open subset of Y' , so we have an exact sequence (I (27)):

$$H^1(Y', O_{-}(Y')) \rightarrow H^1(Y, O_{-}Y) \rightarrow H^2_{-X}(Y', O_{-}\{Y'\}),$$

whose right-hand term is zero by virtue of hypothesis b), and whose left-hand term is zero because Y' is affine. QED.

Lemma.

Retaining the hypotheses of 3.16, suppose moreover that:

1. (c) for every y closed in Y , $\text{prof} O_{X,y} \geq 3$,
2. (d) $\text{prof} A/tA \geq 4$ (stronger than b),
3. (e) for every y closed in X with $y \in Y$, the ring $O_{X,y}$ is parafactorial.

Then the map $\text{Pic}(X) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(Y)$ is an isomorphism; in particular, in order that A be parafactorial, it is necessary and sufficient that B be so.

One knows (X 2.1) that a) and c) imply $\text{Leff}(X, Y)$. Moreover, by the reasoning just made, d) implies that $H^i(Y, P_n) = 0$ for every $n \geq 0$ and $i = 1$ or $i = 2$. Furthermore, for every open neighborhood U of Y in X , the complement of U in X consists of a finite number of closed points. Thanks to e) and Theorem 3.12, we deduce that $\text{Pic}(X) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(Y)$ is an isomorphism. On the other hand, $\text{prof} A \geq \text{prof} B \geq 2$; by criterion 3.5, we deduce that A is parafactorial if and only if B is so.

Let us now prove 3.13 (ii). Let R be a regular noetherian local ring. Let $(t_1, \dots, t_k)$ be an R -sequence. Set $B = R/(t_1, \dots, t_k)$ and suppose $\dim B \geq 4$. We must prove that B is

⁷⁶

parafactorial. We argue by induction on k . If $k = 0$, then B is regular, hence factorial by 3.13 (i), hence parafactorial by 3.10. Suppose $k \geq 1$ and the theorem proved for $k' < k$. Set $A = R/(t_1, \dots, t_{k-1})$, so $B = A/t_k A$. We may suppose B complete by 3.7. By the induction hypothesis, A is parafactorial. Let us prove that we may apply Lemma 3.17. We have supposed B complete, hence so is A , and therefore A is complete for the t_k -adic topology. If $x \in X$, and if x is closed in X , then A_x is a complete intersection of dimension ≥ 4 , with $k' < k$. By the induction hypothesis, A_x is parafactorial, and moreover of depth ≥ 4 . This gives a), c), and e). Moreover $\dim A \geq 5$, whence d). QED.

Theorem.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme and let I be a coherent sheaf of ideals on X . Set $Y = V(I)$. Let n be an integer. Suppose that:

1. $\text{Lef}f(X, Y)$ holds (cf. examples X 2.1 and X 2.2);
2. for every $p \geq n$, one has $H^i(Y, I^{p+1}/I^{p+2}) = 0$ for $i = 1$ and $i = 2$;
3. for every open $U \supset Y$ and every $x \in X - U$, the ring $O_{X,x}$ is regular of dimension ≥ 2 or a complete intersection of dimension ≥ 4 .

Then, for every open $U \supset Y$ and every integer $p \geq n$, the homomorphisms

$$\text{Pic}(X) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(U) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(Y_p)$$

are isomorphisms, where Y_p denotes the prescheme $(Y, O_X/I^{p+1})$.

It suffices to combine 3.12 and 3.13.

Exposé XII. Applications to projective algebraic schemes

1. Projective duality theorem and finiteness theorem

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The following theorem, essentially contained in *FAC*⁷⁸ (except that at the time Serre did not yet have at his disposal the language of Ext of sheaves of modules⁷⁹), is the global analogue of the local duality theorem (Exp. IV), which was modelled on it.

Theorem.

Let k be a field, $X = P_k^r$ projective space of dimension r over k , and F a variable coherent module on X . Then one has an isomorphism of ∂ -functors in F :

$$H^i(X, F)' \simeq \text{Ext}^{\{r-i\}}(X; F, \Omega_{X/k}^r),$$

⁷⁷The present exposé, written up in January 1963, is markedly more detailed than the oral exposé was, in June 1962.

⁷⁸J.-P. Serre, "Faisceaux algébriques cohérents", *Ann. of Math.* **61** (1955), pp. 197–278.

⁷⁹N.D.E. The reader fond of the History of Mathematics will consult with interest the letter that Grothendieck wrote to Serre on 15 December 1955 and the latter's reply of 22 December of the same year; see *Correspondance Grothendieck-Serre*, edited by Pierre Colmez and Jean-Pierre Serre, Documents Mathématiques, vol. 2, Société Mathématique de France, Paris, 2001.

where one sets

$$\Omega_{X/k}^r = \mathcal{O}_{P_k^r}(-r-1).$$

Remark.

Of course, this module is also the module of relative differentials of degree r of X over k . In this form, the theorem remains true if X is a proper and smooth scheme over k (for the projective case, see A. Grothendieck, “Théorèmes de dualité pour les faisceaux algébriques cohérents”, *Séminaire Bourbaki*, May 1957).⁸⁰ When F is locally free, one recovers Serre’s duality theorem

$$H^i(X, F)' \simeq H^{r-i}(X, \Omega_{X/k}^r \otimes F).$$

Theorem 1.1 (which moreover recovers the case of X projective over k , as in *loc. cit.*) will suffice for our purposes.

The homomorphism (1) is deduced from the Yoneda pairing

$$H^i(X, F) \times \text{Ext}^i(X, \Omega_{X/k}^r) \rightarrow H^i(X, \Omega_{X/k}^r),$$

and from a well-known isomorphism (cf. *FAC*, or *EGA* III 2.1.12):

$$H^i(X, \Omega_{X/k}^r) = H^i(P_k^r, \mathcal{O}_{P_k^r}(-r-1)) \simeq k.$$

To show that (1) is an isomorphism, one proceeds as in the case of the local duality theorem, noting that $H^r(X, F)$, as a functor in F , is right exact (since $H^n(X, F) = 0$ for $n > r$), and that every coherent module is isomorphic to a quotient of a direct sum of modules of the form $\mathcal{O}(-m)$ with m large. This reduces us, by descending induction on i , to making the verification for a sheaf of the form $\mathcal{O}(-m)$, where it is contained in the well-known explicit computations (*FAC*, or *EGA* III 2.1.12). One may moreover assume $-m \leq -r-1$, in which case $H^i(X, \mathcal{O}(-m)) = 0$ for $i \neq r$.

Corollary.

For F coherent and given, and m large enough, one has a canonical isomorphism

$$H^i(X, F(-m))' \simeq H^0(X, \text{Ext}^i(X, \mathcal{O}_X) \otimes F(m))$$

(where $'$ denotes the vector-space dual).

Indeed, on projective space X , for any pair of coherent sheaves F, G and for n large enough one has a canonical isomorphism:

$$\text{Ext}^n(X, F(-m), G) \cong \text{Ext}^n(X, F, G(m)) \simeq H^0(X, \text{Ext}^n(\mathcal{O}_X, F \otimes G(m))),$$

(the isomorphism of the first two terms being trivially true for any m), as follows from the spectral sequence of global Ext

$$H^p(X, \text{Ext}^q(\mathcal{O}_X, F \otimes G(m))) \Rightarrow \text{Ext}^{p+q}(X, F \otimes G(m)),$$

which degenerates for m large thanks to the fact that

⁸⁰For a more general duality theorem, cf. the Hartshorne seminar cited at the end of Exp. IV.

$$\mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_X}^q(F, G(m)) \cong \mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_X}^q(F, G)(m),$$

and that the $\mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_X}^q(F, G)$ are coherent sheaves. Hence (5) follows from (6) and (1).

Corollary.

For given i, F , the following conditions are equivalent:

1. $H^i(X, F(-m)) = 0$ for m large.
2. (i bis) $H^i(X, F(\cdot)) = \bigoplus_{m \in \mathbb{Z}} H^i(X, F(-m))$ is a finitely generated S -module, where $S = k[t_0, \dots, t_r]$.
3. $\mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_X}^{r-i}(F, \Omega_{X/k}^r) = 0$.
4. (ii bis) $\mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_X}^{r-i}(F, \mathcal{O}_X) = 0$.
5. $H_x^i(F_x) = 0$ for every closed point x of X .
6. $H_x^{i+1}(\tilde{F}_x) = 0$ for every closed point x of the punctured projecting cone $\tilde{X} = \text{Spec}(S) - \text{Spec}(k)$ of X , where $\tilde{F}$ denotes the inverse image of F under the canonical morphism $\tilde{X} \rightarrow X$.

Proof.

- (i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (i bis) since the submodule of $H^i(X, F(\cdot))$ formed by the sum of the homogeneous components of degree $\geq \nu$ is finitely generated over S (in fact, for $i \neq 0$, it is even finitely generated over k), cf. *FAC* or *EGA* III 2.2.1 and 2.3.2.
- (ii) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii) by virtue of Corollary 1.2.
- (iii) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii bis) since $\Omega_{X/k}^r$ is locally isomorphic to $\mathcal{O}_X$.
- (ii bis) $\Leftrightarrow$ (iii) by virtue of the local duality theorem for $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ (which is a regular local ring of dimension r), according to which the “dual” of $\mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_X}^{r-i}(F, \mathcal{O}_X)_x$ is identified with $H_x^i(F_x)$ (V 2.1).
- (ii bis) is equivalent to the analogous relation

$$\mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_{\tilde{X}}}^{r-i}(\tilde{F}, \mathcal{O}_{\tilde{X}}) = 0$$

(thanks to the fact that $\tilde{X} \rightarrow X$ is faithfully flat, so the inverse image of $\mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_X}^{r-i}(F, \mathcal{O}_X)$ is isomorphic to $\mathcal{E}xt_{\mathcal{O}_{\tilde{X}}}^{r-i}(\tilde{F}, \mathcal{O}_{\tilde{X}})$), and this last relation is equivalent to (iv) by the local duality theorem for the local ring $\mathcal{O}_{\tilde{X},x}$, which is regular of dimension $r + 1$.

In particular, applying this to all $i \leq n$, one finds:

Corollary.

Equivalent conditions for given n, F :

1. $H^i(X, F(-m)) = 0$ for $i \leq n$ and m large.
2. (i bis) $H^i(X, F(\cdot))$ is a finitely generated S -module for $i \leq n$.
3. $\text{prof}(F_x) > n$ for every closed point x of X .
4. $\text{prof}(\tilde{F}_x) > n + 1$ for every closed point x of $\tilde{X}$.

The interest of Corollaries 1.3 and 1.4 is to express a global condition (i) or (i bis) in terms of local conditions, namely the vanishing of local invariants such as $H_x^i(X, F_x)$ or $H_x^i(\tilde{X}, \tilde{F}_x)$, or an inequality on depth. In this form, these results remain trivially valid for an arbitrary projective scheme X and a very ample invertible sheaf $O_X(1)$ on X , as one sees by inducing the latter using a suitable projective immersion $X \rightarrow P_k^r$. (Of course, conditions 1.3 (ii) and 1.3 (ii bis) are no longer equivalent to the others in this general case, except if one assumes for example that X is regular.) One may moreover generalize to the case of a projective morphism $X \rightarrow S$ as follows:

Proposition.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a projective morphism with S noetherian, $O_X(1)$ an invertible module on X very ample relatively to S , F a coherent module on X , flat with respect to S , s an element of S , X_s the fiber of X at s (considered as a projective scheme over $k(s)$), F_s the sheaf induced on X_s by F , finally i an integer. Suppose that for every closed point x of X_s , one has $H_x^i(F_{s,x}) = 0$ (for example $\text{prof}(F_{s,x}) > i$). Then there exists an open neighborhood U of s such that the same condition is verified for $s' \in U$. Moreover, for such a U , one has

$$\text{R}^i f_* (F(-m)) = 0 \text{ for } m \text{ large,}$$

and if $\mathcal{S}$ is a graded quasi-coherent algebra on S , generated by $\mathcal{S}^1$, that defines X together with $O_X(1)$ as $X = \text{Proj}(\mathcal{S})$, $O_X(1) = \text{Proj}(\mathcal{S}(1))$, then the $\mathcal{S}$ -module

$$\text{R}^i f_* (F(\cdot)) = \bigoplus_{\{m \in \mathbb{Z}\}} \text{R}^i f_* (F(m))$$

is finitely generated on U .

Embed X in some $X' = P_S^r$ so that $O_X(1)$ is induced by $O_{X'}(1)$ (which is possible, possibly by replacing S by an affine neighborhood of s). Set⁸¹ for every integer j and every $t \in S$:

$$E^j(t) = \text{Ext}_{O_{X'_t}}^j(F'_t, O_{X'_t}(-r-1)).$$

Thus $E^j(t)$ is a coherent module on X_t . I claim that, for variable t , the family of these modules is “constructible” in the following sense: for every $t \in S$ there exists a non-empty open subset V of the closure of t , which one endows with the induced reduced structure, and a coherent module $E^j(V)$ on $X_V = X \times_S V$, flat relatively to V , such that for every $t' \in V$, $E^j(t')$ is isomorphic to the module induced by $E^j(V)$ on $X_{t'}$. To verify this assertion, setting $Z = t$ with its induced structure, one considers the coherent modules

$$E^j(Z) = \text{Ext}_{O_{X'_Z}}^j(F_Z, O_{X'_Z}(-r-1))$$

(where the subscript Z means again that one induces over Z), and one takes for V a non-empty open subset of Z such that the modules $E^j(Z)$ are flat over V : this is possible since one checks immediately that $E^j(Z) = 0$ for j not lying in the interval $[0, r]$, and one may

⁸¹The first part of 1.5 may be obtained at once by applying the purely local statement EGA IV 12.3.4 to the preceding E^j , which short-circuits the greater part of the proof that follows.

apply *SGA* 1 IV 6.11. One then takes $E^j(V) = E^j(Z)|_{X_V}$, and one verifies easily that it answers the question.

From the preceding remark it follows that there exists a finite partition of S formed by sets V_α of the form $V = V(t)$ as above (noetherian induction), and applying Serre's theorem *EGA* III 2.2.1 to the $E^j(V_\alpha)$, one sees that there exists an integer m_0 such that

$$\text{Rif}_{\{V_\alpha\}}(E^j(V_\alpha)) = 0 \text{ for } i \neq 0, m \geq m_0, \text{ for all } j,$$

whence it follows, using the flatness of $E^j(V_\alpha)$ with respect to V_α and easy Künneth-type relations (cf. *EGA* III, §7), that

$$H^i(X_t, E^j(t)(m)) = 0 \text{ for } i \neq 0, m \geq m_0, \text{ for all } j,$$

for every $t \in V_\alpha$, hence for every t since the V_α cover S . From this and the spectral sequence of global Ext follows, thanks to 1.1 and as in the proof of 1.2, an isomorphism

$$H^i(X_t, F_t(-m))' \simeq H^0(X_t, E^{\wedge\{r-i\}}(t)(m)) \text{ for } m \geq m_0,$$

every integer i , and every $t \in S$.

Let us now use the hypothesis on F_s , which is written

$$E^{r-i}(s) = 0,$$

and which, thanks to (8), is equivalent to

$$H^i(X_s, F_s(-m)) = 0 \text{ for } m \geq m_0.$$

Since F , hence $F(-m)$, is flat with respect to S , it follows by the Künneth-type relations already invoked that (for m given) the same relation (10) holds when s is replaced by a t near s , in particular for any generization t of s . By virtue of (8), one will therefore have, for such a generization,

$$E^{r-i}(t) = 0,$$

now the set of $t \in S$ for which this relation holds is plainly a constructible set (since it induces an open set on each V_α); since it contains the generizations of s , it contains an open neighborhood U of s . This proves the first assertion of 1.5. Moreover, for $t \in U$, one concludes from (11) and (8) that

$$H^i(X_t, F_t(-m)) = 0 \text{ for } m \geq m_0, t \in U,$$

which, by virtue of the Künneth-type relations, implies (in fact, is much stronger than)

$$\text{Rif}_*(F(-m)) = 0 \text{ on } U, \text{ for } m \geq m_0.$$

This proves the second assertion of 1.5. Finally the last assertion follows at once, by proceeding as at the start of the proof of 1.3.

Remark.

The proof simplifies notably (by eliminating any consideration of constructibility) when one assumes already that the hypothesis made for $s \in S$ is verified at every $s' \in S$. In fact, when one makes the hypothesis that F_s is of depth $> i$ at the closed points of X_s , one has at one's disposal a general statement, local in nature on X , which says that the same condition is verified for all X_t , on condition of replacing X by a suitable open neighborhood of the fiber X_s (in other words, a certain part of X , defined by conditions on the modules induced by F on the fibers, is open, cf. *EGA IV*). Since f is proper here, one may therefore take this neighborhood of the form $f^{-1}(U)$, which recovers the first assertion of 1.5 without any tedious dévissage. In this general case, one may still prove by the method of *loc. cit.* that the first assertion of 1.5 (proved here by global means, using that X is projective over S) follows from a purely local statement on X (which the reader will spell out if he thinks it useful).

2. Lefschetz theory for a projective morphism: Grauert's comparison theorem

It is the following theorem:

Theorem.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a projective morphism with S noetherian, $O_X(1)$ an invertible module on X , ample relatively to S , Y the prescheme of zeros of a section t of $O_X(1)$, $\mathcal{J}$ the ideal defining Y , X_n the subprescheme of X defined by $\mathcal{J}^{n+1}$, $\hat{X}$ the formal completion of X along Y , $\hat{f} : \hat{X} \rightarrow S$ the composite morphism $\hat{X} \rightarrow X \rightarrow S$, F a coherent module on X , flat relatively to S . Suppose moreover that for every $s \in S$, the module F_s induced on the fiber X_s is of depth $> n$ at the points of that fiber, and that t is F -regular. Under these conditions:

1. The canonical homomorphism

$$R^i f_*(F) \rightarrow R^i \hat{f}_*(\hat{F})$$

is an isomorphism for $i < n$, a monomorphism for $i = n$.

2. The canonical homomorphism

$$R^i \hat{f}_*(\hat{F}) \rightarrow \lim_m R^i f_*(F_m)$$

is an isomorphism for $i \leq n$.

Proof.

One reduces at once to the case where S is affine, and to proving in this case the following:

Corollary.

Under the conditions of 2.1, suppose moreover that S is affine. Then:

1. The canonical homomorphism

⁸²This remark is made more precise by the footnote on page 112.

$$H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(\hat{X}, \hat{F})$$

is an isomorphism for $i < n$, a monomorphism for $i = n$.

2. The canonical homomorphism

$$H^i(\hat{X}, \hat{F}) \rightarrow \lim_{\leftarrow m} H^i(X_m, F_m)$$

is an isomorphism for $i \leq n$.

Replacing $O_X(1)$ by a tensor power, and t by a power of t if necessary, one may assume $O_X(1)$ very ample relatively to S . On the other hand, t , hence t^m , being F -regular, multiplication by t^m , considered as a homomorphism from $F(-m)$ to F , is injective; so one has for every $m \geq 0$ an exact sequence:

$$0 \rightarrow F(-m) \xrightarrow{t^m} F \rightarrow F_m \rightarrow 0,$$

whence a cohomology exact sequence

$$H^i(X, F(-m)) \rightarrow H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(X, F_m) \rightarrow H^{i+1}(X, F(-m)).$$

Now by virtue of 1.5 one has $H^i(X, F(-m)) = 0$ for $i \leq n$ and m large enough, which proves the following:

Lemma.

For m large, the canonical homomorphism

$$H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(X, F_m)$$

is bijective if $i < n$, injective if $i = n$.

This shows that for $i < n$, the projective system $(H^i(X_m, F_m))_{m \geq 0}$ is essentially constant, *a fortiori* satisfies the Mittag-Leffler condition; therefore (taking into account $\hat{F} = \lim F_m$) one concludes (ii) by EGA 0_III 13.3. On the other hand, (i) follows trivially, taking into account 2.3.

Corollary.

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Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a flat projective morphism with S locally noetherian, $O_X(1)$ an invertible module on X , ample relatively to S , t a section of this module that is O_X -regular, Y the subscheme of zeros of t , $\hat{X}$ the formal completion of X along Y . Suppose that for every $s \in S$, X_s is of depth ≥ 1 (resp. of depth ≥ 2) at its closed points. Then for every open neighborhood U of Y , the functor

$$F \mapsto \hat{F}$$

⁸³N.D.E. See Corollary I.1.4 of the article of Mme Raynaud (Raynaud M., "Théorèmes de Lefschetz en cohomologie des faisceaux cohérents et en cohomologie étale. Application au groupe fondamental", *Ann. Sci. Éc. Norm. Sup.* (4) **7** (1974), pp. 29-52).

from the category of locally free coherent modules on U to the category of locally free coherent modules on $\hat{X}$ is faithful (resp. fully faithful, i.e. the Lefschetz condition (Lef) of X 2 is verified).

For two locally free modules F and G on U introduce the module

$$H = \text{Hom}_{O_U}(F, G);$$

one is reduced to proving that the canonical homomorphism

$$H^0(U, H) \rightarrow H^0(\hat{U}, \hat{H})$$

is injective (resp. bijective). Now the modules H_t are of depth ≥ 1 (resp. ≥ 2) at the closed points of X_t ; one may therefore apply 2.1, which implies the conclusion of 2.4 in the case where $U = X$. In the case of an arbitrary U , one notes that the question is local on S , so one may assume S affine. Then every coherent module on X is a quotient of a locally free coherent module (since $O_X(1)$ is a relatively ample invertible module on X). Since the dual module $H' = \text{Hom}(H, O_U)$ extends to a coherent module on X , which is therefore isomorphic to a cokernel of a homomorphism of locally free modules on X , it follows by transposition that one may find a homomorphism

$$u' : L'^0 \rightarrow L'^1$$

of locally free modules on X , inducing a homomorphism

$$u : L^0 \rightarrow L^1$$

of locally free modules on U , such that one has an exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow H \rightarrow L^0 \xrightarrow{u} L^1.$$

Using the five lemma (which becomes the three lemma), and the left exactness of the functor H^0 , one is reduced to proving that (15) is injective (resp. bijective) when H is replaced by L^0, L^1 , which reduces us to the case where H is induced by a locally free module H' on X . Moreover, in the non-respective case this reduction is even unnecessary, since the kernel of (15) is in any case formed of the sections of H on U that vanish in a suitable open neighborhood V of Y ; now the restriction homomorphism $H^0(U, H) \rightarrow H^0(V, H)$ is injective, since H is of depth ≥ 1 at the points of any closed subset Z of X not meeting Y (cf. the lemma below). In the respective case, one is reduced to proving that

$$H^0(X, H') \rightarrow H^0(U, H')$$

is bijective, which follows from the fact that H' is of depth ≥ 2 at every point of a closed subset $Z = X - U$ of X not meeting Y . One therefore needs only to prove the following:

Lemma.

Let F be a coherent module on X , flat with respect to S , such that for every $s \in S$, F_s is of depth $\geq n$ at every closed point of X_s . Then for any closed subset Z of X not meeting Y , F is of depth $\geq n$ at every point of Z .

Indeed, for every $x \in X$, setting $s = f(x)$, one has

$$\text{prof}(F_x) \geq \text{prof}(F_{s,x}),$$

as one sees by lifting in any way a maximal $F_{s,x}$ -regular sequence of elements of $\mathfrak{r}(O_{X_s,x})$, which yields an F_x -regular sequence by virtue of SGA 1 IV 5.7. Now if x belongs to a $\hat{Z}$ as in Lemma 2.5, then x is necessarily closed in X_s ; in other words, Z is finite over S . Indeed Z (endowed with a structure induced by X) is projective over S as a closed subprescheme of X which is so, and Z is affine over S as a closed subprescheme of $X - Y$, which is so.

Remark.

Suppose that for every $s \in S$ the section t_s of $O_{X_s}(1)$ induced by t is O_{X_s} -regular (which implies, by SGA 1 IV 5.7, that t is O_X -regular). Then the hypotheses made are stable under base extension $S' \rightarrow S$ (S' locally noetherian). Hence the conclusion remains valid after any base change.

3. Lefschetz theory for a projective morphism: existence theorem

Theorem.

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Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a projective morphism, with S noetherian, $O_X(1)$ an invertible module on X ample relatively to S , X_0 the subprescheme of zeros of a section t of $O_X(1)$, $\hat{X}$ the formal completion of X along X_0 , $\mathcal{F}$ a coherent module on $\hat{X}$, $\mathcal{F}_0$ the module that it induces on X_0 . Suppose moreover:

- a) $\mathcal{F}$ is flat with respect to S .
- b) For every $s \in S$, the section t_s induced by t on X_s is $\mathcal{F}_s$ -regular (which implies that $\mathcal{F}_0$ is also flat with respect to S , cf. SGA 1 IV 5.7).
- c) For every $s \in S$, $\mathcal{F}_{0,s}$ is of depth ≥ 2 at the closed points of $X_{0,s}$.

Suppose moreover that S admits an ample invertible sheaf. Under these conditions, there exists a coherent module F on X and an isomorphism of its formal completion $\hat{F}$ with $\mathcal{F}$.

This statement will follow from the following:

Corollary.

Under conditions a), b), c) above, one has the following:

1. The module $\hat{f}_*(\mathcal{F})$ on S is coherent; hence for every n , the module $\hat{f}_*(\mathcal{F}(n))$ on S is coherent.

⁸⁴N.D.E. For a version without flatness hypothesis, see (Raynaud M., “Théorèmes de Lefschetz en cohomologie des faisceaux cohérents et en cohomologie étale. Application au groupe fondamental”, *Ann. Sci. Éc. Norm. Sup.* (4) **7** (1974), pp. 29–52, Theorem II.3.3).

2. For n large, the canonical homomorphism $\hat{f} * \hat{f}_*(\mathcal{F}(n)) \rightarrow \mathcal{F}(n)$ is surjective.

Let us admit the corollary for the moment, and prove 3.1. Thanks to the last hypothesis made in 3.1, one may reduce to the case where $X = P_S^r$, by replacing $O_X(1)$, t by a suitable power. I claim that one may moreover assume that for every s , $t_s \neq 0$. Otherwise, indeed, one has $\mathcal{F}_s = 0$ by b), or what amounts to the same by Nakayama, $\mathcal{F}_{0,s} = 0$ i.e. s does not belong to the image of $\text{Supp } \mathcal{F}_0$ by the morphism $f_0 : X_0 \rightarrow S$ induced by f . Now this image S' is open by virtue of a), b), since $\mathcal{F}_0$ is flat with respect to S ; and it is obvious that it suffices to prove the conclusion of 3.1 in the situation obtained by restricting above S' , since the coherent module F' on $X|S'$ obtained will be the restriction of a coherent module F on X , which will answer the question. One may therefore assume that, in addition to hypotheses a), b), c), the following hypotheses are also verified:

- a') O_X is flat with respect to S .
- b') For every $s \in S$, the section t_s is O_{X_s} -regular.
- c') For every $s \in S$, $O_{X_{0,s}}$ is of depth ≥ 2 at the closed points of $X_{0,s}$.

(It suffices to choose $X = P_S^r$ with $r \geq 3$, which is permissible.)

Now 3.2 implies that one may find an epimorphism

$$\hat{L} \rightarrow \mathcal{F} \rightarrow 0,$$

where L is a module on X of the form $f^*(G)(-n)$, G being a locally free coherent module on S : for n large, it suffices indeed to represent the coherent module $\hat{f}_*(\mathcal{F})$ on S as a quotient of such a G . On the other hand, the hypotheses a), b), c) on f , t imply that $\hat{L}$ satisfies the same conditions a), b), c) as $\mathcal{F}$. One concludes easily that the same holds for the kernel of (17), to which one may therefore apply the same argument; so that $\mathcal{F}$ is represented as cokernel of a homomorphism

$$\hat{L}' \rightarrow \hat{L},$$

where L , L' are locally free modules on X . Now by virtue of a') and the second part of c'), and of 2.1 or 2.4 as preferred, the homomorphism (18) comes from a homomorphism $L' \rightarrow L$ of modules on X . It suffices now to take for F the cokernel of $L' \rightarrow L$, and one wins.

It remains to prove 3.2. This had been done in the seminar by a somewhat tedious expedient, consisting in interpreting everything in terms of cohomology on the punctured projecting cone of X relative to S , in order to reduce to Theorem 2.1. A more direct and more satisfactory way (although substantially the same) seems to me now the following. It consists in noting that in IX, no. 2 (and with the notation of that exposé), the hypothesis that the morphism $f : \mathcal{X} \rightarrow \mathcal{X}'$ be adic does not intervene anywhere in the proof of 2.1, via EGA 0_III 13.7.7; it suffices to assume in its place that $\mathcal{X}$ is also adic, and to choose two ideals of definition $\mathcal{J}$ for $\mathcal{X}'$, $\mathcal{I}$ for $\mathcal{X}$, such that $\mathcal{J}O_{\mathcal{X}} \subset \mathcal{I}$, and to define $\mathcal{S} = gr_{\mathcal{J}}(O_{\mathcal{X}'})$, and to consider $gr_{\mathcal{J}}(\mathcal{F})$. In any case, 2.1 may be applied directly to the morphism $\hat{f} : \hat{X} \rightarrow S$ considered in the present section, where one simply takes $\mathcal{J} = 0$. Thus, to verify that $\hat{f}_*(\mathcal{F})$ is coherent, it

suffices, by virtue of *loc. cit.*, to verify that $\mathrm{R}f_{0*}(\mathrm{gr}_{\mathcal{J}}(\mathcal{F}))$ is coherent on S for $i = 0, 1$; for this one notes that by virtue of a) and b), the module considered is none other than $\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathrm{R}f_{0*}(\mathcal{F}_0(-m))$, which is indeed coherent by virtue of hypothesis c) and of 1.5.

This proves 3.2 (i). For 3.2 (ii), we shall need the following:

Lemma.

Under conditions a), b), c) of 3.1, set

$$G_m = \hat{f}_*(\mathcal{F}(\cdot)_m) = \bigoplus_n f_*(\mathcal{F}_m(n)).$$

Then the projective system (G_m) satisfies the Mittag-Leffler condition.

One may assume S affine, with ring A . Let $\mathcal{S}$ then be a finitely generated graded A -algebra with positive degrees, and $t' \in \mathcal{S}_1$, such that X immerses into $\mathrm{Proj}(\mathcal{S})$, $\mathcal{O}_X(1)$ being induced by $\mathcal{O}(1)$ and the section t being the image of t' . Equip $\mathcal{S}$ with the $\mathcal{J}$ -adic filtration, where $\mathcal{J} = t'\mathcal{S}$, and consider the projective system of the $\mathcal{F}(\cdot)_m$ in the category of abelian sheaves on X_0 . One is again under the preliminary conditions of EGA 0_III 13.7.7⁸⁵ and moreover $H^i(X_0, \mathrm{gr}(\mathcal{F}(\cdot)))$ is a finitely generated module on $\mathrm{gr}_{\mathcal{J}}(\mathcal{S})$ for $i = 0, 1$. Indeed, since t' is $\mathcal{F}$ -regular, one sees at once that as a module on $(\mathcal{S}/t'\mathcal{S})[T]$ (of which $\mathrm{gr}_{\mathcal{J}}(\mathcal{S})$ is a quotient), the module under consideration is identified with $H^i(X_0, \mathcal{F}_0(\cdot)) \otimes_{\mathcal{S}/t'\mathcal{S}} (\mathcal{S}/t'\mathcal{S})[T]$; now by virtue of 1.5, $H^i(X_0, \mathcal{F}_0(\cdot))$ is finitely generated on $\mathcal{S}$, hence on $\mathcal{S}/t'\mathcal{S}$, for $i = 0, 1$, which proves our assertion. Consequently one is under the conditions for applying 0_III 13.7.7 with $n = 1$, which proves 3.3.

This point being acquired (and assuming S still affine, which is permissible for proving 3.2 (ii)) let m_0 be such that $m \geq m_0$ implies $\mathrm{Im}(G_m \rightarrow G_0) = \mathrm{Im}(G_{m_0} \rightarrow G_0)$, so that both sides are also equal to $\mathrm{Im}(\lim G_m \rightarrow G_0) = \mathrm{Im}(\hat{f}_*(\mathcal{F}(\cdot)) \rightarrow f_*\mathcal{F}_0(\cdot))$. Note now that for n large, $\mathcal{F}_{m_0}(n)$ is generated by its sections; hence $\mathcal{F}_0(n)$ is generated by sections that lift to $\mathcal{F}_{m_0}$, and so (thanks to the choice of m_0) that lift to $\mathcal{F}$. So the sections of $\mathcal{F}$ generate $\mathcal{F}_0$, hence also $\mathcal{F}$ thanks to Nakayama. This proves 3.2 (ii), hence 3.1.

Corollary.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a flat projective morphism with S locally noetherian, $\mathcal{O}_X(1)$ an invertible module on X , ample relatively to S , t a section of this module such that for every $s \in S$ the section t_s induced on the fiber X_s is $\mathcal{O}_{X_s}$ -regular, X_0 the subscheme of zeros of t , $\hat{X}$ the formal completion of X along X_0 . Suppose that for every $s \in S$, $X_{0,s}$ is of depth ≥ 2 at its closed points (i.e. X_s is of depth ≥ 3 at the closed points of $X_{0,s}$), and X_s is of depth ≥ 2 at its closed points. Under these conditions, the pair (X, X_0) satisfies the effective Lefschetz condition (Leff) of paragraph 2 of Exposé X, i.e.:

1. For every open neighborhood U of X_0 in X , the functor

$$F \mapsto \hat{F}$$

from the category of locally free coherent modules on U to the category of locally free coherent modules on $\hat{X}$ is fully faithful.

⁸⁵Rectified as indicated in IX p. 85.

2. For every locally free coherent module $\mathcal{F}$ on $\hat{X}$, there exists an open neighborhood U of X_0 , and a locally free coherent module F on U such that $\hat{F}$ is isomorphic to $\mathcal{F}$.

Indeed, a) has already been noted in 2.4 under weaker conditions. For b), one applies 3.1, which gives the conclusion, at least if S is noetherian and admits an absolutely ample invertible module, in particular if S is affine. Indeed, if F is a coherent module on X such that $\hat{F}$ is isomorphic to $\mathcal{F}$ and hence locally free, it follows that F is locally free on a neighborhood U of X_0 , and $F|_U$ will satisfy the required condition. But let us now note that by virtue of 2.5, for such an F , its image under the immersion $U \rightarrow X$ is coherent, and moreover is independent of the chosen solution (U, F) (taking into account the fact that two solutions coincide in a neighborhood of X_0 , by virtue of a)). Precisely, one may find a coherent module F on X and an isomorphism $\hat{F} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{F}$ such that F is of depth ≥ 2 at every point of X that is closed in its fiber, and this determines F up to a unique isomorphism. Thanks to this uniqueness property, the solutions of the problem found by inducing above the affine open subsets of S glue together, yielding a coherent F on all of X and an isomorphism $\hat{F} \cong \mathcal{F}$. Restricting F to the open subset U of points where it is free, one finds what one was looking for.

Thanks to 2.4 and 3.4, one may exploit, in the situation of a projective algebraic scheme and a “hyperplane section” thereof, the general facts established in Exposés X and XI concerning the conditions (Lef) and (Leff). Thus:

Corollary.

Let X be a projective algebraic scheme equipped with an ample invertible module $\mathcal{O}_X(1)$, let t be a section of this module that is $\mathcal{O}_X$ -regular, and let X_0 be the subscheme of zeros of t . Suppose that X is of depth ≥ 2 at its closed points (resp. and of depth ≥ 3 at the closed points of X_0). Then $\pi_0(X_0) \rightarrow \pi_0(X)$ is bijective, in particular X is connected if and only if X_0 is, and choosing a geometric base point in X_0 , $\pi_1(X_0) \rightarrow \pi_1(X)$ is surjective, and more generally for every open subset $U \supset X_0$, the homomorphism $\pi_1(X_0) \rightarrow \pi_1(U)$ is surjective (resp. the homomorphism $\pi_1(X_0) \rightarrow \lim_U \pi_1(U)$ is bijective). In the respective case, if one assumes moreover that the local ring of every closed point of X not in X_0 is pure (3.2) (for example is regular, or only a complete intersection), then $\pi_1(X_0) \rightarrow \pi_1(X)$ is an isomorphism.

One applies 2.4 and 3.4. One will note that in the respective case the hypothesis that X be of depth ≥ 3 at the closed points of X_0 implies that all the irreducible components of dimension $\neq 0$ of X are of dimension ≥ 3 (as one sees by noting that any such component necessarily meets X_0 , and looking at a closed point of the intersection).

Remark.

When X is normal, of dimension ≥ 2 at all its points, it is of depth ≥ 2 at its closed points and one is under the non-respective conditions of 3.5. In this case, one has a more elementary proof of the surjectivity of $\pi_1(X_0) \rightarrow \pi_1(X)$ using Bertini’s theorem (cf. *SGA 1* X.2.10). If one assumes moreover X_0 normal, and X of dimension ≥ 3 at all its points, then one is under the respective conditions of 3.5. In this case, 3.5 was established by Grauert (indeed, thanks to the normality hypothesis, one then succeeds in dispensing with the existence theorem 3.1

by certain expedients). It is this proof of Grauert that was the starting point of the “Lefschetz theory” that is the subject of the present seminar.

Corollary.

Let $X, O_X(1), t, X_0$ be as in 3.5. Suppose that X is of depth ≥ 2 at its closed points, and that

$$H^i(X_0, O_{X_0}(-n)) = 0$$

for $n > 0$ and for $i = 1$ (resp. for $i = 1$ and for $i = 2$), which implies by virtue of 1.4 that X_0 is of depth ≥ 2 (resp. ≥ 3) at its closed points, i.e. that X is of depth ≥ 3 (resp. ≥ 4) at the closed points of X_0 . Under these conditions, for every open neighborhood U of X_0 , $\text{Pic}(U) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(X_0)$ is injective, in particular $\text{Pic}(X) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(X_0)$ is injective (resp. $\lim_U \text{Pic}(U) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(X_0)$ is bijective). In the respective case, if one assumes moreover that the local ring of X at every closed point not in X_0 is parafactorial (3.1) (for example is regular, or more generally a complete intersection), then $\text{Pic}(X) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(X_0)$ is bijective.

One applies XI 3.12 and 3.13, noting that the respective hypothesis implies that the irreducible components of dimension $\neq 0$ of X are of dimension ≥ 4 . One finds in particular, by applying this to the case where X is a global complete intersection of dimension ≥ 4 in projective space:

Corollary.

Let X be an algebraic scheme of dimension ≥ 3 , which is a complete intersection in a scheme P_k^r . Then $\text{Pic}(X)$ is the free group generated by the class of the sheaf $O_X(1)$.

One reasons by induction on the number of hypersurfaces of which X is the intersection, applying 3.6 and noting that for a complete intersection X of dimension ≥ 3 , one has $H^i(X, O_X(n)) = 0$ for $i = 1, 2$ and every n .

Remark.

In the case where X is a non-singular hypersurface, 3.7 is due to Andreotti. The result 3.7 may also be expressed (when X is non-singular) by saying that the homogeneous coordinate ring of X is factorial, and in this form is contained in XI 3.13 (ii). Let us also point out that Serre had given a proof of 3.7 in the non-singular case, by transcendental means, using a specialization argument to reduce to the case of characteristic 0, where one has the Lefschetz theorem in its classical form. Of course, the fact that the purely algebraic proof given here makes it possible to dispense with non-singularity hypotheses in the statement of Lefschetz’s theorem invites one to reconsider the latter also in the classical case. Cf. the following exposé, which proposes conjectures in this direction.

In Corollaries 3.5 and 3.7 we have placed ourselves over a base field, whereas the key theorems 2.4 and 3.4 are valid over an arbitrary base. To generalize Corollaries 3.5 and 3.6 to a general S , we must give serviceable criteria for a point of X (flat over S) to have a “pure” or, respectively, parafactorial local ring. This will be the object of the following section.

4. Formal completion and normal flatness

Theorem.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme, locally immersible in a regular scheme, Y a closed part of X , $U = X - Y$, X_0 a closed subscheme of X defined by an ideal $\mathcal{J}$, $\hat{X}$ the formal completion of X along X_0 , U_0 the trace of X_0 on U , $\hat{U}$ the formal completion of U along U_0 , $i : U \rightarrow X$ and $\hat{i} : \hat{U} \rightarrow \hat{X}$ the canonical immersions, n an integer. Suppose:

- a) X is normally flat along X_0 at the points of $Y \cap X_0$, i.e. at these points the modules $\mathcal{J}^n / \mathcal{J}^{n+1}$ on X_0 are flat, i.e. locally free.
- b) For every $x \in Y \cap X_0$, one has $\text{prof}_{O_{X_0, x}} \geq n + 2$.

Under these conditions, one has the following:

1. Let F be a coherent module on U ; suppose that one has:
 - c) For every $x \in Y - Y \cap X_0$, one has $\text{prof}_{O_{X, x}} \geq n + 2$.
 - d) F is free at the points of U_0 , and of depth $\geq n + 1$ at every point of U where it is not free.

Then the graded module

$$\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \text{R}^p i_* (\mathcal{J}^m F)$$

on $\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathcal{J}^m$ is finitely generated for $p \leq n$.

2. Let F be a coherent module on $\hat{U}$. Then the graded module

$$\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \text{R}^p i_* (\mathcal{J}^m F / \mathcal{J}^{m+1} F)$$

on $\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathcal{J}^m / \mathcal{J}^{m+1} = \text{gr}_{\mathcal{J}}(O_X)$ is finitely generated for $p \leq n$.

Proof.

- (1) Let $X' = \text{Spec}(\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathcal{J}^m)$; the base change $f : X' \rightarrow X$ then defines $U' = X' - Y'$, $X'_0, U'_0 = X'_0 \cap U'$, and immersions $i' : U' \rightarrow X'$, $i'_0 : U'_0 \rightarrow X'_0$. One has therefore a cartesian square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & i' & \\ X' & \longleftarrow & U' \\ \downarrow f & & \downarrow g \\ X & \longleftarrow & U \\ & i & \end{array}$$

and one has

$$\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \text{R}^p i_* (\mathcal{J}^m F) = \text{R}^p i_* (\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathcal{J}^m F) = \text{R}^p i_* (g_* (F')),$$

where $F' = g^* F$, so that one has indeed a canonical isomorphism

$$g_*(F') \xrightarrow{\sim} \bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathcal{J}^m F,$$

since this is true at the points of U_0 , due to the fact that F is free there by virtue of d), and also at the points outside U_0 , due to the fact that there one has $\mathcal{J}^m = \mathcal{O}_U$ (so that in both cases, $\mathcal{J}^m \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_U} F \rightarrow \mathcal{J}^m F$ is an isomorphism).

On the other hand, since f and consequently g are affine, one has

$$R^p i_* (g_* (F')) = R^p (ig)_* (F') = R^p (fi')_* (F') = f_* (R^p i'_* (F')),$$

so comparing (19) and (20), one sees that assertion (1) is equivalent to the following: $R^p i'_* (F')$ is a finitely generated module, i.e. coherent on X' , for every $p \leq n$. Now since X is locally immersible in a regular scheme, the same holds of X' , which is of finite type over X , and one may apply the coherence criterion VIII 2.3 to a coherent extension F'' of F' : one wants to express that $H_{Y'}^p(F'')$ is coherent for $p \leq n+1$, and this is also equivalent to saying that for every $x' \in U'$ such that

$$\text{codim}(x' \cap Y', x') = 1,$$

one has

$$\text{prof} F'_{x'} \geq n+1.$$

Now this condition is verified at the points x' where F' is not free, since for such an x' one has $x' \notin U'_0$ by virtue of d), so g is an isomorphism there, and by virtue of d) again, F is of depth $\geq n+1$ at $g(x')$, so F' is of depth $\geq n+1$ at x' . It therefore suffices to verify condition (21) at the $x' \in U'$ satisfying (20 bis) and at which F' is free. For this, it suffices to prove that one has

$$\text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{X', x'} \geq n+1$$

at these points, *a fortiori* it suffices to establish that one has this relation at all points x' of U' satisfying (20 bis). Now, again by virtue of criterion 2.3 of Exposé VIII, this is equivalent to the assertion that the modules

$$H^p_{-} \{Y'\}(\mathcal{O}_{-} \{X'\}) \text{ for } p \leq n+1$$

are coherent. In fact, we are going to prove that they are even zero, or what amounts to the same by virtue of Exposé III, that one has

$$\text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{-} \{X', x'\} \geq n+2 \text{ for every } x' \in Y'.$$

For this, we distinguish two cases. If $x' \notin X'_0$, then f is an immersion at x' , and it is necessary to verify that F is of depth $\geq n+2$ at the image $x = f(x')$, which is none other than condition c). If on the contrary $x' \in X'_0$, i.e. $x = f(x') \in X_0$ so $x \in Y \cap X_0$, one applies conditions a) and b) thanks to the following:

Lemma.

Let X be a locally noetherian prescheme, X_0 a closed subprescheme of X defined by an ideal $\mathcal{J}$, $X' = \text{Spec}(\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathcal{J}^m)$, $X'_0 = \text{Spec}(\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathcal{J}^m / \mathcal{J}^{m+1}) = X' \times_X X_0$, x a point of

X_0 at which X is normally flat along X_0 , i.e. such that $gr_{\mathcal{J}}(O_X) = \bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathcal{J}^m / \mathcal{J}^{m+1}$ is flat there as a module on X_0 . Then for any sequence of elements $f_i (1 \leq i \leq m)$ of $O_{X,x}$ whose images in $O_{X_0,x}$ form an $O_{X_0,x}$ -regular sequence, and for every $x' \in X'$ above x , the images of the f_i in $O_{X',x'}$ (resp. in $O_{X'_0,x'}$) form respectively an $O_{X',x'}$ -regular sequence (resp. an $O_{X'_0,x'}$ -regular sequence); in particular one has

$$\text{prof } O_{-}\{X', x'\} \geq \text{prof } O_{-}\{X_0, x\}, \quad \text{prof } O_{-}\{X'_0, x'\} \geq \text{prof } O_{-}\{X_0, x\}.$$

To prove this, one may assume that X is local with closed point x , hence affine of ring $A = O_{X,x}$, $\mathcal{J}$ being defined by an ideal J ; and it suffices to prove that for any sequence $f_i (1 \leq i \leq m)$ of elements of A whose images in A/J form an A/J -regular sequence, the f_i form an $(\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} J^m)$ -regular sequence and an $(\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} J^m / J^{m+1})$ -regular sequence, i.e. for every m , they form a J^m -regular sequence and a J^m / J^{m+1} -regular sequence. The second assertion is trivial, since J^m / J^{m+1} is a free module on A/J . The first follows by looking at the J -adic filtration of J^m and noting that, for the graded module associated with J^m for this filtration, the sequence of the f_i is regular.

This proves 4.2 and consequently 4.1, (1).

Let us prove 4.1, (2). For this, let us use the cartesian square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & i'_0 & \\ X'_0 & \xleftarrow{\quad} & U'_0 \\ \downarrow f_0 & & \downarrow g_0 \\ X_0 & \xleftarrow{\quad} & U_0 \end{array}$$

and proceeding as at the beginning of the proof of (1), one finds that

$$\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} R^p i_{*-}(\mathcal{J}^m F / \mathcal{J}^{m+1} F) \cong f_{0*-}(R^p i'_{0*-}(F'_0)),$$

where $F_0 = F / \mathcal{J} F$ and $F'_0 = g_0^*(F_0)$ (using the fact that F is locally free). Hence the conclusion of (2) amounts to saying that for $p \leq n$, $R^p i'_{0*-}(F'_0)$ is a coherent module.

Here again, taking into account that F'_0 is locally free, criterion VIII 2.3 lets us reduce to proving that this is so when one replaces F'_0 by $O_{U'_0}$, i.e. to proving that the modules

$$H^p_{-}\{Y'_0\}(O_{-}\{X'_0\}) \text{ for } p \leq n+1 \quad (\text{where } Y'_0 = Y' \cap X'_0 = X'_0 - U'_0)$$

are coherent. One proves again that they are in fact zero, i.e. that one has

$$\text{prof } O_{-}\{X'_0, x'\} \geq n+2 \text{ for every } x' \in Y'_0.$$

Now this indeed follows from conditions a) and b), taking into account 4.2. This completes the proof of 4.1.

Remark.

One sees at once, by descent, that the hypothesis: X locally immersible in a regular scheme, may be replaced by the following weaker one: there exists a morphism $\bar{X} \rightarrow X$, faithfully flat and quasi-compact, such that $\bar{X}$ is locally immersible in a regular scheme.

Theorem 4.1 puts us in a position to apply the results of Exposé IX (comparison and existence theorems). We shall be particularly interested in the following:

Corollary.

Suppose conditions a), b), c) of Theorem 4.1 verified, with $n = 1$, and $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, A being separated and complete for the $\mathcal{J}$ -adic topology. Then:

1. The functor $F \mapsto \hat{F}$ from the category of locally free coherent modules on U to the category of locally free coherent modules on $\hat{U}$ is fully faithful.
2. For every locally free coherent module $\mathcal{F}$ on $\hat{U}$, there exists a coherent module F on U and an isomorphism $\hat{F} \xrightarrow{\sim} \mathcal{F}$.

In particular, if for every $x \in U$ whose closure in U does not meet U_0 , i.e. such that $x \cap X_0 \subset Y$, one has $\text{prof} O_{U,x} \geq 2$, then the pair (U, U_0) satisfies the effective Lefschetz condition (Leff) of Exposé X.

(For the last assertion, one proceeds as in X 2.1.)

A particular case of 4.4:

Corollary.

Let A be a noetherian ring, J an ideal of A contained in the radical, $A_0 = A/J$. Suppose

1. $\text{prof} A_0 \geq 3$.
2. $\text{gr}_J(A)$ is a free A_0 -module.
3. A is complete for the J -adic topology.

Let $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, $X_0 = \text{Spec}(A_0) = V(J)$, a the closed point of X , $U = X - a$, $U_0 = X_0 - a$, $\hat{U}$ the formal completion of U along U_0 . Then the functor $F \mapsto \hat{F}$ from the category of locally free coherent modules on U to the category of locally free coherent modules on $\hat{U}$ is fully faithful. Moreover, for every locally free coherent module $\mathcal{F}$ on $\hat{U}$, there exists a coherent module (not necessarily locally free!) F on U , and an isomorphism $\hat{F} \cong \mathcal{F}$.

One will note that thanks to 4.3, we did not have to suppose that A is a quotient of a regular ring, since the completion of A for the $\mathfrak{r}(A)$ -adic topology satisfies this condition in any case.

Proceeding as in Exposés X and XI, one concludes from 4.5:

Corollary.

Under the conditions of 4.5, one has the following:

- a) U and U_0 are connected (III 3.1).
Choosing a geometric base point in U_0 , the homomorphism
 $\pi_1(U_0) \rightarrow \pi_1(U)$
is surjective.
- b) The homomorphism

$$\text{Pic}(U) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(U_0)$$

is injective.

To prove b), taking 4.5 into account, this amounts to verifying that any isomorphism $L'_0 \xrightarrow{\sim} L_0$ lifts to an isomorphism $\hat{L}' \xrightarrow{\sim} \hat{L}$. Now for this one lifts step by step to isomorphisms $L'_n \xrightarrow{\sim} L_n$; the obstructions lie in $H^1(U_0, \mathcal{J}^n/\mathcal{J}^{n+1})$, and these modules are zero because $\mathcal{J}^n/\mathcal{J}^{n+1}$ is free and $\text{prof} A_0 \geq 3$.

We are now in a position to prove the following:

Theorem.

Let A be a noetherian local ring, J an ideal of A contained in its radical, $A_0 = A/J$. Suppose

1. $\text{prof} A_0 \geq 3$.
2. $\text{gr}_J(A)$ is a free module on A_0 .

Then, if A_0 is “pure” (X 3.1) (resp. parafactorial (XI 3.1)), so is A .

Proof.

By descent, one may assume that one also has

1. A is complete for the J -adic topology.

Indeed, by virtue of (i) and (ii), one has $\text{prof}(A) \geq 3$, hence $\text{prof}(\hat{A}) \geq 3$, where $\hat{A}$ is the completion of A for the J -adic topology, and one applies X 3.6 and XI 3.6. One is therefore under the conditions of 4.5. Since $\text{prof}(A) \geq 3 \geq 2$, to say that A is parafactorial means simply that $\text{Pic}(U) = 0$, and by virtue of 4.6 b) it suffices for this that $\text{Pic}(U_0) = 0$, i.e. that A_0 be parafactorial. To prove that A is “pure” if A_0 is, one needs to prove that if V is an étale cover of U , defined by an algebra B on U , then $H^0(U, B)$ is a finite étale algebra over A . Now A_0 being pure, the same holds of the A_n (which differ from it only by nilpotent elements), so for every n , $B_n = H^0(U, B_n)$ is an étale algebra over A/J^{n+1} , and these algebras of course glue, so that $\lim B_n$ is an étale algebra over A . Now by virtue of 4.5, this algebra is none other than $H^0(U, B)$, which establishes our assertion.

Corollary.

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a flat morphism of locally noetherian preschemes, $x \in X$, $y = f(x)$; suppose that $O_{X_y, x}$ is a “pure” (resp. parafactorial) local ring of depth ≥ 3 . Then the same holds for $O_{X, x}$.

This is the result of the type promised at the end of the preceding section, in order to generalize Corollaries 3.5 and following. One thus finds, using 3.4, the following:

Corollary.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a flat projective morphism with S locally noetherian, $O_X(1)$ an invertible module on X ample with respect to S , t a section of $O_X(1)$ such that for every $s \in S$ the section t_s induced on X_s is O_{X_s} -regular, X_0 the subscheme of zeros of t , X_m the subscheme

of zeros of t^{m+1} . Suppose that for every $s \in S$, X_s is of depth ≥ 3 at all its closed points. Then:

- a) If the local rings of the closed points of $X_s - X_{0,s}$ ($s \in S$) are “pure”, for example are complete intersections, then the functor $X' \mapsto X'_0 = X' \times_X X_0$ from the category of étale covers of X to the category of étale covers of X_0 is an equivalence of categories; in particular, choosing a geometric base point in X_0 , the homomorphism

$$\pi_1(X_0) \rightarrow \pi_1(X)$$

is an isomorphism.⁸⁶

- b) If the local rings of the closed points of $X_s - X_{0,s}$ ($s \in S$) are “parafactorial”, for example regular, or complete intersections of dimension ≥ 4 , then for every integer m such that $R^i f_{0*}(O_{X_0}(-n)) = 0$ for $n > m$ and $i = 1, 2$, the map $\text{Pic}(X) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(X_m)$ is bijective.

Moreover, if S is noetherian and the $X_{0,s}$ are of depth ≥ 3 at their closed points, there exist such m (cf. 1.5).

Remark.

Under the conditions of the last assertion of 4.9 b), one has seen in 1.5 that there exists an m such that $n > m$ implies even $H^i(X_0, O_{X_0}(-n)) = 0$ for $i = 1, 2$ (and even for $i \leq 2$). This condition is stronger than $R^i f_*(O_{X_0}(-n)) = 0$ for $i = 1, 2$, and it has moreover the advantage of being stable under base change. The same holds of the depth hypotheses made in 4.9, and also of a hypothesis of the type “the X_s are locally complete intersections”. It then follows, under these conditions, that 4.9 b) also implies that the functor morphism

$$\text{Pic}_{X/S} \rightarrow \text{Pic}_{X_n/S}$$

in Sch/S is an isomorphism, hence also the morphism for the relative Picard schemes, when these exist:

$$\text{Pic}_{X/S} \rightarrow \text{Pic}_{X_n/S}.$$

⁸⁶N.D.E. Let us point out the spectacular connectedness result obtained since by Fulton and Hansen, in the case where $S = \text{Spec}(k)$ (k an algebraically closed field). Let $g : X \rightarrow P_k^m \times P_k^m$ be such that $\dim g(X) > m$; then the inverse image of the diagonal is connected. Among other things, this allows one to generalize Corollary 4.9 when f is the structural morphism of the projective space P_k^m over $S = \text{Spec}(k)$: precisely, an irreducible subvariety X of P_k^m of dimension $> m/2$ has trivial fundamental group! (cf. Fulton W. & Hansen J., “A connectedness theorem for projective varieties, with applications to intersections and singularities of mappings”, *Ann. of Math.* (2) **110** (1979), no. 1, pp. 159–166). For generalizations to the case of Grassmannians or abelian varieties, see Debarre O., “Théorèmes de connexité pour les produits d’espaces projectifs et les grassmanniennes”, *Amer. J. Math.* **118** (1996), no. 6, pp. 1347–1367 and “Théorèmes de connexité et variétés abéliennes”, *Amer. J. Math.* **117** (1995), no. 3, pp. 787–805. The triviality result for the fundamental group of X as above was obtained independently by Faltings, who proves moreover that $\text{Pic}(X)$ has no torsion prime to the characteristic of k , by methods of algebraization of formal vector bundles, more in the line of Grothendieck’s techniques, cf. (Faltings G., “Algebraization of some formal vector bundles”, *Ann. of Math.* (2) **110** (1979), no. 3, pp. 501–514).

Even in the case where S is the spectrum of an algebraically closed field, this statement is markedly more precise than the statement saying merely that $\text{Pic}(X) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(X_n)$ is bijective.

One may ask whether one can always take $n = 0$ in the preceding conclusions (assuming therefore the $X_{0,s}$ of depth ≥ 3 at their closed points). When X_0 is smooth over S and the residue characteristics of S are zero, this is indeed so, by virtue of Kodaira's "vanishing theorem" (proved by transcendental means, using a Kählerian metric) which implies that for every smooth connected projective scheme of dimension n over a field k of characteristic zero, and every ample invertible module L on X , one has $H^i(X, L^{-1}) = 0$ for $i \neq n$. It is not known⁸⁷ at present whether this theorem may be replaced by a generalization in characteristic $p > 0$, and whether the smoothness hypothesis may be replaced by a hypothesis of a more general nature (bearing on depth, or of "complete intersection" type ...).

5. Universal finiteness conditions for a non-proper morphism

Let us recall for the record the following:

Proposition.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a proper morphism of preschemes with S locally noetherian, U an open part of X , $g : U \rightarrow X$ the canonical immersion, $h = fg : U \rightarrow S$, F a module on U . Suppose that the modules $R^i g_*(F)$ are coherent for $i \leq n$ (a hypothesis of local nature on X , which is verified in practice using criterion VIII 2.3). Then $R^i h_*(F)$ is coherent for $i \leq n$.

This follows at once from the Leray spectral sequence

$$E_2^{p,q} = R^p f_*(R_*^{qg}(F)) \Rightarrow R^* h_*(F),$$

and from the fact that the higher direct images by f of a coherent module on X are coherent (EGA III 3.2.1).

Proposition.

Let S be a locally noetherian prescheme, $\mathcal{S}$ a quasi-coherent graded algebra of finite type on S , generated by $\mathcal{S}_1$, X a subprescheme of $\text{Proj}(\mathcal{S})$, $\mathcal{O}_X(1)$ the invertible module on X

⁸⁷N.D.E. As Raynaud has remarked, the decomposition result for the de Rham complex of Deligne and Illusie easily entails the vanishing of the group $H^i(X, L^{-1})$ (with L ample on X projective and smooth over k of characteristic $p > 0$) for $i < \inf(p, \dim(X))$ as soon as one assumes that X is liftable to a flat scheme over $W_2(k)$ (cf. Deligne P. & Illusie L., "Relèvements modulo p^2 et décomposition du complexe de de Rham", *Invent. Math.* **89** (1987), no. 2, pp. 247–270); this gives a purely algebraic proof of Kodaira's result for projective varieties in characteristic zero. If X is not liftable, it is well known that the "vanishing theorem" is false; cf. the example in (Raynaud M., "Contre-exemple au 'vanishing theorem' en caractéristique $p > 0$ ", in *C.P. Ramanujam — a tribute*, Tata Inst. Fund. Res. Studies in Math., vol. 8, Springer, Berlin–New York, 1978, pp. 273–278); see also the very pretty examples in (Haboush W. & Lauritzen N., "Varieties of unseparated flags", in *Linear algebraic groups and their representations* (Los Angeles, CA, 1992), Contemp. Math., vol. 153, American Mathematical Society, Providence, RI, 1993, pp. 35–57), simplified in (Lauritzen N. & Rao A.P., "Elementary counterexamples to Kodaira vanishing in prime characteristic", *Proc. Indian Acad. Sci. Math. Sci.* **107** (1997), no. 1, pp. 21–25). On the other hand, I do not know an example where the map $\text{Pic}(X_{n+1}) \rightarrow \text{Pic}(X_n)$ is not surjective for $n > 1$ in positive characteristic, where X_n denotes a thickened hyperplane section of X projective and smooth as above.

very ample relatively to S induced by $\text{Proj}(\mathcal{S}(1))$, U an open part of X , $g : U \rightarrow X$ the canonical immersion, $h = fg : U \rightarrow S$, F a quasi-coherent module on U , whence twisted modules $F(m) = F \otimes \mathcal{O}_X(m)$ ($m \in \mathbb{Z}$), n an integer, m_0 an integer. The following conditions are equivalent:

1. $R^i g_*(F)$ is coherent for $i \leq n$.
2. $\bigoplus_{m \geq m_0} R^i h_*(F(m))$ is a finitely generated $\mathcal{S}$ -module for $i \leq n$.

Proof.

Replacing F by $F(m)$ in the spectral sequence above one finds a spectral sequence of graded $\mathcal{S}$ -modules

$$E_2^{\wedge\{p,q\}} = \bigoplus_{m \geq m_0} R^p f_* (R^q g_*(F(m))) \Rightarrow \bigoplus_{m \geq m_0} R^{\wedge\{p,q\}} h_*(F(m)).$$

Since one has

$$R_*^{qg}(F(m)) \cong R_*^{qg}(F)(m),$$

one sees that if the $R^i g_*(F)$ are coherent, $E_2^{p,q}$ is finitely generated on $\mathcal{S}$ for $q \leq n$, thanks to part a) of Lemma 5.3 below, which implies that the abutment is finitely generated on $\mathcal{S}$ in degree $i \leq n$. This proves (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). Moreover, reasoning in the abelian category of graded $\mathcal{S}$ -modules modulo the thick subcategory C of those that are quasi-coherent of finite type, one finds by the preceding spectral sequence

$$\bigoplus_{m \geq m_0} R^{\wedge\{n+1\}} h_*(F(m)) \cong \bigoplus_{m \geq m_0} f_*(R^{\wedge\{n+1\}} g_*(F(m))) \bmod C,$$

which proves that if the left-hand side is a finitely generated $\mathcal{S}$ -module, then $R^{n+1} g_*(F)$ is coherent, by virtue of part b) of Lemma 5.3. This proves the implication (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i) by induction on n . It remains to prove:

Lemma.

Let $S, \mathcal{S}, X, f$ be as in 5.2, and G a quasi-coherent module on X , m_0 an integer. Then:

- a) If G is coherent, then for every integer i , the graded module $\bigoplus_{m \geq m_0} R^i f_*(G(m))$ on $\mathcal{S}$ is finitely generated.
- b) Conversely, suppose that the module $\bigoplus_{m \geq m_0} R^i f_*(G(m))$ on $\mathcal{S}$ is finitely generated; then G is coherent.

Proof of 5.3.

For a), the case $i = 0$ is given in EGA III 2.3.2; the case $i > 0$ follows from EGA III 2.2.1 (i)(ii), which says that the $R^i f_* G(m)$ are coherent, and zero for m large (if one assumes S noetherian, which is permissible).

For b), one notes that G is isomorphic to $\text{Proj}(\bigoplus_{m \geq m_0} f_*(G(m)))$ (EGA II 3.4.4 and 3.4.2), which proves that G is coherent if $\bigoplus_{m \geq m_0} f_*(G(m))$ is finitely generated on $\mathcal{S}$, by virtue of *loc. cit.* 3.4.4.

Corollary.

(S noetherian.) Suppose that $R^i g_*(F)$ is coherent for $i \leq n$; then for $i \leq n + 1$ and m large, one has a canonical isomorphism:

$$R^i h_*(F(m)) \cong f_*(R^i g_*(F)(m)).$$

Indeed the spectral sequence (26) for $F(m)$ then degenerates in degree $\leq n$, by *EGA* III 2.2.1 (ii), whence at once the result (which moreover recovers the implication (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i) of 5.2).

Corollary.

Under the preliminary conditions of 5.2, S noetherian, the following conditions are equivalent:

1. $\bigoplus_{m \geq m_0} h_*(F(m))$ is finitely generated on $\mathcal{S}$, and $R^i h_*(F(m)) = 0$ for $0 < i \leq n$ and m large.
2. $g_*(F)$ is coherent, and $R^i g_*(F) = 0$ for $0 < i \leq n$.
3. (ii bis) $g_*(F)$ is coherent, and $\text{prof}_Y g_*(F) > n + 1$.

The equivalence of (ii) and (ii bis) is contained in III 3.3. Moreover, by virtue of 5.2 conditions (i) and (ii) both imply that the $R^i g_*(F)$ ($i \leq n$) are coherent. The equivalence of (i) and (ii) then follows from 5.4, taking into account the fact that for a coherent module G on X , one has $G = 0$ if and only if $f_*(G(m)) = 0$ for m large, for instance by virtue of *EGA* III 2.2.1 (iii).

Remark.

One may interpret criteria 5.2 and 5.5 by saying that the “simultaneous finiteness condition” 5.2 (ii) is expressed by properties of local regularity (in terms of depth, thanks to VIII 2.1) of F at the points of U neighboring $Y = X - U$, whereas the “asymptotic vanishing condition” 5.5 (i) is of a markedly stronger nature, and is expressed by conditions of local regularity of $g_*(F)$ at the points of Y itself. It would be interesting, in order to generalize the Lefschetz-type theorems for projective morphisms to quasi-projective morphisms, to find local criteria on X necessary and sufficient for the $\mathcal{S}$ -modules $\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} R^i h_*(F(m))$ for $i \leq n$ to be finitely generated. When S is the spectrum of a field (and doubtless more generally, when it is the spectrum of an artinian ring) and $Y = X - U$ is finite, one can show that it is necessary and sufficient that the following conditions be verified:

1. $\text{prof} F_x > n$ for every closed point x of U (compare 1.4).
2. $R^i g_*(F)$ is coherent for $i \leq n$, or what amounts to the same, there exists an open neighborhood V of Y such that for every closed point x of $U \cap V$, one has $\text{prof} F_x > n + 1$.

Proposition.

Let S be a locally noetherian prescheme, $g : U \rightarrow X$ a morphism of preschemes of finite type over S ,⁸⁸ with structural morphisms h and f , F a quasi-coherent module on U , n an

⁸⁸It suffices in fact that g be quasi-compact and quasi-separated (*EGA* IV 1.2.1), without conditions on U , X .

integer. The following conditions are equivalent:

1. For every base change $S' \rightarrow S$ with S' noetherian, the module $R^n g'_*(F')$ on X' is coherent.
2. For every base change as above, and every coherent ideal J on S' , denoting by $\mathcal{J}$ the ideal $JO_{X'}$ on X' , the graded module

$$\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} R^n g'_*(\mathcal{J}^m F')$$

on $\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathcal{J}^m$ is finitely generated.

3. For every base change $S' \rightarrow S$, and J as above, the graded module

$$\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} R^n g'_*(\mathcal{J}^m F' / \mathcal{J}^{m+1} F')$$

on $gr_{\mathcal{J}}(O_{X'}) = \bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathcal{J}^m / \mathcal{J}^{m+1}$ is finitely generated.

Plainly (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i) and (iii) $\Rightarrow$ (i), as one sees by setting $\mathcal{J} = 0$ in conditions (ii) and (iii). The reverse implications are obtained by applying (i) to the composite base change $S'' \rightarrow S' \rightarrow S$, where S'' is equal to $\text{Spec}(\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathcal{J}^m)$ resp. $\text{Spec}(\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} \mathcal{J}^m / \mathcal{J}^{m+1})$.

The interest of this proposition is that conditions of form (ii) are those that intervene in the “algebraic-formal comparison theorems”, whereas conditions of form (iii) intervene in the “existence theorems” that complement them, cf. Exposé IX. A first interesting case is the one where $f : X \rightarrow S$ is the identity, and where it is therefore a question of conditions on a morphism $h : U \rightarrow S$ locally of finite type and a quasi-coherent module F on U flat with respect to S . To obtain sufficient conditions, we are going to assume that U embeds, via $g : U \rightarrow X$, as an open subscheme of an X proper over S . Applying 5.1, one sees therefore:

Corollary.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a proper morphism with S locally noetherian, U an open subset of X , $g : U \rightarrow X$ the canonical immersion, $h = fg : U \rightarrow S$, F a quasi-coherent module on X , flat with respect to S . Suppose that for every base change $S' \rightarrow S$ with S' locally noetherian, one has $R^i g'_*(F')$ coherent on X' for $i \leq n$. Then one has the following:

1. For every base change $S' \rightarrow S$ with S' locally noetherian, $R^i h'_*(F')$ is coherent on S' for $i \leq n$.
2. For every $S' \rightarrow S$ as above, and every coherent ideal J on S' , the graded modules

$$\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} R^i h'_*(J^m F')$$

on $\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} J^m$ are finitely generated for $i \leq n$.

3. For every $S' \rightarrow S$ and J as above, the graded modules

$$\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} R^i h'_*(J^m F' / J^{m+1} F')$$

on $gr_J(O_{S'}) = \bigoplus_{m \geq 0} J^m / J^{m+1}$ are finitely generated for $i \leq n$.

Moreover, under the conditions of (ii), and by virtue of the comparison theorem 1.1, denoting by $\hat{S}'$ the formal completion of S' along J and by $\hat{U}'$ that of U' along $JO_{U'}$, the canonical homomorphisms

$$\hat{R}^i h'_*(F') \rightarrow R^i \hat{h}'_*(\hat{F}') \rightarrow \lim_k R^i h'_*(F'_k)$$

are isomorphisms for $i \leq n - 1$.

Remark.

Suppose moreover under the conditions of 5.8 with F coherent, and consider a base change $S' \rightarrow S$ as in 5.9 (i). Suppose moreover that S' is locally immersible in a regular scheme, or more generally, that there exists a morphism $S'' \rightarrow S'$ faithfully flat and quasi-compact such that S'' is locally immersible in a regular scheme; this condition is verified in particular if S' is local. Then the conclusion of 5.8 (i) and (ii) remains valid when F' is replaced by a module G' on U' such that every point of U' has an open neighborhood on which G' is isomorphic to a module of the form F'^n . Indeed, one is reduced to the case where S' itself is locally immersible in a regular scheme, so that the same holds of $S'' = \text{Spec}(\bigoplus_{m \geq 0} J^m)$ and of $X'' = X' \times_{S'} S'' = X \times_S S''$, which are of finite type over it. One then applies the finiteness criterion VIII 2.3 to the direct images for $i \leq n$ of G'' under the immersion $U'' \rightarrow X''$, noting that they are satisfied by hypothesis for F'' , hence also for G'' , since they are expressed in terms of depth and G'' is locally isomorphic to a F''^n . The same argument shows that if $\mathcal{G}'$ is a coherent module on $\hat{U}'$ (completion of U' along the ideal $JO_{U'}$) such that $\mathcal{G}'_0 = \mathcal{G}'/J\mathcal{G}'$ is locally of the form $F'_0{}^n$, then the conclusion of (iii) remains valid when F' is replaced there by $\mathcal{G}'$. One thus obtains the following result, using the results of Exposé IX:

Corollary.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a proper morphism with S locally noetherian, U an open part of X ; suppose U flat with respect to S , and that for every base change $S' \rightarrow S$ with S' locally noetherian, one has $R^i g'_*(O_{U'})$ coherent on X' for $i = 0, 1$. Suppose then that S' is of the form $\text{Spec}(A)$, where A is a noetherian ring equipped with an ideal J such that A is separated and complete for the J -adic topology. Under these conditions:

1. The functor $F \mapsto \hat{F}$ from the category of locally free modules on U' to the category of locally free modules on $\hat{U}'$ is fully faithful.
2. For every locally free module $\mathcal{F}$ on $\hat{U}'$, there exists a coherent module F on U' (not necessarily locally free, alas), and an isomorphism $\hat{F} \cong \mathcal{F}$.

It remains only to prove (ii), thanks to 5.9. Now by that remark and 2.1, it follows that $\mathcal{F}$ is induced by a coherent module $\mathcal{G}$ on $\hat{X}'$. By the existence theorem EGA III 5.1.4, $\mathcal{G}$ is of the form $\hat{F}$, where F is coherent on X , whence the conclusion.

Remarks.

1. Using 5.10, 4.7 and a suitable hypothesis, saying that certain local rings of the geometric fibers of $X' \rightarrow S'$ are “pure” resp. parafactorial, one ought to be able to obtain statements saying that the functor $Z' \mapsto \hat{Z}'$ from the category of étale covers of X' to the category of étale covers of $\hat{X}'$ (or what amounts to the same, of X'_0) is an equiv-

alence of categories, resp. that the functor $L \mapsto \hat{L}$ from the category of invertible modules on X' to the category of invertible modules on $\hat{X}'$ is an equivalence. Using recent results of Murre, it is probable that one ought to be able to deduce existence theorems for Picard schemes of certain non-proper algebraic schemes.⁸⁹ More generally, the elimination of purity hypotheses in various existence theorems, notably of representability of functors like Hilbert or Picard functors, by means of the techniques developed in this seminar, deserves a systematic study.

2. One may set oneself the problem of giving handy necessary and sufficient conditions, in terms of depth, for the universal finiteness condition envisaged in 5.10 to be verified.

⁸⁹N.D.E. Of course, in the projective case one refers to Grothendieck's existence theorems of *FGA*; cf. Grothendieck A., "Technique de descente et théorèmes d'existence en géométrie algébrique. VI. Les schémas de Picard: propriétés générales", in *Séminaire Bourbaki*, vol. 7, Société mathématique de France, Paris, 1995, Exp. 236, pp. 221–243 and "Technique de descente et théorèmes d'existence en géométrie algébrique. V. Les schémas de Picard: théorèmes d'existence", in *Séminaire Bourbaki*, vol. 7, Société mathématique de France, Paris, 1995, Exp. 232, pp. 143–161. The nine finiteness conjectures contained therein are proved in Exposés XII and XIII of Mme Raynaud and Kleiman in *SGA 6*. For an excellent elementary text on the subject, see Kleiman's expository article (Kleiman S., "The Picard scheme", to appear in *Contemp. Math.*). For an application of these techniques to the global generalized Jacobians of a relative smooth curve, see (Contou-Carrère C., "La jacobienne généralisée d'une courbe relative; construction et propriété universelle de factorisation", *C. R. Acad. Sci. Paris Sér. A-B* **289** (1979), no. 3, A203–A206 and "Jacobiniennes généralisées globales relatives", in *The Grothendieck Festschrift*, Vol. II, Progr. Math., vol. 87, Birkhäuser, Boston, 1990, pp. 69–109). See also, by the same author, in the purely local context, the construction and study of the "local generalized Jacobian" functor ("Jacobienne locale, groupe de bivecteurs de Witt universel, et symbole modéré", *C. R. Acad. Sci. Paris Sér. I Math.* **318** (1994), no. 8, pp. 743–746). Moreover, while in the case of a projective and smooth morphism the connected components of the Picard scheme are proper, this is no longer the case in the singular case. The problem of compactifying Picard schemes arises naturally: this problem has been studied in detail, notably in (Altman A.B. & Kleiman S., "Compactifying the Picard scheme", *Adv. in Math.* **35** (1980), no. 1, pp. 50–112, and "Compactifying the Picard scheme. II", *Amer. J. Math.* **101** (1979), no. 1, pp. 10–41). The case of curves had been studied earlier (D'Souza C., "Compactification of generalised Jacobians", *Proc. Indian Acad. Sci. Sect. A Math. Sci.* **88** (1979), no. 5, pp. 419–457). One even knows exactly when the compactified Jacobian of a curve is irreducible (Rego C.J., "The compactified Jacobian", *Ann. Sci. Éc. Norm. Sup.* (4) **13** (1980), no. 2, pp. 211–223), this being the closure of the (ordinary) Jacobian when the curve is geometrically integral and locally planar; for a family construction of compactified Jacobians, see (Esteves E., "Compactifying the relative Jacobian over families of reduced curves", *Trans. Amer. Math. Soc.* **353** (2001), no. 8, pp. 3045–3095). Since then, existence results for the Picard scheme in the proper case have progressed since the original edition of *SGA 2*; cf. (Murre J.P., "On contravariant functors from the category of pre-schemes over a field into the category of abelian groups (with an application to the Picard functor)", *Publ. Math. Inst. Hautes Études Sci.* **23** (1964), pp. 5–43) and especially (Artin M., "Algebraization of formal moduli. I", in *Global Analysis (Papers in Honor of K. Kodaira)*, Univ. Tokyo Press, Tokyo, 1969, pp. 21–71). See also (Raynaud M., "Spécialisation du foncteur de Picard", *Publ. Math. Inst. Hautes Études Sci.* **38** (1970), pp. 27–76) in the case of a proper scheme over a discrete valuation ring, but not necessarily flat. For a discussion of more recent results, particularly those of Artin, for the Picard functor of proper and flat schemes, in particular in the cohomologically flat case in dimension 0, see Chapter VIII of (Bosch S., Lütkebohmert W. & Raynaud M., *Néron models*, Ergebnisse der Mathematik und ihrer Grenzgebiete (3), vol. 21, Springer-Verlag, Berlin, 1990) and the references cited. Much more recently, very fine results have been obtained in the case of relative curves $f : X \rightarrow S$ over the spectrum S of a discrete valuation ring with perfect residue field. More precisely, one assumes that f is proper and flat, X regular and $f_*\mathcal{O}_X = \mathcal{O}_S$. On the other hand, one does not assume f cohomologically flat in dimension 0, i.e. one does not assume $H^1(X, \mathcal{O})$ torsion-free. The Picard scheme is then not representable, either by a scheme or an algebraic space, as soon as the torsion in question is non-zero. Let J be the Néron model of the generic fiber of f : it is a quotient of the Picard functor P . Then, Raynaud has shown that the kernel of the tangent map $H^1(X, \mathcal{O}) = \text{Lie}(P) \rightarrow \text{Lie}(J)$ coincides with the torsion subgroup of H^1 and that the cokernel has the same length (see Theorem 3.1 of (Liu Q., Lorenzini D. & Raynaud M., "Néron models, Lie algebras, and reduction of curves of genus one", *Invent. Math.* **157** (2004), pp. 455–518)). This result allows the above-mentioned authors to study the link between the Birch–Swinnerton-Dyer and Artin–Tate conjectures (see Theorem 6.6 of *loc. cit.*). Concerning the local Picard scheme, see Boutot's thesis, cited in editor's note (13) page 149.

When S is the spectrum of a field, it follows easily from *EGA* III 1.4.15 that it is necessary and sufficient that the $R^i g_*(F)$ ($i \leq n$) be coherent, which is expressed in terms of depth thanks to VIII 2.3. In the general case, one will note however that it does not suffice to require that the preceding condition be verified for all the fibers $U_s \subset X_s$ ($s \in S$), even in the case where $n = 0$. Take for example $X = S$, S the spectrum of a discrete valuation ring, U the open subset reduced to the generic point, $F = O_U$.

3. Here is, however, a sufficient condition ensuring that one is under the conditions of the hypothesis of 5.10: it suffices that f be flat, and that for every $s \in S$ and every $x \in Y_s = X_s - U_s$, one has

$$\text{prof } O_{\{X_s, x\}} \geq n + 2.$$

Indeed, taking into account Lemma 2.5 (cf. relation (16) after 2.5), it follows that one then has $g_*(O_U) \cong O_X$ and $R^i g_*(O_U) = 0$ for $0 < i \leq n$, and the same relations will plainly be verified after any base change $S' \rightarrow S$.

Exposé XIII. Problems and conjectures

1. Relations between global and local results. Affine problems related to duality

It is well known that many statements concerning a projective scheme X can be formulated in terms of statements concerning a certain graded ring, or better a complete local ring, namely the homogeneous coordinate ring of X (i.e. the affine ring of the projecting cone $\tilde{X}$ of X), or its completion (i.e. the completion of the local ring of the vertex of $\tilde{X}$). The interest of this reformulation is that it often allows one, starting from known global results, to conjecture, and even to prove, analogous results for complete noetherian local rings more general than those which really appear in the global statement, for instance for local rings that are not necessarily of equal characteristic. Thus, Serre's duality theorem for projective space (XII 1.1) suggested the useful local duality theorem (V 2.1). Serre's fundamental theorem on the cohomology of coherent Modules on projective space (finiteness, asymptotic behavior for large n of $H^i(X, F(n))$, cf. *EGA* III 2.2.1) generalizes to a structure theorem for the local invariants $H_m^i(M)$, see V 3. Likewise, the Lefschetz theorems for the fundamental group, and for the Picard group ("equivalence criteria"), well familiar in the classical case and subsequently extended to an arbitrary base field, suggested the "local" Lefschetz theorems of Exposés X and XI. Of course, the local theorems are in turn precious tools for obtaining global statements. For example, local duality permits one to formulate a global asymptotic property (XII 1.3 (i)) by the vanishing of certain local invariants $H^i(F_x)$. More substantially, the local Lefschetz theorems, implying for instance the "purity" or the parafactoriality of certain local rings that are complete intersections (X 3.4 and XI 3.13), allow one, in the global Lefschetz theorems, to dispose of certain non-singularity hypotheses, as in X 3.5, 3.6, 3.7.

Another useful generalization of the theorems concerning projective schemes over a field k consists in replacing k by a general base scheme. Thus, the sequel of *EGA* III will give⁹⁰ a

⁹⁰*N.D.E.* In fact, this generalization is not to be found there; see note below, and the editor's note (4) on page 2.

generalization in this direction of Serre duality⁹¹; the theorems on finiteness and asymptotic behavior of the $H^i(X, F(n))$ were stated in EGA III 2.2.1 over a general base scheme, and finally the Lefschetz theorems can equally be developed for a projective morphism, as we saw in XII 4.9, thanks to the local theorem XII 4.7. Of course, working over a general base scheme also leads to essentially new statements, such as the “comparison theorem” EGA III 4.15 and the existence theorem for sheaves EGA III 5.1.4 (which, as we saw moreover in IX, derive from the same key cohomological theorems as the Lefschetz theorems for π_1 and Pic).

It then becomes necessary to extract theorems that simultaneously encompass the two generalizations we have just indicated of statements concerning projective schemes over a field. The natural objects for such a common generalization are noetherian rings that are separated and complete for an I -adic topology. Their study, from this point of view, has not yet been seriously addressed, and seems to me at the present time the most interesting subject in the local theory of coherent sheaves. Here is a typical problem in this direction:

Conjecture 1.1 (“Second affine finiteness theorem”^{92,93}).

Let M be a finitely generated module over a noetherian ring A (which one will, if necessary, assume to be a quotient of a regular ring), and let J be an ideal of A . Prove that the modules $H_J^i(M)$ are

“ J -cofinite”, i.e. that the modules

$$\mathrm{Hom}_A(A/J, H_J^i(M))$$

are finitely generated.

Recall that $H_J^i(M)$ denotes the module $H_Y^i(X, \tilde{M})$ (where $X = \mathrm{Spec}(A)$, $Y = V(J)$) of Exposé I, interpreted in II in terms of a direct limit of cohomologies of Koszul complexes, or again for $i \geq 2$ the module $H^{i-1}(X - Y, \tilde{M})$. Actually, 1.1 should be a consequence of a more precise statement, implying that the $H_J^i(M)$ lie in a suitable abelian subcategory $\mathcal{D}_J$ of the category $\mathcal{C}_J$ of A -modules of support $\subset Y = V(J)$, such that $H \in \mathrm{Ob} \mathcal{D}_J$ implies that H is J -cofinite. (N.B. The category of modules H of support contained in $V(J)$ that are J -cofinite is unfortunately not stable under passage to a quotient!). The essential problem

⁹¹Cf. *Séminaire Hartshorne*, cited at the end of Exp. IV.

⁹²This conjecture, and conjecture 1.2 below, are false, as R. Hartshorne has shown, “Affine duality and cofinite modules”, *Invent. Math.* **9** (1969/70), p. 145–164, section 3.

⁹³N.D.E. However, if A is complete local (resp. regular of positive characteristic) and J is the maximal ideal, the statement is true for M finitely generated (resp. $M = A$), cf. (Hartshorne R., “Affine duality and cofinite modules”, *Invent. Math.* **9** (1969/70), p. 145–164, corollary 1.4) (resp. (Huneke C. & Sharp R., “Bass numbers of local cohomology modules”, *Trans. Amer. Math. Soc.* **339** (1993), no. 2, p. 765–779), which moreover contains far stronger results). For completely different methods ($\mathcal{D}$ -modules) allowing one to approach characteristic zero, see (Lyubeznik G., “Finiteness properties of local cohomology modules (an application of $\mathcal{D}$ -modules to commutative algebra)”, *Invent. Math.* **113** (1993), no. 1, p. 41–55); see also by the same author “Finiteness properties of local cohomology modules for regular local rings of mixed characteristic: the unramified case”, *Comm. Algebra* **28** (2000), no. 12, p. 5867–5882, Special issue in honor of Robin Hartshorne, and “Finiteness properties of local cohomology modules: a characteristic-free approach”, *J. Pure Appl. Algebra* **151** (2000), no. 1, p. 43–50. The notion of cofinite module has evolved since under Hartshorne’s aegis. One says that M is J -cofinite if its support is contained in $V(J)$ and if all $\mathrm{Ext}_A^i(A/J, H_J^i(M))$ are finitely generated. On this subject, see for example (Delfino D. & Marley Th., “Cofinite modules and local cohomology”, *J. Pure Appl. Algebra* **121** (1997), no. 1, p. 45–52).

would then consist in defining $\mathcal{D}_J$. More precisely, the solution of problem 1.1 should follow (at least if A is a quotient of a regular ring) from a duality theory, generalizing both local duality and the duality theory of projective morphisms to which we alluded above, and which would be of the following kind:

Conjecture 1.2 (“Affine duality”⁹⁴).

Suppose A is regular, separated and complete for the J -adic topology. Let $C_\bullet(A)$ be an injective resolution of A .

- (i) Prove that the functor

$$D_J : L_\bullet \mapsto \text{Hom}_J(L_\bullet, C_\bullet(A))$$

from the category of complexes of A -modules that are free of finite type in each dimension and bounded above in degree (where morphisms are homomorphisms of complexes up to homotopy) into the category of complexes of A -modules $K_\bullet$ that are injective in each dimension and bounded above in degree (where the morphisms are defined similarly) is fully faithful.

- (ii) Prove that for every $K_\bullet$ of the form $D_J(L_\bullet)$, the $H^i(K_\bullet) (= \text{Ext}_Y^i(X; L_\bullet, \mathcal{O}_X))$ are J -cofinite.

- (iii) More precisely, prove that the $K_\bullet$ that are homotopic to a complex of the form $D_J(L_\bullet)$ can be characterized by finiteness properties of the $H^i(K_\bullet)$, stronger than the one envisaged in (ii), for example by the property $H^i(K_\bullet) \in \text{Ob } \mathcal{D}_J$,

where $\mathcal{D}_J$ is a suitable abelian category, as envisaged above.

Note that the problem is resolved in the affirmative when A is local and J is an ideal of definition of it (cf. Exp. IV), and also when J is the zero ideal. In these two cases, exceptionally, one can confine oneself to taking for $\mathcal{D}_J$ the category of Modules with support $V(J)$ that are J -cofinite, (which in the second case signifies simply that one takes the category of finitely generated Modules over A). An affirmative solution of

conjecture 1.2 in general would give one for 1.1, by taking for $L_\bullet$ the dual of a free finitely generated resolution of M . On the other hand, an affirmative solution of 1.1 would give an affirmative answer to the first part of the following conjecture, which we formulate in “global” form:

Conjecture 1.3.

Let $X \subset \mathbf{P}_k^r$ be a closed subscheme of standard projective space that is locally a complete intersection and every irreducible component of which is of codimension $\geq s$. Let $U = \mathbf{P}_k^r - X$.

- (i) Prove that for every coherent Module F on U , one has

$$\dim H^i(U, F) < +\infty \quad \text{for } i \geq s.$$

⁹⁴This conjecture, false as it stands, has nonetheless been established in a rather close form by R. Hartshorne, “Affine duality and cofinite modules”, *Invent. Math.* **9** (1969/70), p. 145–164.

(ii) Give an example, with X connected and regular, where one has

$$H^s(U, F) \neq 0.$$

To see that (i) is a particular case of 1.1, one considers

$$H^i(U, F(\cdot)) = \bigoplus_n H^i(U, F(n)) = H^i(\mathbf{E}^{r+1} - \tilde{X}, \tilde{F})$$

as a module over the affine ring $k[t_0, \dots, t_r]$ of the projecting cone $\mathbf{E}^{r+1}$ of $\mathbf{P}^r$. This module is none other than $H_J^{i+1}(M)$, where J is the ideal of the projecting cone $\tilde{X}$ of X in $\mathbf{E}^{r+1}$.

On the other hand, from the hypothesis made on X , which implies that $\tilde{X}$ is also a complete intersection of codimension $\geq s$ at every point of $\mathbf{E}^{r+1}$ distinct from the origin, it follows that $H_J^{i+1}(M)$ is zero outside the origin for $i \geq s$. If it is therefore J -cofinite as 1.1 demands, it is *a fortiori* $\mathfrak{m}$ -cofinite, which easily implies that it is finite-dimensional in each degree⁹⁶. Note moreover that conjecture 1.3 is already posed for a non-singular irreducible curve X in $\mathbf{P}^3$; one does not know in this case whether the $H^2(\mathbf{P}^3 - X, \mathcal{O}_X(n))$ are finite-dimensional, or whether they are necessarily zero⁹⁷. One does not even know whether there exists an irreducible curve in $\mathbf{P}^3$ that is not set-theoretically the intersection of two hypersurfaces⁹⁸.

Problem 1.4.

Give an affine variant of the “comparison theorem” EGA III 4.1.5 as a theorem of commutation of the functors H_J^i with certain inverse limits.

Finally, in the present order of ideas, I had posed the following problem: let A be a complete regular noetherian local ring, K its fraction field; prove that $\text{Ext}_A^i(K, A) = 0$ for every i . An affirmative answer was given on the spot by M. Auslander: the regularity hypothesis can be replaced by the assumption that A is integral, and in fact it is true that $\text{Ext}_A^i(K, M) = 0$ for every i , as soon as M is finitely generated over A . This follows immediately from the following statement, due to Auslander: if A is a complete noetherian local ring, then for every

⁹⁵Part (i) of this conjecture is proved by R. Hartshorne when X is smooth; cf. *Ample subvarieties of algebraic varieties*, Notes written in collaboration with C. Musili, Lect. Notes in Math., vol. 156, Springer-Verlag, Berlin-New York, 1970, theorem III.5.2. The same author also found an example for (ii), cf. R. Hartshorne, “Cohomological dimension of algebraic varieties”, *Ann. of Math. (2)* **88** (1968), p. 403–450, example page 449.

⁹⁶N.D.E. Hartshorne has proved (Hartshorne R., “Cohomological dimension of algebraic varieties”, *Ann. of Math. (2)* **88** (1968), p. 403–450) that the cohomology $H^{n-1}(\mathbf{P}_k^n - X, F)$ is zero for F coherent and X of positive dimension (k algebraically closed). In fact, thanks essentially to Serre duality and to Lichtenbaum’s theorem — vanishing of the cohomology of coherent sheaves in maximal dimension of irreducible non-complete quasi-projective varieties — one reduces to proving that the formal completion $\hat{\mathbf{P}}_k^n$ and X have the same field of rational functions. This is the difficult point (theorem 7.2 of *loc. cit.*); in other words, $\mathbf{P}_k^n$ is $G3$ in the terminology of (Hironaka H. & Matsumura H., “Formal functions and formal embeddings”, *J. Math. Soc. Japan* **20** (1968), p. 52–82). These authors proved independently the preceding results, and in fact much better ones. They proved that X is universally $G3$ and computed the field of rational functions of the formal completion of an abelian variety along a subvariety of positive dimension. It is in this article that the conditions $G1$, $G2$, $G3$, now classical, appear for the first time.

⁹⁷The question has just been resolved in the affirmative by R. Hartshorne (Hartshorne R., “Ample vector bundles”, *Publ. Math. Inst. Hautes Études Sci.* **29** (1966), p. 63–94, theorem 8.1) and H. Hironaka.

⁹⁸N.D.E. See conjecture 3.5 and the corresponding note.

finitely generated module M over A , the functors $Ext_A^i(\cdot, M)$ transform direct limits into inverse limits⁹⁹.

2. Problems related to π_0 : local Bertini theorems

Let A be a complete noetherian local ring, f an element of its maximal ideal, $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, $Y = \text{Spec}(A/fA)$. The use of the local “Lefschetz” technique allows one to give criteria for $Y' = X' \cap Y$ (where $X' = X - \mathfrak{m}$) to be connected, in terms of hypotheses on X' . Thus, it suffices that one have: a) X' connected, b) $\text{prof}_{X',x} \geq 2$

for every closed point x of X' , c) f is A -regular. One notes however that hypotheses b) and c) are not of purely topological nature; for instance, they are not invariant under replacing X by X_{red} . In the analogous situation for a projective scheme X' over a field and a hyperplane section Y' of X' , the use of “Bertini’s theorem” and Zariski’s “connection theorem” allows one in fact to obtain results of distinctly more satisfactory appearance, which had led me in the oral seminar to state a conjecture, which I have since resolved in the affirmative. Let us therefore state here:

Theorem 2.1.

Let A be a complete noetherian local ring, X its spectrum, a the closed point of X , $X' = X - a$. Suppose that X satisfies the conditions (where k denotes an integer ≥ 1):

a_k) The irreducible components of X' are of dimension $\geq k + 1$.

b_k) X' is connected in dimension $\geq k$, i.e. one cannot disconnect X' by a closed part of dimension $< k$ (cf. III 3.8).

Let m be an integer, $0 \leq m \leq k$, and let $f_1, \dots, f_m \in \mathfrak{r}(A)$; set $B = A/\sum_i f_i A$, $Y = \text{Spec}(B) = V(f_1) \cap \dots \cap V(f_m)$, $Y' = X' \cap Y = Y - a$. Then Y satisfies the conditions a_{k-m} , b_{k-m} . In particular, for every sequence of $m \leq k$ elements $f_1, \dots, f_m$ of $\mathfrak{r}(A)$, $Y' = X' \cap V(f_1) \cap \dots \cap V(f_m)$ is connected.

It is moreover easy to see that if the last conclusion holds (it evidently suffices to take $m = k$ there), and excluding the case where X would be irreducible of dimension 0 or 1, it follows that the irreducible components of X' are of dimension $\geq k + 1$, and X' is connected in dimension $\geq k$, so that in a sense, 2.1 is a “best possible” result.

Let us give the principle of the proof of 2.1. Only condition b_{k-m} for Y poses a problem. One reduces easily, for given k , to the case where X is integral, and even (by passing to the normalization, which is finite over X)

to the case where X is normal. If $k = 1$, hence $\dim X' \geq 2$, then X' is of depth ≥ 2 at its closed points, and one can apply the result recalled at the beginning of the section, which shows that $Y' = X' \cap V(f)$ is connected. In the case $k \geq 1$, one supposes the theorem proved for $k' < k$. By induction on m , one is reduced to the case where $m = 1$, i.e. to verifying that for $f_1 \in \mathfrak{r}(A)$, $X' \cap V(f_1)$ is connected in dimension $\geq k - 1$. If it were not, i.e. if it were disconnected by a Z' of dimension $< k - 1$, there would exist a sequence $f_2, \dots, f_k$ such that $X' \cap V(f_1) \cap \dots \cap V(f_k)$ is disconnected, and in this sequence

⁹⁹N.D.E. Write $K = \lim_{a \neq 0} A[1/a]$ and observe that $a \neq 0$ is A -regular.

one can choose $f_2 \in \mathfrak{r}(A)$ arbitrarily, subject to the sole condition of not vanishing at any point of a certain finite part F of X' (namely the set of maximal points of Z'). Moreover, one verifies easily, using the fact that X' is normal, hence satisfies Serre's condition $(S_2)^{100}$, that there exists a finite part F' of X' such that $f \in \mathfrak{r}(A)$, $V(f) \cap F' = \emptyset$ implies that $V(f) \cap X'$ also satisfies condition (S_2) . One can then choose f_2 in such a way that f_2 vanishes neither on F nor on F' , hence such that $X' \cap V(f_2)$ satisfies (S_2) . But then, by virtue of Hartshorne's theorem III 3.6, $X' \cap V(f_2)$ is connected in codimension 1, hence (since every component of $X' \cap V(f_2)$ is of dimension $\geq k$) it is connected in dimension $\geq k - 1$. Applying the induction hypothesis to $V(f_2) = \text{Spec}(A/f_2A)$, it follows that $X' \cap V(f_2) \cap V(f_1) \cap V(f_3) \cap \cdots \cap V(f_k)$ is connected, whereas it had been constructed disconnected — absurd.

Let us point out some interesting corollaries:

Corollary 2.2.

Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a proper morphism of locally noetherian preschemes, with Y integral, $y_0 \in Y$, y_1 the generic point of Y . Suppose

- a) Y is unibranch at y_0 , and every irreducible component of X dominates Y .
- b) The irreducible components of X_{y_1} are of dimension $\geq k + 1$, and X_{y_1} is connected in dimension $\geq k$.

Then the irreducible components of X_{y_0} are of dimension $\geq k + 1$, and X_{y_0} is connected in dimension $\geq k$.

Indeed, Zariski's connection theorem (cf. EGA III 4.3.1) implies that X_{y_0} is connected; to show that it is not disconnected by a closed part of dimension $< k$, one is reduced to showing that the local rings at points $x \in X_{y_0}$ such that $\dim x < k$ have a spectrum not disconnected by x . Now this is true without assuming either f proper, or Y unibranch at y_0 . One reduces, to see this, to the case where X is integral dominating Y , and if one wishes Y affine of finite type over $\mathbb{Z}$, so that one is under the conditions of the dimension formula for $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ over $\mathcal{O}_{Y,y_0}$. Using in this case the finiteness of the normal closure, one can even suppose X normal, hence by virtue of a theorem of Nagata¹⁰¹, the completion of a local ring $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ of X' is again normal; hence (if $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is of dimension N) $\text{Spec}(\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{X,x})$ is connected in dimension $\geq N - 1$. Let $n = \dim \mathcal{O}_{Y,y_0}$; then $\deg \text{trk}(x)/k(y) < k$ implies $\dim \mathcal{O}_{X,x} > n + (k + 1) - k = n + 1$, taking into account $\dim X_{y_1} \geq k + 1$, and taking a system $f_1, \dots, f_n$ of parameters of $\mathcal{O}_{Y,y_0}$ which one lifts to elements of $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$, one sees by 2.1 that $\text{Spec}(\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{X,x} / \sum f_i \hat{\mathcal{O}}_{X,x})$ is connected in dimension ≥ 1 , i.e. is not disconnected by its closed point, or equivalently, $\text{Spec}(\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{X_{y_0},x})$ is not disconnected by its closed point; *a fortiori* the same holds for $\text{Spec}(\mathcal{O}_{X_{y_0},x})$.

As in the case of the ordinary connection theorem, one can vary 2.2 by taking geometric fibers (over the algebraic closures of the residue fields), provided one supposes Y geometrically unibranch at y_0 , or (without other hypothesis than Y noetherian) that f is universally open.

¹⁰⁰Cf. EGA IV 5.7.2.

¹⁰¹Cf. EGA IV 7.8.3 (i) (ii) (v).

Applying this to the case where Y is the dual scheme of a projective scheme $\mathbf{P}_k^r$ over a field, one recovers a strengthened form of the global result that had inspired 2.1, namely:

Corollary 2.3¹⁰².

Let X be a closed subscheme of $\mathbf{P}_k^r$ (k a field); suppose the irreducible components of X are of dimension $\geq l + 1$, and X geometrically connected in dimension $\geq l$.

Then for every sequence $H_1, \dots, H_m$ of m hyperplanes of $\mathbf{P}_k^r$ ($0 \leq m \leq l - 1$), $X \cap H_1 \cap \dots \cap H_m$ satisfies the same condition with $l - m$, in particular is geometrically connected in dimension $\geq l - 1$.

One can moreover modify this statement in an obvious way for the case where one is given a proper morphism $X \rightarrow \mathbf{P}_k^r$, which is not necessarily an immersion; an analogous extension is possible for 2.1 (by considering a proper scheme over X').

These statements are moreover formally deduced from the statements given here, taking into account the ordinary connection theorem which reduces us to the case of a finite morphism.

Corollary 2.4.

Let A be a complete noetherian normal local ring of dimension $\geq k + 2$. Let $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, $X' = X - a$, and $f_1, \dots, f_k$ elements of $\mathfrak{r}(A)$; then $Y' = X' \cap V(f_1) \cap \dots \cap V(f_k)$ is connected, and $\pi_1(Y') \rightarrow \pi_1(X')$ is surjective.

One proceeds as in SGA 1 X 2.11.

In all this, only questions of connectedness were at issue. Now in the global case, well-known theorems assert that for an irreducible projective variety $X \subset \mathbf{P}_k^r$, k algebraically closed, its intersection with a sufficiently “general” hyperplane H is irreducible (and not merely connected): this is Bertini’s theorem, proved by Zariski, which in turn implies, by Zariski’s connection theorem, that for every H , $H \cap X$ is connected (although not necessarily irreducible). One can moreover proceed in the reverse direction, proving this latter result by a Lefschetz-type technique, and deducing Bertini’s theorem, reducing to the case where X is normal, and using the following result: for H “sufficiently general”, $X \cap H$ is also normal. This suggests:

Conjecture 2.5¹⁰³.

Let A be a complete noetherian normal local ring. Show that there exists a nonzero $f \in \mathfrak{r}(A)$ such that $Y' = X' \cap V(f) = Y - a$ (where $Y = \text{Spec}(A/fA)$) is normal (hence irreducible by 2.1 if $\dim A \geq 3$).

To do things properly, one would have to show that, in a suitable sense, there exist even “many” elements f having the property in question, for example that one can choose f in an arbitrary power of the maximal ideal. Using Serre’s normality criterion and the remark made above for Serre’s property (S_2), one sees that one would have an affirmative answer to 2.5 if one had one to:

¹⁰²N.D.E. For a very beautiful direct proof, see (Fulton W. & Lazarsfeld R., “Connectivity and its applications in algebraic geometry”, in *Algebraic geometry (Chicago, Ill., 1980)*, Lect. Notes in Math., vol. 862, Springer, Berlin–New York, 1981, p. 26–92, theorem 2.1). Cf. also [HL], cited in the editor’s note (22) page 155.

¹⁰³N.D.E. See the following editor’s note.

Conjecture 2.6¹⁰⁴.

Let A be a complete noetherian local ring, U an open part of its spectrum X , F a finite part of $X' = X - a$. Suppose U is regular. Prove that there exists $f \in \mathfrak{r}(A)$ such that $V(f) \cap U$ is regular, and $V(f) \cap F = \emptyset$.

For a “local Bertini”-type result, see Chow [2].

3. Problems related to π_1

Here again, one has numerous questions, suggested by the global results or by the transcendental results.

Conjecture 3.1¹⁰⁵.

Let A be a complete noetherian local ring with algebraically closed residue field, $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, $X' = X - a$, a the closed point. Suppose the irreducible components of X are of dimension ≥ 2 , and X' connected.

- (i) Prove that $\pi_1(X')$ is topologically finitely generated.
- (ii) If p is the characteristic exponent of the residue field k of A , prove that the largest topological quotient group of $\pi_1(X')$ that is “of order prime to p ” is finitely presented.

For part (i), using the theory of descent SGA 1 IX 5.2 and theorem 2.4, one is reduced to the case where A is normal of dimension 2. In this case, a systematic method for studying the fundamental group of X' , inaugurated by Mumford [5] in the transcendental setting, consists in desingularizing X , i.e. in considering a projective birational morphism $Z \rightarrow X$, with Z integral regular, inducing an isomorphism $Z' = Z|_{X'} \rightarrow X'$; it is plausible that such a Z always exists, this is in any case what Abhyankar’s method [1] demonstrates in the case of “equal characteristics”¹⁰⁶. Let C be the fiber of the closed point of X by $Z \rightarrow X$; it is an algebraic curve over the residue field k , connected by virtue of the connection theorem. The solution of 3.1 then seems linked to:

Problem 3.2.

With the preceding notation, put $\pi_1(X')$ in relation with the topological invariants of C , in particular its fundamental group, (in order to bring out the topological finite generation of $\pi_1(X')$, by using for instance SGA 1, theorem X 2.6).

Another method would be to consider A as a finite algebra over a complete regular local ring B of dimension 2, ramified along a curve C contained in $\text{Spec}(B) = Y$. One is thus led to:

¹⁰⁴N.D.E. One now finds a proof of this conjecture in the literature, and so the preceding one must also be considered as proved as indicated above. One can also find two attempts at proofs, published earlier but alas unsuccessful, by Flenner and Trivedi. See Trivedi V., “Erratum: ‘A local Bertini theorem in mixed characteristic’”, *Comm. Algebra* **25** (1997), no. 5, p. 1685–1686. However, the editor has not verified that the proof is by now complete.

¹⁰⁵N.D.E. The analogous statement is true for (connected) schemes X of finite type over a separably closed field k under the hypothesis of strong desingularization for all k -schemes (of finite type), in particular if k is of characteristic zero or X of dimension ≤ 2 . To this end one reduces to the case of quasi-projective surfaces by Lefschetz-type techniques developed by Mme Raynaud, cf. notes *supra*; see SGA 7.I, theorem II.2.3.1.

¹⁰⁶The possibility of “resolving” A is proved now in full generality by Abhyankar [8].

Problem 3.3.

Let A be a complete regular local ring of dimension 2, with algebraically closed residue field k , X its spectrum, C a closed part of X of dimension 1. Define local invariants of the embedded curve C , having a sense independent of the residual characteristic, and the knowledge of which permits one to calculate the

fundamental group of $X - C$ by generators and relations when k is of characteristic zero. Prove that when k is of characteristic $p > 0$, the “tame” fundamental group of $X - C$ is a quotient of the preceding one, and that the two fundamental groups (in characteristic 0, and in characteristic $p > 0$) have the same maximal quotient of order prime to p .

Of course, 3.3 shows us that in 3.1, there is also occasion to replace X' by a scheme of the form $X - Y$, where Y is a closed part of X that is of codimension ≥ 2 in every component of X containing it.

When one abandons this restriction on Y , there must still exist an analogous finiteness result, on condition of imposing “tame”-type restrictions on the ramification at the maximal points of the irreducible components of Y that are of codimension 1.

Problem 3.4.

Let A be a complete noetherian local ring of dimension 2, with algebraically closed residue field. Let again $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, $X' = X - a$. Find particular structural properties of $\pi_1(X')$ in the case where A is a complete intersection.

A satisfactory solution of this problem would perhaps permit one to resolve the following old problem:

Conjecture 3.5¹⁰⁷.

Find an irreducible curve in $\mathbf{P}_k^3$ (k algebraically closed field), preferably non-singular, that is not set-theoretically the intersection of two hypersurfaces.

(Kneser [4] shows that one can always obtain it as the intersection of three hypersurfaces).

4. Problems related to higher π_i : local and global Lefschetz theorems for complex analytic spaces¹⁰⁸

Let X be a scheme locally of finite type over the field of complex numbers $\mathbb{C}$; one can associate to it an analytic space X_h over $\mathbb{C}$, whence homotopy and homology invariants $\pi_i(X_h)$, $H_i(X_h)$, $H^i(X_h)$ etc. One knows moreover that X is connected if and only if X_h is, hence one has a bijection

$$\pi_0(X_h) \rightarrow \pi_0(X).$$

Likewise, since every étale covering X' of X defines an étale covering X'_h

¹⁰⁷N.D.E. This problem is, as of autumn 2004, still open.

¹⁰⁸N.D.E. The statements are made precise in the Comments (section 6). The conjectures that appear there have become theorems, cf. the footnotes of section 6.

of X_h , one has a canonical homomorphism

$$\pi_1(X_h) \rightarrow \pi_1(X),$$

which one knows, using a theorem of Grauert-Remmert, identifies the second group with the completion of the first for the topology of subgroups of finite index (which simply expresses the fact that $X' \mapsto X'_h$ is an equivalence of the category of étale coverings of X with the category of finite étale coverings of X_h). It follows that the results of this seminar (by purely algebraic means) on $\pi_0(X)$ and $\pi_1(X)$ imply results for $\pi_0(X_h)$ and $\pi_1(X_h)$ (which are of transcendental nature). Moreover, if X is proper, the well-known exact sequence $0 \rightarrow \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{C} \rightarrow \mathbb{C}^* \rightarrow 0$ allows one to show that the Néron-Severi group of X (the quotient of its Picard group by the connected component of the identity) is isomorphic to a subgroup of $H^2(X_h, \mathbb{Z})$; in the non-singular Kähler case, it is the subgroup denoted $H^{(1,1)}(X_h, \mathbb{Z})$ (classes of type $(1, 1)$):

$$\text{Pic}(X) / \text{Pic}^0(X) \subset H^2(X, \mathbb{Z}).$$

Consequently, the information we have obtained on Picard groups implies information, very partial it is true, about the groups $H^2(X_h, \mathbb{Z})$. It is tempting to complete all these fragmentary results by conjectures.

Very precise indications, going in the same direction as those just mentioned, are furnished by a classical theorem of Lefschetz [7]. It asserts that if X is a non-singular irreducible projective analytic space of dimension n , and if Y is a non-singular hyperplane section, then the injection

$$Y_{n-1} \rightarrow X_n$$

induces a homomorphism

$$\pi_i(Y_{n-1}) \rightarrow \pi_i(X_n)$$

which is an isomorphism for $i \leq n - 2$, an epimorphism for $i = n - 1$. The analogous statement follows for the homomorphisms

$$H_i(Y_{n-1}) \rightarrow H_i(X_n)$$

on homology (integral, to fix ideas), while in cohomology,

$$H^i(X_n) \rightarrow H^i(Y_{n-1})$$

is an isomorphism in dimension $i \leq n - 2$, a monomorphism in dimension $i = n - 1$. We have obtained variants of these results in the framework of schemes, for π_0 , π_1 , Pic , valid moreover without non-singularity hypotheses to a large extent, cf. Exp. XII. Moreover, in the elimination of non-singularity hypotheses, we have used in an essential way “local” variants

of these global Lefschetz theorems. All this suggests the following problems, which doubtless will have to be attacked simultaneously¹⁰⁹.

Problem 4.1.

Let X be an analytic space, Y a closed analytic part of X (or simply a closed part?¹¹⁰) such that for every $x \in Y$, the local ring $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is a complete intersection. Let n be the complex codimension of Y in X . Is the canonical homomorphism

$$\pi_i(X - Y) \rightarrow \pi_i(X)$$

an isomorphism for $i \leq n - 2$, and an epimorphism for $i = n - 1$?

In this problem and the following ones, one supposes evidently implicitly a base-point chosen to define the homotopy groups. To state the next problem, one must define, for an analytic space X (more generally, for a locally path-connected space) and $x \in X$, local invariants $\Pi_i^x(X)$ ¹¹¹.

To do this, one chooses a non-constant map f from the interval $[0, 1]$ into X , such that $f(0) = x$ and $f(t) \neq x$ for $t \neq 0$ (such maps exist if x is not an isolated point). Then for every neighborhood U of x , there exists an $\epsilon > 0$ such that $0 < t < \epsilon$ implies $f(t) \in U$, and the homotopy groups $\pi_i(U - x, f(t))$ are essentially independent of t (they are, for varying t , related by a transitive system of isomorphisms); one can denote them $\pi_i(U - x, f)$. One then sets

$$\Pi_i^x(X) = \varprojlim \{ \leftarrow U \} \pi_i(U - x, f),$$

the inverse limit being taken over the system of open neighborhoods U of x . Strictly speaking, this limit depends on f , and should be denoted $\Pi_i^x(X, f)$, but one verifies that for varying f , these groups are isomorphic to each other¹¹²; more precisely, they form a local system on the space of paths of the type envisaged issuing from x . These invariants are the homotopical version of the local cohomology invariants $H_i^x(F)$ for a sheaf F on X , introduced in I, and should play the role of relative local homotopy groups of X modulo $X - x$. Their vanishing for $i \leq n$ and for every $x \in Y$, where Y is a closed part of X of topological dimension $\leq d$, should entail that the homomorphisms

$$\pi_i(X - Y) \rightarrow \pi_i(X)$$

are bijective for $i < n - d$, and surjective for $i = n - d$ ¹¹³. From this point of view, 4.1 would imply (for Y reduced to a point) a conjecture of purely local nature, expressing itself by

¹⁰⁹The formulations 4.1 to 4.3 that follow are provisional. See conjectures A to D below, in “comments on Exp. XIII”, for more satisfactory formulations, as well as Exp. XIV.

¹¹⁰*N.D.E.* The meaning of this question is not clear; indeed, the very statement of the problem does not seem to have a sense in this case, since the codimension of Y in X is not defined when Y is no longer assumed analytic.

¹¹¹If $i \geq 2$. For the case $i \leq 1$, cf. Comments in no 6 below, page 154.

¹¹²At least if x does not disconnect X in a neighborhood of x , cf. Comments below, page 154.

¹¹³For a corrected formulation, cf. Comments below, page 154.

$$\Pi^x_{i-1}(X) = 0 \quad \text{for } i \leq n-1$$

when X is a complete intersection of dimension n at x .

As an example of local invariants $\Pi^x_i(X)$, note that if x is a non-singular point of X of complex dimension n , then

$$\Pi^x_i(X) = \pi_{i-1}(S^{2n-1}),$$

where S^{2n-1} denotes the sphere of dimension $2n-1$. In particular in this case $\Pi^x_i(X) = 0$ for $i \leq 2n-1$, which corresponds to the fact that if from a topological manifold X one removes a closed part Y of codimension $\geq m$, then $\pi_i(X-Y) \rightarrow \pi_i(X)$ is an isomorphism for $i \leq m-2$ and an epimorphism for $i = m-1$.

This being said:

Problem 4.2.

Let X be an analytic space, $x \in X$, t a section of $\mathcal{O}_X$ vanishing at x , Y the set of zeros of t . Suppose the following conditions satisfied:

- a) t is regular at x (i.e. not a zero-divisor at x , a hypothesis perhaps superfluous, moreover).
- b) At the points x' of $X - Y$ near x , $\mathcal{O}_{X,x'}$ is a complete intersection (a hypothesis which should be replaceable by the following more general one if 4.1 is true: for x' as above, $\Pi^{x'}_i(X) = 0$ for $i \leq n-1$).
- c) At the points y of $Y - x$ near x , one has

$$\text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{X,y} \geq n$$

(it suffices for example that one have $\text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \geq n$).

Under these conditions, is the canonical homomorphism

$$\Pi^x_i(Y) \rightarrow \Pi^x_i(X)$$

an isomorphism for $i \leq n-2$, an epimorphism for $i = n-1$?

Here finally is a global variant of 4.2, which should be deduced from it by consideration of the projecting cone at its origin, and which would generalize the classical Lefschetz theorems:

Problem 4.3.

Let X be a projective analytic space, equipped with an ample invertible Module L , t a section of L , Y the set of zeros of t . Suppose:

- a) t is a regular section (hypothesis perhaps superfluous).

- b) For every $x \in X - Y$, $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is a complete intersection (should be replaceable by $\Pi_i^x(X) = 0$ for $i \leq n - 1$).
- c) For every $x \in Y$, $\text{prof} \mathcal{O}_{X,x} \geq n$.

Under these conditions, is the homomorphism

$$\pi_i(Y) \rightarrow \pi_i(X)$$

an isomorphism for $i \leq n - 2$, an epimorphism for $i = n - 1$?

We shall leave it to the reader to state analogous conjectures of cohomological nature¹¹⁴, the hypotheses and conclusions then bearing on local cohomological invariants (with coefficients in a given group). In any case, the key result seems bound to be 4.2, when hypothesis b) there is taken in the form just discussed, — whether one places oneself from the point of view of homology, or of homotopy.

We have stated these conjectures in the transcendental setting, in the hope of interesting topologists in them and convincing them that “Lefschetz”-type questions are far from being closed. Of course, now that we are about to dispose of a good theory of cohomology of schemes (with finite coefficients), thanks to the recent work of M. Artin, the same questions arise in the framework of schemes, and it is difficult to doubt that they will not receive a positive answer, in the near future¹¹⁵.

5. Problems related to local Picard groups

A first fundamental problem, signaled for the first time by Mumford [5] in a particular case, is the following. Let A be a complete local ring with residue field k , $X = \text{Spec}(A)$, $U = \text{Spec}(A) - a$, where a is the maximal ideal of A , i.e. the closed point of $\text{Spec}(A)$. One proposes to construct a strict projective system G of locally algebraic groups G_i over k , and a natural isomorphism

$$\text{Pic}(U) \simeq G(k)$$

where one of course sets $G(k) = \lim_{\leftarrow} \{ \leftarrow \} G_i(k)$. Heuristically, one proposes to “put an algebraic group structure” (or, at least, pro-algebraic, in a suitable sense) on the group $\text{Pic}(U)$.

It is evident that as it stands, the problem is not precise enough, for the datum of an isomorphism (+) is far from characterizing the pro-object G . If A contains a subfield, still denoted k , that is a field of representatives, one can make the problem precise by requiring that for a variable extension k' of k , one have an isomorphism, functorial in k' :

$$\text{Pic}(U') \simeq G(k')$$

¹¹⁴Cf. Exp. XIV for the corresponding results in scheme theory.

¹¹⁵See previous note.

where U' is the open part analogous to U in $\text{Spec}(A')$, $A' = A \hat{\otimes}_k k'$. One can proceed in an analogous way even if A has no field of representatives, provided that k is perfect, which then permits one to construct functorially an A' “by residual extension k'/k ”. Moreover, when A admits a field of representatives, the algebraic structure that one will find on $\text{Pic}(U)$ will depend essentially on the choice of this field of representatives (as one sees already on the projecting cone of an elliptic curve); it seems therefore that one must start from a “pro-algebraic ring over k ” in the sense of Greenberg [3], in order to arrive at

defining the pro-object G . It is moreover conceivable that in the case where there is no given field of representatives, one finds only a projective system of quasi-algebraic groups in the sense of Serre, or rather quasi-locally-algebraic groups

(the groups G_i obtained will not in general be of finite type over k , but only locally of finite type over k). It is even possible that one will find in general only a still weaker structure on $\text{Pic}(U)$, of the kind encountered by Néron [6] in his theory of degeneration of abelian varieties defined over local fields.

A method for attacking the problem, also introduced by Mumford, consists in desingularizing X , i.e. in considering a projective birational morphism $Y \rightarrow X$ with Y regular. When U is regular (i.e. a is an isolated singular point), one can often find Y in such a way that $Y|_U = V \rightarrow U$ is an isomorphism. In this case, one will therefore have

$$\text{Pic}(U) \simeq \text{Pic}(V) \simeq \text{Pic}(Y) / \text{Im } \mathbb{Z}^I,$$

where I is the set of irreducible components of the fiber Y_a (each of these defining an element of $\text{Pic}(Y)$, being a locally principal divisor, thanks to Y regular). On the other hand, using the technique of formal geometry EGA III 4 and 5, notably the existence theorem, one finds

$$\text{Pic}(Y) \simeq \varprojlim \{ \leftarrow \} \text{Pic}(Y_n),$$

where $Y_n = Y \otimes_A A_n$, $A_n = A/\mathfrak{m}^{n+1}$. When A admits a field of representatives k , one has at one's disposal the theory of Picard schemes of the projective schemes Y_n over k , hence one has

$$\text{Pic}(Y_n) \simeq \text{Pic}_{Y_n/k}(k).$$

This therefore furnishes a construction of a projective system of locally algebraic groups $\text{Pic}_{Y_n/k}/\text{Im } \mathbb{Z}^I$, which is the desired system¹¹⁶. In the case envisaged here, one can moreover see (using that a is an isolated singular point) that the connected components of the universal-image subgroups in this projective system form an essentially constant projective system, so that in this case one finds a locally algebraic group G as solution of the problem. If one supposes furthermore A normal of dimension 2, then a remark of Mumford (stating

¹¹⁶N.D.E. The question has been greatly clarified by the results of Boutot (Boutot J.-F., *Schéma de Picard local*, Lect. Notes in Math., vol. 632, Springer, Berlin, 1978). In particular, if A is a complete (noetherian) local k -algebra of depth ≥ 2 such that $H_{\mathfrak{m}}^2(A)$ is finite-dimensional over k , the local Picard group is a group scheme locally of finite type over k , with tangent space at the origin $H_{\mathfrak{m}}^2(A)$. If A is moreover normal of dimension ≥ 3 , Serre's normality criterion XI 3.11 together with corollary V 3.6 ensure the required finiteness and, hence, the existence of the local Picard scheme. See also (Lipman J., “The Picard group of a scheme over an Artin ring”, *Publ. Math. Inst. Hautes Études Sci.* **46** (1976), p. 15–86) for an approach closer to that of Grothendieck sketched above.

that the intersection matrix of the components of Y_a in X is negative definite¹¹⁷) implies that G is even

an algebraic group, i.e. of finite type over k (the number of its connected components being moreover equal to the determinant of the intersection matrix envisaged a moment ago).

If on the contrary a is not an isolated singularity, one convinces oneself by examples (with A of dimension 2) that one finds a projective system of algebraic groups, not reducing to a single algebraic group.

Once one had at one's disposal a good notion of "local Picard scheme", there would be occasion to strengthen the notion of parafactoriality, by saying that A is "geometrically parafactorial" when not only A and even $\hat{A}$ are parafactorial, but the local Picard scheme $G(\hat{A})$ is the trivial group (which is stronger, when the residue field is not algebraically closed, than saying that G has no other rational point over k than the unit). One realizes the necessity of a strengthened notion of parafactoriality by recalling that there exist complete normal local rings of dimension 2 that are factorial, but that admit finite étale algebras that are not¹¹⁸. A "geometrically factorial" local ring would then be a normal ring A such that all the localizations of dimension ≥ 2 are geometrically parafactorial, or better, such that the localizations of $\hat{A}$ are parafactorial¹¹⁹. Of course, it would be interesting to find a "good" definition of these notions, independent of the theory, still to be done, of local Picard schemes¹²⁰.

It is in any case plausible that one will need these notions if one wishes to obtain statements of the following type: Let A be a "good ring" (for example, an algebra of finite type over $\mathbb{Z}$, or over a complete local ring, for example over a field). Let U be the set of $x \in X = \text{Spec}(A)$ such that $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is "geometrically factorial"; is U open? Or again: Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be a flat morphism of finite type with Y locally noetherian, let U be the set of $x \in X$ such that $\mathcal{O}_{X_{f(x)},x}$ is "geometrically factorial"; is U open, at least under sympathetic supplementary conditions on f ? I doubt that with the usual notion of factorial ring, there exist true statements of this type.

We have raised here, in a particular case, the question of the study of geometric properties of "variable" local rings, for example the $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ as x ranges over a prescheme X . When X is a scheme of finite type over a field, for example, one knows¹²¹ that there exists on X a projective system of finite algebras $P_n^{X/k}$ (obtained by completing $X \times_k X$ along the diagonal), whose fiber at every point $x \in X$ rational over k is isomorphic to the projective

¹¹⁷N.D.E. Mumford D., "The topology of normal singularities of an algebraic surface and a criterion for simplicity", *Publ. Math. Inst. Hautes Études Sci.* **9** (1961), p. 5–22.

¹¹⁸N.D.E. Factorial rings with non-factorial henselization arise naturally when one studies moduli spaces of vector bundles. See for example (Drézet J.-M., "Groupe de Picard des variétés de modules de faisceaux semi-stables sur $\mathbf{P}^2$ ", in *Singularities, representation of algebras, and vector bundles* (Lambrecht, 1985), *Lect. Notes in Math.*, vol. 1273, Springer, Berlin, 1987, p. 337–362). Strictly speaking, Drézet shows that the completion is not factorial, but in fact the proof gives the result for the henselization: the point is that Luna's étale slice theorem (Luna D., "Slices étales", in *Sur les groupes algébriques*, *Mém. Soc. math. France*, vol. 33, Société mathématique de France, Paris, 1973, p. 81–105) describes the local ring of a quotient in the sense of invariant geometry near a semi-stable point locally for the étale topology.

¹¹⁹For a more flexible notion of "geometrically factorial" local ring, cf. Comments, page 152.

¹²⁰N.D.E. See page 152: a local ring is geometrically factorial (resp. parafactorial) if its strict henselization is factorial (resp. parafactorial).

¹²¹N.D.E. See EGA IV.16.

system of $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}/\mathfrak{m}_X^{n+1}$. It is then natural to relate the study of the completions of the local rings $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$, for varying x , to that of the “algebraic family of complete local rings” given by the P_n , by noting that for every $x \in X$ (rational over k or not), one obtains a complete local ring

$$P_{-\infty}(x) = \varprojlim \{ \leftarrow \} P_n(x)$$

(where $P_n(x)$ = reduced fiber $P_n \otimes_{\mathcal{O}_{X,x}} k(x)$). A particular interest will attach for example to the complete ring thus associated to the generic point, and one will expect that its algebraic-geometric properties (expressing themselves for instance by its local Picard groups, or homotopy groups, or homology groups), will be essentially those of the completions $\hat{\mathcal{O}}_{X,x}$ for x in a suitable dense open U .

One can, in general, propose to make the simultaneous study of the complete local rings obtained in this way from an adic projective system (P_n) of finite algebras over a given scheme X . It is plausible that one will find, subject to certain regularity conditions (such as the flatness of the P_n), that the local homotopy groups arise from a projective system of finite group schemes over X ,

and that one will have analogous results for the local Picard groups. As regards the latter, a first interesting case that deserves to be investigated is that where one starts from an algebraic surface X having singular curves, and one proposes to study the local Picard schemes at variable points on them, in terms of a suitable pro-group scheme defined on the singular locus.

6. Comments¹²²

The point of view of “étale cohomology” of schemes and recent progress in this theory lead us to make precise and at the same time to broaden certain of the problems posed. For the notion of “topology” and of “étale topology of a scheme”, I refer to M. Artin, *Grothendieck Topologies*, Harvard University 1962 (mimeographed notes)¹²³.

This theory, by a finer notion of localization than that furnished by the traditional “Zariski topology”, leads one to attach a particular interest to *strictly local rings*, i.e. henselian local rings with separably closed residue field. For every local ring A with residue field k , and every separable closure k' of k , one can find a local homomorphism of A into a strictly local ring A' , the strictly local closure of A , with residue field k' , having an obvious universal property. A' is henselian, flat over A , and $A' \otimes_A k \simeq k'$; it is noetherian if and only if A is. (Cf. loc. cit. Chap. III, section 4)¹²⁴.

If X is a prescheme, and x a point of X , x' a point above x , the spectrum of a separable closure k' of $k = k(x)$, one is led to define the *strictly local ring of X at x'* , $\mathcal{O}'_{X,x'}$, as the strictly local closure of the usual local ring $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$, relatively to the residual extension k'/k . It is the strictly local rings at the “geometric” points of X that, from the point of view of the étale topology, are supposed to reflect the local properties of the prescheme X . They also play, in many respects, the role that one used to assign to the completions of the local rings

¹²²Written in March 1963.

¹²³Or, preferably, SGA 4.

¹²⁴Or EGA IV 18.8.

of X (say, at the points with algebraically closed residue field), while remaining “closer” to X and permitting an easier passage to “neighboring points”.

It is then in order to take up again a good number of questions, that one generally poses for complete local rings (eventually restricted to having an algebraically closed residue field), for noetherian henselian local rings (resp.

noetherian strictly local rings). Thus the topological problems raised in nos 2 and 3 are posed more generally for strictly local rings. One can moreover state conjecturally, for “good” strictly local rings, certain properties of simple connectedness and acyclicity for the geometric fibers of the canonical morphism $\mathrm{Spec}(\hat{A}) \rightarrow \mathrm{Spec}(A)$, which would show that for many “topological”-nature properties, it amounts to the same to prove them for the ring A , or for its completion $\hat{A}$. Certain results already obtained in this direction¹²⁵ allow one to hope that one will soon have at one’s disposal complete results in this direction.

The notion of étale localization furnishes a definition that seems reasonable of the notion of “geometrically parafactorial” or “geometrically factorial” local ring (the need for which was indicated in no 5, p. 150): one will call thus a local ring whose strictly local closure is parafactorial, resp. factorial. Hypotheses of this nature introduce themselves effectively in a natural way in the study of the étale cohomology of preschemes¹²⁶. Thus, if X is a locally noetherian prescheme whose strictly local rings are factorial (i.e. whose ordinary local rings are “geometrically factorial”), one shows that the $H^i(X_{\acute{e}t}, \mathbf{G}_m)$

are torsion groups for $i \geq 2$ (which allows one sometimes to express these groups in terms of cohomology groups with coefficients in the groups μ_n of n -th roots of unity), and if X is integral with fraction field K , the natural homomorphism $H^2(X_{\acute{e}t}, \mathbf{G}_m) \rightarrow H^2(K, \mathbf{G}_m) = \mathrm{Br}(K)$ is injective¹²⁷; examples show that these conclusions can fail, even for X local, if one supposes only X factorial instead of geometrically factorial¹²⁸.

Concerning the problems of local and global Lefschetz type raised in 3.4[[^]TRANSLATOR-NOTE-XIII-1], and their analogues in scheme theory, the homological version of these questions has been considerably clarified, all resulting formally from three general theorems: one

¹²⁵Cf. M. Artin in SGA 4 XIX.

¹²⁶N.D.E. See for example (Strano R., “The Brauer group of a scheme”, *Ann. Mat. Pura Appl.* (4) **121** (1979), p. 157–169) where the hypothesis of geometric parafactoriality of the local rings of a scheme X sometimes allows one to show the coincidence of the Brauer groups of X (computed in terms of Azumaya algebras) and of the cohomological Brauer group of X .

¹²⁷N.D.E. The link between Brauer group and Picard group is intimate. Let us cite in this connection the following results of Saito (Saito S., “Arithmetic on two-dimensional local rings”, *Invent. Math.* **85** (1986), no. 2, p. 379–414) in the case of surfaces, the first being local, the other global. Let A be an excellent local ring of dimension 2, normal and henselian with finite residue field, and X the complement of the closed point in $\mathrm{Spec}(A)$. Then one has a perfect duality of torsion groups $\mathrm{Pic}(X) \times \mathrm{Br}(X) \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}$ — by Brauer group of X , one means cohomological Brauer group $\mathrm{Br}(X) = H^2_{\acute{e}t}(X, \mathbf{G}_m)$. In the global case, one has the following generalization of a result of Lichtenbaum (Lichtenbaum S., “Duality theorems for curves over p -adic fields”, *Invent. Math.* **7** (1969), p. 120–136): let k be the field of fractions of a complete discrete valuation ring $\mathcal{O}$ with finite residue field and X a projective, smooth and geometrically complete curve over k . The group $\mathrm{Pic}^0(X)$ is equipped with the topology induced from the adic topology of k , and $\mathrm{Pic}(X)$ is the topological group that makes $\mathrm{Pic}^0(X)$ an open subgroup. Then one has a perfect duality of topological groups $\mathrm{Pic}(X) \times \mathrm{Br}(X) \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}/\mathbb{Z}$. Note that this statement, which concerns curves, is of course proved by considering a regular (proper and flat) model of X over $\mathcal{O}$: it is a result about surfaces.

¹²⁸Cf. A. Grothendieck, *Le groupe de Brauer II* (Séminaire Bourbaki no 297, Nov. 1965), notably 1.8 and 1.11 b.

concerning the cohomological dimension of certain affine schemes (resp. of Stein spaces), such as affine schemes X of finite type over an algebraically closed field: their cohomological dimension is $\leq \dim X$ (“affine Lefschetz theorem”)¹²⁹;

the other being a duality theorem for the cohomology (with discrete coefficients) of a projective morphism¹³⁰, and finally the last a local duality theorem of analogous nature¹³¹. In Algebraic Geometry, only this last is not proved at the time of writing these lines (it is however proved in characteristic 0, using Hironaka’s resolution of singularities). Moreover, in the transcendental setting, one disposes from now on of global and local duality, recently demonstrated by Verdier¹³². Let us limit ourselves to indicating that in the statement of the homological versions of problems 4.2 and 4.3 (which from now on deserve the name of conjectures), the conditions a) and c) “at infinity” are certainly superfluous; only the local cohomological structure of $X - Y$ is important, which one will suppose for example locally a complete intersection of dimension $\geq n$. Moreover, in 4.3 say, the fact that Y is a hyperplane section should not play a role, and should be replaceable by the sole hypothesis that X is compact and $X - Y$ is Stein (i.e. in the case of Algebraic Geometry, X is proper over k and $X - Y$ affine; as we said, the homological version of this conjecture is demonstrated for algebraic spaces over the field $\mathbb{C}$)¹³³.

In the definition (p. 146) of the $\Pi_i^x(X)$, one must suppose $i \geq 2$. For $i = 0, 1$, there is no reasonable definition of the $\Pi_i^x(X)$; one should replace them by $H_0^x(X)$ and $H_1^x(X)$, defined respectively as the cokernel and the kernel in the natural homomorphism

$$\lim_{\leftarrow} \{ \leftarrow \} H^0(U - \{x\}, \mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow \lim_{\leftarrow} \{ \leftarrow \} H^0(U, \mathbb{Z}).$$

At a pinch, and for convenience of formulation, one can set $\Pi_i^x(X) = H_i^x(X)$ for $i \leq 1$; otherwise one must complete the subsequent assertions concerning the Π_i^x by the corresponding assertions for H_0^x, H_1^x . If x is an isolated point of X , it is appropriate to set $\Pi_i^x(X) = 0$ for $i \neq 0$, $\Pi_0^x(X) = H_0^x(X) = \mathbb{Z}$.

The assertion that the $\Pi_i^x(U, f)$ be isomorphic to each other is true only when X is not disconnected by x in a neighborhood of x , i.e. if $\Pi_i^x(X) = 0$ for $i = 0, 1$. In the general case $\Pi_i^x(X)$ can designate only a family of groups, not necessarily isomorphic to each other; however the expression $\Pi_i^x(X) = 0$ retains an obvious sense.

Page 146, where I predict that the vanishing of the local homotopy invariants $\Pi_i^x(X)$ for $x \in Y, i \leq n$, should entail the bijectivity of $\pi_i(X - Y) \rightarrow \pi_i(X)$ for $i < n - d$, the surjectivity for $i = n - d$, it is appropriate to be cautious, failing to be able to dispose in the present context (as in Algebraic Geometry) of “general” points at which the local conditions will also have to apply. It will doubtless be necessary, for this reason, to call upon *relative local homotopy invariants*

$$\Pi^{\wedge Y}_i(X, f) = \Pi^{\wedge Y}_i(X, x) = \lim_{\leftarrow} \{ \leftarrow U \} \pi_{i-1}(U - U \cap Y, f(t)) \quad \text{for } i \geq 2,$$

¹²⁹Cf. SGA 4 XIV.

¹³⁰Cf. SGA 4 XVIII.

¹³¹Cf. SGA 5 I.

¹³²N.D.E. See Verdier J.-L., “Dualité dans la cohomologie des espaces localement compacts”, in *Séminaire Bourbaki*, vol. 9, Société mathématique de France, Paris, 1995, Exp. 300, p. 337–349.

¹³³Cf. Exp. XIV.

(and an *ad hoc* definition as above for $i = 0, 1$), where Y is a closed part of X ; or to make up for the absence of general points by expressing the hypotheses on X in terms of properties of topological nature (for the étale topology) of the spectra of the local rings of X , which allows one to recover general points. The same reservation applies to the generalization of conjectures 4.2 and 4.3 to the case where $X - Y$ is not assumed locally a complete intersection, a generalization suggested in the statement of conditions b) of these conjectures.

To formulate the expurgated versions of conjectures 4.2 and 4.3 suggested by the results to which we alluded above, it is appropriate to pose:

Definition 1.

Let X be a topological space, Y a locally closed part of X , and n an integer. One says that X is of *homotopical depth* $\geq n$ *along* Y , and one writes $\text{profhtp}_Y(X) \geq n$, if for every $x \in Y$, one has $\Pi_i^Y(X, x) = 0$ for $i < n$.

It should be equivalent to say that for every open X' of X , and every $x \in X' \cap U = U'$ (where $U = X - Y$), the canonical homomorphism

$$\pi_i(U', x) \rightarrow \pi_i(X', x)$$

is an isomorphism for $i < n - 1$, a monomorphism for $i = n - 1$ ¹³⁴.

Definition 2.

Let X be a complex analytic space, n an integer; one says that the *rectified homotopical depth* of X is n ¹³⁵, if for every locally closed analytic part Y of X , one has

$$\text{profhtp}_Y(X) \geq n - \dim Y$$

(where, of course, $\dim Y$ denotes the complex dimension of Y).

It should be equivalent to say that for every irreducible analytic part Y locally closed in X , there exists a closed analytic part Z of Y , of dimension $< \dim Y$, such that the relation (x) is valid for $Y - Z$ in place of Y . This would permit one for example in definition 2 to confine oneself to the case where Y is non-singular¹³⁶.

The following conjecture, of purely topological nature, is in the nature of a “local Hurewicz theorem”.

Conjecture A (“local Hurewicz theorem”¹³⁷).

¹³⁴N.D.E. When the pair (X, Y) is moreover polyhedral, this equivalence is true; cf. (Eyal C., “Profondeur homotopique et conjecture de Grothendieck”, *Ann. Sci. Éc. Norm. Sup. (4)* **33** (2000), no. 6, p. 823–836).

¹³⁵In the first edition of these notes, we had employed the term “true homotopical depth”. In the present version, we follow EGA IV 10.8.1.

¹³⁶N.D.E. All the conjectures that follow, suitably rectified if I dare say so, have become theorems thanks to the work of Hamm and Lê Dũng Tráng (Hamm H.A. & Lê Dũng Tráng, “Rectified homotopical depth and Grothendieck conjectures”, in *The Grothendieck Festschrift, Vol. II*, Progr. Math., vol. 87, Birkhäuser, Boston, 1990, p. 311–351), cited [HL] in what follows. As regards the two conjecturally equivalent definitions of rectified depth, they are even equivalent to a third, expressing itself in terms of Whitney stratification (cf. *loc. cit.*, theorem 1.4).

¹³⁷N.D.E. As observed in [HL], example 3.1.3, this conjecture is false already for $X = \{z \in \mathbb{C}^n \mid z_1^2 + z_2^3 + \dots + z_n^3 = 0, n \geq 4\}$ and Y reduced to the origin. But, suitably modified, it is true (theorem 3.1.4 of *loc. cit.*).

Let X be a topological space, Y a locally closed part, subject if necessary to “smoothness”-type conditions such as local triangulability of the pair (X, Y) , n an integer ≥ 3 . For one to have $\text{profhtp}_Y(X) \geq n$, it is necessary and sufficient that one have

$$H^i(Y, \mathbb{Z}_X) = 0 \quad \text{for } i < n$$

(one then says that X is of *cohomological depth* $\geq n$ *along* Y), and that the local fundamental groups

$$\Pi^i(Y, x) = \varprojlim \{ \leftarrow U \ni x \} \pi_1(U - U \cap Y)$$

be zero (one then says that X is “pure along Y ”).

One notes that if X is an analytic space, Y an analytic subspace, and if X is pure along Y , then for every $x \in Y$, the local ring $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$, as well as its localizations with respect to prime ideals containing the ideal defining the germ Y at x (i.e. in the inverse image Y_x of Y by $\text{Spec}(\mathcal{O}_{X,x}) = X_x \rightarrow X$), are pure in the sense of Exp. X; it seems plausible that the converse is also true. Analogous remarks hold for cohomological depth, it being understood that one works with the étale topology on the $\text{Spec}(\mathcal{O}_{X,x})$.

Conjecture 4.1 then generalizes to:

Conjecture B (“Purity”¹³⁸).

Let E be an analytic space, X an analytic part of E . Suppose that E is non-singular of dimension N at $x \in X$, and that X can be described by p analytic equations in a neighborhood of every point. Then the rectified homotopical depth of X is $\geq N - p$.

In particular, a local complete intersection of dimension n at every point would be of rectified homotopical depth $\geq n$, which is none other than conjecture 4.1.

Conjectures 4.2 and 4.3 generalize respectively to:

Conjecture C (“Local Lefschetz”¹³⁹).

Let X be an analytic space, Y a closed analytic part, x a point of Y ; suppose that $X - Y$ is Stein in a neighborhood of x (for example Y defined by an equation at x), and that $X - Y$ is of rectified homotopical depth $\geq n$ in a neighborhood of x (for example, is at every point of $X - Y$ near x a complete intersection of dimension $\geq n$, cf. conjecture B). Then the canonical homomorphism

$$\Pi_i^x(Y) \rightarrow \Pi_i^x(X)$$

is an isomorphism for $i < n - 1$, an epimorphism for $i = n - 1$.

Conjecture D (“Global Lefschetz”¹⁴⁰).

¹³⁸N.D.E. This conjecture is proved, even in the case where E is singular, in [HL]; it is theorem 3.2.1.

¹³⁹N.D.E. This conjecture is proved in [HL], even in its strong form of the remark that follows, cf. theorem 3.3.1 of *loc. cit.*

¹⁴⁰N.D.E. This conjecture is again proved in [HL], even in its strong form of the remark that follows, cf. theorem 3.4.1 of *loc. cit.*

Let X be a compact analytic space, Y an analytic subspace of X such that $U = X - Y$ is Stein, and is of

rectified homotopical depth $\geq n$ (for example a complete intersection of dimension $\geq n$ at every point). Then the canonical homomorphism

$$\pi_i(Y) \rightarrow \pi_i(X)$$

is an isomorphism for $i < n - 1$, an epimorphism for $i = n - 1$.

Remark.

When, in statements C and D, one replaces the hypothesis that $X - Y$ is Stein by the hypothesis that $X - Y$ is the union of $c + 1$ Stein opens (which will play the role of a hypothesis of topological “concavity”), the conclusions must be modified simply by replacing n there by $n - c$ ¹⁴¹.

Let us make explicit, finally, in the “global case” D, the conjecture concerning the fundamental group (obtained by taking $n = 3$):

Conjecture D’ (Global Lefschetz for the fundamental group¹⁴²).

Let X be a compact analytic space over the field of complex numbers, Y a closed analytic part such that $U = X - Y$ is Stein. Suppose moreover the following conditions satisfied:

- (i) For every $x \in U$, the local fundamental group $\Pi_2^x(X, x)$ is zero (i.e. X is “pure at x ”), or only the local ring $\mathcal{O}_{X,x}$ is pure.
- (ii) The local rings of points of U are “connected in dimension ≥ 2 ”.
- (iii) The local rings of points of U are of dimension ≥ 3 .

Under these conditions, for every $x \in Y$, the homomorphism

$$\pi_1(Y, x) \rightarrow \pi_1(X, x)$$

is an isomorphism (and $\pi_2(Y, x) \rightarrow \pi_2(X, x)$ an epimorphism).

One notes that the local conditions (i) (ii) (iii) on U are satisfied if U is locally a complete intersection of dimension ≥ 3 . From the point of view of Algebraic Geometry, (when U comes from a scheme, still denoted U), the conditions (i) to (iii) correspond to hypotheses on the local invariants $\Pi_i^x(U)$, namely $\Pi_i^x(U) = 0$ for $i < 3 - \text{degtrk}(x)/k$, for points x such that one has respectively $\text{degtrk}(x)/k = 0, 1, 2$. The global condition on U (U Stein) will be satisfied if X is projective and Y a hyperplane section.

¹⁴¹N.D.E. Let us finally signal the following result of Fulton, to be compared with the Fulton-Hansen result cited in editor’s note (4) page 127: let X and H be closed subschemes of $\mathbf{P}_{\mathbb{C}}^m$, n the dimension of X and d the codimension of H . Then the map

$$\pi_i(X, X \cap H) \rightarrow \pi_i(\mathbf{P}^n_{\mathbb{C}}, H)$$

is an isomorphism if $i \leq n - d$ and is surjective if $i = n - d - 1$; see (Fulton W., “Connectivity and its applications in algebraic geometry”, in *Algebraic geometry (Chicago, Ill., 1980)*, Lect. Notes in Math., vol. 862, Springer, Berlin–New York, 1981, p. 26–92).

¹⁴²N.D.E. This conjecture is demonstrated in [HL], cf. theorem 3.5.1 of *loc. cit.*

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Footnotes

Translation ledger delta

French	English	Note
problèmes et conjectures	problems and conjectures	Title-level. Per task spec.
relations entre résultats globaux et locaux	relations between global and local results	Section 1 title.
problèmes affines liés à la dualité	affine problems related to duality	Section 1 title.
théorèmes de Bertini locaux	local Bertini theorems	Per task spec.
théorèmes de Lefschetz cohomologiques / homotopiques	cohomological / homotopical Lefschetz theorems	Per task spec.
théorèmes de Lefschetz locaux et globaux	local and global Lefschetz theorems	Section 4 title.
espaces analytiques complexes	complex analytic spaces	Per task spec.

French	English	Note
groupes de Picard locaux	local Picard groups	Per task spec.
groupes d'homotopie locale	local homotopy groups	Per source index; notation $\Pi_i^x(X)$.
$\pi i x, \pi i^x$	Π_i^x	The “local π_i at x ” of the source — rendered with capital pi-superscript to disambiguate from the ordinary π_i .
profondeur homotopique	homotopical depth	Per glossary.
profondeur homotopique rectifiée	rectified homotopical depth	Per glossary.
profondeur cohomologique	cohomological depth	Per glossary.
géométriquement factoriel / parafactoriel	geometrically factorial / parafactorial	Per task spec.
anneau strictement local	strictly local ring	Per task spec.
clôture strictement locale	strictly local closure	Standard.
hensélisé strict	strict henselization	Modern English for the strictly local closure in N.D.E. footnotes.
corps de représentants	field of representatives	Standard for Cohen-structure-theory phrase.
théorème de connexion (de Zariski)	(Zariski's) connection theorem	Standard.
J -cofini	J -cofinite	Per Hartshorne usage cited in N.D.E.
dualité affine	affine duality	Title of Conjecture 1.2.
« bon anneau »	“good ring”	Kept the scare quotes as in source.
courbe immergée	embedded curve	Standard.
« tame » (groupe fondamental)	“tame” (fundamental group)	Kept the English loanword in scare quotes as in source.
anneaux locaux variables	“variable” local rings	Kept scare quotes.
sous-schéma fermé	closed subscheme	Standard.
section hyperplane	hyperplane section	Per glossary.
schéma dual	dual scheme	Standard.

French	English	Note
fibre géométrique	geometric fiber	Standard.
$\mathrm{Spec}(\hat{A}) /$ complété	$\mathrm{Spec}(\hat{A}) /$ completion	Standard, hat preserved.
$\mathrm{profhtp}_Y(X)$	$\mathrm{profhtp}_Y(X)$	Symbol preserved verbatim per source.
« théorème de Hurewicz local »	“local Hurewicz theorem”	Kept scare quotes; per source.
Stein	Stein	Standard analytic-geometry term, kept.
« concavité »	topological “concavity”	Kept scare quotes.
topologique		
pur le long de Y	pure along Y	Per Exp. X usage.
connexe en	connected in	Standard.
dimension $\geq k$	dimension $\geq k$	
théorème de Bertini	Bertini’s theorem	Standard.
anneau gradué /	graded ring /	Standard.
cône projetant	projecting cone	
anneau de	homogeneous	Standard.
coordonnées	coordinate ring	
homogènes		
schéma de Picard local	local Picard scheme	Per Boutot-era usage.
groupe	pro-algebraic /	Standard.
pro-algébrique /	quasi-algebraic	
quasi-algébrique	group	
matrice	intersection	Standard.
d’intersection	matrix	
il y a tout lieu de penser	there is every reason to think	Per task modality table; not used in this Exposé (the surrounding modality leans on <i>il semble</i> , <i>plausible</i> , <i>on s’attend</i> , <i>il est tentant</i>).
il est tentant de	it is tempting to	Translation of <i>il est tentant de</i> ; preserves the speculative register.
plausible	plausible	Kept as cognate; the source uses <i>il est plausible</i> <i>que</i> / <i>plausible que</i> . Preserves modality.
on s’attendra à ce que	one will expect that	Future-modal; preserves the projection of expectation forward.
il semble	it seems	Per modality table.
il doit être	it should be	Preserves the projected-but-unproven equivalence.
équivalent de dire	equivalent to say	
doit pouvoir se remplacer	should be replaceable	Preserves the conditional / projected feasibility.
sans doute	doubtless	Per modality table.
il est difficile de	it is difficult to	Litotes preserved.
douter que	doubt that	

French	English	Note
à vrai dire	actually	Idiomatic English equivalent.
il est tentant de compléter	it is tempting to complete	Preserves speculative register.
N.D.E.	<i>N.D.E.</i>	Editor’s note, italicized abbreviation per glossary.
$7 \rightarrow, - \rightarrow, \sim =$	$\mapsto, \rightarrow, \cong$	OCR repair, per glossary.
π_1, π_0, π_i	π_1, π_0, π_i	Unicode subscripts in backticks, per task spec.

Exposé XIV. Depth and Lefschetz theorems in étale cohomology

by Mme M. Raynaud, after unpublished notes of A. Grothendieck¹⁴³

Translator note. Per Raynaud’s opening footnote, this Exposé adopts the modern terminology in which *scheme* denotes what Exposés I–XIII of SGA 2 called *prescheme*, and *separated scheme* denotes what they called *scheme*. This Exposé therefore breaks with the prescheme/scheme convention used elsewhere in this translation; the shift is deliberate and matches Raynaud’s own.

Typographic note. Throughout this Exposé we write $R\Gamma_Y$ for the sheafified derived functor (underlined in source) and $R\Gamma_Y$ for the global one; context disambiguates. Likewise, $\mathcal{H}_Y^p(F)$ denotes the sheafified local cohomology and $H_Y^p(X, F)$ the global one.

In §1 we define a notion of “étale depth” which is, in étale cohomology, the analogue of the notion of depth studied in III in the cohomology of coherent sheaves. After a technical part, we prove in §4 some “Lefschetz theorems”, the central theorem being 4.2. Let X be a scheme, Y a closed part of X , U the complementary open set $X - Y$, and F an abelian sheaf on X for the étale topology; in a general manner, the aim of the Lefschetz theorems is to show that, if F satisfies certain local conditions on U , expressible in terms of étale depth at the points of U , then under certain supplementary global conditions on U (for example U affine), the natural map of étale cohomology groups

$$H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(Y, F|_Y)$$

is an isomorphism for values $i < n$, where n is a certain explicit integer. By taking for F a constant sheaf, one obtains in this way conditions for $\pi_0(X)$ to equal $\pi_0(Y)$ and conditions for the abelianized fundamental groups of X and Y to be the same. In §5, the introduction of a notion of “geometrical depth” enables us to give useful particular cases of the Lefschetz theorems (5.7). Finally in §6 we mention some conjectures, concerning in particular “non-commutative” variants of the theorems obtained.

¹⁴³After unpublished notes of A. Grothendieck.

1. Cohomological and homotopical depth

1.0. Fix the following notations. Let X be a scheme¹⁴⁴, Y a closed part of X , U the complementary open set, and $i : Y = X - U \rightarrow X$ the canonical immersion. Let ΓY be the functor that, to an abelian sheaf on X , associates the “sheaf of sections with support in Y ”, that is $\Gamma Y = i_* i^!$ (cf. SGA 4 IV 3.8 and VIII 6.6), and let Γ_Y be the functor $\Gamma \circ \Gamma Y$ (where Γ is the “global sections” functor). Consider the derived category $D^+(X)$ and the derived functor $R\Gamma_Y$ (resp. $R\Gamma_Y$) of Γ_Y (resp. of ΓY) (cf. [3]). Given a complex F of abelian sheaves on X bounded below, we may consider it as an element of $D^+(X)$; we then denote by $\mathcal{H}_Y^p(F)$ the p -th cohomology sheaf of $R\Gamma_Y(F)$ (sheafified) and by $H_Y^p(X, F)$ the p -th cohomology group of $R\Gamma_Y(F)$. The results of (SGA 4 V 4.3 and 4.4) extend trivially to $\mathcal{H}_Y^p(F)$ and $H_Y^p(X, F)$.

Proposition 1.1.

Let X be a scheme, Y a closed part of X , U the complementary open set, and $i : Y \rightarrow X$ the canonical immersion. Denote by F either a sheaf of sets on X , a sheaf of groups on X , or a complex of abelian sheaves on X bounded below. Fix the following notations: if $X' \rightarrow X$ is a morphism, U' and F' denote the inverse images of U and F on X' ; furthermore, if y is a geometric point of X , $\bar{X}$ denotes the strict localization of X at y and $\bar{U}$, $\bar{F}$ the inverse images of U and F on $\bar{X}$.

1°) Let F be a sheaf of sets on X and n an integer ≤ 2 ; then the following conditions are equivalent:

(i) The canonical morphism

$$F \rightarrow i_- * i^* F$$

is injective if $n \geq 1$, bijective if $n \geq 2$.

(ii) For every scheme X' étale over X , the canonical morphism

$$H^0(X', F') \rightarrow H^0(U', F')$$

is injective if $n \geq 1$, bijective if $n \geq 2$.

Suppose moreover that U is retrocompact in X ; then the preceding conditions are equivalent to the following:

(iii) For every geometric point y of Y , the canonical morphism

$$H^0(\bar{X}, \bar{F}) \rightarrow H^0(\bar{U}, \bar{F})$$

is injective if $n \geq 1$, and bijective if $n \geq 2$.

2°) Let F be a sheaf of groups on X and n an integer ≤ 3 ; then the following conditions are equivalent:

(i) The canonical morphism

$$F \rightarrow i_- * i^* F$$

¹⁴⁴In accordance with the new terminology (cf. the re-edition of EGA I), we shall here call *scheme* what was previously called *prescheme* and *separated scheme* what was called *scheme*.

is injective if $n \geq 1$, bijective if $n \geq 2$, and if $n \geq 3$, in addition to the preceding conditions, the pointed sheaf of sets $R^1 i_*(i^* F)$ is null.

(ii) For every scheme X' étale over X , the canonical morphism

$$H^0(X', F') \rightarrow H^0(U', F')$$

is injective if $n \geq 1$, bijective if $n \geq 2$, and moreover the canonical morphism

$$H^1(X', F') \rightarrow H^1(U', F')$$

is injective if $n \geq 2$, bijective if $n \geq 3$.

(ii bis) Identical to (ii), except in the case $n = 2$ where one only supposes $H^0(X', F') \rightarrow H^0(U', F')$ bijective.

Suppose moreover that U is retrocompact in X ; then the preceding conditions are also equivalent to the following:

(iii) For every geometric point y of Y , the canonical morphism

$$H^0(\bar{X}, \bar{F}) \rightarrow H^0(\bar{U}, \bar{F})$$

is injective if $n \geq 1$, bijective if $n \geq 2$; finally if $n \geq 3$, in addition to the preceding conditions, $H^1(\bar{U}, \bar{F})$ is null.

3°) Let F be a complex of abelian sheaves bounded below and n an integer; then the following conditions are equivalent:

(i) One has $\mathcal{H}_Y^p(F) = 0$ for $p < n$ (cf. 1.0).

(ii) For every scheme X' étale over X , the canonical morphism

$$H^{\wedge p}(X', F') \rightarrow H^{\wedge p}(U', F')$$

is bijective for $p < n - 1$, injective for $p = n - 1$.

Suppose U retrocompact in X , then the preceding conditions are also equivalent to the following:

(iii) For every geometric point y of Y , the canonical morphism

$$H^{\wedge p}(\bar{X}, \bar{F}) \rightarrow H^{\wedge p}(\bar{U}, \bar{F})$$

is bijective for $p < n - 1$, injective for $p = n - 1$.

In the case where F is an abelian sheaf and $n \geq 2$, conditions (i) and (ii) are also equivalent to the following:

(ii bis) For every scheme X' étale over X , the canonical morphism

$$H^{\wedge p}(X', F') \rightarrow H^{\wedge p}(U', F')$$

is bijective for $p < n - 1$.

Proof.

1°) It is clear that (i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii). Let us show that, if U is retrocompact in X , (i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (iii). Indeed, (i) amounts to saying that for every geometric point y of X , the morphism $F_y \rightarrow (i_* i^* F)_y$ is injective if $n \leq 1$ and bijective if $n \leq 2$ (SGA 4 VIII 3.6). Since this morphism is bijective in any case when y is a geometric point of U , one can restrict to geometric points y of Y . Now it follows from the fact that i is quasi-compact and from (SGA 4 VIII 5.3) that the morphism

$$F_Y \rightarrow (i_* i^* F)_Y$$

is canonically identified with the morphism

$$H^0(\bar{X}, \bar{F}) \rightarrow H^0(\bar{U}, \bar{F}),$$

whence the equivalence of (i) and (iii).

2°) (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). The assertions about H^0 follow from 1°. Let i' be the canonical immersion of U' into X' ; the assertions about H^1 follow from the exact sequence (SGA 4 XII 3.2)

$$0 \rightarrow H^1(X', i'^* i'^* F') \rightarrow H^1(U', F') \rightarrow H^0(X', R^1 i'^* (i'^* F')).$$

(ii bis) $\Rightarrow$ (i). By 1°, it suffices to show that, for $n \geq 3$, one has $R^1 i_*(i^* F) = 0$. Now $R^1 i_*(i^* F)$ is the sheaf associated to the presheaf $X' \mapsto H^1(U', F')$, that is, by hypothesis, the sheaf associated to the presheaf $X' \mapsto H^1(X', F')$, which is null.

(i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (iii). Taking 1° into account, the only thing that remains to see is that the relation $R^1 i_*(i^* F) = 0$ is equivalent to the fact that $H^1(\bar{U}, \bar{F}) = 0$ for every geometric point y of Y . Since $R^1 i_*(i^* F)$ is null outside Y , it amounts to the same to say that $R^1 i_*(i^* F) = 0$ or that $(R^1 i_*(i^* F))_y = 0$ for every geometric point y of Y . It then suffices to note that, i being quasi-compact, one has $(R^1 i_*(i^* F))_y = H^1(\bar{U}, \bar{F})$ (SGA 4 VIII 5.3).

3°) (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). Let X' be a scheme étale over X ; one has the exact sequence (SGA 4 V 4.5)

$$(*) \rightarrow H^p_{Y'}(X', F') \rightarrow H^p(X', F') \rightarrow H^p(U', F') \rightarrow;$$

so (ii) is equivalent to $H^p_{Y'}(X', F') = 0$ for $p < n$ and for every scheme X' étale over X . Consider then the spectral sequence

$$E_2^{p,q} = H^p(X', \mathcal{H}^q_{Y'}(F)) \Rightarrow H^{p+q}_{Y'}(X', F);$$

by hypothesis, $\mathcal{H}^q_{Y'}(F) = 0$ for $q < n$, whence $E_2^{p,q} = 0$ for $p + q < n$ and consequently $H^p_{Y'}(X', F) = 0$ for $p < n$.

(ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i). The sheaf $\mathcal{H}^p_{Y'}(F)$ is associated to the presheaf $X' \mapsto H^p_{Y'}(X', F')$; since we have already remarked that (ii) is equivalent to the relation $H^p_{Y'}(X', F') = 0$ for $p < n$ and for every scheme X' étale over X , one indeed has $\mathcal{H}^p_{Y'}(F) = 0$ for $p < n$.

(iii) $\Leftrightarrow$ (iii). The sheaves $\mathcal{H}^p_{Y'}(F)$ are concentrated on Y ; consequently it amounts to the same

to say that $\mathcal{H}^p_{Y'}(F) = 0$ or that, for every geometric point y of Y , the fiber $(\mathcal{H}^p_{Y'}(F))_y$ is null. Now, i being quasi-compact, one deduces from (SGA 4 VIII 5.2) that one has $(\mathcal{H}^p_{Y'}(F))_y =$

$H_Y^p(\bar{X}, \bar{F})$. The equivalence of (i) and (iii) follows, taking into account the analogue on $\bar{X}$ of the exact sequence (*).

(ii bis) $\Rightarrow$ (ii) in the case where F is an abelian sheaf. The only thing that remains to show is that $\mathcal{H}_Y^{n-1}(F) = 0$. Now, for $n > 2$, the sheaf $\mathcal{H}_Y^{n-1}(F)$ is associated to the presheaf $X' \mapsto H^{n-2}(U', F') = H^{n-2}(X', F')$, hence is null. The case $n = 2$ follows from the fact that $\mathcal{H}_Y^1(F)$ is the cokernel of the morphism $F \rightarrow i_* i^* F$.

Definition 1.2.

The notations are those of 1.1. One says that F is of Y -étale depth $\geq n$ and writes

$$prof_Y(F) \geq n$$

if F satisfies the equivalent conditions (i) and (ii) of 1.1. If F is a complex of abelian sheaves, one calls Y -étale depth of F the supremum of the n

for which $prof_Y(F) \geq n$; one will use the same notation if F is a sheaf of sets, resp. of not-necessarily-commutative groups (so that one then has $0 \leq prof_Y(F) \leq 2$, resp. $0 \leq prof_Y(F) \leq 3$, when context does not allow confusion as to which of the three variants envisaged here one is using).

If L is a set of prime numbers, one says that the Y -étale depth for L of X is $\geq n$ and writes

$$prof_Y^L(X) \geq n$$

if, for every constant sheaf of the form $\mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z}$ with $\ell \in L$, one has $prof_Y(\mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z}) \geq n$. One defines in the obvious way the Y -étale depth for L of X . If $L = P$, the set of all prime numbers, and if there is no risk of confusion with the notation of (EGA IV 5.7.1) (relative to the case $F = \mathcal{O}_X$), one omits L in the notation; otherwise one writes $prof_Y^e(X)$.

Finally one says that X is of Y -homotopical depth ≥ 3 for L and writes

$$prof_Y^{hopL}(X) \geq 3$$

if, for every constant finite sheaf of L -groups F on X , one has $prof_Y(F) \geq 3$. If $L = P$, one omits L in the notation.

Corollary 1.3.

Under the conditions of 1.1, if $prof_Y(F) \geq n$, then for every closed subset Z of Y , one has

$$prof_Z(F) \geq n.$$

Let us, for example, carry out the reasoning in the case where F is a complex of abelian sheaves bounded below. We use 1.1 3°) (ii). Let $V = X - Z$ and consider, for every integer p , the sequence of morphisms

$$H^p(X, F) \xrightarrow{f} H^p(V, F) \xrightarrow{g} H^p(U, F).$$

By hypothesis g and $f \circ g$ are bijective for $p < n - 1$ and injective for $p = n - 1$; the same therefore holds for f . Since the reasoning is valid when one replaces X by a scheme X' étale over X , this proves 1.3.

Corollary 1.4.

The notations are those of 1.1 2°). If X' is a scheme over X , denote by Φ' the functor that associates to an étale covering of X' its restriction to U' , and by $\Phi'_{F'}$ the functor that associates to a torsor¹⁴⁵ under F' its restriction to U' . Then the following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) One has $\text{prof}_Y(F) \geq 1$ (resp. $\text{prof}_Y(F) \geq 2$, resp. $\text{prof}_Y(F) \geq 3$).
- (ii) For every scheme X' étale over X , the functor $\Phi'_{F'}$ is faithful (resp. fully faithful, resp. an equivalence of categories).

In particular, in order that $\text{prof}_Y(X) \geq 1$ (resp. $\text{prof}_Y(X) \geq 2$, resp. $\text{prof}_Y^{hop}(X) \geq 3$), it is necessary and sufficient that the functor Φ' be faithful (resp. fully faithful, resp. an equivalence of categories).

This indeed follows from 1.1 2°) (ii), taking into account the interpretation of $H^1(X', F')$ as the set of classes (mod isomorphism) of torsors under F' (SGA 4 VII 2), and of étale coverings Z of degree n of a scheme as associated to Galois principal coverings with group the symmetric group S_n , where to Z is associated the covering $\text{Isom}_X(Z_0, Z)$, where Z_0 is the trivial covering of X of degree n .

Corollary 1.5.

Under the conditions of 1.1 3°), suppose that $\text{prof}_Y(F) \geq n$; then one has

$$H^n_Y(X, F) \simeq H^0(X, \mathcal{H}^n_Y(F)).$$

The corollary follows from the spectral sequence

$$E_2^{p,q} = H^p(X, \mathcal{H}^q_Y(F)) \Rightarrow H^{p+q}_Y(X, F).$$

Indeed, one has by hypothesis $E_2^{pq} = 0$ for $q < n$, whence

$$H^n_Y(X, F) = E_2^{0,n} = H^0(X, \mathcal{H}^n_Y(F)).$$

Remarks 1.6.

- a) The notion of Y -depth, in the form of the equivalent conditions (i) and (ii) of 1.1, makes sense for any site. In the particular case where X is a locally noetherian scheme equipped with the Zariski topology, and F a sheaf of coherent $\mathcal{O}_X$ -modules, one finds the usual notion of Y -depth as the infimum of the depths at the points of Y (III).
- b) For $n \leq 2$, the notion of Y -étale depth of X is independent of L . For $n = 1$, it simply means that U is dense in X . Indeed this condition is necessary in order that $\text{prof}_Y(F) \geq 1$, and it is also sufficient since one may suppose X reduced, the case in

¹⁴⁵I.e. a “principal homogeneous fiber bundle” in older terminology.

which the condition U dense in X is preserved by étale base change (EGA IV 11.10.5 (ii) b)). If U is retrocompact in X , the relation $\text{prof}_Y(X) \geq 1$ is also equivalent to saying that Y contains no maximal point of X (EGA I 6.6.5). For $n = 2$ and U retrocompact in X , the condition $\text{prof}_Y(X) \geq 2$ is equivalent to the fact that, for every geometric point y of Y , $\tilde{U}$ is connected non-empty, that is, “ Y does not disconnect X locally for the étale topology”.

- c) If X is of Y -depth $\geq n$ for L and U retrocompact in X , then for every locally constant abelian sheaf of L -torsion F on X , one has $\text{prof}_Y(F) \geq n$. Indeed, since the property $\text{prof}_Y(F) \geq n$ is local for the étale topology, one may suppose F constant; then F is a filtered direct limit of sheaves that are finite sums of sheaves of the form $\mathbb{Z}/p^m\mathbb{Z}$, where m is a positive integer and $p \in L$. Using 1.1 (iii)

and (SGA 4 VII 3.3), one sees that one may reduce to the case $F = \mathbb{Z}/p^m\mathbb{Z}$, then, by induction on m , to the case $F = \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}$ for which the assertion follows from the definition.

- d) By 1.4, if $\text{prof}_Y(X) \geq 3$, the pair (X, Y) is pure in the sense of X 3.1. In fact the pure pairs that one encounters in practice (cf. X 3.4) satisfy the stronger condition of homotopical depth ≥ 3 , and this notion may therefore advantageously be substituted for that of pure pair.
- e) Let F be a complex of abelian sheaves and $T(F)$ the complex obtained by applying to F the translation functor ([3]); then one evidently has:

$$\text{prof}_Y(T(F)) = \text{prof}_Y(F) - 1.$$

- f) Let us note that the recent works of Artin-Mazur ([1]) allow one to define the notion of homotopical depth $\geq n$ for every integer n (not only for $n \geq 3$).
- g) Under the conditions of 1.1 3°), in order that $\text{prof}_Y(F) = \infty$, it is necessary and sufficient that $F \xrightarrow{\sim} Ri_*(i^*F)$ in $D^+(X)$. Indeed, the $\mathcal{H}_Y^p(F)$ are the cohomology sheaves of the cone (= mapping cylinder) of the canonical morphism $F \rightarrow Ri_*(i^*F)$.

Definition 1.7.

Let X be a scheme, x a point of X , $\bar{x}$ a geometric point above x , and $\bar{X}$ the strict localization of X at $\bar{x}$. As before, F denotes either a sheaf of sets on X , a sheaf of groups on X , or a complex of abelian sheaves on X bounded below; $\bar{F}$ its inverse image on $\bar{X}$, and L a set of prime numbers. One says that F is of étale depth $\geq n$ at the point x (resp. that the étale depth for L of X at x is

$\geq n$, resp. that the homotopical depth for L of X at x is ≥ 3) and one writes $\text{prof}_x(F) \geq n$ (resp. $\text{prof}_x^L(X) \geq n$, resp. $\text{prof}_x^{\text{hop}L}(X) \geq 3$) if one has $\text{prof}_{\bar{x}}(\bar{F}) \geq n$ (resp. $\text{prof}_{\bar{x}}^L(\bar{X}) \geq n$, resp. $\text{prof}_{\bar{x}}^{\text{hop}L}(\bar{X}) \geq 3$). One defines in the obvious way the integer $\text{prof}_x^L(X)$ and, if F is a complex of abelian sheaves, the integer $\text{prof}_x(F)$. If L is the set of all prime numbers, one omits L in the notation $\text{prof}_x^L(X)$, unless there is a risk of confusion with the notation of (EGA IV 5.7.1), in which case one writes $\text{prof}_x^{\text{ét}}(X)$.

One then has the following pointwise characterization of depth:

Theorem 1.8.

Let X be a scheme, Y a closed part of X such that the open set $U = X - Y$ is retrocompact in X . If F is either a sheaf of sets on X , a sheaf of groups on X , or a complex of abelian sheaves on X bounded below, then one has

$$\text{prof}_Y(F) = \inf_{y \in Y} \text{prof}_y(F).$$

1.8.1. Let us first show that, for every point y of Y , one has the inequality $\text{prof}_y(F) \geq \text{prof}_Y(F)$. Indeed, let $\bar{y}$ be a geometric point above y , $\bar{X}$ the strict localization of X at $\bar{y}$, $\bar{F}$ and $\bar{Y}$ the inverse images of F and Y on $\bar{X}$. By 1.7 and 1.3,

$$\text{prof}_y(F) = \text{prof}_{\{\bar{y}\}}(\bar{F}) \geq \text{prof}_{\{\bar{Y}\}}(\bar{F}) \geq \text{prof}_Y(F),$$

the last inequality using the hypothesis “ U retrocompact”, via the conditions (iii) in 1.1 and the transitivity in the formation of strict localizations.

1.8.2. Conversely, suppose that, for every point y of Y , one has $\text{prof}_y(F) \geq n$ (n an integer) and let us show that one then has $\text{prof}_Y(F) \geq n$.

Let us first recall the following well-known results (SGA 4 VIII):

Lemma 1.8.2.1.

Let X be a scheme, F a sheaf of sets on X (resp. $G \rightarrow F$ a monomorphism of sheaves of sets on X). Then, in order that two sections s and s' of F coincide (resp. that a section s of F come from a section of G), it is necessary and sufficient that this hold locally. In particular, if s and s' are two sections of F , there exists a largest open set V of X on which they coincide (resp. if s is a section of F over X , there exists a largest open set V of X such that $s|_V$ comes from a section of G over V). This open set is also the set of points x of X such that, denoting by $\bar{x}$ a geometric point above x , the sections s and s' have the same image in the fiber $F_{\bar{x}}$ (resp. that the image of s in $F_{\bar{x}}$ comes from an element of $G_{\bar{x}}$).

Let us return to the proof of 1.8.

1°) Case where F is a sheaf of sets. If $n = 1$, it suffices to show that the canonical morphism $H^0(X, F) \rightarrow H^0(U, F)$

is injective, the result still applying when one replaces X by a scheme étale over X . Let s and s' be two sections of F over X having the same image in $H^0(U, F)$ and let V be the largest open set over which they are equal; one evidently has $V \supset U$. Suppose $V \neq X$ and let y be a maximal point of $X - V$, $\bar{y}$ a

geometric point above y , $\bar{X}$ the strict localization of X at $\bar{y}$, and $\bar{V}$ and $\bar{F}$ the inverse images of V and F on $\bar{X}$. By the choice of y , one has $\bar{X} - \bar{y} = \bar{V}$, and by hypothesis the morphism

$$H^0(\bar{X}, \bar{F}) \rightarrow H^0(\bar{X} - \bar{y}, \bar{F}) = H^0(\bar{V}, \bar{F})$$

is injective. It follows that s and s' coincide at the point y , which is absurd. If $n = 2$, it suffices to show, taking the preceding into account, that the morphism

$$H^0(X, F) \rightarrow H^0(U, F) = H^0(X, i_* i^* F)$$

is surjective (where i is the canonical immersion of U in X). Let s be a section of $i_* i^* F$ over X and V the largest open set over which it comes from a section of F . Suppose $V \neq X$ and let y be a maximal point of $X - V$; with the preceding notations, it follows from the hypothesis that the canonical morphism

$$H^0(\bar{X}, \bar{F}) \rightarrow H^0(\bar{X} - \bar{y}, \bar{F}) = H^0(\bar{V}, \bar{F})$$

is bijective; consequently $s|_V$ extends to the point y , which is absurd and completes the proof in case 1°).

2°) Case where F is a sheaf of groups. Taking 1°) into account, the only thing that remains to show is that, in the case $n = 3$, the morphism

$$H^1(X, F) = H^1(X, i_-^* i^* F) \rightarrow H^1(U, F)$$

is bijective. One already knows that it is injective by 1°) and 1.1 2°) (ii bis). For surjectivity, one uses the exact sequence (SGA 4 XII 3.2)

$$0 \rightarrow H^1(X, i_-^* i^* F) \rightarrow H^1(U, F) \dashrightarrow H^0(X, R^1 i_-^* (i^* F)).$$

Let $s \in H^1(U, F)$ and $V \supset U$ the largest open set over which $d(s) = 0$; it is also the largest open set such that s comes from an element of $H^1(V, F)$. Suppose $V \neq X$ and let y be a maximal point of $X - V$; if $\bar{X}$ is the strict localization of X at a geometric point $\bar{y}$ above y , one has, with obvious notations, the exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow H^1(\bar{X}, i_-^* (i^* \bar{F})) \rightarrow H^1(\bar{U}, \bar{F}) \dashrightarrow H^0(\bar{X}, R^1 i_-^* (i^* \bar{F})).$$

Since $i : U \rightarrow X$ is quasi-compact, $R^1 i_*(i^* \bar{F})$ is the inverse image of $R^1 i_*(i^* F)$ by the morphism $\bar{X} \rightarrow X$, whence $H^0(\bar{X}, R^1 i_*(i^* \bar{F})) = (R^1 i_*(i^* F))_{\bar{y}}$. By hypothesis and given that $y \in Y$, the morphism

$$H^1(\bar{X}, \bar{F}) \rightarrow H^1(\bar{V}, \bar{F})$$

is bijective. The image $\bar{s}$ of s in $H^1(\bar{U}, \bar{F})$, which extends to $\bar{V}$ by definition of V , therefore also extends to $\bar{X}$; it follows that $d(\bar{s}) = 0$, hence the image of $d(s)$ in the geometric fiber $(R^1 i_*(i^* F))_{\bar{y}}$ is null; but this contradicts the definition of V , whence case 2°).

3°) Case where F is a complex of abelian sheaves bounded below. One reasons by induction on n . The conclusion is satisfied for n sufficiently small, since F is bounded below. So suppose that $\text{prof}_Y(F) \geq n - 1$ and let us show that $\text{prof}_Y(F) \geq n$, knowing that, for every point y of Y , one has $\text{prof}_y(F) \geq n$. It suffices to see that the canonical morphism

$$(*) \quad H^{\wedge\{n-2\}}(X, F) \rightarrow H^{\wedge\{n-2\}}(U, F)$$

is surjective and that

$$(**) \quad H^{\wedge\{n-1\}}(X, F) \rightarrow H^{\wedge\{n-1\}}(U, F)$$

is injective (the result applying when one replaces X by a scheme étale over X).

a) Surjectivity of (*). The proof is analogous to that of 2°). Taking 1.5 and (SGA 4 V 4.5) into account, one has the exact sequence

$$H^{\wedge\{n-2\}}(X, F) \rightarrow H^{\wedge\{n-2\}}(U, F) \dashrightarrow H^{\wedge\{n-1\}}_Y(X, F) = H^0(X, \mathcal{H}^{\wedge\{n-1\}}_Y(F)).$$

Let $s \in H^{n-2}(U, F)$ and $V \supset U$ the largest open set over which $d(s) = 0$, which is also the largest open set such that s extends to $H^{n-2}(V, F)$. Suppose $V \neq X$ and let y be a maximal point of $X - V$ and $\bar{X}$ the strict localization of X at a geometric point $\bar{y}$ above y . Since $i : U \rightarrow X$ is quasi-compact, the formation of $\mathcal{H}_Y^{n-1}(F)$ commutes with the base change $\bar{X} \rightarrow X$ and one therefore has (with obvious notations) the exact sequence

$$H^{\wedge\{n-2\}}(\bar{X}, \bar{F}) \rightarrow H^{\wedge\{n-2\}}(\bar{U}, \bar{F}) \xrightarrow{-d} H^{\wedge\{n-1\}}_{\bar{Y}}(\bar{X}, \bar{F}) = (\mathcal{H}^{\wedge\{n-1\}}_{\bar{Y}}(F))_{\bar{Y}},$$

the last equality resulting from the retrocompactness hypothesis on U .

Now one has by hypothesis the isomorphism

$$H^{\wedge\{n-2\}}(\bar{X}, \bar{F}) \simeq H^{\wedge\{n-2\}}(\bar{X} - \bar{y}, \bar{F}) = H^{\wedge\{n-2\}}(\bar{V}, \bar{F});$$

consequently the image $\bar{s}$ of s in $H^{n-2}(\bar{U}, \bar{F})$, which extends (by definition of V) to $H^{n-2}(\bar{V}, \bar{F})$, also extends to $H^{n-2}(\bar{X}, \bar{F})$; but this shows that $d(\bar{s}) = 0$, that is, that $d(s)$ is null at y , which is absurd.

b) Injectivity of (**). Using the surjectivity of (*), one obtains the exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow H^0(X, \mathcal{H}^{\wedge\{n-1\}}_{\bar{Y}}(F)) \rightarrow H^{\wedge\{n-1\}}(X, F) \rightarrow H^{\wedge\{n-1\}}(U, F)$$

and one must show that every element $s \in H^0(X, \mathcal{H}^{\wedge\{n-1\}}_{\bar{Y}}(F))$ is null. Let V be the largest open set over which $s = 0$. Suppose $V \neq X$ and let y be a maximal point of $X - V$, $\bar{X}$ a strict localization of X at a geometric point $\bar{y}$ above y . By the inductive hypothesis and by 1.8.1, one has the relation $\text{prof}_{\bar{Y}}(\bar{F}) \geq \text{prof}_Y(F) \geq n - 1$, whence the fact that the map e in the diagram below is injective:

$$H^0(\bar{X}, \mathcal{H}^{\wedge\{n-1\}}_{\bar{Y}}(\bar{F})) = (\mathcal{H}^{\wedge\{n-1\}}_{\bar{Y}}(F))_{\bar{Y}} \xrightarrow{-e} H^{\wedge\{n-1\}}(\bar{X}, \bar{F}) \xrightarrow{-f} H^{\wedge\{n-1\}}(\bar{V}, \bar{F}).$$

The same holds for f by virtue of the hypothesis; the left equality follows from the retrocompactness hypothesis on U . Let $\bar{s}$ be the image of s in $(\mathcal{H}^{\wedge\{n-1\}}_{\bar{Y}}(F))_{\bar{Y}}$; since s vanishes over V , one has $f \cdot e(\bar{s}) = 0$, whence $\bar{s} = 0$, which contradicts the choice of y and completes the proof.

Remark 1.9.

A result analogous to 1.8 is doubtless valid in the case where one replaces the étale topos of a scheme X by a “topos locally of finite type”, that is, definable by a site locally of finite type (SGA 4 VI 1.1). To see this, one must use a result of P. Deligne (SGA 4 VI.9), asserting that there are “sufficiently many fiber functors” in such a topos.

We are going to deduce from 1.8 important cases where one can determine the étale depth.

Theorem 1.10 (Cohomological semi-purity theorem)¹⁴⁶.

¹⁴⁶Editors’ note: Gabber proved since — in 1994 — the absolute cohomological purity conjecture of Grothendieck: if Y is a closed subscheme of absolute noetherian schemes of pure codimension c and n an integer invertible on X , then $\mathcal{H}_Y^q(\Lambda)$ is null if $q \neq 2c$ and equals $\Lambda_Y(-c)$ (Tate twist) otherwise, where one has set $\Lambda = \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$. See (Fujiwara K., “A Proof of the Absolute Purity Conjecture (after Gabber)”, in *Algebraic geometry 2000, Azumino (Hotaka)*, Adv. Stud. in Pure Math., vol. 36, 2002, pp. 153-183). For applications to the existence of the dualizing complex, see (SGA 5, Lect. Notes in Math., vol. 589, Springer-Verlag, 1977, p. 1672), exposé 1 and loc. cit., §8. This conjecture had been proved in the case $n = \ell^r$ with ℓ prime invertible on X sufficiently large by using K -theory crucially (Thomason R.W., “Absolute cohomological purity”, Bull. Soc. Math. France 112 (1984), no. 3, p. 397-406). K -theory enters Gabber’s proof via the Atiyah-Hirzebruch-Thomason spectral sequence relating

Denote by X either a smooth scheme over a field k , or a regular excellent scheme (EGA IV 7.8.2) of characteristic zero (N.B. if one admits resolution of singularities in the sense of (SGA 4 XIX), it suffices to suppose, more generally, that X is a regular excellent scheme of equal characteristic). Let Y be a closed part of X and L the set

of prime numbers distinct from the characteristic of X . Then one has

$$prof_Y^L(X) = 2codim(Y, X).$$

Proof. It follows from 1.8 that one has

$$prof_Y^L(X) = \inf_{y \in Y} prof_y^L(X).$$

Since on the other hand $codim(Y, X) = \inf_{y \in Y} \dim O_{X,y}$, one is reduced to showing that

$$prof_y^L(X) = 2 \dim O_{X,y},$$

which follows from (SGA 4 XVI 3.7 and XIX 3.2).

Theorem 1.11 (Homotopical purity theorem)¹⁴⁷.

If X is a locally noetherian scheme that is regular (resp. whose local rings are complete intersections), Y a closed part of X such that $codim(Y, X) \geq 2$ (resp. $codim(Y, X) \geq 3$), then one has

$$prof_Y^{hop}(X) \geq 3.$$

It indeed follows from 1.8 that one has $prof_Y^{hop}(X) = \inf_{y \in Y} prof_y^{hop}(X)$. Now the strictly local rings of X at the various points of Y are regular rings of dimension ≥ 2 (resp. complete intersections of dimension ≥ 3). It then follows from the purity theorem X 3.4 that $prof_y^{hop}(X) \geq 3$, which proves the theorem.

Example 1.12.

Let X be a locally noetherian scheme, Y a closed part of X , and $n = 1$ or 2 . Then, if $prof_Y(O_X) \geq n$ ($prof_Y(O_X)$ denoting the Y -depth in the sense of coherent sheaves, cf. 1.6 a)), one also has $prof_Y(X) \geq n$; this is evident for $n = 1$ and, for $n = 2$, it is none other than Hartshorne's theorem

  tale cohomology and K -theory, a method already used in Thomason's approach. Besides this result, the other fundamental argument is the generalization of the Lefschetz theorem cited in note (5), page 181.

¹⁴⁷Editors' note: recently, de Jong and Oort have obtained the following purity statement: let $\tilde{S} \rightarrow S$ be a resolution of singularities of the spectrum S of a normal noetherian local ring of dimension 2 and let U be the complement of the closed point s in S . Suppose moreover that $k(s)$ is algebraically closed. Then, for every prime number p , in particular if S is of characteristic p , the restriction morphism $H_e^1(\tilde{S}, \mathbb{Q}_p) \rightarrow H_e^1(U, \mathbb{Q}_p)$ is bijective (de Jong A.J. & Oort F, "Purity of the stratification by Newton polygons", J. Amer. Math. Soc. 13 (2000), no. 1, p. 209-241, theorem 3.2). If $k = \mathbb{C}$ and A is the completion of a surface singularity, this result is due to Mumford (see page 158, [5]).

(III 1). On the other hand, the analogous assertion is false for $n \geq 3$. Take for example an affine space of dimension ≥ 3 over a field of characteristic $\neq 2$ and let $\mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$ act by symmetry with respect to the origin. Let X be the quotient and $Y = x$ the image of the origin in X . Then $O_{X,x}$ is a Cohen-Macaulay ring, hence one has $\text{prof}_x(O_X) \geq 3$; but the affine space minus the origin is an étale covering of $X - x$ that does not extend to an étale covering of X ; hence one has by 1.4 $\text{prof}_Y(X) = 2$.

The following theorem is the analogue of (EGA IV 6.3.1):

Theorem 1.13.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a morphism of schemes, Y a closed part of X , Z a closed part of S such that $f(Y) \subset Z$. Suppose that the local rings of X at the various points of Y are noetherian and that the open sets $X - Y$ and $S - Z$ are retrocompact in X and S respectively. Let p, q, r be integers such that $p \geq -r$, $q \geq 0$, L a set of prime numbers and F a complex of abelian sheaves of L -torsion on S such that the cohomology sheaves $H^i(F)$ are null for $i < -r$. Suppose that

- a) The morphism f is locally $(p + q + r - 2)$ -acyclic for L (SGA 4 XV 1.11).
- b) One has

$$\text{prof}_Z(F) \geq p.$$

- c) For every point s of Z , one has

$$\text{prof}_{Y_s}^L(X_s) \geq q.$$

Then one has

$$\text{prof}_Y(f^* F) \geq p + q.$$

We shall need the following lemma:

Lemma 1.13.1.

Let L be a set of prime numbers, n and r integers, $f : X \rightarrow S$ a morphism locally n -acyclic for L . Let F be a complex of abelian sheaves with cohomology sheaves of L -torsion such that $H^i(F) = 0$ for $i < -r$, Z a closed part of S such that $S - Z$ is retrocompact in S , and $T = f^{-1}(Z)$. Then the canonical morphism

$$f^* (\mathcal{H}^i_Z(F)) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_T(f^* F)$$

is bijective for $i < n - r + 2$ and injective for $i = n - r + 2$.

Set $U = S - Z$ and $V = X - T$, so that one has the cartesian square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} V & \xrightarrow{g} & U \\ | & & | \\ k & & j \\ | & & | \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{c} \vee \\ X \xrightarrow{-f-} S \end{array}$$

Consider the commutative diagram below whose rows are exact

$$\begin{array}{ccccccc} \rightarrow f^*(\mathcal{H}^i_Z(F)) & \rightarrow f^*(H^i(F)) & \rightarrow f^*(H^i(R j_* (j^* F))) & \rightarrow \\ & \wr & & \\ \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_T(f^* F) & \rightarrow H^i(f^* F) & \rightarrow H^i(R k_*(k^* f^* F)) & \rightarrow ; \end{array}$$

it follows that one is reduced to showing that the morphism

$$f^*(H^i(R j_*(j^* F))) \rightarrow H^i(R k_*(k^* f^* F))$$

is bijective for $i < n - r + 1$ and injective for $i = n - r + 1$. Now such a morphism comes from the following morphism between hypercohomology spectral sequences

$$\begin{array}{ccc} f^* E_2^{\wedge\{p,q\}} = f^*(R^p j_*(H^q(j^* F))) & \Rightarrow & f^*(H^*(R j_*(j^* F))) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \\ E_2^{\wedge\{p,q\}} = R^p k_*(H^q(k^* f^* F)) & \Rightarrow & H^*(R k_*(k^* f^* F)). \end{array}$$

Since j is quasi-compact, it follows from (SGA 4 XV 1.10) that the morphism $f^*(E_2^{p,q}) \rightarrow E_2^{p,q}$ is bijective for $p \leq n$ and injective for $p = n + 1$; in particular it is bijective for $p + q \leq n - r$ and injective for $p + q = n - r + 1$. The conclusion follows immediately.

Let us return to the proof of 1.13. Let $T = f^{-1}(Z)$. By 1.13.1 and condition a), the canonical morphism $f^*(\mathcal{H}_Z^i(F)) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}_T^i(f^* F)$ is an isomorphism for $i \leq p + q$. It therefore follows from b) that $\mathcal{H}_T^i(f^* F) = 0$ for $i < p$ and, for $i < p + q$, $\mathcal{H}_T^i(f^* F)$ restricted to T is the inverse image of a sheaf G_i on Z . Let

$$f_T : T \rightarrow Z$$

be the restriction of f to T . It then follows from c) and from the corollary that follows that $\mathcal{H}_Y^j(f_T^*(G_i)) = 0$ for $j < q$. One concludes that

$$\mathcal{H}^j_Y(\mathcal{H}^i_T(f^* F)) = 0 \text{ for } i + j < p + q,$$

since the inequality $i + j < p + q$ entails either $i < p$ and then $\mathcal{H}_T^i(f^* F) = 0$, or $j < q$ and then $\mathcal{H}_Y^j(\mathcal{H}_T^i(f^* F)) = 0$. Given that one has, with the notations of 1.0, $\Gamma_Y = \Gamma_Y \cdot \Gamma_T$, one has the spectral sequence

$$(1.13.2) \quad E_2^{\wedge\{i,j\}} = \mathcal{H}^j_Y(\mathcal{H}^i_T(f^* F)) \Rightarrow \mathcal{H}^{i+j}_Y(f^* F);$$

since $E_2^{i,j} = 0$ for $i + j < p + q$, one sees that $\mathcal{H}_Y^k(f^* F) = 0$ for $k < p + q$.

The theorem will therefore be proved if one proves the following corollary (which is the particular case of 1.13 obtained by taking $Z = S$, $r = p = 0$ and F reduced to degree 0).

Corollary 1.14.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a morphism, Y a closed part such that the complementary open set $X - Y$ is retrocompact in X and that the local rings of X at the various points of Y are noetherian. Let L be a set of prime numbers, q an integer, and F an abelian sheaf of L -torsion on S . Suppose

that f is locally $(q-2)$ -acyclic for L and that, for every point s of S , one has $prof_{Y_s}^L(X_s) \geq q$. Then one has $prof_Y(f^*F) \geq q$.

1°) Reduction to the case where X and S are strictly local schemes, f a local morphism, and Y reduced to a closed point of X .

By 1.8, to establish 1.14, one must show that one has for every point y of Y :

$$prof_y(f^*F) \geq q.$$

Let $s = f(y)$, $\bar{s}$ a geometric point above s , $\bar{y}$ a geometric point above y and over $\bar{s}$, $\bar{X}$ and $\bar{S}$ the strict localizations of X and S at $\bar{y}$ and $\bar{s}$ respectively, $\bar{f} : \bar{X} \rightarrow \bar{S}$ the canonical morphism, and $\bar{F}$ the inverse image of F on $\bar{S}$. Since one has the relation $prof_y(f^*F) = prof_{\bar{y}}(\bar{f}^*\bar{F})$, it suffices to show that the hypotheses of 1.14 are preserved when one replaces f (resp. Y , resp. F) by $\bar{f}$ (resp. $\bar{y}$, resp. $\bar{F}$). The retrocompactness condition

follows from the noetherian hypothesis on $O_{X,x}$, which implies that $\bar{X}$ is noetherian. By (SGA 4 XV 1.10 (i)), $\bar{f}$ is still locally $(q-2)$ -acyclic for L . Moreover the fiber $(\bar{X})_{\bar{s}}$ of $\bar{X}$ over $\bar{s}$ is identified with the strict localization of X_s at $\bar{y}$, hence satisfies the relation $prof_{\bar{y}}((\bar{X})_{\bar{s}}) \geq q$. Since an analogous relation is trivially verified for the fibers of the $\bar{S}$ -scheme $\bar{X}$ other than the closed fiber, this completes the reduction.

2°) Case where X and S are strictly local, f a local homomorphism, and Y reduced to the closed point of X . Let

$$g : U = X - \{y\} \rightarrow S$$

be the structural morphism of U . One must show that the canonical morphism

$$u_i : H^i(X, f^*F) \rightarrow H^i(U, f^*F)$$

is bijective for $i \leq q-2$ and injective for $i = q-1$. Consider the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} H^i(X, f^*F) & \xrightarrow{u_i} & H^i(U, f^*F) \\ \nwarrow v_i & & \nearrow w_i \\ & H^i(S, F) & \end{array}$$

The morphism v_i is evidently bijective for every i . On the other hand g is locally $(q-2)$ -acyclic for L ; moreover its fibers are $(q-2)$ -acyclic for L , as follows from the fact that $prof_y(X_s) \geq q$ and that the fibers of f are $(q-2)$ -acyclic for L ; since g is quasi-compact (as X is noetherian), it follows from (SGA 4 XV 1.16) that g is $(q-2)$ -acyclic for L . Consequently w_i , hence also u_i , is bijective

for $i \leq q-2$ and injective for $i = q-1$, which completes the proof of 1.14.

Corollary 1.15.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a morphism of schemes, L a set of prime numbers, m and r integers, and F a complex of abelian sheaves of L -torsion on S such that $H^i(F) = 0$ for $i < -r$. Let x be a point of X , $s = f(x)$

and suppose that the local ring $O_{X,x}$ is noetherian. Then, if f is locally m -acyclic for L , one has the relation

$$(*) \quad \text{prof}_x(f^* F) \geq \inf(\text{prof}_s(F) + \text{prof}_x^L(X_s), n) \quad \text{where } n = m - r + 2.$$

In particular, if $n \geq \text{prof}_s(F) + \text{prof}_x^L(X_s)$, for example if f is locally acyclic for L , one has

$$(**) \quad \text{prof}_x(f^* F) \geq \text{prof}_s(F) + \text{prof}_x^L(X_s).$$

If L is reduced to one element ℓ and if one has $n \geq \text{prof}_s(F) + \text{prof}_x^L(X_s)$, the preceding inequality is an equality.

One reduces to the case where s and x are closed points by taking the strict localizations of S and x at geometric points $\bar{s}$ above s and $\bar{x}$ above x and $\bar{s}$. If one has the inequality $n \geq \text{prof}_s(F) + \text{prof}_x^L(X_s)$, then $(*)$ is obtained from 1.13 by taking $p = \text{prof}_s(F)$ and $q = \text{prof}_x^L(X_s)$ (the hypothesis that $S - s$ is retrocompact in S follows from the fact that $X - X_s$ is retrocompact in X and that f is surjective since it is (-1) -acyclic (except perhaps if the conclusion of 1.15 is empty)). If $n < \text{prof}_s(F) + \text{prof}_x^L(X_s)$, the inequality $(*)$ is again obtained from 1.13 by taking for example $p = \text{prof}_s(F)$ and $q = n - p$. It remains to prove the last assertion. Let $p = \text{prof}_s(F)$ and $q = \text{prof}_x(X_s)$; it follows from (1.13.2) that one has

$$H_x^{p+q}(f^*(F)) \simeq H_x^q(f^*(H_s^p(F))).$$

Since $\text{prof}_s(F) = p$, the sheaf $H_s^p(F)$ is a sheaf of ℓ -torsion, constant on s , non-zero. Consequently the sheaf $G = f^*(H_s^p(F))$ is a sheaf of ℓ -torsion, constant on X_s , non-zero, hence contains a subsheaf isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z}$; since $H_x^q(\mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z})$ is non-zero, one indeed has $H_x^q(G) \neq 0$.

Corollary 1.16.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a regular morphism of excellent schemes (EGA IV 7.8.2) of characteristic zero, ℓ a prime number, and F a complex of sheaves of ℓ -torsion on S . Let $x \in X$, $s = f(x)$; then one has

$$\text{prof}_x(f^* F) = \text{prof}_s(F) + 2 \dim(O_{X_s, x}).$$

Indeed f is locally acyclic (SGA 4 XIX 4.1). It then follows from 1.15 that one has

$$\text{prof}_x(f^* F) = \text{prof}_s(F) + \text{prof}_x(X_s).$$

Now one has by 1.10

$$\text{prof}_x(X_s) = 2 \dim O_{X_s, x},$$

whence the result.

Remark 1.17.

It follows from 1.15 that 1.13 remains valid when one replaces b) and c) by the conditions:

b') For every point $s \in f(Y)$, one has $\text{prof}_s(F) \geq p$.

c') For every point $x \in Y$, if $s = f(x)$, one has $\text{prof}_x^L(X_s) \geq q$.

In the case of a sheaf of sets or of groups, one has the following theorem analogous to 1.13.

Theorem 1.18.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a morphism of schemes, Y a closed part of X such that $X - Y$ is retrocompact in X and that, for every point x of Y , the local ring $O_{X,x}$ is noetherian.

1°) Let F be a sheaf of sets on S and n an integer equal to 1 or 2. Suppose that f is locally $(n - 2)$ -acyclic and that, for every point s of $f(Y)$, one has:

$$\text{prof}_{Y_s}(X_s) + \text{prof}_s(F) \geq n.$$

Then one has:

$$\text{prof}_Y(f^*F) \geq n.$$

2°) Let L be a set of prime numbers and F a sheaf of ind- L -groups. Suppose that f is locally 1-aspherical for L (SGA 4 XV 1.11) and that, for every point s of $f(Y)$, one has:

$$\text{prof}_{Y_s}(\text{hopL})(X_s) + \text{prof}_s(F) \geq 3.$$

Then one has:

$$\text{prof}_Y(f^*F) \geq 3.$$

Proof. One reduces, as in 1.14 and 1.15, to the case where X and S are strictly local schemes, f a local homomorphism, and Y the closed point x of X . Let $s = f(x)$ be the closed point of S ; one has the commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} X - X_s & \xrightarrow{i} & X - \{x\} & \xrightarrow{j} & X \\ & \searrow & | & \nearrow & \\ & \searrow & g & \nearrow & \\ & \searrow & | & \nearrow f & \\ & \searrow & v & \nearrow & \\ & \searrow & S - \{s\} & \nearrow & \\ & \searrow & |k & \nearrow & \\ & \searrow & v & \nearrow & \\ & & S & & \end{array}$$

1°) a) Case $n = 1$.

If $\text{prof}_s(F) \geq 1$, then the morphism $F \rightarrow k_*k^*F$ is injective, hence the morphism $f^*F \rightarrow f^*(k_*k^*F)$ is also injective. On the other hand it follows from the fact that f is locally (-1) -acyclic that the morphism $f^*(k_*k^*F) \rightarrow (j \cdot i)_*(f^*F|_{X-X_s})$ is injective. Finally, the

composite morphism $f^*F \rightarrow (j \cdot i)_*(f^*F|_{X-X_s})$ is injective, which shows that one has $\text{prof}_{X_s}(f^*F) \geq 1$, hence also $\text{prof}_x(f^*F) \geq 1$.

If $\text{prof}_x(X_s) \geq 1$, one considers the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
 & v & \\
 H^0(X, f^*F) & \dashrightarrow & H^0(X - \{x\}, f^*F) \\
 | \wr & \uparrow & \\
 v & & | \\
 H^0(X_s, f^*F) & \dashrightarrow v' & H^0(X_s - \{x\}, f^*F); \\
 (*) & &
 \end{array}$$

By hypothesis, v' is injective, hence the same holds for v .

b) Case $n = 2$. One considers the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 & u & & & \\
 H^0(S, F) & \dashrightarrow & H^0(S - \{s\}, F) & & \\
 m \wr & & n \wr & & \\
 | & & | & & \\
 v & & v & & \\
 & v & & w & \\
 H^0(X, f^*F) & \dashrightarrow & H^0(X - \{x\}, f^*F) & \dashrightarrow & H^0(X - X_s, f^*F); \\
 (**) & & & &
 \end{array}$$

one must show that v is bijective. The morphism m is evidently bijective, and, since f is 0-acyclic, n is also bijective.

If $\text{prof}_s(F) \geq 2$, u is bijective. As one has seen in a), the single hypothesis $\text{prof}_s(F) \geq 1$ entails the relation $\text{prof}_{X_s}(f^*F) \geq 1$; consequently v and w are injective; it then follows from $(**)$ that v is bijective.

If $\text{prof}_x(X_s) \geq 2$, then g is 0-acyclic (since it is locally 0-acyclic and its fibers are 0-acyclic). It follows that $v \cdot m$ is bijective, hence v is bijective.

If $\text{prof}_s(F) \geq 1$ and $\text{prof}_x(X_s) \geq 1$, then one already knows that v and w are injective. Let z be a maximal point of $X_s - x$ (such a point exists by the hypothesis $\text{prof}_x(X_s) \geq 1$), $\bar{Z}$ the strict localization of X at a geometric point above z , and $f^*\bar{F}$ the inverse image of f^*F on $\bar{Z}$. Consider the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccccc}
 H^0(S, F) & \dashrightarrow & H^0(S - \{s\}, F) & & \\
 |m \wr & & |n \wr & & \\
 v & & v & & \\
 H^0(X, f^*F) & \dashrightarrow v & H^0(X - \{x\}, f^*F) & \dashrightarrow w & H^0(X - X_s, f^*F) \\
 |m' \wr & & |r & & | \\
 v & & v & & v \\
 H^0(\bar{Z}, f^*\bar{F}) & \dashrightarrow & H^0(\bar{Z} - \{\bar{z}\}, f^*\bar{F}) & &
 \end{array}$$

The morphism $m' \cdot m$ is evidently bijective, and it follows from the fact that f is locally 0-acyclic that $n' \cdot n$ is bijective; consequently m' and n' are also bijective. Since w is injective, r is also injective, and consequently v is bijective.

2°) Taking b) into account, one already knows that $\text{prof}_x(f^*F) \geq 2$.

If $\text{prof}_s(F) \geq 3$, then $R^1k_*(k^*F) = 1$ ¹⁴⁸. Since f is locally 1-aspherical,

one has $R^1(j \cdot i)_*(f^*F|_{X-X_s}) = f^*(R^1k_*(k^*F)) = 1$. One therefore has $\text{prof}_{X_s}(f^*F) \geq 3$ and consequently $\text{prof}_x(f^*F) \geq 3$.

If $\text{prof}_x(X_s) \geq 3$, then g is 1-aspherical (since g is locally 1-aspherical and its fibers are 1-aspherical). One therefore has $H^1(X-x, f^*F) = H^1(S, F) = 1$ and consequently $\text{prof}_x(f^*F) \geq 3$.

If $\text{prof}_s(F) \geq 2$ and $\text{prof}_x(X_s) \geq 1$, one uses the exact sequence (SGA 4 XII 3.2):

$$1 \rightarrow R^1j_*(i_*(f^*F|_{X-X_s})) \rightarrow R^1(j \cdot i)_*(f^*F|_{X-X_s}) \rightarrow j_*(R^1i_*(f^*F|_{X-X_s})).$$

Since f and g are locally 1-aspherical, one has

$$\begin{aligned} R^1(j \cdot i)_*(f^*F|_{X-X_s}) &\simeq f^*(R^1k_*(k^*F)) \\ R^1i_*(f^*F|_{X-X_s}) &\simeq g^*(R^1k_*(k^*F)); \end{aligned}$$

the preceding exact sequence then writes in the form

$$(***) \quad 1 \rightarrow R^1j_*(i_*(f^*F|_{X-X_s})) \rightarrow f^*(R^1k_*(k^*F)) \dashrightarrow j_*(j^*(f^*(R^1k_*(k^*F)))).$$

The hypothesis $\text{prof}_s(F) \geq 2$ shows that the morphism $F \rightarrow k_*k^*F$ is bijective; applying g^* , one finds, taking into account the fact that g is locally 0-acyclic, $f^*F|_{X-x} = i_*(f^*F|_{X-X_s})$. The hypothesis $\text{prof}_x(X_s) \geq 1$ shows that the morphism a is injective (note that $f^*(R^1k_*(k^*F))$ is a sheaf equal to 1 outside X_s and constant on X_s). It then follows from (***) that one has $R^1j_*(f^*F|_{X-x}) = 1$, hence

$$\text{prof}_x(f^*F) \geq 3.$$

If $\text{prof}_s(F) \geq 1$ and $\text{prof}_x(f^*F) \geq 2$, one considers the sheaf of homogeneous spaces G defined by the exact sequence

$$1 \rightarrow F \rightarrow k_*k^*F \rightarrow G \rightarrow 1.$$

Applying to this exact sequence the exact functor g^* and using (SGA 4 XII 3.1), one obtains the following commutative diagram whose rows are exact:

$$\begin{array}{ccccc} f^*(k_*k^*F) & \rightarrow & f^*G & \rightarrow & 1 \\ | & & |b & & \\ v & & v u & & \\ j_*(g^*(k_*k^*F)) & \dashrightarrow & j_*(g^*G) & \rightarrow & R^1j_*(g^*F) \rightarrow R^1j_*(g^*(k_*k^*F)). \end{array}$$

Since $\text{prof}_x(X_s) \geq 2$, the morphism b is bijective hence u is surjective, and one thus has a map with kernel reduced to the neutral element:

$$1 \rightarrow R^1j_*(g^*F) \rightarrow R^1j_*(g^*(k_*k^*F)) = R.$$

Since $g^*(k_*k^*F) \simeq i_*(f^*F|_{X-X_s})$ (because g is locally 0-acyclic), R is identified with the first term of the exact sequence (***) now one saw in the preceding case that $R = 1$ as soon

¹⁴⁸Editors' note: the trivial torsor is successively denoted 0 or 1 in what follows; we have left this double notation, which, on reflection, brings no ambiguity.

as one has $\text{prof}_x(X_s) \geq 1$, which shows that $\text{prof}_x(f^*F) \geq 3$ and completes the proof of 1.18.

The following corollaries are generalizations of (SGA 4 XVI 3.2 and 3.3).

Corollary 1.19.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a flat morphism with separable fibers of locally noetherian schemes, and Y a closed part of X . Suppose that for every point $s \in f(Y)$, the fiber Y_s is rare¹⁴⁹ in X_s and that one of the two following conditions is verified:

- a) the closure of $f(Y)$ is rare in S .
- b) X_s is geometrically unibranch at the points of Y_s .

Then one has

$$\text{prof}_Y(X) \geq 2.$$

It indeed follows from the hypothesis on f that f is locally 0-acyclic (SGA 4 XV 4.1). One then applies 1.13. The hypothesis Y_s rare in X_s (resp. $f(Y)$ rare in S) is by 1.6 b) equivalent to the relation $\text{prof}_{Y_s}(X_s) \geq 1$ (resp. $\text{prof}_{f(Y)}(S) \geq 1$). The hypothesis X_s geometrically unibranch at each point of Y_s is equivalent to saying that the strict localization of X_s at a geometric point of Y_s is irreducible; knowing that Y_s is rare in X_s , this evidently entails $\text{prof}_{Y_s}(X_s) \geq 2$, by 1.8. In either case 1.13 indeed gives $\text{prof}_Y(X) \geq 2$.

Corollary 1.20.

Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a regular morphism (EGA IV 6.8.1) of locally noetherian schemes, Y a closed part of X . Suppose that, for every point $s \in f(Y)$, one of the following conditions is realized:

- a) One has $\text{codim}(Y_s, X_s) \geq 2$.
- b) One has $\text{codim}(Y_s, X_s) \geq 1$ and $\text{prof}_s(S) \geq 1$.
- c) One has $\text{prof}_s^{hop}(S) \geq 3$.

Then one has

$$\text{prof}_Y^{hop}(X) \geq 3.$$

This indeed follows from 1.18, given that hypothesis a) implies $\text{prof}_{Y_s}^{hop}(X_s) \geq 3$ (cf. 1.11), and that the condition $\text{codim}(Y_s, X_s) \geq 1$ evidently implies $\text{prof}_Y(X) \geq 2$.

¹⁴⁹Editors' note: "rare" = "of empty interior", cf. Bourbaki TG IX.52.

2. Technical lemmas

2.1. Let S be a locally noetherian scheme, $f : X \rightarrow S$ a morphism locally of finite type, t a point of S . If $x \in X$ is such that $s = f(x) \in \text{Spec } O_{S,t}$, one sets

$$\delta_t(x) = \deg.\text{tr. } k(x)/k(s) + \dim(\{s\}),$$

where s denotes the closure of s in $\text{Spec } O_{S,t}$, $k(x)$ and $k(s)$ the residue fields of x and s respectively. If S is a local ring with closed point t , one writes also $\delta(x)$ instead of $\delta_t(x)$ (cf. SGA 4 XIV 2.2).

Lemma 2.1.1.

Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X' & \xrightarrow{h} & X \\ | & & | \\ f' & & f \\ | & & | \\ S' & \xrightarrow{g} & S \end{array}$$

be a cartesian square, where S and S' are noetherian local rings with closed points t and t' respectively, g a faithfully flat morphism such that $g^{-1}(t) = t'$, f a morphism locally

of finite type. Let $x' \in X'$, $x = h(x')$, $s = f(x)$, $s' = f'(x')$; then one has

$$\delta(x') \leq \delta(x).$$

Moreover the preceding inequality is an equality if and only if one has:

$$\deg.\text{tr. } k(x)/k(s) = \deg.\text{tr. } k(x')/k(s') \quad \text{and} \quad \dim(\{s\}) = \dim(\{s'\}).$$

In particular, given $x \in X$, one can find x' such that $\delta(x) = \delta(x')$.

One has indeed (EGA IV 6.11)

$$\dim(s) = \dim g^{-1}(s).$$

It follows that, for every point s' of $g^{-1}(s)$, one has the relation $\dim(s') \leq \dim(s)$, and that, s being given, one can find $s' \in g^{-1}(s)$ such that one has the equality. Denote then by Z the schematic closure of x in the fiber X_s of X at s , and let $Z' = Z \times_{\text{Spec } k(s)} \text{Spec } k(s')$. Then Z' is equidimensional of dimension $\deg.\text{tr. } k(x)/k(s)$; one therefore has, for every point $x' \in Z'_x$,

$$\deg.\text{tr. } k(x')/k(s') \leq \deg.\text{tr. } k(x)/k(s), \quad \text{with equality}$$

when x' is a maximal point of Z'_x . Whence immediately the announced conclusion.

2.2. Let $f : X \rightarrow S$ be a morphism locally of finite type and T a closed part of S . Let $x \in X$, $s = f(x)$; we shall set

$$\delta_T(x) = \deg.\text{tr. } k(x)/k(s) + \text{codim}(\{s\} \cap T, \{s\}) = \inf_{t \in T \cap \{s\}} \delta_t(x).$$

Lemma 2.2.1.

Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X' & \xrightarrow{h} & X \\ | & & | \\ f' & & f \\ | & & | \\ S' & \xrightarrow{g} & S \end{array}$$

be a cartesian square, where the schemes S and S' are locally noetherian, catenary, the morphism f locally of finite type, and g faithfully flat. Let T be a closed part of S , T' a closed part of S' such that $g(T') \subset T$, x' an element of X' , $x = h(x')$ and

$$h_{\{x'\}} : \text{Spec } \mathcal{O}_{X',x'} \rightarrow \text{Spec } \mathcal{O}_{X,x}$$

the morphism induced by h . Then one has:

$$\delta_T(x) - \delta_{T'}(x') \leq \dim h_{\{x'\}}^{-1}(x).$$

Let $s' = f'(x')$, $s = f(x)$. By definition:

$$\begin{aligned} \delta_T(x) - \delta_{T'}(x') &= \deg.\text{tr. } k(x)/k(s) - \deg.\text{tr. } k(x')/k(s') \\ &\quad + \text{codim}(\{s\} \cap T, \{s\}) - \text{codim}(\{s'\} \cap T', \{s'\}). \end{aligned}$$

Since g is faithfully flat, it follows from (EGA IV 6.1.4) that one has

$$\begin{aligned} (*) \quad \text{codim}(\{s\} \cap T, \{s\}) &= \text{codim}(g^{-1}(\{s\}) \cap g^{-1}(T), g^{-1}(\{s\})) \\ &\leq \text{codim}(g^{-1}(\{s\}) \cap T', g^{-1}(\{s\})); \end{aligned}$$

since S' is catenary, one has, by (EGA 0_IV 14.3.2 b)):

$$\begin{aligned} \text{codim}(\{s'\} \cap T', g^{-1}(\{s\})) &= \text{codim}(\{s'\} \cap T', \{s'\}) + \text{codim}(\{s'\}, g^{-1}(\{s\})) \\ &= \text{codim}(\{s'\} \cap T', g^{-1}(\{s\}) \cap T') + \text{codim}(g^{-1}(\{s\}) \cap T', g^{-1}(\{s\})). \end{aligned}$$

One deduces from this relation and (*)

$$\delta_T(x) - \delta_{T'}(x') \leq \deg.\text{tr. } k(x)/k(s) - \deg.\text{tr. } k(x')/k(s') + \text{codim}(\{s'\}, g^{-1}(\{s\})).$$

Let us compute $\text{codim}(s', g^{-1}(s)) = \dim \mathcal{O}_{S'_s, s'}$ (where S'_s is the fiber of S' at s). Let Z be the closed image of x in X_s and $Z' \subset X'_s$ the scheme defined by the cartesian square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} Z' & \longrightarrow & Z \\ | & & | \\ \mathcal{V} & & \mathcal{V} \\ S'_s & \longrightarrow & \text{Spec } k(s) \end{array}$$

The morphism $Z \rightarrow \text{Spec } k(s)$ is flat, locally of finite type, and one has $\dim Z = \deg.\text{tr. } k(x)/k(s)$. It then follows from (EGA IV 6.1.2) that

$$\dim(\mathcal{O}_{Z',x'}) = \dim(\mathcal{O}_{S'_s, s'}) + \deg.\text{tr. } k(x)/k(s) - \deg.\text{tr. } k(x')/k(s');$$

taking into account the fact that $Z'_{s'} \simeq Z \otimes_{k(s)} k(s')$, one obtains:

$$\delta_T(x) - \delta_{T'}(x') \leq \dim(O_{Z',x'}).$$

Now $\text{Spec}(O_{Z',x'})$ is identified with the fiber at x of the morphism

$$(\text{Spec}(O_{X',x'}))_s \rightarrow (\text{Spec}(O_{X,x}))_s,$$

hence also with the fiber at x of $h_{x'}$, which proves the theorem.

2.3. The proofs of the theorems of §4 are based on duality theory; they use the following lemmas. Let m be an integer that is a power of a prime number ℓ ; if X is a scheme, all the sheaves considered on X are sheaves of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules; one then has

the notion of dualizing complex on X (SGA 5 I 1.7). Suppose there exists such a complex K on X ; then, for each geometric point $\bar{x}$ above a point x of X , one deduces from K (cf. SGA 5 I 4.5) a dualizing complex $K_{\bar{x}}$ on $\text{Spec } k(\bar{x})$, so that one has $K_{\bar{x}} \simeq \mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}[n]$ (the bracket denoting the translation functor) for some integer n depending only on x . We shall set

$$\delta^K(x) = n.$$

If K is normalized at the point x (SGA 5 I 4.5), one therefore has $n = 0$.

Lemma 2.3.1.

Let X be a locally noetherian scheme equipped with a dualizing complex K . If x and x' are two points of X such that x is a specialization of x' and that $\text{codim}(x, x') = 1$, then one has

$$\delta^K(x) = \delta^K(x') - 2.$$

One can first reduce to the case where X is a strictly local scheme. Indeed, let $\bar{X}$ be the strict localization of X at a geometric point $\bar{x}$ above x , $i : \bar{X} \rightarrow X$ the canonical morphism, and $\bar{x}'$ a geometric point of $\bar{X}$ above x' . Then i^*K is a dualizing complex on $\bar{X}$ and one has (SGA 5 I 4.5)

$$(i^*K)_{\bar{x}} \simeq K_{\bar{x}} \text{ and } (i^*K)_{\bar{x}'} \simeq K_{\bar{x}'},$$

which completes the reduction to the strictly local case.

If $j : x' \rightarrow X$ denotes the immersion of the reduced closed subscheme of X with underlying space x' , then $R^!j(K)$ is a dualizing complex on x' and one sees immediately, using (SGA 5 I 4.5), that it suffices to prove the lemma for x' . One is thus reduced to the case where X is a strictly local integral scheme of dimension 1.

Let then X' be the normalization of X and $f : X' \rightarrow X$ the canonical morphism; f is an integral, surjective, radicial morphism, and it follows that f^*K is a dualizing complex on X' and that it suffices to prove the lemma for X' and for the points above x and x' . One is thus

reduced to the case where X is a regular integral local scheme of dimension 1, but one knows (cf. SGA 5 I 4.6.2 and 5.1) that then $\mu_m[2]$ and $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ are dualizing complexes, normalized respectively at the points x and x' ; the lemma follows immediately.

Lemma 2.3.2.

Let S be a noetherian local scheme, $f : X \rightarrow S$ a morphism of finite type. If K is a dualizing complex on S , normalized at the closed point t of S , and if $R^!f(K) = K'$ is a dualizing complex on X (cf. SGA 5 I 3.4.3), one has, for every point x of X :

$$\delta^{K'}(x) = 2\delta(x).$$

Indeed let $s = f(x)$ and x' a closed point of the fiber X_s ; then one has $\delta^{K'}(x') = \delta^K(s)$ and by 2.3.1

$$\delta^K(s) = 2 \operatorname{codim}(\{t\}, \{s\}) = 2 \dim(\{s\}).$$

Since one can choose for x' a specialization of x , one has by 2.3.1

$$\delta^{K'}(x) = \delta^{K'}(x') + 2 \operatorname{codim}(\{x\}, \{x'\}) = \delta^K(s) + 2 \deg. \operatorname{tr.} k(x)/k(s);$$

the lemma follows immediately.

The following lemma will be used only for the converse of the Lefschetz theorem in §4:

Lemma 2.3.3.

Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X' & \xrightarrow{h} & X \\ | & & | \\ f' & & f \\ | & & | \\ S' & \xrightarrow{g} & S \end{array}$$

be a cartesian square, where S is a strictly local excellent scheme of characteristic zero, S' the completion of S , and f a morphism of finite type. Let ℓ be a prime number, $x \in X$, Z the

schematic closure of X'_x in X' , and $i : X'_x \rightarrow Z$, $j : Z \rightarrow X$ the canonical morphisms. Then, if $k : X' \rightarrow R$ is a closed immersion of X' into a regular excellent scheme R of characteristic zero, the complex

$$K' = i^*(R^!(k \cdot j)(\mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z}))$$

is a dualizing complex on X'_x that is constant (that is, having only one non-null cohomology sheaf, isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z}$).

Taking (SGA 5 I 3.4.3) into account, the only thing to prove is that K' is constant. Now, since Z is excellent, the set of points of Z whose local rings are regular is an open set U (EGA IV 7.8.3 (iv)), and U evidently contains X'_x which is regular. Let then

$$u : U \rightarrow R$$

be the canonical immersion of U in R ; it follows from the purity theorem (SGA 4 XIX 3.2 and 3.4) and from the isomorphism

$$(\mu_\ell)_S \simeq (\mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z})_S$$

(S strictly local) that one has

$$R^!u(\mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z}) \simeq \mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z}[2c],$$

where c is a locally constant function on U , necessarily constant in a neighborhood of X'_x , since the fibers of g are geometrically integral by (EGA IV 18.9.1) hence X'_x integral. The lemma follows immediately.

3. Converse of the affine Lefschetz theorem

The present section will be used in §4 to prove a converse to the “Lefschetz theorem”; a reader interested only in the direct part of the said theorem may therefore omit the reading of the present section.

3.1. Let us recall the statement of the affine Lefschetz theorem¹⁵⁰ (SGA 4 XIX 6.1 bis):

Let S be a strictly local excellent scheme of characteristic zero, $f : X \rightarrow S$ an affine morphism of finite type, and F a torsion sheaf on X . Then, if one sets

$$\delta(F) = \sup\{\delta(x) \mid x \in X \text{ and } F_x \neq 0\},$$

one has

$$H^q(X, F) = 0 \text{ for } q > \delta(F).$$

Before stating the converse, let us prove a few lemmas.

Lemma 3.2.

¹⁵⁰Editors' note: Gabber has proved the following generalization. Let Y be a strictly local scheme of arithmetic type over a regular noetherian scheme S of dimension ≤ 1 . Let $f : X \rightarrow Y$ be an affine morphism of finite type, $\Lambda = \mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ with n invertible on X and F a Λ -sheaf. Then $H^q(X, F) = 0$ if $q > \delta(F)$. From this one deduces the following local Lefschetz theorem. Let O be strictly local of arithmetic type over S . For every $f \in O$ not a zero divisor and every Λ -sheaf F on $\text{Spec}(O[f^{-1}])$, one has $H^q(\text{Spec}(O[f^{-1}]), F) = 0$ for $q > \dim(O)$. Cf. (Fujiwara K., “A Proof of the Absolute Purity Conjecture (after Gabber)”, in *Algebraic geometry 2000, Azumino (Hotaka)*, Adv. Stud. in Pure Math., vol. 36, 2002, p. 153-183, §5) and especially the article of Illusie (Illusie L., “Perversité et variation”, *Manuscripta Math.* 112 (2003), p. 271-295). This result is one of the crucial points used by Gabber in his proof of the Grothendieck purity theorem (cf. note (1), page 168).

Let K be a field, ℓ a prime number distinct from the characteristic of K , and F an ℓ -torsion sheaf on K , constructible, non-null. Suppose that the ℓ -cohomological dimension of K (SGA 4 X 1) is equal to n (this is realized for example if K is the field of fractions of a strictly local excellent integral ring of characteristic zero of dimension n (SGA 4 XIX 6.3), or if K is a finitely generated extension of transcendence degree n of a separably closed field (SGA 4 X 2.1)). Then one can find a finite separable extension L of K such that:

$$H^n(L, F|_L) \neq 0.$$

One can find a finite extension K' of K such that the restrictions of F and μ_ℓ to $\text{Spec } K'$ are constant sheaves. One then has $cd_\ell(K') = cd_\ell(K) = n$ (SGA 4 X 2.1), and it follows from ([2] II §3 Prop. 4 (iii)) that one can find a finite extension L of K' such that

$$H^n(L, \mu_{\ell}) \neq 0, \text{ i.e. } H^n(L, \mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z}) \neq 0.$$

Now the functor $H^n(L, \cdot)$ is right exact on the category of ℓ -torsion sheaves, since $cd_\ell(L) = n$; since F admits a quotient isomorphic to $\mathbb{Z}/\ell\mathbb{Z}$, one also has $H^n(L, F|_L) \neq 0$.

Corollary 3.3.

Let k be a field, K a finitely generated extension of transcendence degree n of k , F a constructible non-null ℓ -torsion sheaf on K , with ℓ prime to the characteristic of k . Then one can find a finite separable extension L of K such that, if $u : \text{Spec } L \rightarrow \text{Spec } k$ denotes the canonical morphism, one has

$$R^n u_*(F|_{\text{Spec } L}) \neq 0.$$

When the field k is separably closed, the corollary is a particular case of 3.2. In the general case, one can find a finite separable extension k_1 of k such that the irreducible components of $K \otimes_k k_1$ are geometrically irreducible (EGA IV 4.5.11); let K_1 be one of them. If k' is a separable closure of k_1 , then $K' = K_1 \otimes_{k_1} k'$ is a field, and one has by (EGA IV 4.2)

$$\deg.\text{tr. } K'/k' = \deg.\text{tr. } K/k = n.$$

It then follows from 3.2 that one can find a finite separable extension L' of K' such that one has $H^n(L', F|_{L'}) \neq 0$. But $k' = \lim_i k_i$ (direct limit), where k_i runs over the finite extensions of k_1 contained in k' , and consequently $K' = \lim_i (k_i \otimes_{k_1} K_1)$. It follows that one

can find an index i and a finite separable extension L of $k_i \otimes_{k_1} K_1 = K_i$ such that one has $L' \simeq L \otimes_{K_i} K'$. The extension L of K answers the question; indeed it follows from the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & \text{Spec } L & \\ & / \quad \backslash & \\ v & & u \\ / & & \backslash \\ v & & \backslash \\ \text{Spec } k_i & \dashrightarrow & \text{Spec } k, \end{array}$$

with w finite, hence $R^q w_* = 0$ if $q > 0$, that one has

$$R^n u_* (F|_{\{\text{Spec } L\}}) \simeq w_* (R^n v_* (F|_{\{\text{Spec } L\}})).$$

Now $R^n v_* (F|_{\text{Spec } L}) \neq 0$, since $H^n(L', F|_{L'}) \neq 0$; one therefore also has $R^n u_* (F|_{\text{Spec } L}) \neq 0$.

Let us recall the following well-known lemma (cf. EGA 0_III 10.3.1.2 and EGA IV 18.2.3):

Lemma 3.4.

Let X be a scheme, x a point of X , K a finite separable extension of $k(x)$. Then there exists a scheme X_1 étale over X , affine, and a point $x_1 \in X_1$ above x such that $k(x_1)$ is $k(x)$ -isomorphic to K .

We shall use in §4 the following technical form of the converse of 3.1.

Proposition 3.5.

Let

$$\begin{array}{ccc} X' & \xrightarrow{h} & X \\ | & & | \\ f' & & f \\ | & & | \\ S' & \xrightarrow{g} & S, \end{array}$$

be a cartesian square where the schemes S and S' are strictly local excellent of characteristic zero, the morphism f locally of finite type, g regular (EGA IV 6.8.1) surjective, with closed fiber of g reduced to the closed point of S' . Given an S -scheme X_1 (resp. an S -morphism f_1 , etc.), we shall denote by X'_1 (resp. f'_1 , etc.) the scheme $X_1 \times_S S'$ (resp. the morphism $(f_1)_{(S')}$, etc.). Let F be a constructible sheaf of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules on X' (m a power of a prime number ℓ) satisfying the following conditions:

- (i) For every point $x \in X$, one can find a finite separable extension K of $k(x)$ such that the restriction of F to the fiber $(X')_{(\text{Spec } K)}$ comes by inverse image from a constructible sheaf on $\text{Spec } K$.
- (ii) For every morphism $f_1 : X_1 \rightarrow S$, with X_1 étale over X , affine, for every point $s \in S$, and for every integer $q > 0$, one can find a finite separable extension K of $k(s)$ such that the restriction of $R^q f'_{1*} (F|_{X'_1})$ to the fiber $S'_{(\text{Spec } K)}$ comes by inverse image from a constructible sheaf on $\text{Spec } K$.

Let n be an integer, and suppose that for every scheme X_1 étale over X , affine, one has

$$H^i(X'_1, F) = 0 \text{ for } i > n.$$

Then, if $\bar{x}'$ is a geometric point above the point $x' \in X'$ such that $F_{\bar{x}'} \neq 0$, one has

$$\delta(x') \leq n.$$

Let Z' be the set of points x' of X' such that $F_{\bar{x}'} = 0$. Then, if $Z = h(Z')$, one has by (i) $Z' = h^{-1}(Z)$; let $x' \in X'$, $x = h(x')$, $s' = f'(x')$, $s = f(x)$. It follows from 2.1.1 and from the fact that the function δ decreases under specialization that it suffices to prove the inequality $\delta(x') \leq n$ when x is a maximal point of Z and x' is such that

$$r = \deg. \text{tr. } k(x)/k(s) = \deg. \text{tr. } k(x')/k(s') \text{ and } d = \dim \{s\} = \dim \{s'\}.$$

Let x' be such a point; it suffices to show that one can find a scheme X_1 étale over X , affine, such that one has

$$H^{d+r}(X'_1, F) \neq 0.$$

The set Z' is constructible (SGA 4 IX 2.4), hence the same holds for Z (EGA IV 1.9.12); one can then suppose, by restricting X to a neighborhood of x , that Z is an irreducible closed set with generic point x . Let $T = f(Z)$; T is a constructible set contained in s ; one can therefore find an affine open U of S such that $s \in U$ and that $T \cap U = T_U$ is an irreducible closed set of U with generic point s .

Let then V be a scheme étale over X , affine, whose image in X contains x and whose image in S is contained in U ; let Z_V be the inverse image of Z in V and $u : Z_V \rightarrow T_U$ the canonical morphism. Let W be a scheme étale over U , affine; we then denote by T_W the inverse image of T_U in W and let $X_1 = W \times_U V$. Since F is null outside Z' , one has the spectral sequence

$$E_2^{p,q} = H^p((T_W)', R^q u'_*(F|_{(Z_V)'})) \Rightarrow H^{p+q}(X'_1, F).$$

We shall show that one can choose V and W such that one has

- a) $E_2^{pq} = 0$ for $p > d$ and for $q > r$.
- b) $E_2^{dr} \neq 0$.

It will then follow from the spectral sequence that $H^{d+r}(X'_1, F) \neq 0$.

1°) Set $G^q = R^q u'_*(F|_{(Z_V)'});$ then one has:

$$(G^q)_{s'} = H^q((Z_V)'_{s'}, F|_{(Z_V)'_{s'}}),$$

since s' is a maximal point of $(T_U)'$. Since the fiber $(Z_V)'_{s'}$ is an affine scheme of finite type of dimension r over a separably closed field, it follows from 3.1 that one has

$$(G^q)_{s'} = 0 \text{ for } q > r.$$

For $q > r$, let Y'_q be the set of points of $(T_U)'$ where the geometric fiber of G^q is $\neq 0$ and $Y_q = g(Y'_q)$; then one has $Y'_q = g^{-1}(Y_q)$ by (ii), so Y_q is a constructible subset of T_U (SGA 4 XIX 5.1 and EGA 1.9.12) which does not contain s ; restricting U to an open neighborhood of s , one can suppose that one has $G^q = 0$ for $q > r$, hence $E_2^{pq} = 0$ for $q > r$.

Moreover, since $(T_W)'$ is an affine scheme of finite type over $g^{-1}(s)$, one has, whatever q (cf. 3.1):

$$H^p((T_W)', G^q) = 0 \text{ for } p > \dim g^{-1}(\{s\}) = d,$$

whence condition a).

2°) Let us show that one can choose V such that $(G^r)_{s'} \neq 0$. By (i), there exists a constructible sheaf I , defined on a finite separable extension K of $k(x)$, whose inverse image on $(X')_{(\text{Spec } K)}$ is isomorphic to $F|_{(X')_{(\text{Spec } K)}}$. By 3.3, one finds a finite separable extension L of K such that, if $v : \text{Spec } L \rightarrow \text{Spec } k(s)$ denotes the canonical morphism, one has $R^r v_*(I) \neq 0$. Since the morphism $S'_s \rightarrow \text{Spec } k(s)$ is regular, one has by (SGA 4 XIX 4.2):

$$R^r v'_*(F|_{(\text{Spec } L)'}) \simeq (R^r v'_*(I))' \neq 0.$$

By Lemma 3.4, one can find a scheme X_2 étale over X , affine, and a point x_2 of X_2 above x such that L is $k(x)$ -isomorphic to $k(x_2)$, and one can suppose X_2 over U . Since x is a maximal point of Z , one has

$$\text{Spec } L \simeq \lim_{\leftarrow} V \rightarrow Z \rightarrow V,$$

where V runs over the affine open neighborhoods of x_2 . One deduces by passage to the limit (SGA 4 VII 5.8), after restriction to the geometric fiber at s' :

$$(R^r v'_*(F|_{(\text{Spec } L)'})_{s'}) = \lim_{\rightarrow} V (R^r u'_*(F|_{(Z \rightarrow V)'}))_{s'},$$

which shows that one can find V such that $(G^r)_{s'} \neq 0$.

3°) The scheme V having been chosen in 2°), let us show that one can choose the scheme W such that one has

$$E_2^{dr} = H^d((T_W)', G^r) \neq 0.$$

By (ii), there exists a constructible sheaf J , defined on a finite separable extension K of $k(s)$, whose inverse image on $(S')_{(\text{Spec } K)}$ is isomorphic to $G^r|_{(S')_{(\text{Spec } K)}}$. By Lemma 3.2, one can find a finite separable extension L of K such that one has $H^d(\text{Spec } L, J) \neq 0$. Since the morphism $(S')_{(\text{Spec } L)} \rightarrow \text{Spec } L$ is acyclic (SGA 4 XIX 4.1 and XV 1.10 and 1.16), one has $H^d((\text{Spec } L)', G^r|_{(\text{Spec } L)'}) = H^d(\text{Spec } L, J) \neq 0$.

By 3.4, one can find a scheme U_1 étale over U , affine, and a point s_1 above s , such that $k(s_1)$ is $k(s)$ -isomorphic to L . Now, s being a maximal point of T_U , one has

$$\text{Spec } L \simeq \lim_{\leftarrow} W \rightarrow T_U \rightarrow W,$$

where W runs over the affine open neighborhoods of s_1 . One deduces that $(\text{Spec } L)' \simeq$

$\lim_{\leftarrow} W (T_W)'$, and by passage to the limit (SGA 4 VII 5.8):

$$H^d((\text{Spec } L)', G^r|_{(\text{Spec } L)'}) \simeq \lim_{\rightarrow} W H^d((T_W)', G^r|_{(T_W)'});$$

consequently one can find W such that one has

$$H^d((T_W)', G^r|_{(T_W)'}) \neq 0,$$

which completes the proof of the theorem.

Corollary 3.6.

The hypotheses concerning S, S', f, f', m are those of 3.5. Denote now by F a complex of sheaves of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules on X' , bounded below and with constructible cohomology, and whose cohomology sheaves satisfy conditions (i) and (ii) of 3.5. Let n be an integer, and suppose that, for every scheme X_1 étale over X , affine, one has

$$H^i(X_1, F) = 0 \text{ for } i > n.$$

Then, if $\bar{x}'$ is a geometric point above a point x' of X' such that, for some integer j , $(H^j(F))_{\bar{x}'} \neq 0$, one has

$$\delta(x') \leq n - j.$$

Let T' be the set of points of X' where the conclusion of 3.7 fails, and suppose $T' \neq \emptyset$; let $T = f(T')$, x a maximal point of T , and x' a point of X' above

x . Let j be the largest integer such that $(H^j(F))_{\bar{x}'} \neq 0$; one therefore has $r = \delta(x) > n - j$. Let Z'_q be the set of points where the geometric fiber of $H^q(F)$ is $\neq 0$ and $Z_q = h(Z'_q)$; as in the proof of 3.5, Z_q is constructible. One evidently has $Z'_q = \emptyset$ for $q > n$ and for q sufficiently small. The other values of q are distributed in three subsets. Let

$$Q_1 = \{q \mid x \in Z_q \text{ and a generization of } x \text{ distinct from } x \text{ is } \notin Z_q\}.$$

One has $j \in Q_1$ and one can find an affine open neighborhood U_1 of x such that, for every $q \in Q_1$, $U_1 \cap Z_q$ is an irreducible closed set with generic point x . If $q \in Q_1$, one has

$$(*) \quad \delta(H^q(F)|_{U_1}) = \delta(x) \quad (\text{for the definition of } \delta(H^q(F)) \text{ cf. 3.1}).$$

Let

$$Q_2 = \{q \mid \text{no generization of } x \text{ belongs to } Z_q\}.$$

Then, if $j < q \leq n$, one has $q \in Q_2$, and one can find an affine open neighborhood U_2 of x such that, for every $q \in Q_2$, one has $Z_q \cap U_2 = \emptyset$; thus

$$(**) \quad H^q(F)|_{U_2} = 0 \text{ for } q \in Q_2.$$

Let finally

$$Q_3 = \{q \mid Z_q \text{ contains strict generizations of } x\}.$$

Then one can find an affine open neighborhood U_3 of x such that, for every $q \in Q_3$, all the maximal points of $Z_q \cap U_3$ are generizations of x . If $q \in Q_3$, one has

$$(***) \quad \delta(H^q(F)|_{U_3}) \leq n - q.$$

For every scheme X_1 étale over $U_1 \cap U_2 \cap U_3$, affine, consider the hypercohomology spectral sequence

$$E_2^{p,q} = H^p(X'_1, H^q(F)) \Rightarrow H^{p+q}(X'_1, F).$$

One has $E_2^{pq} = 0$ for $q \in Q_2$ by (**). One has $E_2^{pq} = 0$ for $p + q \geq r + j$ except perhaps for $p = r, q = j$. Indeed this is clear if $q \in Q_2$; if $q \in Q_1$, one has $p > r$ unless $p = r, q = j$, and this follows from 3.1 taking (*) into account; finally if $q \in Q_3$, since $r > n - j$, one has $p > n - q$ and the assertion follows from 3.1 taking (***) into account. Given that $H^{r+j}(X'_1, F) = 0$, it follows from the spectral sequence that one has

$$H^r(X'_1, H^j(F)) = 0;$$

now this entails, by 3.5, $\delta(x) < r$, which is absurd.

Corollary 3.7.

Let S be a strictly local excellent scheme of characteristic zero, $f : X \rightarrow S$ a morphism locally of finite type, m a power of a prime number, F a complex of sheaves of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules on X , bounded below with constructible cohomology, and n an integer. Then the following conditions are equivalent:

(i) For every scheme X_1 étale over X , affine, one has

$$H^i(X_1, F) = 0 \text{ for } i > n.$$

(ii) For every geometric point $\bar{x}$ above the point x of X and for every integer j

such that $(H^j(F))_{\bar{x}} \neq 0$, one has

$$\delta(x) \leq n - j.$$

(i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii) is the particular case of 3.6 obtained by taking $S = S'$.

(ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i) follows immediately from 3.1, using the hypercohomology spectral sequence

$$H^p(X_1, H^q(F)) \Rightarrow H^{p+q}(X_1, F).$$

4. Main theorem and variants

4.0. Let $g : X \rightarrow S$ be a separated morphism of finite type, T a closed part of S , $Z = g^{-1}(T)$, and F a complex of abelian sheaves on X bounded below. We call i -th cohomology group of F with proper support, with support in Z , the group

$$H^i_{\{Z!\}}(X/S, F) = H^i_{\{T\}}(S, R^!g_*(F)),$$

where $R^!g_*$ denotes “direct image with proper support” (SGA 4 XVII). In the particular case where g is proper, one simply has

$$H^i_{\{Z!\}}(X/S, F) = H^i_{\{Z\}}(X, F).$$

Proposition 4.1.

Let $f : U \rightarrow S$ be a morphism of finite type, F a complex of abelian sheaves on U bounded below. Suppose one has a factorization of f :

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
U & \xrightarrow{i} & X \\
\searrow & & \nearrow \\
& & \\
& f & g \\
& \searrow & \nearrow \\
& & S
\end{array}$$

where i is an open immersion and g a separated morphism of finite type, and denote by G a complex of abelian sheaves on X bounded below that prolongs F . Let Y be a closed subscheme of X with underlying space $X - U$, so that one has a commutative diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
Y & \xrightarrow{j} & X \\
\searrow & & \nearrow \\
& h & g \\
& \searrow & \nearrow \\
& & S
\end{array}$$

Let finally n be an integer and T a closed part of S . Then the following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) One has $\text{prof}_T(R^! f(F)) \geq n$.
- (ii) The canonical morphism

$$\mathcal{H}^i_T(R^! g(G)) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_T(R^! h(j^* G))$$

is bijective for $i < n - 1$, injective for $i = n - 1$.

- (iii) For every scheme S' étale over S , if one denotes by X' (resp. f' , resp. etc.) the scheme $X \times_S S'$ (resp. the morphism $f_{(S')}$, resp. etc.), the canonical morphism

$$H^i_{\{g'^{-1}\}(T')!}(X'/S', G') \rightarrow H^i_{\{h'^{-1}\}(T')!}(Y'/S', j'^* G')$$

is bijective for $i < n - 1$, injective for $i = n - 1$.

Consider in the derived category $D^+(X)$ (cf. [3]) the distinguished triangle

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
& j_* j^* G & \\
\nearrow & & \searrow \\
i_* F & \xleftarrow{\quad} & G.
\end{array}$$

In applying to this triangle the functor $R^! g$, one obtains the triangle

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
& R^! h(j^* G) & \\
\nearrow & & \searrow \\
(*) \quad R^! f(F) & \xleftarrow{\quad} & R^! g(G).
\end{array}$$

Let us show (i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii). Indeed, by Definition 1.2, (i) is equivalent to the relation

$$\mathcal{H}^i_T(R^! f(F)) = 0 \text{ for } i < n;$$

now one deduces from (*) the exact sequence of sheaves

$$\rightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_T(R^! f(F)) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_T(R^! g(G)) \rightarrow \mathcal{H}^i_T(R^! h(j^* G)) \rightarrow,$$

whence the equivalence of (i) and (ii).

(i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (iii). Indeed (i) is equivalent to saying that, for every scheme S' étale over S , one has the relation

$$(**) H^i_{\text{ét}}(S', R^i f'_*(F')) = 0 \text{ for } i < n.$$

Now one deduces from (*) the exact sequence of abelian groups

$$\rightarrow H^i_{\text{ét}}(S', R^i f'_*(F')) \rightarrow H^i_{\text{ét}}(S', R^i g'_*(G')) \rightarrow H^i_{\text{ét}}(S', R^i h'^*(j'^* G')) \rightarrow;$$

taking 4.0 into account, this exact sequence writes in the form

$$\rightarrow H^i_{\text{ét}}(S', R^i f'_*(F')) \rightarrow H^i_{\text{ét}}(g'^{-1}(T)!, (X'/S', G')) \rightarrow H^i_{\text{ét}}(h'^{-1}(T)!, (Y'/S', j'^* G')) \rightarrow.$$

The equivalence of (i) and (iii) follows, taking the form (**) of (i) into account.

4.2.0. When $f : U \rightarrow S$ is affine, we shall give local conditions on F for conditions (i) to (iii) of 4.1 to be verified. In what follows, the schemes considered are excellent schemes of characteristic zero, the sheaves are sheaves of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules, where m is a power of a prime number. If one had resolution of singularities in the sense of (SGA 4 XIX), the results stated, as well as their proofs, would still be valid for excellent schemes of equal characteristic, with m prime to the characteristic.

Theorem 4.2.

Let S be an excellent scheme of characteristic zero and $f : U \rightarrow S$ a separated morphism of finite type. Let F be a complex of sheaves of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules on U , bounded below with constructible cohomology, n an integer, and T a closed part of S . Then the following conditions are equivalent:

(i) For every scheme U_1 étale over U , affine over S , one has, denoting by f_1 the structural morphism of U_1 and by F_1 the restriction of F to U_1 :

$$\text{prof}_T(R^! f_1(F_1)) \geq n$$

(cf. Prop. 4.1 on the meaning of this relation).

(ii) For every point u of U , one has:

$$\text{prof}_u(F) \geq n - \delta_T(u),$$

where one sets (cf. 2.2): $\delta_T(u) = \text{deg.tr.}(k(x)/k(s)) + \text{codim}(s \cap T, s)$.

Proof.

1°) Let t be a point of T , $\bar{S}$ the strict localization of S at a geometric point above t , and S' the completion of $\bar{S}$ with closed point t' ; then $\bar{S}$ is excellent by (EGA IV 7.9.5), so S' is a complete strictly local excellent scheme. Given a scheme U over X (resp. an S -morphism f , resp. etc.), we shall denote by U' (resp. f' , resp. etc.) the scheme $U \times_S S'$ (resp. the morphism $f_{(S')}$, resp. etc.). One has the cartesian square

$$\begin{array}{ccc}
U' & \xrightarrow{h} & U \\
| & & | \\
f' & & f \\
| & & | \\
v & & v \\
S' & \xrightarrow{g} & S,
\end{array}$$

in which the morphism g is regular (EGA IV 7.8.2). Let us show that it suffices to prove that (for every point $t \in T$) the two following properties are equivalent:

(i)_t For every scheme U_1 étale over U , affine over S , setting $f_1 : U_1 \rightarrow S$, one has

$$\text{prof}_{t'}(R^! f_1'(F_1')) \geq n.$$

(ii)_t For every point u' of U' , one has

$$\text{prof}_{u'}(F') \geq n - \delta_{t'}(u').$$

It suffices to prove the following lemma:

Lemma 4.2.1.

One has (i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (i)_t for every $t \in T$ and (ii) $\Leftrightarrow$ (ii)_t for every $t \in T$.

(i) $\Leftrightarrow$ (i)_t for every $t \in T$. Indeed (i) is equivalent to saying that, for every scheme U_1 étale over U , affine over S , one has

$$\text{prof}_T(R^! f_1(F_1)) \geq n;$$

now by 1.8

$$\text{prof}_T(R^! f_1(F_1)) = \inf_{t \in T} \text{prof}_t(R^! f_1(F_1)).$$

Since $g^*(R^! f_1(F_1)) \simeq R^! f_1'(F_1')$ (SGA 4 XVII), one has by 1.16

$$\text{prof}_t(R^! f_1(F_1)) = \text{prof}_{t'}(R^! f_1'(F_1')),$$

so (i) is equivalent to saying that one has, for every $t \in T$, $\text{prof}_{t'}(R^! f_1'(F_1')) \geq n$, which is none other than (i)_t.

(ii)_t for every $t \in T \Rightarrow$ (ii). Indeed let $u \in U$; one must show the relation

$$\text{prof}_u(F) \geq n - \delta_T(u),$$

where $\delta_T(u) = \inf_{t \in T \cap s} \delta_t(u)$ (cf. 2.2); one is therefore reduced to showing that one has, for every $t \in T \cap s$

$$\text{prof}_u(F) \geq n - \delta_t(u).$$

Let u' be a point of U' such that $h(u') = u$ and $\delta_{t'}(u') = \delta_t(u)$ (cf. 2.1.1). Since h is locally acyclic (SGA 4 XIX 4.1), it follows from 1.16 and from the fact that u' is a generic point of U'_u that one has

$$\text{prof}_{u'}(F') = \text{prof}_u(F).$$

But one has by (ii)_t $\text{prof}_u(F) = \text{prof}_{u'}(F') \geq n - \delta_t(u)$, which proves (ii).

(ii) $\Rightarrow$ (ii)_t for every t . With the notations of 2.2.1, for every point u' of U' , one has by 1.16

$$\text{prof}_{\{u'\}}(F') \geq \text{prof}_u(F) + 2 \dim h_{\{u'\}^{-1}}(u) \geq \text{prof}_u(F) + \dim h_{\{u'\}^{-1}}(u).$$

Taking 2.2.1 and (ii) into account, one obtains

$$\text{prof}_{\{u'\}}(F') \geq n - \delta_{-T}(u) + \dim h_{\{u'\}^{-1}}(u) \geq n - \delta_{-T'}(u'),$$

which is none other than (ii)_t.

2°) (ii)_t $\Leftrightarrow$ (i)_t. One immediately reduces to the case where F is bounded, by truncating F at a sufficiently high rank. One can realize S' as a closed subset of a complete regular local scheme, hence excellent; it then follows from (SGA 5 I 3.4.3) that there exists a dualizing complex K on S' and that $R^!f'(K) = K'$ is a dualizing complex on U' . We shall choose K such that $\delta^K(t') = 0$ (for the definition of $\delta^K(t')$, cf. 2.3), and denote by DF' the dual of F' with respect to K' . One can reformulate hypothesis (ii)_t as follows:

Lemma 4.2.2.

Let u' be a point of U' ; then the following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) One has $\text{prof}_{u'}(F') \geq n - \delta_{t'}(u')$.
- (ii) One has $(H^q(DF'))_{\bar{u}'} = 0$ for $q > -n - \delta_{t'}(u')$ ($\bar{u}'$ geometric point above u').

Let $\bar{U}'$ be the strict localization of U' at $\bar{u}'$ and $\bar{F}'$ the inverse image of F' by the morphism $\bar{U}' \rightarrow U'$. The relation $\text{prof}_{u'}(F') \geq n - \delta_{t'}(u')$ is equivalent by definition to:

$$(*) \ H^i_{\bar{u}'}(\bar{F}') = 0 \text{ for } i > n - \delta_{-T'}(u').$$

Let $DH^i_{\bar{u}'}(\bar{F}')$ be the dual of the abelian group $H^i_{\bar{u}'}(\bar{F}')$ with respect to $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$. By 2.3.2, $K'[-2\delta_{t'}(u')] = K''$ satisfies $\delta^{K''}(u') = 0$; since F' has constructible cohomology, one has $DF' = D(\bar{F}')$ and the local duality theorem (SGA 5 I 4.5.3) shows then

that one has

$$DH^i_{\bar{u}'}(\bar{F}') \simeq H^{-i-2\delta_{t'}(u')}(DF')_{\bar{u}'}.$$

So (*) is equivalent to the relation

$$(**) \ (H^q(DF'))_{\bar{u}'} = 0 \text{ for } q > -n - \delta_{-T'}(u').$$

We are now in a position to prove the theorem. The relation (ii)_t is equivalent to the relation (**). Let $G^q = H^q(DF')$; the affine Lefschetz theorem (3.1) entails in particular that, for every scheme U_1 étale over U , affine over S , one has

$$H^p(U_1, G^q) = 0 \text{ for } p > \delta(G^q),$$

where $\delta(G^q)$ is the supremum of the $\delta_{t'}(u')$ for the u' such that $(G^q)_{\bar{u}'} \neq 0$; by (**) one has $\delta(G^q) \leq -n - q$, so (ii)_t entails the relation

$$H^p(U_1, H^q(DF')) = 0 \text{ for } p > -q - n.$$

Taking the hypercohomology spectral sequence of the functor “sections over U_1 ” with respect to the complex DF' :

$$E_2^{p,q} = H^p(U_1, H^q(DF')) \Rightarrow H^{p+q}(U_1, DF'),$$

one obtains the relation

$$(***) H^i(U_1, DF') = 0 \text{ for } i > -n.$$

Conversely, suppose the preceding relation verified, for every U_1 étale over U , affine over S . Apply Proposition 3.6 by replacing S by $\bar{S}$; the hypotheses of 3.6 concerning S are satisfied, since for every scheme U_1 étale over U , affine, one can find a scheme over U_1 that comes by inverse image from an étale scheme over U affine over S ; as for the hypotheses concerning F , they are satisfied thanks to 2.3.3. One thus has, for every point u' of U' such that $(H^q(DF'))_{\bar{u}'} \neq 0$:

$$\delta_{t'}(u') \leq -n - q,$$

which is none other than the relation (**); one has therefore proved the equivalence

$$(ii)_t \Leftrightarrow (**).$$

We are going to transform the relation (***); one has first

$$H^i(U_1, DF') = H^i(Rf'_*(DF'_1))_{t'};$$

but by (SGA 5 I 1.12), there exists a canonical isomorphism

$$Rf'_*(DF'_1) \simeq D(R^!f'_1(F'_1)),$$

where $D(R^!f'_1(F'_1))$ denotes the dual of $R^!f'_1(F'_1)$ with respect to K . One sees thus that (ii)_t is equivalent to

$$(H^i(D(R^!f'_1(F'_1))))_{t'} = 0 \text{ for } i > -n.$$

Applying again the local duality theorem (SGA 5 I 4.5.3), but this time at the point t' , one finds

$$H^i(D(R^!f'_1(F'_1)))_{t'} \simeq D(H^{-i}_{t'}(R^!f'_1(F'_1))),$$

and finally (ii)_t is equivalent to the relation

$$H^i_{-}(t')(R^! f'_1(F'_1)) = 0 \text{ for } i < n,$$

that is, $\text{prof}_{t'}(R^! f'_1(F'_1)) \geq n$, which completes the proof of the theorem.

Remark 4.2.3.

The reasoning simplifies considerably when one supposes that S admits (at least locally) a dualizing complex (for example is locally immersible in a regular scheme). This avoids recourse to a completion (the passage to the strictly local case being immediate), to 2.3.3, and to the rather unpleasant technical statement 3.6, which one can then replace by the more sympathetic reference 3.7.

Corollary 4.3.

Let S be an excellent scheme of characteristic zero and $f : U \rightarrow S$ a separated morphism of finite type, such that U is the union of $c + 1$ open sets, affine over S . Let F be a complex of sheaves of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules, bounded below with constructible cohomology, n an integer, and T a closed part of S . Suppose that, for every point $u \in U$, one has

$$\text{prof}_u(F) \geq n - \delta_T(u).$$

Then one has

$$\text{prof}_T(R^! f(F)) \geq n - c.$$

Let indeed U_j , $0 \leq j \leq c$, be a covering of U by open sets U_j affine over S . Resuming the notations of the proof of 4.2, one has, for every j ,

$$H^i(U'_j, H^q(DF')) = 0 \text{ for } i > -n.$$

Using the spectral sequence relating the cohomology of U to that of the covering formed by the U_j (SGA 4 V 2.4), the preceding relation shows that one has

$$H^i(U', H^q(DF')) = 0 \text{ for } i > -n + c.$$

The corollary follows from the end of the proof of 4.2.

Corollary 4.4.

Let S be an excellent scheme of characteristic zero, $g : X \rightarrow S$ a morphism, U an open set of X , union of $c + 1$ opens affine over S , Y a closed subscheme with underlying space $X - U$, and $j : Y \rightarrow X$ the natural morphism. Let F be a complex of sheaves of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules on X , bounded below with constructible cohomology, T a closed part of S , and n an integer. Suppose that, for every point u of U , one has

$$\text{prof}_u(F) \geq n - \delta_T(u).$$

Then the canonical morphism

$$H^i_{-}(g^*[-1](T)!(X/S, F)) \rightarrow H^i_{-}((g^*[-1](T) \cap Y)!(Y/S, j^* F))$$

is bijective for $i < n - c - 1$, injective for $i = n - c - 1$.

This follows immediately from 4.1 and 4.3.

Corollary 4.5 (Local Lefschetz theorem).

Let S be an excellent henselian local scheme of characteristic zero, t the closed point of S , X a scheme proper over $S' = S - t$, and U an open set of X , union of $c + 1$ affine opens. Let Y be a closed subscheme of X with underlying space $X - U$, $j : Y \rightarrow X$ the canonical morphism, F a complex of sheaves of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules on X , bounded below with constructible cohomology, and n an integer. Suppose that, for every point u of U , one has

$$\text{prof}_u(F) \geq n - \delta_{\{t'\}}(u), \text{ where } \delta_{\{t'\}}(u) = \delta_t(u) - 1.$$

Then the canonical morphism

$$H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(Y, j^* F)$$

is bijective for $i < n - c - 1$, injective for $i = n - c - 1$.

Let $f : U \rightarrow S$ be the canonical morphism; it follows from 4.2, applied by replacing n by $n + 1$, that one has

$$\text{prof}_t(R^! f(F|_U)) \geq n + 1 - c.$$

The preceding relation shows that the canonical morphism

$$H^i(S, R^! f(F|_U)) \rightarrow H^i(S', R^! f(F|_U))$$

is bijective for $i < n - c$, injective for $i = n - c$. Since $R^! f(F|_U)$ is null outside S' , one has $H^i(S, R^! f(F|_U)) \simeq H^i(R^! f(F|_U))_t = 0$, and consequently

$$(*) H^i(S', R^! f(F|_U)) = 0 \text{ for } i < n - c.$$

Let $g : X \rightarrow S'$, $h : Y \rightarrow S'$, $f' : U \rightarrow S'$ be the canonical morphisms. It follows from the distinguished triangle

$$\begin{array}{ccc} R h_*(j^* F) & & \\ \nearrow & & \searrow \\ R^! f'(F|_U) & \longleftarrow & R g_*(F) \end{array}$$

that condition $(*)$ is equivalent to the fact that the morphism

$$H^i(S', R g_*(F)) \rightarrow H^i(S', R h_*(j^* F))$$

is bijective for $i < n - c - 1$, injective for $i = n - c - 1$. Since this morphism is canonically identified with the morphism

$$H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(Y, j^* F),$$

the conclusion follows immediately.

Corollary 4.6 (Global Lefschetz theorem).

Let S be the spectrum of a field, X a scheme proper over S , and U an open set of X union of $c + 1$ affine opens. Let Y be a closed subscheme of X with underlying space $X - U$, $j : Y \rightarrow X$ the canonical morphism, F a complex of sheaves of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules on X ,

bounded below with constructible cohomology, and n an integer. Suppose that, for every point u of U , one has

$$\text{prof}_u(F) \geq n - \dim(u).$$

Then the canonical morphism

$$H^i(X, F) \rightarrow H^i(Y, j^* F)$$

is bijective for $i < n - c - 1$, injective for $i = n - c - 1$.

More generally, if $g : X \rightarrow S$ is a separated morphism of finite type, the hypotheses on S , U , Y , F being the same as before, then the canonical morphism

$$H^i_!(X/S, F) \rightarrow H^i_!(Y/S, j^* F)$$

(where $H^i_!$ denotes cohomology with proper support, that is, $H^i_!(X/S, F) = H^i(S, R^!g(F))$) is bijective for $i < n - c - 1$, injective for $i = n - c - 1$.

The corollary is a particular case of 4.4, with $T = S$.

Here is a partial converse to 4.3:

Proposition 4.7.

Let S be a noetherian scheme, $f : U \rightarrow S$ a morphism of finite type. Suppose that there exists a dualizing complex K on S and that $R^!f(K)$ is a dualizing complex on U . Let T be a closed part of S and c an integer. Then the following conditions are equivalent:

- (i) For every complex of sheaves of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules F on U , bounded below with constructible cohomology, and for every integer n such that, for every point u of U ,

$$\text{prof}_u(F) \geq n - \delta_T(u),$$

one has

$$\text{prof}_T(R^!f(F)) \geq n - c.$$

- (ii) For every constructible sheaf of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules G on U and for every point $t \in T$, one has

$$(R^p f_*(G))_t = 0 \text{ for } p > \delta(G, f, t) + c$$

(let us recall from (SGA 4 XIX 6.0) that $\delta(G, f, t) = \sup \delta_t(u) | t \in u \text{ and } G_u \neq 0$).

N.B. Condition (ii) is satisfied by virtue of 3.1 if f is separated and if U is, locally on S for the étale topology, a union of $c + 1$ opens affine over S , so 4.7 contains 4.3.¹⁵¹

One can evidently suppose that S is local and that T is the closed point t of S .

¹⁵¹At least in the case where S admits locally a dualizing complex, for example S locally immersible in a regular scheme.

The proof of (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i) is essentially identical to part 2°) of the proof of 4.2. Let us show briefly that (i) $\Rightarrow$ (ii). The local duality theorem (SGA 5 I 4.3.2) applied to DG shows that

$$D H^i_u(DG) \simeq H^{-i-2\delta_t(u)}(G)_u.$$

Since G is reduced to degree 0, one therefore has $H^i_u(DG) = 0$ except perhaps for $i = -2\delta_t(u)$; more precisely

$$\text{prof}_u(DG) = \begin{cases} -2\delta_t(u) & \text{if } G_u \neq 0, \\ \infty & \text{if } G_u = 0. \end{cases}$$

It follows that one has, whatever $u \in U$:

$$\text{prof}_u(DG) \geq -n - \delta_t(u).$$

It then follows from hypothesis (i) that one has $\text{prof}_t(R^1 f(DG)) \geq -n - c$. One transforms this relation using the isomorphism $R^1 f(DG) \simeq D(Rf_*(G))$ (SGA 5 I 1.12) and applying the local duality theorem at the point t ; one obtains thus

$$H^i(Rf_*(G))_t = 0 \text{ for } i > n + c,$$

which is none other than (ii).

4.8. The hypotheses being those of 4.4 with g proper (resp. 4.5, resp. 4.6 with g proper), if V is an open neighborhood of Y in X , the morphism

$$H^i(V, F) \rightarrow H^i(Y, j^* F)$$

is bijective for $i < n - c - 1$, injective for $i = n - c - 1$. If $\iota : V \rightarrow X$ is the canonical morphism, it suffices indeed to see that one applies 4.4 (resp. 4.5, resp. 4.6) to the complex $R\iota_*(F|_V)$. One can ask whether the preceding morphism is bijective for $i = n - c - 1$, injective for $i = n - c$. It evidently suffices for the hypotheses to be verified when one replaces n by $n + 1$; the proposition that follows shows that it suffices to require a little less.

Proposition 4.9.

Let S be a local excellent scheme of characteristic zero with closed point t (resp. in addition to the preceding conditions, one supposes S henselian), $f : X \rightarrow S$ a scheme proper over S (resp. proper over $S - t$), and U an open set of X union of $c + 1$ affine opens. Let Y be a closed subscheme of X with underlying space $X - U$, $j : Y \rightarrow X$ the canonical morphism, F a complex of sheaves of $\mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}$ -modules on X , bounded below with constructible cohomology, and n an integer. Suppose that one has, for every point u of U ,

$$\text{prof}_u(F) \geq \inf(n - 1, n - \delta_t(u)) \quad (\text{resp. } \text{prof}_u(F) \geq \inf(n - 1, n + 1 - \delta_t(u))).$$

Then for every open neighborhood V of Y in X , the canonical morphism

$$H^i_{\{f^{-1}(-1)(t)\}}(V, F) \rightarrow H^i_{\{f^{-1}(-1)(t) \cap Y\}}(Y, j^* F) \quad (\text{resp. } H^i(V, F) \rightarrow H^i(Y, j^* F))$$

is bijective for $i < n - c - 2$ and injective for $i = n - c - 2$. Moreover, there exists an open neighborhood V_0 of Y in X such that, for every other such V with $V \subset V_0$, the canonical morphism

$$H^i_{\{f^{-1}\}(t) \cap V}(V, F) \rightarrow H^i_{\{f^{-1}\}(t) \cap Y}(Y, j^* F) \quad (\text{resp. } H^i(V, F) \rightarrow H^i(Y, j^* F))$$

is bijective for $i < n - c - 1$, injective for $i = n - c - 1$.

Proof. Let us set, for simplicity, $\delta_{t'}(u) = \delta_t(u)$ (resp. $\delta_{t'}(u) = \delta_t(u) - 1$). One deduces from 4.8 the first assertion of 4.9, since the hypotheses of 4.4 (resp. 4.5) are verified when one replaces n by $n - 1$. They are also verified for n itself, except at the points u such that $\delta_{t'}(u) = 0$. Now, for $u \in U$, to say that $\delta_{t'}(u) = 0$ is equivalent to saying that u is a closed point of U_t (resp. a closed point of X). Let E be the set of points of U such that $\delta_{t'}(u) = 0$; let us show that, for all the points $u \in E$, except a finite number, one has $\text{prof}_u(F) \geq n$. Let $\tilde{S}$ be the strict localization of S at t , S' the completion of $\tilde{S}$ with closed point t' , and consider the cartesian square

$$\begin{array}{ccc} U' & \xrightarrow{h} & U \\ | & & | \\ f' & & f \\ | & & | \\ v & & v \\ S' & \xrightarrow{g} & S. \end{array}$$

The depth hypotheses at the points of U are preserved when one replaces U by U' and F by the inverse image F' of F on U' . Indeed let $u' \in U'$ and $u = h(u')$. If $u \notin E$, one has the relation $\text{prof}_u(F) \geq n - \delta_{t'}(u)$, and it follows from 4.2.1 that this entails the relation $\text{prof}_{u'}(F') \geq n - \delta_{t'}(u')$. If $u \in E$, u' is a closed point of U'_t (resp. a closed point of $X' = X \times_S S'$), and since the fiber U'_u of h at u is of dimension zero and h regular, it follows from 1.16 that one has $\text{prof}_{u'}(F') = \text{prof}_u(F) \geq n - 1$.

Let then K be a dualizing complex on S' , normalized at the closed point t' , and DF' the dual of F' with respect to $R^1 f(K)$. By 4.2.2, the étale depth hypotheses at the points of U' translate by the relations:

$$(H^q(DF'))_{\{u'\}} = 0 \text{ for } q > -n - \delta_{t'}(u') \quad (\text{resp. } q > -n - 2 - \delta_{t'}(u')),$$

if u' is not a point of $E' = h^{-1}(E)$,

$$(H^q(DF'))_{\{u'\}} = 0 \text{ for } q > -(n - 1) \quad (\text{resp. } q > -n - 1), \text{ if } u' \in E'.$$

Let $G = H^{-(n-1)}(DF')$ (resp. $G = H^{-n-1}(DF')$); since G is a constructible sheaf, the set of points at which the geometric fiber is non-null is a constructible set (SGA 4 IX 2.4 (iv)); now by hypothesis this set is contained in the set E' of closed points of U'_t (resp. of points of U' closed in X'); it therefore follows from 4.9.1 below that this set reduces to a finite number of points. Applying 4.2.2, one sees that, for all the points of E' except a finite number, one has $\text{prof}_{u'}(F') \geq n$. It follows by 1.16 that, for all the points of E except a finite number, one has

$$\text{prof}_u(F) \geq n.$$

Let V be an open neighborhood of Y in X , contained in the complement in X of the finite set of points u of E for which one has $\text{prof}_u(F) = n - 1$. If $\iota : V \rightarrow X$ is the canonical immersion, let

$$F_1 = R\iota_*(F|_V);$$

then F_1 is a complex of sheaves on X with constructible cohomology (SGA 4 XIX 5.1) and bounded below. We shall see that, for every point u of U , the complex F_1 verifies the relation

$$(*) \operatorname{prof}_u(F_1) \geq n - \delta_{t'}(u).$$

If $u \in U \cap V$, one has $\operatorname{prof}_u(F_1) = \operatorname{prof}_u(F)$, and the relation $(*)$ is verified by hypothesis at the points of U not belonging to E ; for the latter, it is also verified by the choice of V . Finally, if $u \in U$ and $u \notin V$, one has by 1.6 g) $\operatorname{prof}_u(F_1) = \infty$. One then applies 4.4 (resp. 4.5) replacing F by F_1 ; one obtains the announced result, taking into account that one has, for every i :

$$H^i_{\{f^{-1}(-1)\}(t)}(X, R\iota_*(F|_V)) \simeq H^i_{\{f^{-1}(-1)\}(t) \cap V}(V, F) \quad (\text{resp. } H^i(X, R\iota_*(F|_V)) \simeq H^i(V, F)).$$

Lemma 4.9.1.

A constructible set E contained in the set of closed points of a noetherian scheme X is reduced to a finite number of points.

Indeed, E is a finite union of sets of the form $U \cap \mathbb{C}V$, where U and V are open sets of X ; by hypothesis all the points of $U \cap \mathbb{C}V$ are maximal points of this set, hence they are finite in number.

5. Geometrical depth

To apply 4.2 and its corollaries in practice, one needs a convenient criterion to verify the étale-depth hypotheses at the points of U . We shall give such a criterion, using the local Lefschetz theorem 4.5.

5.1. Let A be a noetherian local ring; when we speak of the étale depth of A , this will mean the depth at the closed point. We are going to introduce a notion of “geometrical depth of A ”, and use 4.5 to compare it to the étale depth $\operatorname{prof}^{\text{ét}}(A)$.

Proposition 5.2.

Let A be a noetherian local ring; suppose that A is isomorphic to a quotient of a regular local ring B by an ideal I (this is true, for example, when A is complete by virtue of the Cohen theorem (EGA 0_IV 19.8.8)). Let q be the minimal number of generators of I ; then the number $\dim(B) - q$ is independent of the choice of B .

The minimal number of generators of I is also equal to the rank of the k -vector space $I \otimes_B k$, where k denotes the residue field of A . One reduces immediately to the case where A is complete, since one has $\hat{A} \simeq \hat{B}/\hat{I}$ with $\dim \hat{B} = \dim B$ and $\operatorname{rg}_k(I \otimes_B k) = \operatorname{rg}_k(\hat{I} \otimes_{\hat{B}} k)$; for the same reason one can suppose B complete.

Let B and B' be two complete regular local rings, $f : B \rightarrow A$, $f' : B' \rightarrow A$ two surjective homomorphisms, and $I = \operatorname{Ker}(f)$, $I' = \operatorname{Ker}(f')$. One must show that

$$\dim B - \operatorname{rg}_k(I \otimes_B k) = \dim B' - \operatorname{rg}_k(I' \otimes_{B'} k).$$

Let us first place ourselves in the case where one has a factorization of the form

$$\begin{array}{ccc} B & \xrightarrow{f} & A \\ & \searrow & \swarrow \\ & g & f' \\ & \searrow & \swarrow \\ & B' & \end{array}$$

with g surjective. Let $J = \operatorname{Ker}(g)$; then $J \subset I$ and $I/J = I'$. Since B' is regular, $\dim(B') = \dim(B) - \operatorname{rg}_k(J \otimes_B k)$ and J is generated by elements forming part of a regular system of parameters of B . It follows that one has the exact sequence

$$0 \rightarrow J \otimes_B k \rightarrow I \otimes_B k \rightarrow J/I \otimes_{B'} k \rightarrow 0,$$

and consequently

$$\dim B - \operatorname{rg}_k(I \otimes_B k) = \dim B - \operatorname{rg}_k(J \otimes_B k) - \operatorname{rg}_k(J/I \otimes_{B'} k) = \dim B' - \operatorname{rg}_k(I' \otimes_{B'} k).$$

The general case reduces to the preceding; to see this, it suffices to show that one can find a complete regular local ring B'' and surjective homomorphisms $g : B'' \rightarrow B$ and $g' : B'' \rightarrow B'$, rendering commutative the diagram

$$(*) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} & B & \\ & \nearrow & \searrow f \\ g & & \backslash \\ B'' & & A \\ g' & & / \\ & \searrow & \nearrow f' \\ & B' & \end{array}$$

Now, if W is a Cohen ring with residue field k , one has a local morphism $W \rightarrow A$ that lifts to B and B' (EGA IV 19.8.6), so that one has the commutative diagram

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & B & \\ & \nearrow & \\ W & & A \\ & \searrow & \\ & B' & \end{array}$$

One can find integers n and n' and surjective morphisms $h : W[[T_1, \dots, T_n]] \rightarrow B$ and $h' : W[[T'_1, \dots, T'_{n'}]] \rightarrow B'$ that are morphisms of W -algebras (EGA 0_IV 19.8.8); if one then sets $B'' = W[[T_1, \dots, T_n, T'_1, \dots, T'_{n'}]]$ and if one defines g and g' as morphisms of W -algebras such that

$$g(T_i) = h(T_i), \quad g(T'_i) = h'(T'_i), \quad g'(T_i) = h(T_i), \quad g'(T'_i) = h'(T'_i),$$

where b_i (resp. b'_i) is an element of B (resp. of B') lifting $(f' \circ h')(T'_i)$ (resp. $(f \circ h)(T_i)$), the diagram $(*)$ is indeed commutative.

Proposition 5.2 justifies the following definition:

Definition 5.3.

Let A be a noetherian local ring, $\hat{A}$ its completion, which is therefore isomorphic to the quotient of a complete regular local ring B by an ideal I ; if q is the minimal number of generators of I , one calls geometrical depth of A the number

$$\text{prof.géom}(A) = \dim B - q.$$

Proposition 5.4.

Let A be a noetherian local ring. Then one has

$$\text{prof.gom}(A) \leq \dim A,$$

and one has equality if and only if A is a complete intersection.

One can suppose A complete. Let then $A = B/I$, where B is a complete regular local ring and I an ideal of B . If $(x_1, \dots, x_q)$ is a minimal system of generators of I , one has $\dim A \geq \dim B - q$, and to say that $\dim A = \dim B - q$ is equivalent to saying that $(x_1, \dots, x_q)$ forms part of a system of parameters of B (EGA 0_IV 16.3.7); the proposition follows immediately.

Proposition 5.5.

Let A and A' be noetherian local rings, $f : A \rightarrow A'$ a local homomorphism. Suppose that f is flat and that, denoting by k the residue field of A , $A' \otimes_A k$ is a field, a separable extension of k . Then one has

$$\text{prof.gom}(A) = \text{prof.gom}(A').$$

By replacing A and A' by their completions, one can suppose A and A' complete (it follows from (EGA 0_III 10.2.1) that the flatness hypothesis is preserved and this is evident for the other hypotheses). Let then $A = B/I$, where B is a regular local ring and I an ideal of B . Since A' is formally smooth over A (EGA 0_IV 19.8.2), it follows from (EGA 0_IV 19.7.2) that one can find a complete noetherian local ring B' and a local homomorphism $B \rightarrow B'$ such that B' is a flat B -module and $B' \otimes_B A \simeq A'$. One therefore has $A' \simeq B'/IB'$; moreover the ring B' is regular; indeed, if $\mathfrak{m}$ is the maximal ideal of B , $\mathfrak{m}B'$ is the maximal ideal of B' , and since $\mathfrak{m}$ is generated by a regular sequence by definition of “regular”, $\mathfrak{m}B'$ is generated by a B' -regular sequence (EGA 0_IV 15.1.14). Since one evidently has $\dim B = \dim B'$, and since I and IB' have the same minimal number of generators, the assertion follows.

Theorem 5.6.¹⁵²

¹⁵²Editors' note: Illusie has since shown the inequality $\text{prof}_x(\mathbb{Z}/\ell^\nu\mathbb{Z}) \geq \text{prof.gom}_x(X/S) - \delta(x) + 1$ for x a point of X a scheme of finite type over a trait S of residual characteristic prime to ℓ , and $\nu \geq 1$. If S is of characteristic zero, this is a consequence of theorem 5.6; see (Illusie L., “Perversité et variation”, Manuscripta Math. 112 (2003), p. 271-295).

Let A be an excellent local ring of characteristic zero. Then one has

$$prof^{\acute{e}t}(A) \geq prof.gom(A).$$

One can suppose A strictly local complete, since the geometrical depth and the étale depth are preserved by passage to the strict henselization and to the completion by 5.5 and 1.16. Let $A \simeq B/I$, where B is a complete regular local ring, and let $(f_1, \dots, f_q)$ be a minimal system of generators of the ideal I . One therefore has

$$\pi = prof.g\acute{e}om(A) = \dim B - q.$$

Consider the closed immersion

$$Y = \text{Spec } A \rightarrow X = \text{Spec } B,$$

and let $U = X - Y = \bigcup_{1 \leq i \leq q} X_{f_i}$. If a denotes the closed point of X , one must show that, for every prime number p , one has

$$H^i_a(Y, \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}) = 0 \text{ for } i < \pi.$$

Since B is regular excellent, one has $prof^{\acute{e}t}(B) = 2 \dim X$ (cf. 1.10) and consequently $H^i_a(X, \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}) = 0$ for $i < 2 \dim X$. To prove the theorem, it therefore suffices to show that the morphism

$$(*) H^i_a(X, \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow H^i_a(Y, \mathbb{Z}/p\mathbb{Z})$$

is bijective for $i < \pi$. One applies for this the local Lefschetz theorem 4.5 with $n = \pi + q - 1$, $c = q - 1$, so $n - c = \pi$. Note that $U = X - Y$ is the union of the q affine opens X_{f_i} . Let us show that one has, for every point u of U :

$$prof^{\acute{e}t}_u(X) \geq \pi + q - 1 - \dim(\{u\}) = \dim O_{X,u}$$

(where u denotes the closure of u in $X - a$). Indeed it follows from 1.10 that one has

$$prof^{\acute{e}t}_u(X) = 2 \dim O_{X,u} \geq \dim O_{X,u}.$$

Using 4.5, one sees that $(*)$ is bijective for $i < \pi$, which completes the proof of the theorem.

Corollary 5.7.

Let S be the spectrum of a field of characteristic zero (resp. an excellent henselian local scheme of characteristic zero), $f : X \rightarrow S$ a scheme proper over S (resp. over $S - s$). Let U be a union of $c + 1$ affine opens of X , Y a closed subscheme with underlying space $X - U$, n and m positive integers. Suppose that, for every point u of U , one has

$$prof.gom(O_{X,u}) \geq n - \dim(u)$$

(u closure of u in X). Then the canonical morphism

$$H^i(X, \mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow H^i(Y, \mathbb{Z}/m\mathbb{Z})$$

is bijective for $i < n - c - 1$, injective for $i = n - c - 1$.

One applies 4.5 and 4.6. The étale-depth hypotheses at the points of U are verified, since by 5.6

$$\text{prof}^{\text{ét}}_u(X) \geq \text{prof.géom}(O_{\{X,u\}}) \geq n - \dim(\{u\}).$$

6. Open questions

6.1. One can ask whether the implication (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i) of 4.2 is valid more generally for torsion sheaves F , not necessarily annihilated by a given integer m

and not necessarily constructible. In the case where S is not of characteristic zero, it seems possible that this implication remains valid, even for p -torsion sheaves (p the residual characteristic). Finally it is not clear either that the hypothesis S excellent cannot be lifted.

6.2. Let X be a scheme proper over a field k , or the complement of the closed point of a henselian local scheme, and $j : Y \rightarrow X$ a closed subscheme of X whose complement U is affine. Then, if F is a sheaf of sets on X or a sheaf of not-necessarily-commutative groups, the statements 4.5 or 4.6 and 4.9 still have a meaning for such an F , provided one restricts to small values of n . If u is a point of U , one denotes by $\bar{u}$ a geometric point above u , by $X_{(\bar{u})}$ the strict localization of X at $\bar{u}$, and by $F_{\bar{u}}$ the fiber of F at $\bar{u}$. Then, by making possibly certain hypotheses on X and on F , for example by supposing X excellent (possibly of characteristic zero, or of equal characteristic by using resolution of singularities) and F ind-finite (or if needed even L -ind-finite with L prime to the characteristic of X), one would like to prove the following statements:

- a) Let F be a sheaf of sets (resp. a sheaf of groups) and suppose that, for every point u of U , one has

$$F_{\bar{u}} \rightarrow H^0(X_{\{(\bar{u})\}} - \bar{u}, F) \text{ injective if } \dim(\{u\}) \leq 1$$

(that is, for such a u , one has $\text{prof}_u(F) \geq 1$). Then, when V runs over the set

of open neighborhoods of Y , the canonical morphism

$$\lim \rightarrow V H^0(V, F) \rightarrow H^0(Y, j^* F)$$

is bijective (resp. one has the preceding conclusion and moreover the morphism $\lim \rightarrow V H^1(V, F) \rightarrow H^1(Y, j^* F)$ is injective). If F is constructible, one can replace the $\lim \rightarrow$ by the cohomology of V for V “small enough”.

- b) Let F be a sheaf of sets (resp. a sheaf of groups) and suppose that, for every point u of U , one has $\text{prof}_u(F) \geq 2 - \dim(u)$, which translates also by the relations

$$F_{\bar{u}} \rightarrow H^0(X_{\{(\bar{u})\}} - \bar{u}, F) \text{ is bijective if } \dim(\{u\}) = 0$$

$$F_{\bar{u}} \rightarrow H^0(X_{\{(\bar{u})\}} - \bar{u}, F) \text{ is injective if } \dim(\{u\}) = 1.$$

Then the canonical morphism

$$H^0(X, F) \rightarrow H^0(Y, j^* F)$$

is bijective (resp. one has the preceding conclusion and moreover the morphism $H^1(X, F) \rightarrow H^1(Y, j^* F)$ is injective).

c) Let F be an ind-finite sheaf of groups. Suppose that, for every point u of U , one has

$F_u \rightarrow H^0(X_{\{u\}} - \bar{u}, F)$ bijective if $\dim(\{u\}) = 0$ or 1 ,
 $F_u \rightarrow H^0(X_{\{u\}} - \bar{u}, F)$ injective if $\dim(\{u\}) = 2$.

Then, when V runs over the set of open neighborhoods of Y , the canonical morphisms

$\lim \rightarrow V H^0(V, F) \rightarrow H^0(Y, j^* F)$ and $\lim \rightarrow V H^1(V, F) \rightarrow H^1(Y, j^* F)$

are bijective. If F is constructible, one can replace the $\lim \rightarrow$ by the cohomology of V for V small enough.

d) Let F be a sheaf of groups. Suppose that, for every point u of U , one has $\text{prof}_u(F) \geq 3 - \dim(u)$, which translates also by the conditions

$F_u \rightarrow H^0(X_{\{u\}} - \bar{u}, F)$ bijective, and $H^1(X_{\{u\}} - \bar{u}, F) = 0$ if $\dim(\{u\}) = 0$,
 $F_u \rightarrow H^0(X_{\{u\}} - \bar{u}, F)$ bijective if $\dim(\{u\}) = 1$,
 $F_u \rightarrow H^0(X_{\{u\}} - \bar{u}, F)$ injective if $\dim(\{u\}) = 2$.

Then the canonical morphisms

$H^0(X, F) \rightarrow H^0(Y, j^* F)$ and $H^1(X, F) \rightarrow H^1(Y, j^* F)$

are bijective.

As an indication in favor of these statements¹⁵³, we mention XIII 2.1, X 3.4 and XII 3.5. Note that, thanks to the argument of 4.8 and 4.9, statement a) (resp. c)) would follow from b) (resp. d)).

6.3. From d) would follow the statement, analogous to 5.6: if A is a noetherian local ring (possibly excellent) and if $\text{prof.gom}(A) \geq 3$, then one has

$\text{prof}^{hop}(A) \geq 3$. To see this, one realizes $Y' = \text{Spec } A$ as a closed subset of a regular local scheme $X' = \text{Spec } B$, whose complement is a union of q affine opens, with the relation $\dim B - q = \text{prof.gom}(A)$. One has, for every point x of X' , if $n = \dim B$, $\text{prof}^{hop}_x(X) \geq \inf(3, n - \dim(\{x\}))$ (cf. 1.11), and one deduces from d) that this entails $\text{prof}^{hop}_y(Y') \geq \inf(3, n - q - \dim(\{y\}))$ for every point y of Y' . The result is obtained then by taking for y the closed point of Y' .

6.4. A variant of 4.2, at least of the implication (ii) $\Rightarrow$ (i), should still be valid in the complex analytic case, provided one works with “analytically constructible” sheaves (cf. XIII); the proof would be analogous to that of 4.2, using the duality theory of J.-L. Verdier. Note, on the other hand, that for the complex analytic analogue of the non-commutative variants signalled in 6.2, one does not even have a method of attack for the statements concerning the fundamental group suggested by the results of Exposés X, XII, XIII recalled at the end of 6.2.

¹⁵³Editors' note: all the statements of 6.2, apart from the constructible variants, have been proved by Mme Raynaud; see (Raynaud M., “Théorèmes de Lefschetz en cohomologie des faisceaux cohérents et en cohomologie étale. Application au groupe fondamental”, Ann. Sci. Éc. Norm. Sup. (4) 7 (1974), p. 29-52, corollary III.1.3).

The methods of the Séminaire indeed seem irremediably tied to the case of finite coverings (which can be studied in terms of coherent sheaves of algebras).

Bibliography

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3. J.-L. Verdier — *Des catégories dérivées des catégories abéliennes*, with a preface by Luc Illusie, edited by Georges Maltsiniotis, Astérisque, vol. 239, Société mathématique de France, Paris, 1996.

Footnotes

SGA 2: Local Cohomology of Coherent Sheaves and Local and Global Lefschetz Theorems

Séminaire de Géométrie Algébrique du Bois-Marie, 1962.

A. Grothendieck (with collaborators I. Giorgiutti, J. Giraud, M. Hakim née Jaffe, A. Laudal). Augmented by Exposé XIV of Mme Michèle Raynaud (1967). Revised reprint, IHÉS, Bures-sur-Yvette, April 1968. Modern LaTeX edition by Yves Laszlo *et al.* (2005).

Abstract

This volume develops the theory of local cohomology of coherent sheaves on noetherian schemes and applies it to prove local and global theorems of Lefschetz type — for the fundamental group, the Picard group, and projective algebraic schemes — through a systematic interplay between local results and global ones. Exposés I–II set up the formalism of cohomology with supports $H_Y^i(X, F)$; III relates it to the classical notion of depth; IV–V develop local duality and dualizing modules in the style later subsumed by Hartshorne’s *Residues and Duality*; VI–VIII prove the central finiteness theorem for $H_Y^i(F)$; IX uses it to obtain comparison and existence theorems in formal geometry, parallel to those of EGA III for proper morphisms; X–XII apply these to Lefschetz-type theorems for π_1 , Pic, and projective schemes; XIII surveys open problems; and Raynaud’s XIV recasts the Lefschetz theorems in étale cohomology, drawing on SGA 4 and SGA 5.

Reading order

Files are numbered so alphanumeric order matches reading order.

- Title page, preface (Laszlo), and table of contents
- Introduction (Grothendieck, 1968)
- Exposé I — Global and local cohomological invariants with respect to a closed subspace
- Exposé II — Application to quasi-coherent sheaves on preschemes

- Exposé III — Cohomological invariants and depth
- Exposé IV — Dualizing modules and dualizing functors
- Exposé V — Local duality and the structure of the $H^i(M)$
- Exposé VI — The functors $Ext_Z^\bullet(X; F, G)$ and $Ext_Z^\bullet(F, G)$
- Exposé VII — Vanishing criteria and coherence conditions for the sheaves $Ext_Y^i(F, G)$
- Exposé VIII — The finiteness theorem
- Exposé IX — Algebraic geometry and formal geometry
- Exposé X — Application to the fundamental group
- Exposé XI — Application to the Picard group
- Exposé XII — Applications to projective algebraic schemes
- Exposé XIII — Problems and conjectures
- Exposé XIV — Depth and Lefschetz theorems in étale cohomology (Raynaud)
- Index of notation
- Terminological index
- Translation glossary

Reference convention

Following the source, SGA 2 is cited as (Exp. N, M.K) where N is the Exposé Roman numeral and M.K is the decimal numbering inside that Exposé — for example (VIII, 2.3) for Théorème 2.3 of Exposé VIII. The 1968 revised reprint introduced a uniform decimal numbering across Exposés III–VIII; the original 1962 numbering is occasionally preserved with the adverb *bis* where collisions occurred. Cross-references to other SGA volumes follow the same source conventions (e.g. SGA 4 IV 3.8).

Editorial conventions

- **Terminology.** Exposés I–XIII keep the historical SGA/EGA distinction between *prescheme* (préschéma) and *scheme* (schéma, in the older sense of separated prescheme). Exposé XIV, added in 1967 by Raynaud, explicitly adopts the modern usage in which *scheme* means what was previously called *prescheme*, and *separated scheme* means what was previously called *scheme*; her opening footnote announces this. The translation honors that per-Exposé split; a translator note at the head of Exposé XIV recalls it.
- **Editor footnotes (N.D.E.).** The 2005 LaTeX edition by Yves Laszlo *et al.* added footnotes (*Notes de l'éditeur*, abbreviated *N.D.E.*) recording corrections, updates, and the current status of questions raised in the original. In this translation, original Grothendieck-era footnotes use slugs like $[I - 3 - 1]$, while editor footnotes use $[^N.D.E - IV - 2]$ so the two are visibly distinct.
- **Page marks.** HTML comments `<!-- original page N -->` mark the start of page N in the 1968 IHÉS edition, whose pagination is preserved in the margin of the modern LaTeX edition.
- **Mathematics.** Mathematics is written with Unicode and wrapped in backticks where

formatter mangling is a risk. Displayed equations use fenced ````text` blocks, optionally pinned with `<!-- label: eq:N.X.Y -->`.

- **The Γ_Z / Γ_Z distinction.** SGA 2 systematically uses an underlined Γ_Z for the *sheafified* version of the sections-with-support functor and a non-underlined Γ_Z for the global-section version. The translation preserves this; where the source OCR has lost the underline, the surrounding French reveals which functor is meant. A small typographic note at first use in each Exposé fixes the convention there.

Provenance

This is a translation, not a critical edition. The authoritative text remains the French 2005 LaTeX edition, derived from the IHÉS/North-Holland 1968 reprint as recomposed by Y. Laszlo. For any claim that matters mathematically, consult the source: this English version exists to make the volume readable, not to replace it.

Glossary and Translation Ledger — SGA 2

This file records the translation choices made for the SGA 2 Markdown translation. It is the authoritative reference for the parallel translators of individual Exposés; every translator must consult it before drafting and must obey it where it applies.

Core terminology

French	English	Note
préschéma	prescheme	Historical SGA/EGA term. Used through Exposés I–XIII. <i>Not</i> silently modernized.
schéma	scheme	In Exposés I–XIII, denotes a separated prescheme. In Exposé XIV, the modern meaning (= prescheme of Exp. I–XIII), per Raynaud’s opening footnote.
schéma séparé (Exp. XIV)	separated scheme	Raynaud’s modern terminology in Exposé XIV.
faisceau	sheaf	Standard.
faisceau (quasi-)cohérent	(quasi-)coherent sheaf	Standard.
espace annelé	ringed space	Standard.
espace topologique	topological space	Standard.
application	map	“Function” only in elementary set-theoretic contexts.
morphisme	morphism	Standard.
morphisme étale / lisse /	étale / smooth / flat / proper	Standard; matches SGA 1 glossary.
plat / propre	morphism	
revêtement étale	étale covering	Per SGA 1 glossary.

French	English	Note
immersion / immersion	immersion / closed	Standard.
fermée / ouverte	immersion / open immersion	
ouvert / fermé / localement fermé	open / closed / locally closed	Standard.
voisinage	neighborhood	American spelling.
recouvrement	covering	“Cover” only in casual prose.
corps	field	False friend: not “body”.
anneau	ring	Commutative by SGA convention unless stated.
anneau local (noethérien)	(noetherian) local ring	Standard.
anneau local régulier	regular local ring	Standard.
corps résiduel	residue field	Denoted $\kappa(x)$ or $\kappa(A)$ (per SGA 1).
module de type fini	finitely generated module	“Of finite type” if matching adjacent SGA 1 prose.
de type fini (morphisme, présentation)	of finite type	Morphism-level terminology, EGA-standard.
catégorie	category	Standard.
foncteur /	functor /	Standard.
foncteur dérivé	derived functor	
foncteur exact / exact à gauche / à droite	exact / left exact / right exact functor	Standard.
sous-foncteur	subfunctor	Standard.
catégorie dérivée $D^+(X)$	derived category $D^+(X)$	Used principally in Exposé XIV.
catégorie abélienne	abelian category	Standard.
limite projective / inductive	inverse / direct limit	Modern English. Flag the SGA-era usage in a translator note on first occurrence per Exposé.
fibre	fiber	American spelling.
spécialisation	specialization	American spelling.
canonique	canonical	Do <i>not</i> translate as “natural” unless the source specifically appeals to naturality.
fonctoriel	functorial	Standard.
naturel	natural	Reserve for genuine naturality.

French	English	Note
à	up to	Standard.
isomorphisme	isomorphism	
près		
nécessaire et	necessary and	Sometimes “if and only if” in theorem statements.
suffisant	sufficient	
si et seulement	if and only if	“Iff” only if local idiom permits.
si		

SGA 2 topics

French	English	Note
cohomologie	local cohomology	Title-level. Not “cohomology locally”.
locale		
cohomologie à	cohomology with supports in Y	Match the SGA 1 phrasing.
support dans Y		
$H_Y^i(X, F)$	$H_Y^i(X, F)$	Global, non-underlined.
(sections with		
support)		
$\mathcal{H}_Y^i(F)$	$\mathcal{H}_Y^i(F)$	Use the script-H Unicode $\mathcal{H}$ to mark the sheafified functor. Where OCR drops the underline, the surrounding French reveals which is meant.
(sheafified,		
underlined in		
source)		Global, non-underlined functor.
Γ_Z (global	Γ_Z	
sections with		
support in Z)		
ΓZ underlined	Γ_Z (sheafified) — render as	The translator should pin the
(sheafified)	ΓZ or Γ_Z with a one-line	convention at first use in each Exposé.
	typographic note at first use per	
	Exposé.	
sorite	sorites	Loanword, kept (per SGA 1).
dévissage	dévissage	Loanword, kept.
Hartogs	Hartogs phenomenon	Standard.
(phénomène de		
—)		
profondeur	depth	Standard.
profondeur co-	cohomological depth	Per source index.
homologique		
profondeur	étale depth	Per source index.
étale		
profondeur	homotopical depth	Per source index.
homotopique		

French	English	Note
profondeur homotopique rectifiée	rectified homotopical depth	Per source index.
profondeur géométrique	geometrical depth	Per source index. (“Geometrical” with -ical, as the index uses it.)
M -régulier anneau de Cohen-Macaulay	M -regular Cohen-Macaulay ring	For sequences regular on M . Standard.
théorème de comparaison	comparison theorem	Per source index.
théorème d’existence	existence theorem	Per source index.
théorème de finitude	finiteness theorem	Per source index.
théorème de dualité (locale / projective)	(local / projective) duality theorem	Per source index.
théorème d’excision	excision theorem	Per source index.
module dualisant / foncteur dualisant	dualizing module / dualizing functor	Per source index.
enveloppe injective	injective envelope	Per source index.
extension essentielle	essential extension	Per source index.
forme résidu	residue form	Per source index.
résolution injective / projective	injective / projective resolution	Standard.
résolution flasque	flasque (flabby) resolution	Use “flasque” (the SGA term) inline; “flabby” only if the local prose already uses it.
faisceau flasque	flasque sheaf	Per SGA usage.
faisceau mou / fin	soft / fine sheaf	Less common in SGA 2; if encountered, use these renderings.
suite spectrale	spectral sequence	Standard.
terme initial / aboutissement	initial term / abutment	Standard.
homomorphisme de Gysin	Gysin homomorphism	Per source index.

French	English	Note
théorème de pureté de Zariski-Nagata	Zariski-Nagata purity theorem	Per source index.
théorème de pureté cohomologique	cohomological purity theorem	Per source index.
théorème de semi-pureté cohomologique	cohomological semi-purity theorem	Per source index.
couple parafactoriel de préschémas	parafactorial pair of preschemes	Per source index. (“Pair” preserves the <i>couple</i> sense.)
anneau local parafactoriel	parafactorial local ring	Per source index.
anneau local pur	pure local ring	Per source index.
couple pur de préschémas	pure pair of preschemes	Per source index.
géométriquement factoriel / parafactoriel	geometrically factorial / parafactorial	Per source index.
anneau strictement local	strictly local ring	Per source index.
condition de Lefschetz	Lefschetz condition	Per source index.
condition de Lefschetz effective	effective Lefschetz condition	Per source index.
théorème de Lefschetz affine	affine Lefschetz theorem	Per source index.
théorèmes de Lefschetz (du type —)	Lefschetz-type theorems / Lefschetz theorems	Either rendering, depending on rhythm.
groupes d’homotopie locale	local homotopy groups	Per source index.
platitude normale	normal flatness	Standard.
complétion formelle	formal completion	Standard.

French	English	Note
complété formel (de X le long de Y) section hyperplane schéma algébrique projectif théorème de représentabil- ité de Brown Tôhoku	formal completion (of X along Y) hyperplane section projective algebraic scheme Brown’s representability theorem <i>Tôhoku</i>	Standard; the hat $\hat{X}$ notation is preserved. Standard. Title-level for Exposé XII. If cited in N.D.E. footnotes. Cite as the journal/article; italicize.

Proof movement

These follow *references/french – math – idiom.md* of the translation skill, with SGA-specific tweaks.

French	English	Note
Soit / Soient X / X et Y	Let X / X and Y be	Match singular / plural.
Supposons (que)	Suppose (that) / Assume	“Assume” if the sentence is a hypothesis register.
Posons	Set / Put	“Put” for variable assignments; “Set” for ad-hoc definitions.
Notons	Denote / Write / Note	Choose by what follows; <i>Notons que</i> is “Note that”.
On a	We have	Not “one has” except for register.
On en déduit	We deduce	“It follows” if the inference is non-trivial.
Montrons (que)	We show (that)	“It remains to show” if it closes a reduction.
Il suffit de	It suffices to	Standard.
Il reste à montrer	It remains to show	Standard.
Il en résulte (que) /	It follows (that) / It	Choose by structure; “hence” in compact proof prose.
Il résulte (de)	follows (from)	Avoid “as a result of this”.
Par suite	Consequently / hence	“Whence” only if register supports it.
D’où	Hence / whence	Standard introduces a justification.
En effet	Indeed	Pivot conjunction; “but” only if the sentence really contrasts.
Or	Now	
Donc	Thus / hence / so	Choose by rhythm.
D’une part ... d’autre part	On the one hand ... on the other hand	Keep both clauses.

French	English	Note
Cela achève la démonstration	This completes the proof	Standard.
CQFD	QED	Or “This proves the claim.”
à savoir	namely	Standard.
compte tenu de	taking into account / in view of	Choose by clause weight.
en vertu de	by virtue of / by	“By” usually suffices.
moyennant	by means of / using	Standard.
quitte à	(possibly) by ... / replacing X by Y if necessary	A standard French move; “replacing X by Y if necessary” reads best in English.
à condition que	provided that	Standard.
dès que	as soon as	Standard.
chaque fois que	whenever	Standard.

Modality and certainty

Preserve modality exactly; do *not* upgrade certainty.

French	English
il est clair que	it is clear that
il est évident que	it is evident that
manifestement / il est manifeste que	manifestly / it is manifest that
il semble que	it seems that
on s’attend à ce que	one expects that
il est probable que	it is probable that
sans doute	doubtless / probably (context-dependent)
conjecturalement	conjecturally
il y a tout lieu de penser que	there is every reason to think that
on peut conjecturer	one may conjecture
il n’est pas exclu que	it is not excluded that
il se peut que	it may be that
vraisemblablement	presumably

Common OCR repairs

These recur across the source files. Apply them locally as the translator reads each block; do not silently “correct” the mathematics — only repair what the OCR clearly mangled, and flag anything genuinely ambiguous with a <!-- TRANSLATOR NOTE: ... --> comment.

- **Dropped sub/superscripts on big operators.** Γ , H^i , Ext^i , $R^i f_*$, O_X , $H^\bullet$, $H_\bullet$ routinely lose their indices. The surrounding French sentence almost always names

them (“la cohomologie locale de F le long de Y ”, “les H^i de F ”, etc.); recover from context.

- **Underline loss on sheafified functors.** SGA 2 distinguishes ΓZ (the global section functor — non-underlined) from $\underline{\Gamma Z}$ (the sheafified functor — underlined). The OCR routinely loses the underline. In the translation, render the sheafified functor with a script- $\mathcal{H}$ for the cohomology version ($\mathcal{H}_Y^i(F)$) and keep an explicit ΓZ for the underlined section functor, pinning the convention at first use per Exposé with a small note.
- **Hat across line break.** Formal-completion hats break across lines: $Et(b/X)$ is $\hat{Et}(\hat{X})$. X b after a closing paren is $\hat{X}$. Repair as needed.
- **OCR substitutions for arrows.**
 - $\rightarrow$ is $\mapsto$.
 - $\rightarrow$ is $\rightarrow$.
 - $\sim$ (often broken across lines) is $\cong$.
 - $\leadsto$ (OCR artefact, with literal newline) is $\xrightarrow{\sim}$ or $\rightarrow$ annotated with $\sim$; pick the rendering that matches what is being claimed.
- **OCR substitutions for accents.**
 - $Et(X)$ should be $\hat{Et}(X)$ (the étale site / category of étale objects).
 - étale should be étale.
 - Tohoku should be *Tôhoku*.
- **Greek subscripts.** π_1, π_0, H_1, H_0 etc. should be π_1, π_0, H^1, H^0 etc. (Unicode), inside backticks.
- **Math run-ons.** When a displayed equation has been broken into prose by the OCR, restore it as a fenced text block. - **Embedded N.D.E. footnotes.** Source convention is $(N)N.D.E. :< text >$ at the bottom of a page. Recover the whole footnote (which may span lines) and render it as $[^N.D.E-N]$ (or $[^N.D.E- < expose > - < n >]$ if multiple Exposés might collide) with its English translation in the footnote body. - **Dash lead-ins.** Statement bodies preceded by — in the source (after Proposition X.Y., *ThormeX.Y.*, etc.) are rendered SGA 1-style: bold keyword on its own line, then a paragraph break, then the body.

Cross-Exposé additions (discovered during translation)

Consolidated from the per-Exposé ledger deltas appended at the foot of each translation file. Refer to that file for the original context. New cross-cutting terms encountered during translation:

French	English	Note
sous-faisceau	subsheaf	Standard.
extension par 0 (en dehors de Z)	extension by 0 (outside Z)	Standard for $j_!$ constructions.
famille de supports (au sens de Cartan)	family of supports (in Cartan’s sense)	Kept verbatim from the source.
à support dans Z	with support in Z	Standard.

French	English	Note
faisceautiser	“sheafify”	In quotes when the source treats it as a coinage.
par abus de langage	by abuse of language	Standard.
à valeurs dans	with values in	Standard.
aboutissement	abutment	Of a spectral sequence.
terme initial	initial term	Of a spectral sequence.
immersion canonique	canonical immersion	Standard.
partie localement fermée	locally closed subset	Standard.
suite exacte de cohomologie relative	exact sequence of relative cohomology	Standard.
∂ -foncteur / δ -foncteur	∂ -functor / δ -functor	Preserve Grothendieck’s distinction.
foncteur cohomologique universel	universal cohomological functor	Standard.
système projectif essentiellement nul	essentially zero projective system	Standard SGA terminology.
opérateur bord	boundary operator	Standard.
cohomologie de Koszul / complexe de Koszul	Koszul cohomology / Koszul complex	Standard.
Module, Idéal, Algèbre (capitalised)	Module, Ideal, Algebra (capitalised)	Per SGA convention for sheaves of modules/ideals/algebras. Preserve case.
annulateur	annihilator	Standard.
assassin de M	“assassin of M ”	Bourbaki idiom; kept in quotes with explanatory gloss.
racine de a	radical of a	Symbol $r(a)$ preserved.
M -régulier (élément, suite)	M -regular (element, sequence)	Per glossary; matches the depth taxonomy.
homothétie de rapport a	multiplication by a	“Homothety of ratio” is unidiomatic in module-theoretic prose.
suite régulière	regular sequence	Standard.
anneau semi-local	semi-local ring	Standard.
codimension homologique ($\text{cod}h_A M$)	homological codimension ($\text{cod}h_A M$)	Older terminology for depth; symbol preserved.
platitude / fidèlement plat	flatness / faithfully flat	Standard.
antifiltre	antifilter	Order-theoretic loanword.
chaîne (condition des chaînes)	chain (chain condition)	Standard.

French	English	Note
connexe en codimension $d - 1$	connected in codimension $d - 1$	Standard.
ensemblissement intersection complète (absolue)	set-theoretically (absolute) complete intersection	Standard. Standard.
image directe supérieure	higher direct image	$R^i f_*$ notation preserved.
Module gradué	graded Module	Capital preserved per SGA convention.
modules gradués	graded modules	Lowercase when context is module-level, not sheaf-of-modules.
résolution injective	injective resolution	Standard.
augmentation canonique	canonical augmentation	Standard.
homotopes à zéro	homotopic to zero	Standard.
accouplement	pairing	Standard.
théorème des syzygies	syzygy theorem	Hilbert's syzygy theorem.
théorème de Cohen	Cohen's theorem	Structure theorem for complete local rings.
dimension homologique globale	global homological dimension	Standard.
système de paramètres	system of parameters	Standard.
composantes irréductibles	irreducible components	Standard.
point générique	generic point	Standard.
morphisme déduit de f par passage aux complétés	morphism deduced from f by passing to the completions	Standard SGA proof movement.
idéal de définition	ideal of definition	Standard.
I' -bonne (filtration)	I' -good (filtration)	EGA terminology for "good filtration".
morphisme adique	adic morphism	Standard EGA term.
condition de Mittag-Leffler	uniform Mittag-Leffler condition	Standard.
uniforme		
préschéma formel	formal prescheme	Standard.
anneau noethérien	noetherian adic ring	Standard.
adique		
séparé et complet pour la topologie I -adique	separated and complete for the I -adic topology	Standard.
anneau gradué associé	associated graded ring gr_I	Standard.
gr_I		
Module inversible	invertible Module	Capital preserved per source.

French	English	Note
pleinement fidèle	fully faithful	Standard.
factoriel / factoriel en codimension $\geq k$	factorial / factorial in codimension $\geq k$	Standard (unique factorization).
critère de normalité de Serre	Serre's criterion of normality	Standard.
diviseur principal / localement principal	principal / locally principal divisor	Standard.
diviseur de Cartier	Cartier divisor	Standard.
anneau de valuation discrète	discrete valuation ring	Standard.
résolution libre finie	finite free resolution	Standard.
dimension cohomologique	cohomological dimension	Standard.
dimension projective (dp)	projective dimension (dp)	Auslander–Buchsbaum formula context.
base de filtre	filter base	“Decreasing filtered family” per N.D.E.
algébrisable	algebraizable	Standard formal-geometry term.
Hauptidealsatz	Hauptidealsatz	Krull's principal-ideal theorem; kept untranslated.
canularesque (Grothendieck slang)	farcical / a farce	From canular (hoax). Preserves the joking register.
Je dis que	I claim that	Preserves the first-person move.
“point-base”	“base-point”	In quotation marks.

Style anchors (style is non-negotiable for cross-volume consistency)

These are inherited from SGA 1's translation; deviate only if SGA 1 itself is inconsistent.

- **File naming.** 00-title-preface.md, 00-introduction.md, NN-<slug>.md for Exposés, glossary.md, zz-index-*.md for indexes.
- **Heading hierarchy.** # Exposé N. <English Title>, then ## 1. <Section Title>, then ### <Subsection> if needed. The Exposé heading carries a <!-- label: N --> comment on the next line.
- **Statement blocks.** **Proposition.***, **Lemma.***, **Theorem.***, **Corollary.***, **Definition.***, **Remark.***, **Example.*** on their own line. The label <!-- label: N.X.Y --> follows on the next line (after a blank line). The body begins after another blank line.
- **Math.** Unicode math wrapped in backticks for inline. Displayed math in fenced ```text blocks. Numbered displayed equations get a <!-- label: eq:N.X.Y --> comment immediately after the closing fence.
- **Footnotes.** Markdown [^slug] syntax. The footnote body goes at the end of the section (or end of file). Original Grothendieck-era footnotes: [^<exposenum>-<sec>-<n>] slugs (e.g. [^I-1-1]). Editor footnotes: [^N.D.E– < expose > – < n >]

(e.g. $[^N.D.E - IV - 2]$).

- **Page marks.** <!-- original page N --> on its own line at page boundaries.
- **Cross-references.** Use the source's own convention: (VIII 2.3), (EGA III 4.1.5), (SGA 4 IV 3.8).
- **Bibliographies.** Each Exposé's own bibliography section, at its end, is preserved as a ## Bibliography section with entries as a numbered list, journal titles in italics, with the original keys (e.g. [1], [2]) preserved as leading bracketed labels.

Index of notation

A reference index of notation used throughout SGA 2. Locators are of the form <Exposé Roman>.<section>(<sub>>) or < *ExposRoman* > (p. < page >).

Notation	Where introduced
$\Gamma_Z, \Gamma Z$ (sheafified)	I.1
$i^!, i_!$	I.1
$Z_{Z,X}$	I.1.6
$H_Z^i(X, F), \mathcal{H}_Z^i(F)$ (sheafified)	I.2
$H_J^i(M), H^i((f), M), H^i(M)$	IV.5.4, V.2 (p. 50)
Ass M, Supp M, Ann M, $r(a)$	III.1.1
$prof_I(M), prof_Y(F)$	III.2.3, III.2.8
Ab (the category of abelian groups)	IV.1 (p. 33)
$\text{Hom}_\bullet(F_\bullet, G_\bullet)$ (complex of homomorphisms)	V.1.1
$Ext_Z^i(X; F, G), \mathcal{E}xt_Z^i(F, G)$ (sheafified)	VI.1.1
$\hat{E}t(X), L(Z)$	X (p. 89)
$Le f(X, Y), Le ff(X, Y)$	X.2 (p. 90)
$P(X)$ (Picard functor), $\text{Pic}(X)$ (Picard group)	XI (p. 99)
$\Pi_i^x(X)$ (local homotopy groups)	XIII (p. 146)
$D^+(X)$ (derived category)	XIV.1.0
$prof_Y(F) \geq n$	XIV.1.2
$prof_Y^L(X) \geq n$ (depth with respect to a set of primes L)	XIV.1.2
$prof_Y^{\acute{e}t}(X)$ (étale depth)	XIV.1.2
L (a set of prime numbers)	XIV.1.2
$prof_x(F) \geq n$	XIV.1.7
$prof_x^L(X) \geq n$	XIV.1.7
$prof_x^{hopL}(X) \geq 3$	XIV.1.7
$prof_x^{\acute{e}t}(X)$	XIV.1.7
$\delta_t(x), \delta(n)$	XIV.2.1
$H_{Z!}^i(X/S, F)$	XIV.4.0

Terminological index

A reference index of terminology used throughout SGA 2. Locators are of the form <Exposé Roman>.<section>(<sub>>) or < *ExposRoman* > (p. < page >).

Term	Where introduced
Auslander–Buchsbaum theorem	XI.3.13
comparison theorem	IX.1.1, XII.2.1
local duality theorem	V.2.1
projective duality theorem	XII.1.1
injective envelope	IV (p. 41)
excision theorem	I.2.2, VI.1.3
existence theorem	IX.2.1, XII.3.1
essential extension	IV (p. 41)
finiteness theorem	VIII.2.1, XII.1.5
dualizing functor	IV.4.1, IV.4.2
residue form	IV.5.5
geometrically factorial (resp. geom. parafactorial) local ring	XIII (pp. 20, 24)
local homotopy groups	XIII (p. 146)
Gysin homomorphism	I (p. 14)
Hartshorne theorem	III.3.6
Lefschetz condition	X.2 (p. 90)
effective Lefschetz condition	X.2 (p. 90)
affine Lefschetz theorem	XIV.3.1
dualizing module	IV.4.1
orthogonal of a submodule	IV.5
parafactorial pair of preschemes	XI.3.1
parafactorial local ring	XI.3.2
depth	III.2.3
étale depth	XIV.1.2
geometrical depth of a noetherian local ring	XIV.5.3
homotopical depth	XIII.6, Def. 1 (p. 154)
homotopical depth (with respect to L)	XIV.1.2
rectified homotopical depth	XIII, Def. 2 (p. 155)
pure local ring	X.3.2
pure pair of preschemes	X.3.1
Zariski–Nagata purity theorem	X.3.4
cohomological purity theorem	XIV.1.11
M -regular	III.2.1
Samuel conjecture	XI.3.14
cohomological semi-purity theorem	XIV.1.10
strictly local ring	XIII.6 (p. 151)